

Joachim of Fiore and the Influence of Inspiration

ESSAYS IN MEMORY OF
MARJORIE E. REEVES (1905–2003)



Edited by
Julia Eva Wannenmacher

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*Brenda Bolton, Anne J. Duggan, and
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About the volume

Joachim of Fiore and the Influence of Inspiration: Essays in Memory of Marjorie E. Reeves (1905–2003) is a title that is deliberately reminiscent of the title of Marjorie Reeves's *opus magnum*: her book *The Influence of Prophecy in the Later Middle Ages* has been fundamental in the field of Joachimist studies from its publication in 1969 right up to the present.

The present volume is inspired both by Joachim of Fiore's lasting influence, which can be found in many places from the early thirteenth century until postmodern times, and by Marjorie Reeves's unsurpassed scholarly achievements and her inspiring personality. British, Continental and American scholars of several generations, from different academic disciplines, follow the paths she has opened, try to answer questions she was the first to ask, offer new insights and new texts in state of the art

editions, immersing themselves deeply into materials Marjorie Reeves provided us with in the field of Joachimism and the influence of prophecy.

The volume is divided into three parts. In the first, the studies shed new light on different aspects of Joachim of Fiore's life and work. The second and third parts are dedicated to Joachim's afterlife – with the contemporary and late medieval reception of Joachim's thought in the Iberian Peninsula, England, and Provence, and then on Joachim's *Wirkungsgeschichte* in early modern England and Germany.

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Marjorie Reeves in April 2003

Joachim of Fiore and the Influence of Inspiration

Essays in Memory of Marjorie E. Reeves (1905–
2003)

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Preface

The essays which follow here are offered in gratitude both to honour the memory of Marjorie E. Reeves (1905–2003) and as a modest tribute to her distinguished lifelong career as scholar and teacher. Although an active contributor to so many fields, much of her research and a great deal of her personal affection were devoted to the life and work of the Calabrian abbot Joachim of Fiore (d. 1202). Indeed, it was our mutual quest for Joachim which initiated a treasured long-distance correspondence between us, eventually culminating in several invitations to Oxford.

On the eve of what was to be my last visit to that famous house in Norham Gardens, I watched with friends a video which Marjorie had made in 1988 in the series *Interviews with Historians*, commissioned by the Institute of Historical Research in London. From her interview with Gillian Lewis, I was surprised to learn that she would soon be celebrating her centenary – news which seemed hard to believe. Although frail, she was full of energy, quick to laugh and talk in spirited fashion, with a vivid interest in her visitors and, as always, she insisted on preparing tea for us, which we drank in her room with its book-lined walls, looking out over her beloved springtime garden. The frontispiece photograph in this volume was taken on this same April afternoon when Marjorie was a mere 97 years old. Not many days later, we ventured to dream of a Centenary volume on Joachim of Fiore to which all Joachites, young and old, could contribute, not only those who had benefited from Marjorie Reeves's scholarly achievements but others, too, who had profited from her generous teaching, advice, and encouragement. And wonderful to relate, scholars from many countries, from across several generations, friends and disciples of both

Marjorie Reeves and Joachim from Fiore, gathered together and consented to write the essays for this volume.

In her long ‘pilgrimage’ with Abbot Joachim,¹ as she herself called it, Marjorie Reeves first discovered, then published, and shared much new and exciting evidence on Joachim of Fiore. She it was who originally compiled a list of Joachim’s *opera*, the authentic and the pseudo-epigraphic,² collating and sorting through the manuscripts in which many of these were preserved.³ But Marjorie’s research focused not only on the historical Joachim and his work but also covered his reception from his own day down to the twentieth century, of which her magisterial and still unsurpassed study *The Influence of Prophecy in the Later Middle Ages* is by no means the sole, but perhaps the most impressive, witness.⁴ Many of the hints which she gives there and elsewhere have still never been followed up, much less have become outdated. Some are pursued in this volume, hence the allusion to inspiration in its title.

Indeed, what is most remarkable about Marjorie Reeves’s research is the crucial influence and important meaning which she attributed to the role of the Holy Spirit, to its gift of spiritual intelligence and to Joachim’s expectation of the spiritual men of the third *status* for the development of his theology of history. No one before or after her has made this clearer. This explains the volume’s title: the *Influence of Inspiration*, referring not only to the inspiration of the Holy Spirit, which she detected and described in Joachim’s work, but also to the inspiration which she herself provided, and still does, for many scholars, both in the study of Joachim of Fiore and his successors, and in the wider field of medieval and early modern history in general. The first is evidenced in more studies than we can possibly think of, the present volume being only the latest to date, the latter being witnessed, for example, in the volume edited by Ann Williams on the occasion of Marjorie Reeves’s retirement in 1980.⁵

For Marjorie’s Centenary, no other gift would have seemed more appropriate than a volume which allows us to express our gratitude for all her inspirational insights into Joachim and his afterlife. The contributors have, therefore, taken some of these issues upon themselves, attempting to answer several of the most thought-provoking questions she raised, and delving more closely into some Joachite circles or texts on which she was the first to shed the light of day. This volume, therefore, while aiming at coherence and consistency in its content, has ended up by producing

contributions of markedly varying lengths. I remain convinced that Marjorie Reeves would have been deeply interested in each and every one and would have relished discussing them with us.

The volume itself divides naturally into three parts. In the first of these, E. Randolph Daniel, Bernard McGinn, Christopher Rowland, Matthias Riedl, and John V. Fleming shed new light on several aspects of Joachim of Fiore's life and work. The second and third parts are dedicated to Joachim's afterlife. In the second part, Fabio Troncarelli, Julia Eva Wannenmacher, and Christoph Egger deal with the contemporary and late medieval reception of Joachim's thought in the different parts of Europe, on the Iberian Peninsula (Fabio Troncarelli) and England (Christoph Egger), while the third part contains three studies by Kathryn Kerby-Fulton, Sabine Schmolinsky, and Anke Holdenried on Joachim's *Wirkungsgeschichte* in early modern England and Germany. The volume was also planned to include a contribution by Matthias Kaup, presenting the first edition of an important Joachite text, but this grew into a book in its own right, and should now appear in effect as a companion volume to the present one.

This was always going to be an ambitious project, but over time it has inevitably suffered some setbacks. Marjorie Reeves's death in December 2003 at the age of ninety-eight and a half, although not unexpected, was nevertheless, still mourned by many. Our gift for her Centenary could from then onwards be only a memorial volume. Family circumstances intervened in the meantime and my daughters, now aged seven and four, join me in apologizing to all the contributors for the delays in bringing the volume to its completed state.

Now, at last, it is ready and my thanks go to John Smedley and his colleagues at Ashgate Publishing who have been more patient and kinder than ever I deserved, as well as to both Series Editors: Brenda M. Bolton, for her never-ending kindness and encouragement, and her spontaneous offer to include this volume into her series, and Damian Smith with his eye for meticulous detail. Grateful thanks go also to Fiona Robb, who most generously read, discussed, and corrected the papers written by the non-native speakers, to Anthony Shepperd, Marjorie Reeves's nephew, who welcomed and encouraged this project, to Günther Hägele and the University Library of Augsburg for permission to use the beautiful Sibyl from the Pamplona Bible, both as cover illustration and in the book itself, to all the contributors, not only for their inspired and inspiring papers, but also

for sharing their memories of Marjorie with me, and for their patience with this long-standing project. Above all, however, we express as best we can our gratitude to the late Marjorie Reeves, to whose affectionate memory this volume is dedicated.

Notes

¹ Marjorie E. Reeves, 'A Sixty-year Pilgrimage with the Abbot Joachim' *Florentia. Bollettino del Centro internazionale di Studi Gioachimiti*, 6 (1992), 7–32.

² Marjorie E. Reeves, *The Influence of Prophecy in the Later Middle Ages: A Study in Joachimism* (Oxford, 1969, repr. London, 1993), 511–35.

³ *Ibid.*, 536–42.

⁴ On Marjorie Reeves's professional career, see in this volume Bernard McGinn, 'In Memory of Marjorie E. Reeves', xvii–xxii.

⁵ Ann Williams (ed.), *Prophecy and Millenarism: Essays in Honour of Marjorie Reeves* (Harlow, 1980).

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Christoph Egger teaches Medieval History at the University of Vienna and the Institut für Österreichische Geschichtsforschung. He specializes in the ecclesiastical and intellectual history of the higher Middle Ages. His publications in this field include: ‘Joachim von Fiore, Rainer von Ponza und die römische Kurie’, in *Gioacchino da Fiore tra Bernardo di Clairvaux e Innocenzo III. Atti del 5° Congresso internazionale di studi gioachimiti* (Rome, 2001), 129–62 and ‘The Growling of the Lion and the Humming of the Fly: Gregory the Great and Innocent III’, in *Pope, Church and City: Essays in Honour of Brenda M. Bolton*, ed. F. Andrews et al., The Medieval Mediterranean 56 (Leiden et al., 2004), 13–46.

John V. Fleming is the Louis W. Fairchild Professor emeritus of English, Professor of Comparative Literature, and Master of Wilson House at Princeton University. He specializes in the fields of medieval English and European literature, medieval art history, and the history of Christian thought and spirituality. Together with the late Marjorie Reeves, he has

published *Two Poems Attributed to Joachim of Fiore* (Princeton, 1978). His most recent publications include ‘The Friars and Medieval English Literature’, in *The Cambridge History of Medieval English Literature*, ed. D. Wallace (Cambridge, 1999).

Anke Holdenried has taught at the University of Leicester, held a Research Fellowship at the Herzog August Bibliothek, Wolfenbüttel, and is now teaching at the University of Bristol. Her research centres on medieval prophecy, in particular the religious and political context of apocalyptic predictions. Recent publications in this field include: *The Sibyl and Her Scribes: Manuscripts and Interpretation of the Latin Sibylla Tiburtina c. 1050–1500* (Farnham, 2006) and ‘Observations on the Reception of Revelation c. 1200–1700: Apocalyptic Prophecy as Refractory Lens’, in *The Book of Revelation and Effective History*, ed. J. Økland and J. Lyons (Sheffield, 2009), 166–85.

Kathryn Kerby-Fulton is Professor of English at Notre Dame University. Together with E. Randolph Daniel, she published ‘English Joachimism, 1300–1500: The Columbinus Prophecy’, in *Il profetismo gioachimita tra Quattrocento e Cinquecento. Atti del Congresso internazionale di studi gioachimiti* (Genoa, 1991), 313–50. Recent publications include: *Books under Suspicion: Censorship and Revelatory Theology in the Literature of Late Medieval England* (Notre Dame, 2006) and “‘The Place of the Apocalyptic View of History in the Later Middle Ages’ and the Legacy of Morton Bloomfield’, in *The Morton W. Bloomfield Lectures on Medieval English Literature*, ed. D. Donoghue et al. (Kalamazoo, 2010).

Bernard McGinn is the Naomi Shenstone Donnelley Professor emeritus at the Divinity School of the University of Chicago. He has written extensively in the areas of Christian mysticism and apocalypticism, of medieval spirituality, and on Joachim of Fiore. Recent publications in the latter fields are: (ed., with John J. Collins and Stephen J. Stein), *The Continuum History of Apocalypticism* (2003) and ‘Aspects of Joachimism in Renaissance Italy’, in *Il ricordo del futuro. Gioacchino da Fiore e il Gioachimismo attraverso la storia*, ed. Fabio Troncarelli (Bari, 2006), 148–52.

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Sabine Schmolinsky is Professor of Medieval History at the University of Erfurt. She specializes in medieval prophecy and millenarianism, concepts of authorship, and the history of religious and political thought. Her publications in this field include: ‘Prophezeite Geschichte und früher Joachitismus in Deutschland. Zur Apokalypsendeutung des Alexander Minorita’, in *Ende und Vollendung. Eschatologische Perspektiven im Mittelalter*, Miscellanea Mediaevalia 29, ed. J.A. Aertsen and M. Pickavé (Berlin and New York, 2001) 525–44 and ‘Im Angesicht der Endzeit? Positionen in den Lectiones memorabiles des Johannes Wolff (1600)’, in *Endzeiten: Eschatologie in den monotheistischen Weltreligionen*, ed. W. Brandes and F. Schmieder (Berlin, 2008), 369–417.

Fabio Troncarelli is Professor of Paleography at the Scuola Superiore di Studi Medievali e Francescani, Pontificio Ateneo Antonianum, at Rome, and at the University of Viterbo. His most recent publications in this field include: *Gioacchino da Fiore. La vita, il pensiero, le opere* (Rome, 2002); ‘Un autografo di Raniero da Ponza’, in *Il ricordo del futuro. Gioacchino da Fiore e il Gioachimismo attraverso la storia*, ed. Fabio Troncarelli (Bari, 2006), 47–53; ‘Dante e Gioacchino da Fiore’, *ibid.*, 106–13, and (together

with Francesco Scarpelli), *Celico città celeste: sulle tracce dell'abate Gioacchino nei luoghi di origine* (San Giovanni in Fiore, 2008).

Julia Eva Wannenmacher teaches Medieval History at Humboldt University/Berlin and is currently Visiting Fellow of IKGF Erlangen/Nuremberg. Recent publications include: *Hermeneutik der Heilsgeschichte. De septem sigillis und das Motiv der sieben Siegel im Werk Joachims von Fiore*, Studies in the History of Christian Tradition 118 (Leiden and Boston, 2005); *Giacomo Greco, Cronologia dell'abate Gioacchino el dell' ordine Florense* (Soveria Mannelli, 2008); 'Apocalypse, Antichrists and the Third Age: Joachim of Fiore's Peaceful Revolution', in, *Ancient Christian Interpretations of 'Violent Texts' in the Apocalypse*, ed. J. Verheyden et al. (Göttingen, 2011), 267–86.

In Memory of Marjorie E. Reeves¹

Bernard McGinn

When Marjorie Reeves died on 28 November 2003, well into her ninety-ninth year, many of us experienced not only sadness, but even a sense of shock. Somehow Marjorie had seemed almost immortal. But every life, no matter how rich and how long, comes to an end. In light of that end it is fitting to try to say a few words about what Marjorie meant for the ‘ancient and honourable company of scholars’ of apocalypticism. Although I knew Marjorie for over three decades, I count myself very much a latecomer in her life, though one filled with gratitude for her friendship and inspiration.

Born 17 July 1905, in Bratton, Wiltshire, Marjorie was a distinguished medievalist and a major figure in British education. She was also perhaps the last living link with a bygone world of Oxford University in the decades before World War II, the world of C.S. Lewis, J.R.R. Tolkien, and their friends and colleagues. Marjorie’s life was a model of the scholarly achievement of women that would have been almost unthinkable prior to the past century. Her maternal family, the Whitakers, resident in Bratton since 1576, had long been concerned with the education of women. Marjorie channelled this commitment into a university career, taking a First in the Honour School of Modern History at St Hugh’s College, Oxford, in 1926, and subsequently a Diploma in Education. After some years as a secondary school teacher, she began graduate work at the University of London.

In 1929, as the result of a chance reading of Emile Gebhardt’s *L’Italie mystique*, she fell in love with Joachim of Fiore, not a fashionable topic in the world of British history, then dominated by what the late Sir Richard

Southern, in an insightful analysis of Marjorie's work published in a Festschrift dedicated to her in 1980, called an 'austerely political' approach.² Marjorie broke with this mould in a daring fashion that may be difficult to appreciate today. In her delightful intellectual autobiographical sketch, 'A Sixty-year Pilgrimage with the Abbot Joachim', she records that one of her contemporaries, on hearing of her dissertation topic, commented: 'That outlandish subject won't assist your career. You should have chosen something like "the Wardrobe under Edward II"'.³ I do not know how many studies have been done recently on the Wardrobe of Edward II, but I doubt that they approach the spate of books and articles on Joachim that continue to pour from the presses in many languages, not least because of the efforts of Marjorie Reeves.

In 1932 Marjorie presented her dissertation on 'Studies in the Reputation and Influence of the Abbot Joachim, chiefly in the Fifteenth and Sixteenth Centuries', written under the supervision of the Italianist Edmund Gardner, with Frederick Maurice Powicke and Canon Claude Jenkins as examiners. Although the young British historian was not the first to turn her attention to the neglected abbot in these years (Herbert Grundmann in Germany and Ernesto Buonaiuti in Italy also recognized Joachim's import), her lifelong contribution to our knowledge of the mysterious Calabrian was second to none.

What enabled the young woman from Bratton to make such a bold move in 1929? Much of her inspiration seems to have come from an intuitive appreciation of the power of the apocalyptic imagination. Marjorie's passion for Joachim (she sometimes humorously referred to him as 'my Joachim') was in large part fuelled by her interest in how apocalyptic symbols helped shape Western history. As she put it in the 1992 article in *Florensia*, 'Joachim's thought forms, based on figural biblical exegesis, are, of course, outmoded, but the poetry of his vision transcends that intellectual framework.'⁴ Marjorie's choice of Joachim as a dissertation topic was an early example of a basic shift in twentieth-century historical scholarship away from political and social history narrowly conceived toward a broader and richer view of history and the deep springs of imagination and states of mind that have shaped human society. Reflecting on those enigmatic prophetic texts and strange images often ascribed to Joachim and known as the *Vaticinia de summis pontificibus*, documents that in 1929 would have been dismissed by many historians as bizarre flights of fantasy, Marjorie

remarked, 'It is through the study of such strange symbols that we can peer into the shadowy recesses of the imagination and come closer to the springs of hopes and fears that underlie the rational mind.'⁵

Let us remember that it was in the very same years between 1929 and 1932 when Marjorie defended her dissertation that two professors at the University of Strasbourg, Lucien Febvre and Marc Bloch, were laying the foundations for what came to be known as the 'Annales School' through the noted journal that began publication in 1929. I would not want to claim that Marjorie was an 'Annaliste'. She eschewed all such labels. But I think that her aim as an historian was in accord with the words that Marc Bloch addressed to his friend and colleague Lucien Febvre in the dedication of his posthumous classic, *The Historian's Craft*: 'Long have we worked together for a wider and more human history.'⁶ Marjorie's contribution to this wider and more human history was to help us gain a better understanding of how (again to cite her own words), '... the prophets of the past who saw the future in terms of the interaction between providential design and human choice are still relevant today in an age of great change'.⁷

The shift to the new vision of history with its wide horizons and imaginative creativity did not mean abandoning the painstaking philological and research skills developed in historical studies during the nineteenth and early twentieth centuries. Rather, it meant using a more ample net to take account of previously neglected evidence, turning to other disciplines, such as art history, for assistance, and creating new research methods that would complement and enrich older approaches. It also meant challenging many of the commonly accepted views of the day. One good example is the early twentieth-century sense of a strong dividing line between the Middle Ages and the Renaissance, something which Marjorie soon realized made little sense, at least in the history of apocalyptic expectations. Marjorie's eventually 70-year pilgrimage with the Abbot Joachim and his followers provides a model for these shifts in the study of history.

Marjorie returned to Oxford in 1938 as Fellow and Tutor in History at the Society of Oxford Home Students, which later became St Anne's College. She was to spend the rest of her life at Oxford. During the late 1930s and 1940s she began to assume a public role in speaking out against the dangers of totalitarianism and in support of the public responsibilities of teachers. Although she always respected her family roots in the Baptist tradition, Marjorie became a member of the Church of England and a communicant

of the church of St Mary the Virgin in Oxford. In 1975 she was the first woman to preach a University Sermon at Oxford, setting forth the case that the purpose of a degree must be the pursuit of truth and the discovery of value, not a ticket to a highly paid position.

During World War II Marjorie was one of the small group who kept alive the Oxford Faculty of Modern History. After the war she became more and more active in educational circles, serving on the Central Advisory Council of the Ministry of Education and also on the Robbins Committee on Higher Education. She wrote numerous influential papers and several books on educational issues. She was also instrumental in the transformation of the Society of Oxford Home Students into St Anne's College. Marjorie served as Vice-Principal of St Anne's from 1951 to 1962 and again from 1964 to 1967, introducing important innovations into the college organization and curriculum. Marjorie's contributions to teaching extended beyond higher education. She encouraged innovation in history textbooks through the collection she edited for Longman's, called the 'Then and There' series, writing a number of the volumes herself. She lectured widely on educational issues, not only in Britain, but around the world.

When Marjorie first began to work on the Abbot Joachim she found herself immersed in a world of largely unstudied manuscripts, obscure early printed editions, and the records of forgotten prophets. It took two decades of hard work, work often impeded by the shadow of the growing totalitarianism in Europe and the tragedy of World War II, before she was ready to begin to make her research available to the world. Two crucial events in her research curriculum are worthy of note. During World War II, following the suggestions of Otto Pächt and Fritz Saxl, Marjorie recognized that an Oxford manuscript was actually a copy of the long lost *Liber figurarum* associated with the name of Joachim in a number of sources. It was only after the war that the independent discovery in 1939 of another manuscript of the *Liber* by Monsignor Leone Tondelli came to her attention. Marjorie later collaborated with Mgr Tondelli and Beatrice Hirsch-Reich in the publication of a facsimile edition of the work in 1953. The second event was the research trip she took to Italy in 1950. Her extensive work in Italian libraries and manuscript collection helped her realize the wealth of resources available to trace the history of prophecy in the Middle Ages and Renaissance. Describing that visit, she later said, 'In effect, a whole new

field of cultural history was opening up before our eyes but in the early nineteen-fifties not many scholars were working on it.’⁸

During the 1950s Marjorie published a series of ground-breaking articles that put Joachim scholarship on a new foundation. These original forays into the bewildering complexities of Joachim and Joachimism eventually saw fruit in her magnum opus, *The Influence of Prophecy in the Late Middle Ages: A Study in Joachimism*, first published in 1969. This remarkable work remains a monument of twentieth-century medieval studies. With impressive and wide-ranging learning, and her own independent perspective, Marjorie’s book revealed a whole new dimension of late medieval and early modern religious history. It was largely through this work that the Calabrian seer emerged in contemporary scholarship as one of the most influential thinkers of the Middle Ages.

Marjorie’s reputation as the master of Joachim studies was enhanced by the appearance in 1972 of the book she produced with Beatrice Hirsch-Reich on *The Figurae of Joachim of Fiore*. Her decades of studying the abbot’s difficult prose helped Marjorie grasp that the key to Joachim’s potent vision of the meaning of history was best revealed in the strange diagrams, or *figurae*, that the abbot had laboured on during his life. She described her first study of the images as ‘a unique experience’, in which ‘one felt the presence of a seer whose “eyes of the imagination” ... saw deeply into the spiritual forces at work in history.’⁹ Her publications on the *figurae*, both in the magisterial volume of 1972, as well as in a number of other essays, have spurred much further research. Marjorie continued to write on Joachim of Fiore for the remainder of her life, producing both popular works (*Joachim and the Prophetic Future* in 1976) and, along with Warwick Gould, a major study of the late impact of the abbot, *Joachim of Fiore and the Myth of the Eternal Evangel in the Nineteenth Century* (1987). In 1992 she edited a collection of essays on *Prophetic Rome in the High Renaissance Period*, showing how the study of Joachim and his heritage necessarily embraced both the Middle Ages and the Renaissance.

In 1974 Marjorie retired as Senior History Tutor at St Anne’s, but this scarcely reduced her activities. Younger scholars who wrote to her always received enthusiastic answers; those who sought her out in Oxford were always given a warm welcome. Many awards came to Marjorie in the three decades of her retirement. Not the least appreciated was her being declared an honorary citizen of the Calabrian town of San Giovanni in Fiore,

Joachim's own city and the site of the Centro internazionale di Studi Gioachimiti, which she had strongly supported from the time of its foundation in the late 1970s. Marjorie was a revered figure at the International Congresses held by the Centro at San Giovanni every four years, beginning in 1979.

Marjorie's enthusiasm for Joachim burned bright to the very end of her life. On 25 March 2003, a large gathering at the Accademia dei Licei in Rome marked the opening of the 'Anno Gioachimitico', a year of events to commemorate the eight hundredth anniversary of the abbot's death. By all rights, Marjorie should have given the inaugural discourse, but her fragile health prevented that, so I was invited to deliver an address on 'Joachim of Fiore in the History of European Culture'. When my wife and I had our last visit with Marjorie which fortuitously coincided with her ninety-eighth birthday, I gave her a copy of the talk. Just a few days before the announcement of her death, I received a typically generous letter from her commenting on my essay. I would like to quote a passage from that letter, because (for me at least) it expresses Marjorie's personal warmth and unfailing enthusiasm for Joachim. She says:

I am writing this on Sunday November 2 [2003] when we have celebrated the All Saints Feast. Of course the second lesson was the passage I almost know by heart: 'Then I saw a new heaven and new earth... And I saw the holy city, the New Jerusalem, coming down...' (Rev. 21). And of course it immediately brought into my imagination Joachim's *figura* of events of the third *status*. I have always found this one of the most striking of the *figurae* because its concept of the transformed society includes not only the monastic community but the 'sheepdogs' of the lay clergy and the life of the committed lay society. Alas – how far it is from most of the concepts of third millennium society today. I sit here and wonder whether medieval images can ever again appeal to the modern imagination. But then I remember the continuing appeal of icons, ancient and modern ... Well, I'd better stop.

Marjorie's living voice may have stopped, but not the spiritual voice found in her writings. It will be heard by all those who will read and profit from her exemplary and original scholarship in years to come.

Notes

¹ Some parts of this essay appeared as a Memorial Notice in *Speculum. A Journal of Medieval Studies*, 79 (2004), 891–3.

² Richard Southern, 'Marjorie Reeves as an Historian', *Prophecy and Millenarianism: Essays in Honour of Marjorie Reeves*, ed. Ann Williams (Harlow, 1980), 4.

³ Marjorie Reeves, 'A Sixty-year Pilgrimage with the Abbot Joachim', *Florentia*, 6 (1992), 7–8.

⁴ *Ibid.*, 32.

⁵ Ibid., 23.

⁶ Marc Bloch, *The Historians Craft* (New York, 1964), v.

⁷ Reeves, 'A Sixty-year Pilgrimage' 32.

⁸ Ibid., 19.

⁹ Ibid., 13.

PART I

Perspectives on Joachim of Fiore's
Life and Work

Chapter 1

Joachim's Unnoticed Pattern of History: The Second *Diffinitio*

E. Randolph Daniel

The first *diffinitio* is symbolized by the Greek letter *alpha* which letter is shaped like a triangle. The second *diffinitio* is symbolized by the Greek letter *omega* in which letter a single twig proceeds upward from the union of two twigs. Both of these *diffinitiones* need to be known because both pertain fully to the catholic faith.¹

Joachim's first pattern is the familiar division of history into three *status*, which *status* correspond respectively to the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit as well as to the three orders, the married laity, the clergy, and the monks. Joachim envisioned the *alpha* as an equilateral triangle and saw this same shape in the psaltery, a triangular stringed instrument, with a hole in the middle. For Joachim the top of the triangle denoted the Father, the left-hand corner the Son, and the right-hand corner the Holy Spirit. Hence the line from the top to the left corner designated the generation of the Son by the Father. The line from the top to the right corner symbolized the procession of the Holy Spirit from the Father, and the bottom line denoted the procession of the Holy Spirit from the Son. Thus the *prima diffinitio* showed how two persons came from one. The top of the triangle also connoted the married laics, the left corner the clergy, and the right one the monks, showing that two orders came from one. Each *status* had a preliminary or initiatory phase, a period of flowering and finally one of decline. The root of the first *status* was Adam, its flowering began with

Abraham, and its end came with Joseph, Mary's husband. The second had its root in Uzziah [*Ozias*], flowered from Jesus and would end with the forty-second generation after Jesus. The third *status* had two roots, reflecting the double procession of the Holy Spirit, the first root from Elijah and the second from Benedict of Nursia, and would flower shortly after the year 1200.²

Joachim conceived the *secunda, diffinitio* as a lower-case *omega*. This letter, he suggested, symbolized two *virgule*, rods or twigs, each of them shaped like the letter 'u'. These two rods merged in the stem that thrust up in the middle of the *omega*. The left-hand rod designated the procession of the Holy Spirit from the Father; the right-hand one denoted the procession of the Spirit from the Son. Hence one person, the Holy Spirit, proceeded from two persons, the Father and the Son. The two rods corresponded to the two *tempora* and to the two peoples, the Jewish and the Gentile, from which would come the spiritual men, the *virī spirituales*. The rods also symbolized the two Testaments, the Old and the New, from which have come the spiritual understanding, *spiritualis intellectus*. The first *tempus* corresponded to the first *status*, extending from Adam to Joseph, and the second *tempus* corresponded to the second *status*. Instead of a third *tempus*, Joachim alluded to a sabbath that was to begin shortly after 1200.³

Before the year 1254 Joachim was best known for his *Concordia* of the Testaments, and as a prophet of Antichrist.⁴ The third *status* of the Holy Spirit first became widely known, indeed became notorious, when the Franciscan Minorite Gerard of Borgo San Donnino made it the central thrust of his *Liber introductorius in Evangelium eternum*, published in 1254 in Paris. According to Gerard, the second *status* was going to end and the third was to begin precisely in the year 1260. An Eternal Gospel made up of the writings of Joachim would replace the Old and New Testaments. A new spiritual church led by the barefoot — that is, the friars — would supersede the clergy and the sacraments.⁵

Antagonism between the friars and the secular faculty at the University of Paris was intense in 1254. The seculars immediately seized on Gerard's *Liber* as proof that the friars should be banned from the university because of their radicalism. Pope Alexander IV ordered a copy of the *Liber* and other of Joachim's works to be brought to Anagni, where a group of commissioners extracted and condemned numerous passages from the *Liber* and from Joachims own works. Pope Alexander condemned Gerard's *Liber*

introductionis on 23 October 1255 but did not condemn Joachim's writings. Florentius, one of the commissioners at Anagni, was disappointed that Alexander had not condemned Joachim's works and, having become archbishop of Arles, called a council there that condemned Joachim's pattern of three *status* and the writings of Joachim in which that pattern was found. Despite the fact that no pope endorsed this provincial council's judgement, the stigma of heterodox radicalism became widely attached to Joachim's first definition.⁶

Twentieth-century scholarship has concentrated almost exclusively on this first pattern, debating whether Joachim was orthodox or a radical who anticipated Hegel and modern revolutionaries.⁷ Was Joachim's Trinitarian doctrine tritheist, and did the third *status* of the Holy Spirit really represent a radical break from the present clerical *status*?⁸

The twentieth-century Catholic scholars Marie-Dominique Chenu, Henri Cardinal de Lubac, and Yves Congar focused virtually exclusively on the *prima diffinitio*, understood it as radical, and made 'a consistent and on the whole negative appraisal of Joachim's third *status*'.⁹ Antonio Crocco tried to defend the orthodoxy of the *status* of the Holy Spirit.¹⁰ Henri Mottu, a Protestant, interpreted the *status* of the Holy Spirit as 'the moment when the word "revolution" came to have its modern political meaning' instead of its traditional astronomical meaning.¹¹ Later, Mottu drastically moderated his interpretation of the *tertius status* but it remained his primary concern.¹² Bernhard Töpfer, a Marxist scholar from the German Democratic Republic, saw the *status* of the Holy Spirit as a new age, *Zeitalter*, which would be an idyllic era of peace in sharp contrast to the present age.¹³

The late Delno West and Sandra Zimdars-Swartz made a significant contribution to the study of both definitions by emphasizing the centrality of Joachim's interpretation of Ezekiel's vision of the living creatures and the wheels (Ezek. 1:4–21) in the structuring both of his works and of his thought, but the first pattern dominated their thinking.¹⁴ Stephen E. Wessley's Joachim was a *novus Benedictus* whom God had chosen to found a religious order that in the coming new *status* would place Joachim and Benedict himself on the same plane. Wessley emphasized the *prima diffinitio*.¹⁵

Robert Lerner has won a preeminent place among contemporary scholars who have concentrated virtually exclusively on the *prima diffinitio*. Lerner insists that Joachim's third *status* derived from the tradition that there would

be a period of time on earth after the annihilation of the Antichrist for the rest of the saints. This tradition stemmed from Jerome, who, commenting on the book of Daniel, came to the passage where Daniel predicted that the ‘abomination that desolates’ will reign for 1295 days, but then added that ‘happy are those who persevere and attain the 1335 days’ (Dan. 12:11b—12). Jerome suggested that those extra 45 days might be a time of silence during which period the elect might be tested.¹⁶ Later, this brief space came to be interpreted as a time of rest and some commentators added to it another extra period of undefined length. Lerner argues that Joachim developed his third *status* directly from this ‘refreshment of the saints’.¹⁷

According to the tradition, the ‘refreshment of the saints’ must follow the annihilation of the Antichrist. Joachim discussed the antichrists and Antichrist extensively, but the most comprehensible text is tav. XIV of the *Liber figurarum* that depicts a dragon with seven heads and a tail. The caption to the seventh head reads: ‘Here is the seventh king who is properly called antichrist, although another exists similar to him and equally malicious who is designated in the tail.’¹⁸ Because the period of ‘refreshment’ has to follow the annihilation of Antichrist, Lerner insists that the Antichrist must be Joachim’s seventh head, not the tail.¹⁹

According to Lerner, Joachim’s interpretation of the Apocalypse as referring sequentially to key events from Jesus to the end of history led Joachim ‘across the border into the forbidden territory of millennialism or chiliasm’ so that Joachim came to foretell ‘a future millennial kingdom on earth’. Thus he ‘[contravened] the Augustinian position’ and ‘[teetered] on the edge of heresy’.²⁰ Lerner’s Joachim was a millennialist whose third *status* was to be a new earthly phenomenon. Lerner reaffirmed his thesis in his recent book on Joachim, Joachimism and the Jews.²¹

Bernard McGinn has also been a dominant figure in Joachim research over the last 25 years. He, too, has emphasized the *prima diffinitio* but has consistently recognized that the *secunda diffinitio* must be considered in any effort to interpret the totality of Joachim’s thought.²²

Joachim saw himself neither as a visionary nor as a seer of the future. God had given him, he believed, the key to a spiritual understanding of the scriptures that went farther than previous understandings and that was urgently needed in the light of the looming crisis.²³ Joachim in the first four books of his *Liber de Concordia* composed a prolegomenon to his commentaries on the scriptures.²⁴ His plan was to comment on all those

books of the Scriptures that were customarily commented upon using the spiritual senses — that is, the histories, the prophets, the gospels, Acts, and the Apocalypse. In Book Five of the *Liber de Concordia* Joachim commented on the Hebrew Scriptures, focusing chiefly on the histories from Abraham to the return from Babylon. The unfinished *Tractatus super quatuor Evangelia* was the beginning of a commentary on a harmony of the four gospels. The *Expositio in Apocalypsim* was the crown of this exegetical corpus. The fifth book of the *Liber de Concordia* had covered the outer wheel, that is, the histories from Genesis to Ezra and Nehemiah. The *Expositio* covered the inner wheel, the history of the church from Jesus to the end of history and the advent of eternity.²⁵

Joachim used the concords between the generations from Abraham to Joseph and from Jesus to the year 1200 as the structural framework on which to build both *diffinitiones*. Joachim followed Augustine's model, the Genealogy of Jesus from the Gospel of Matthew (Matt. 1:1–17), who counted 42 generations from Abraham to Joseph and divided them into three groups, 14 from Abraham to David, 14 from David to the exile to Babylon, and another 14 from the exile to Joseph. To these Joachim added the 20 from Luke (Luke 3:23–38) that led from Abraham back to Adam. Augustine divided these 62 generations into five *etates* between Adam and the incarnation. The sixth *etas* began with Jesus and would endure until the end of history. The seventh *etas*, which corresponded to the seventh day of creation week, was the *etas* of those elect souls who had died and had gone to heaven. The eighth day denoted the eternity after the Last Judgement and the final resurrection. Joachim not only borrowed from Augustine the structural framework for the *Concordia* but also the seven *etates*, the foundation on which he built the other patterns.²⁶ Joachim's *De ultimis tribulationibus* argued that the seven *etates* denoted periods when God's peoples were being persecuted but also sabbath-like eras of peace. The first of these followed the return from Babylon and the cessation of prophecy among the Hebrew people. The second sabbath would follow after the persecutions by the sixth and seventh heads of the dragon and just as King Antiochus IV Epiphanes interrupted the sabbath of the Hebrews, so, too, Gog and Magog, the dragon's tail, will interrupt this Christian sabbath.²⁷

First Joachim laid out the concords.²⁸ Then he explained the first *prima diffinitio*. His explication culminated in a figure depicting three circles, each circle corresponding to a *status*. Each circle contained three smaller circles

narrating three exoduses. The first exodus belonged to the sons of Israel who were delivered from Egypt and who conquered the Promised Land. The second exodus included the deliverance of the apostles from the synagogue and their conquest of the Gentiles. The third exodus would belong to the spiritual men, who would leave the world for the harsher life and would enter into the peace about which the prophets had spoken.²⁹

Joachim's exposition of the *secunda diffinitio* began in the final three chapters of Book Two, where he enumerated the generations from Adam to Zorobabel, a leader in the return from Babylon to Jerusalem. The parallel generations ran from King Uzziah of Judah (725–697 BC) to the forty-second generation after Jesus. First Joachim enumerated the concords between the persecutions suffered by the Hebrew and the Christian peoples.³⁰ Then he fitted the seven seals and their seven openings into the *secunda diffinitio*. Joachim allotted the first four openings six generations each, a total of 24. These openings, therefore, covered the years down to the year 720. Joachim gave the fifth opening 16 generations so that it began during the Carolingian era and was going to end in Joachim's own fortieth generation, namely the years 1170–1200. The sixth opening in generation 41 would include twin persecutions. The seventh opening, a sabbath, would follow under the forty-second generation.³¹

However, the true meaning of the *secunda diffinitio* emerged only when Joachim laid out the history of the Hebrew and the Christian peoples individual generation by individual generation. Here the history of Judah from king Josiah (639–609 BC) to the Babylonian exile concorded with the history of the papacy since the year 1049. Pope Leo IX (1049–54), who began the Gregorian reform but suffered defeat at the hands of Robert Guiscard, stood in concord with Josiah who had initiated a reform in Jerusalem after the discovery of a fresh copy of the Torah (usually thought to be Deuteronomy) but then perished in combat against the Egyptian pharaoh Necho II (610–595 BC). During the ensuing generations the Babylonians conquered Judah and exiled most of the leading people to Babylonia. Likewise, the Latin Christians since Pope Leo IX were going into a figurative exile in Babylon, because Babylon symbolized all that corruption that the Gregorian reformers were striving to eradicate but which was flourishing even more than before Leo IX's pontificate.³² Joachim argued that during the exile Judith had averted an Assyrian persecution by cutting off Holofernes' head and that Queen Esther successfully frustrated

Haman's plan to persecute the Jews in the Persian Empire.³³ Under the forty-first generation, beginning in the year 1200, the sixth and seventh heads of the dragon would attack and purify the exiled church.³⁴

Finally, Cyrus II the Persian (559–530 BC) permitted the Jews to return to Jerusalem under the leadership of Zorobabel. After the return to Jerusalem, prophecy and the writing of history ceased and a sabbath ensued. In the thirteenth century after the defeat of the seventh head, the new 'Zorobabel' would be a pope whom Joachim identified with the angel of the sixth seal. This pope's preaching would reform the Christian religion and initiate the sabbath of the second *tempus*.³⁵ Finally, just as Antiochus IV Epiphanes in the second century before Christ had persecuted the people of Judah, Gog would come near the end of the second sabbath and inaugurate the usual end-time scenario.³⁶

Joachim's *secunda diffinitio* was clearly reformist. Joachim utilized the two *tempora* to interpret the historical trends since Leo IX. All papal efforts had failed to reform the clergy and create a holier Christendom. Instead of reforming the Christian world, the papacy was usurping the legal jurisdiction and military duties that rightly belonged to the emperors.³⁷ In common with his contemporaries Bernard of Clairvaux, Gerhoch of Reichersberg, and Hildegard of Bingen, Joachim longed for God to reform the church truly and completely. To Joachim, the concords demonstrated that such a reform would soon come to pass under the leadership of a truly reformed pope.³⁸

Space makes it impossible to lay out the role of the *secunda diffinitio* in the *Liber figurarum* except very generally. The tree figures immediately before their tops [tav. I, II, IV] all enumerate the popes from Leo IX to Alexander III (d. 1181) or Celestine III (1191–98). The tops are labelled the Holy Spirit, Jesus Christ, or Christus and are associated with the return of Elijah. Tavola X refers both to the symbolic Babylon and to the restoration of the church. The Trinitarian circles (tav. Xia–Xib) set out graphically both the *prima* and the *secunda diffinitiones*. Tav. XXII depicts two vines, representing the Jewish and Gentile peoples, that intertwine to form three circles and is usually interpreted as a representation of the three *status*. However, because it deals with the two peoples from whom the flowers emerge, it probably reflects the two *tempora* and the sabbath during which time the spiritual men would flourish in the reformed church.³⁹

The structure of the *Expositio in Apocalypsim* derived from the seven openings that Joachim laid out in the third book of the *Liber de Concordia*. The fifth opening had begun with the Carolingians and would end about 1200, to be followed by the sixth when the church would be exiled in Babylon until the twin persecutions broke the back of the ‘new Babylonians’ and reform would ensue.⁴⁰

Marjorie Reeves in her *The Influence of Prophecy* deserves recognition as the first scholar to point to the *secunda diffinitio*.⁴¹ She devoted more attention to this pattern in her book *Joachim of Fiore and the Prophetic Future*.⁴² She remained convinced that the *secunda diffinitio* showed that Joachim’s theology of history was not millennial but organic and evolutionary.

In the Congress of Joachimist Studies at San Giovanni in Fiore in 1999, Kurt-Victor Selge forcefully argued that Joachim was a church reformer in the same camp as Bernard of Clairvaux and Gerhoch of Reichersberg and that he was an Augustinian, not a chiliast.⁴³ The *secunda diffinitio*, the pattern of the two *tempora*, was the core of this Augustinian reformer who founded the Order of Fiore. This pattern is the one that drew the parallel between the final days of the kingdom of Judah and the era of papal reform. This pattern emphasized the ‘Babylonian Exile’, as well as the dual persecutors and the reforming pope whose preaching would reform the church.

The *secunda diffinitio* also played a key role in Joachimism. Some years ago I suggested that Bonaventure had turned to the second pattern in his *Collationes in Hexaemeron* in 1273.⁴⁴ Peter Olivi knew Joachim’s *Liber de Concordia* and his *Expositio in Apocalypsim*. Olivi’s seven *status ecclesie* are in my opinion clearly based on Joachim’s seven openings of the seals. Olivi’s long fifth *status* corresponds clearly to Joachim’s fifth opening, to give one example.⁴⁵

The third *status* of the Holy Spirit may have been Joachim’s most original contribution to apocalyptic thought, but the too long neglected second definition is the foundation of Joachim’s thinking, the key to understanding his position among his contemporaries, and a key element in Joachimism. Marjorie Reeves first pointed out the *omega* pattern. This chapter has sought to build on her insights.

Notes

¹ Joachim of Fiore, *Liber de Concordia noui ac ueteris testamenti: Books 1–4*, lib. ii, pars. 1, cap. 11, ed. E. Randolph Daniel, Transactions of the American Philosophical Society, vol. 73, part 8 (Philadelphia, 1983), 80 (Venice, 1519, repr. Frankfurt/Main, 1964), fol. 10rb: ‘Prima diffinitio designatur in A quo est elementum triangulatum. Secunda designatur in w in quo una uirgula de medio duarum procedit. Utrumque ergo sciri oportuit quia utrumque plenarie pertinent ad catholicam fidem’. The literal translation of *diffinitio* is ‘definition’ but I do not find that translation satisfactory and have sometimes used pattern or scheme. A number of my articles that are cited in this book are published in E. Randolph Daniel, *Abbot Joachim of Fiore and Joachimism: Selected Articles* (Farnham, 2011).

² Joachim of Fiore, *Liber de Concordia*, 2:1:9–10 and table seven, 74–9, 173–8, fol. 9rb–10rb, 38ra–b. An English translation of [chapters 2](#) through 12 of the first part of the second book of the *Liber de Concordia* can be found in Bernard McGinn, *Apocalyptic Spirituality. Treatises and Letters of Lactantius, Adso of Montier-en-Der, Joachim of Fiore, the Franciscan Spirituals, Savonarola* (New York, 1979), 120–34.

³ Joachim of Fiore, *Liber de Concordia*, 2:1:8, 4:1:45, 72–3, 402–3, fol. 9ra–b, 56rb–va. On these two *diffinitiones*, see E. Randolph Daniel, ‘The Double Procession of the Holy Spirit in Joachim’s Understanding of History’, *Speculum*, 55 (1980), 469–83, repr. in id., *Abbot Joachim*, II.

⁴ Marjorie Reeves, *The Influence of Prophecy in the Later Middle Ages: A Study in Joachimism* (Oxford, 1969, repr. Notre Dame, 1993), 37–44. See also Morton Bloomfield and Marjorie Reeves, ‘The Penetration of Joachimism into Northern Europe’, *Speculum*, 43 (1954), 772–93, repr. in *Joachim of Fiore in Christian Thought*, 2 vols, ed. Delno C. West (New York, 1975), i, 107–28.

⁵ Reeves, *Influence*, 59–60.

⁶ Reeves, *Influence*, 60–62; Heinrich Denifle, ‘Das Evangelium aeternum und die Commission zu Anagni’, *Archiv für Literatur- und Kirchengeschichte des Mittelalters*, 1 (1885), 49–142; Luigi Verardi, *Gioacchino da Fiore: Il Protocollo di Anagni* (Cosenza, 1992). Both Denifle and Verardi contain editions of the Protocol. Fabio Troncarelli has explored the work of the Anagni commission thoroughly in his two articles: ‘Fiorenzo D’Acre e la condanna di Gioacchino da Fiore’, *Frate Francesco*, n.s. 68 (2002), 111–35; ‘“Ke la malonta va don Dé”. Herneis le Romanceur, Bartolomeo Guiscolo e lo scandolo dell’*Evangelium Aeternum*’, *Quaderni medievali*, 51 (2001), 6–34.

⁷ Gregory La Piana, ‘Joachim of Flora: A Critical Survey’, *Speculum*, 7 (1932), 257–82, repr. in *Joachim of Fiore in Christian Thought*, i, 3–28, surveyed scholarship on Joachim through the 1920s. Morton Bloomfield, ‘Joachim of Flora: A Critical Survey of His Canon, Teachings, Sources, Biography, and Influence’, *Traditio*, 13 (1957), 249–311, repr. in *Joachim of Fiore in Christian Thought*, ii, 29–91, was an outstanding and thorough survey of the issues and the literature down into the middle of the 1950s. Morton W. Bloomfield, ‘Recent Scholarship on Joachim of Fiore and His Influence’, in *Prophecy and Millenarianism: Essays in Honour of Marjorie Reeves*, ed. Ann Williams (Harlow, 1980), 21–52, was useful mostly for its bibliography.

⁸ Herbert Grundmann, Ernst Benz, and Ernesto Buonaiuti were the leading figures in research on Joachim during the period between 1920 and 1960. See, for example, Herbert Grundmann, *Studien über Joachim von Floris* (Leipzig and Berlin, 1927, repr. Stuttgart, 1975), id., ‘Lex und Sacramentum bei Joachim von Fiore’, *Miscellanea mediaevalia* (Berlin, 1969), repr. in Herbert Grundmann, *Ausgewählte Aufsätze. Teil 2: Joachim von Fiore*, MGH Schriften, Bd. 25,2 (Stuttgart, 1977), 403–20; Ernst Benz, *Ecclesia Spiritualis: Kirchenidee und Geschichtstheologie der franziskanischen Reformation* (Stuttgart, 1964), 3–48; id., *Evolution and Christian Hope: Man’s Concept of the Future from the Early Fathers to Teilhard de Chardin*, trans. by Heinz G. Frank (Garden City, NY, 1968), 35–48; Ernesto Buonaiuti, *Gioacchino da Fiore: I tempi, La Vita, Il Messaggio* (Rome, 1931, repr. Cosenza, 1984).

⁹ Bernard McGinn, ‘Joachim of Fiore’s *tertius status*: Some Theological Appraisals’, in *L’età dello Spirito e la fine dei tempi in Gioacchino da Fiore e nel Gioachimismo medievale. Atti del 2°*

Congresso internazionale di studi gioachimiti, San Giovanni in Fiore — Luzzi — Celico, 6–9 settembre 1984, ed. Antonio Crocco (San Giovanni in Fiore, 1986), 234, repr. in Bernard McGinn, *Apocalypticism in the Western Tradition* (Aldershot, 1994), X.

¹⁰ Antonio Crocco, *Gioacchino da Fiore: La più singolare ed affascinante figura del medioevo cristiano* (Naples, 1960).

¹¹ Henri Mottu, *La Manifestation de L'Esprit selon Joachim de Fiore* (Neuchâtel and Paris, 1977), E. Randolph Daniel, 'Joachim of Fiore and Medieval Apocalypticism: Some Current Research', *Medievalia et Humanistica*, n.s. 14 (1986), 173–88. The quotation is from 181–2.

¹² Daniel, 'Current Research', 182; Henri Mottu, 'Joachim de Fiore et Hegel. Apocalyptique biblique et philosophie de l'histoire', in *Storia e messaggio in Gioacchino da Fiore. Atti del I Congresso internazionale di studi gioachimiti, San Giovanni in Fiore, 19–23 settembre 1979* (San Giovanni in Fiore, 1980), 153–75; id., 'La mémoire du futur: Signification de l'Ancien Testament dans la pensée de Joachim de Fiore', in *L'età dello Spirito*, 13–28.

¹³ Bernhard Töpfer, *Die Entwicklung chiliastischer Zukunftserwartungen im Hochmittelalter* (Berlin, 1960), 48–103. Töpfer wrote: 'Bei ihm (Joachim) kristallisieren sich jene Erwartungen eines kommenden Idealzustandes zu dem umfassenden und eindrucksvollen Bild eines in Kürze anbrechenden neuen und grundsätzlich andersgearteten Zeitalters, das gegenüber den davor liegenden Zeiten klar abgegrenzt ist und das bis zu einem gewissen Grade als eine notwendige und organische Fortentwicklung des bisherigen Geschehens aufgefasst wird.'

¹⁴ Delno C. West and Sandra Zimdars-Swartz, *Joachim of Fiore: A Study in Spiritual Perception and History* (Bloomington, IN, 1983); Daniel, 'Current Research', 174–7.

¹⁵ Stephen E. Wessley, *Joachim of Fiore and Monastic Reform* (New York, 1990).

¹⁶ Jerome, *Commentaria in Danielelem*, ed. R. Glorie, CCSL 75A, 943–4.

¹⁷ Robert E. Lerner, 'Refreshment of the Saints. The Time after Antichrist as a Station for Earthly Progress in Medieval Thought', *Traditio*, 32 (1976), 97–144. Lerner's articles on Joachim have been collected and published in an Italian translation in Robert E. Lerner, *Refrigerio dei santi: Gioacchino da Fiore e l'escatologia medievale* (Rome, 1995). My review of *Refrigerio* and of Lerner's articles is entitled 'Joachim of Fiore: New Editions and Studies', *Cristianesimo nella storia*, 21 (2000), 675–85.

¹⁸ Joachim of Fiore, *Liber figurarum*, in *Il libro delle figure*, ed. Leone Tondelli, Marjorie Reeves, and Beatrice Hirsch-Reich, 2 vols (Turin, 1953), ii. The second volume in which the *Liber* is edited was reprinted in 1990 for the Centro internazionale di studi gioachimiti. The caption reads: 'Hic est septimus rex qui proprie dicitur antichristus, quamuis sit alius similes, nec minor eo in malitia designatus in cauda' (trans. mine). This figure with a translation of the text is in McGinn, *Apocalyptic Spirituality*, 135–41. See also Marjorie Reeves and Beatrice Hirsch-Reich, *The Figurae of Joachim of Fiore*, Oxford-Warburg Studies (Oxford, 1972), 146–52.

¹⁹ Robert E. Lerner, 'Antichrists and Antichrist in Joachim of Fiore', *Speculum*, 60 (1985), 553–70.

²⁰ Robert E. Lerner, 'Ecstatic Dissent', *Speculum*, 67 (1992), 33–57, at 40; see also id., 'Joachim of Fiore's Breakthrough to Chiliasm', *Cristianesimo nella storia*, 6 (1985), 489–512.

²¹ Robert E. Lerner, *The Feast of Saint Abraham: Medieval Millenarians and the Jews* (Philadelphia, 2001), 12–22. Bernard McGinn affirmed Lerner's argument in his *Antichrist: Two Thousand Years of the Human Fascination with Evil* (New York, 1994), 136–7. On *The Feast of Saint Abraham*, see Marjorie Reeves's review in *Journal of Theological Studies*, 52 (2001), 941–3.

²² McGinn, *Apocalyptic Spirituality*, 97–117; id., *Visions of the End: Apocalyptic Traditions in the Middle Ages*, Columbia Records of Civilization Series XCVI (New York, 1979, rev. paperback edn, 1998), 126–41; id., *The Calabrian Abbot: Joachim of Fiore in the History of Western Thought* (New York, 1985); id., *Antichrist*, 135–42, id., 'Ratio and Visio: Reflections on Joachim of Fiore's Place in Twelfth-century Theology', in *Gioacchino da Fiore tra Bernardo di Clairvaux e Innocenzo III. Atti*

del 5° Congresso internazionale di studi gioachimiti, *San Giovanni in Fiore, 16–21 settembre 1999*, ed. Roberto Rusconi (Rome, 2001), 27–46; id., ‘Alter Moyses: The Role of Bernard of Clairvaux in the Thought of Joachim of Fiore’, in *Bernardus magister: Papers presented at the nonacentenary celebration of the birth of Saint Bernard of Clairvaux*, ed. John R. Sommerfeldt (Kalamazoo, 1990), 429–48, repr. in McGinn, *Apocalypticism*, XI.

²³ See, for example, Joachim of Fiore, *Liber de Concordia*, Praepatio, 7–18, fol. 2ra–3vb, or for Joachim’s answer to Adam of Perseigne, see in this volume 145–78. On Joachim’s idea of his *intelligentia spiritualis*, see also Gian Luca Potestà, ‘“Intelligentia scripturarum” und Kritik des Prophetismus bei Joachim von Fiore’, in *Neue Richtungen in der hoch- und spätmittelalterlichen Bibelexegese* (Munich, 1996), 95–119.

²⁴ Joachim of Fiore, *Liber de Concordia*, xxiii. I have argued that lib. i was composed before 1186 and never revised. Effectively, Joachim began the prolegomenon with lib. ii (ibid., xxvii).

²⁵ Joachim of Fiore, *Tractatus super quattuor Evangelia*, ed. F. Santi, *Joachim abbas Florentis Opera Omnia V*, Fonti per la storia dell’Italia medievale (Rome, 2002), id., *Expositio in Apocalypsim* (Venice, 1527, repr. Frankfurt/Main, 1964); id., *Liber de Concordia*, xxii–xxiv.

²⁶ Augustine, *Concerning the City of God against the Pagans*, lib. xxii, cap. 30, trans. by Henry Bettenson (New York, 1972), 1091; Joachim of Fiore, *Liber de Concordia*, lib. ii, pars i, cap. 12, 81, fol. 10va.

²⁷ E. Randolph Daniel, ‘Abbot Joachim of Fiore: The *De ultimis tribulationibus*’, in *Prophecy and Millenarism*, 165–89, repr. in id., *Abbot Joachim*, III. That edition of the text has been superseded by a new one edited by Kurt-Victor Selge, ‘Ein Traktat Joachims von Fiore über die Drangsale der Endzeit: *De ultimis tribulationibus*’, *Florentia*, 7 (1993), 7–35. The seven *etates* are clearly indicated in *Liber figurarum*, tav. XVIIIa and XVIIIb.

²⁸ Joachim of Fiore, *Liber de Concordia*, lib. ii, pars I, cap. 13–24, tables 1–2, 82–106, fol. 10va–13va.

²⁹ Joachim of Fiore, *Liber de Concordia*, lib. ii, pars i, cap. 25 — lib. ii, pars ii, cap. 9, figs 1–2, tables 3–7, 107–84, fol. 13va–23rb. The three circles are figure 2.

³⁰ Joachim of Fiore, *Liber de Concordia*, lib. ii, pars ii, cap. 10–12, table 8, 185–98, fol. 23rb–25rb.

³¹ Joachim of Fiore, *Liber de Concordia*, lib. iii, partes i–ii, 208–306, fol. 25rb–42ra. According to Joachim, the pattern of the seven seals corresponds to the vision of the throne and the four living creatures in Rev. 4:6b–8.

³² Joachim of Fiore, *Liber de Concordia*, lib. iv, pars i, cap. 39, 390–94, fol. 54ra–55ra. This chapter is a commentary on Lamentations in which Joachim laid out the failings of the clergy and the monks.

³³ Joachim of Fiore, *Liber de Concordia*, lib. iv, pars i, cap. 40, 395–8, fol. 55ra–vb.

³⁴ Joachim of Fiore, *Liber de Concordia*, lib. iv, pars i, cap. 43, 400, fol. 55vb–56ra.

³⁵ Joachim of Fiore, *Liber de Concordia*, lib. iv, pars i, cap. 44–45, 401–3, fol. 56ra–va.

³⁶ Joachim of Fiore, *Liber de Concordia*, lib. iv, pars i, cap. 28–46, 373–404, fol. 51rb–56va.

³⁷ On Joachim’s position towards papacy and emperors, see Herbert Grundmann, ‘Kirchenfreiheit und Kaisermacht um 1190 in der Sicht Joachims von Fiore’, *Deutsches Archiv für Erforschung des Mittelalters*, 19 (1963), 353–96, repr. in id., *Auswählte Aufsätze*, ii, 361–402.

³⁸ For a fuller discussion of Joachim and the reformists, see E. Randolph Daniel, ‘Exodus and Exile: Joachim of Fiore’s Apocalyptic Scenario’, in *Last Things: Death and the Apocalypse in the Middle Ages*, ed. Caroline Walker Bynum and Paul Freedman (Philadelphia, 2000), 124–39; id., ‘A New Understanding of Joachim: the Concords, the Exile, and the Exodus’, in *Gioacchino da Fiore tra Bernardo di Clairvaux e Innocenzo III*, 209–22, repr. in id., *Abbot Joachim*, V; id., ‘Abbot Joachim of Fiore and the Conversion of the Jews’, in *Friars and Jews in the Middle Ages and*

Renaissance, ed. Steven J. McMichael and Susan E. Myers (Leiden and Boston, 2004), 1–21, repr. in id., *Abbot Joachim*, VI.

³⁹ Joachim of Fiore, *Liber Figurarum*. In my opinion, the figures seem to come from Joachim himself with only minor alterations, although a disciple probably was responsible for the order of the figures in the collection.

⁴⁰ Joachim of Fiore, *Expositio*, pars 6, fol. 191va–198va; id., *Liber introductorius*, cap. 6, *Expositio*, fol. 4rb–9ra. The comparable chapter in the version of the *Liber introductorius* called the *Enchiridion super Apocalypsim*, ed. Edward K. Burger (Toronto, 1986), begins at 754 on 32 but soon diverges sharply.

⁴¹ Reeves, *Influence*, 16–27.

⁴² Marjorie Reeves, *Joachim of Fiore and the Prophetic Future* (London, 1976, 2nd rev. edn Stroud, Gloucestershire, 1999), 1–22; ead., ‘The Originality and Influence of Joachim of Fiore’, *Traditio*, 36 (1980), 269–316, at 287–97, repr. in ead., *The Prophetic Sense of History in Medieval and Renaissance Europe* (Aldershot, 1999), IV.

⁴³ Kurt-Victor Selge, ‘Trinität, Millennium, Apokalypse im Denken Joachims von Fiore’, in *Gioacchino da Fiore tra Bernardo di Clairvaux e Innocenzo III*, 47–69; cf. Julia Eva Wannenmacher, ‘Die Macht des Bösen. Zur Rolle und Bedeutung des Antichristen in der Eschatologie Joachims von Fiore’, *Florentia*, 13/14 (1999–2000), 365–78, at 374–5.

⁴⁴ E. Randolph Daniel, ‘St. Bonaventure’s Debt to Joachim’, in *Medievalia et Humanistica*, n.s. 11 (1982), 61–75, repr. in id., *Abbot Joachim*, XIV.

⁴⁵ For recent studies on Olivi that emphasize his debt to the *prima diffinitio*, see David Burr, *Olivi’s Peaceable Kingdom: A Reading of the Apocalypse Commentary* (Philadelphia, 1993); Kevin Madigan, *Olivi and the Interpretation of Matthew in the High Middle Ages* (Notre Dame, 2003).

Chapter 2

Joachim of Fiore and the Twelfth-century Papacy

Bernard McGinn

In his last address, given on the morning of his death in 1968, Thomas Merton compared Marxist and monastic perspectives on change. He recognized that monks and the Marxist students who were so active in the 1960s shared critical attitudes toward the contemporary world and its structures, but he insisted: ‘The difference between the monk and the Marxist is fundamental insofar as the Marxist view of change is oriented to the change of substructures, economic substructures, and the monk is seeking to change man’s consciousness.’ Reflecting on the fact that the monk still lives on the earth, Merton observed that ‘The monk belongs to the world, but the world belongs to him insofar as he has dedicated himself totally to liberation from it in order to liberate it.’¹

From its early beginnings in the fourth century monasticism had a divided attitude toward economic and political power, as suggested by Merton’s remarks. The early monks fed the world, but often felt compelled to return to the world to challenge it and to seek to free it from itself. The inner *reformatio* of self that is the goal of monastic practice flowed over into a desire for *reformatio ecclesiae*. Sometimes monks went on to try to reform the world, too, on the basis of models of a better state of life.² The paradox of monastic fight from, and yet engagement with, the world helps us to understand the significance of the twelfth-century Calabrian abbot and

quintessentially monastic figure, Joachim of Fiore. Specifically, I will argue that the abbot's attitude toward the papacy is a helpful prism for understanding his view of a reform that was both monastic and apocalyptic.

For two hundred years historians have studied the changes that the Western Church and society underwent in the 'long' twelfth century that stretched from 1073, the accession of Gregory VII to the throne of Peter, until 1216 and the death of Innocent III. Many of these changes were what today we would call geopolitical in scope. During this time the papacy was transformed from a largely local institution to the central agency of ecclesiastical governance, the arbiter of religious reform, and a major political power. In the same years the German Empire, the predominant political entity in the mid-eleventh century, became embroiled with the papacy in two lengthy struggles over the leadership of Christendom. The empire also was increasingly challenged by the growing might of the nascent European kingdoms, especially France, England, and the Norman kingdom of Sicily – realms the popes turned to for support in their struggles against the emperors. These internal developments within Christendom were matched by external expansion through campaigns of conquest and colonization that were a mixture of religion and politics. The most famous of these were the series of invasions of Muslim territories which, while successful in recapturing Sicily and Spain, were to prove an eventual failure in the Holy Land. Although many interests and forces converged in the crusading movement, the crusades were essentially the foreign policy of the reformed papacy.

Other developments of the long twelfth century focused on the religious life of the church – its structures, beliefs, and practices. There were important reforms in the monastic life, especially the great success of the Cistercian order. There was also a revival of the canonical life and a growing thirst for the *vita apostolica*, viewed as an imitation of the poverty and preaching of the apostles. The spreading desire for the apostolic life challenged the conception of the monastic way of life as the acme of Christian living. Closely tied to the apostolic ideal (historians still dispute about the exact relations) was the growth of heresy, which often began from criticism of the failings of the clergy, but also spilled over into attacks on the church in general, its sacraments and beliefs. Finally, both theology and church law became systematized and professionalized during the long twelfth century.

Joachim of Fiore (c.1135–1202) was a witness to these challenging developments. A monastic reformer, he was convinced that the cloistered life was not in any way superseded, but was actually the germ of a new age in world history – the dawning *tertius status*, the Age of the Holy Spirit. Although Joachim withdrew to the isolation of the high Sila plateau to found his new Florentian order, he often came down from the mountains to meet with the ecclesiastical and political leaders of the day – a series of late twelfth-century popes and such rulers as Richard the Lionhearted of England, William II of Sicily, the Emperor Henry VI, his wife Constance, and the young Frederick II. Obviously, it is not possible to investigate all aspects of Joachim's life and views here, but by focusing on his relation to the papacy and papal politics during the last decades of the 1100s, we can uncover something of the fascination of his personality and the complexity of his views.

In order to frame the originality of the abbot's attitude toward the papacy, some brief background remarks will be helpful. In the year 492 Pope Gelasius, writing to the Byzantine Emperor Anastasius, expressed a formulation of how two great powers share the governance of Christian society: 'Two there are, August Emperor, by which this world is chiefly ruled, the sacred authority of the priesthood and the royal power. Of these the responsibility of the priests is more weighty insofar as they will answer for the kings of men themselves at the divine judgement ...'.³ Six centuries later Gregory VII, the major figure in the papal reform movement, sounded a different note in a letter of 1081 written to Bishop Hermann of Metz, defending his view of papal authority:

Who is not aware of the voice of our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ saying in the Gospel, 'You are Peter and on this rock I shall build my Church ... And I shall give you the keys of the kingdom of heaven, so that whatever you bind on earth will be bound in heaven and whatever you loose on earth will be loosed in heaven' [Matt. 16:18–19]. Surely kings are not excepted here; or do they not belong to the sheep the Son of God committed to St. Peter?... Is he to whom the power of opening and closing heaven has been given, not permitted to judge the earth?⁴

Gregory and the other leaders of the Reform movement fought under the banner of *libertas ecclesiae*, the freedom of the church from domination by the laity. Writing to Bishop Altmann of Passau, he said: 'We hold it to be far nobler to fight on for a long time for the freedom of Holy Church than to sink into a miserable and slavish servitude.'⁵ However, as the historian Gerd

Tellenbach noted, 'Freedom has always been regarded as at the bottom something indefinite and relative, and this was particularly so in the middle ages; it is both dignity and humility, possibility and bondage, lordship and dependence.'⁶

Gregory VII died defeated and in exile, but his immediate successors generally adhered to his new and radical understanding of papal monarchy. The compromise between the claims of papacy and empire worked out between Callixtus II and Emperor Henry v at Worms in 1122, however, saw a shift back to a more dualistic, or Gelasian, view of the relation of the two great powers of Christendom. The programmes of the later twelfth-century popes and their advisors, especially the College of Cardinals whom the Reform movement had made the central agency of the papal court, show a tension and oscillation between the Gelasian and Gregorian understandings of the papacy down to the accession of Innocent III in 1198.⁷

Most early medieval German emperors had thought of themselves as theocratic rulers of Christendom, with the pope serving as their chief ecclesiastical agent. In the wake of the agreement at Worms, some emperors seemed to have accepted a more dualistic view, but the accession of Frederick I Barbarossa to the throne in 1152 marked a return to attempts to achieve dominance. Frederick, the first emperor to use the term *sacrum imperium* extensively in his decrees and letters, expressed his responsibility for both church and empire clearly in a letter from the beginning of his reign: 'By our careful application the Catholic Church should be adorned by the privileges of its dignity, and the majesty of the Roman Empire should be reformed, by God's help, to the original strength of its excellence.'⁸ After clashing with Pope Hadrian IV, Frederick took advantage of a split in the College of Cardinals to reject the election of Alexander III in 1159 and plunge the church into schism. For almost two decades (1159–77) a protracted conflict ensued between Pope Alexander and Barbarossa. Worn down but not defeated, Frederick finally sued for peace and a ceasefire was patched up at Venice in 1177 where Frederick recognized Alexander as true pope.⁹

Many issues were not resolved at the Peace of Venice, so that after Alexander's death in 1181 his successors struggled to chart a safe course for the papacy in the final decade of Barbarossa's life and the beginning years of his successor, Henry VI. During this time the curia contained some members who sought to come to an accord with the German Empire and

others who resisted imperial claims. The five popes between 1181 and 1198 can be seen as interim figures – aged men who sought to do their best in a difficult time. Four of the five had been members of Alexander's entourage and thus tried to find ways to conciliate Barbarossa, but another group in the curia continued to advocate military resistance. The plight of the papacy grew more perilous when Henry VI married Constance, the aunt of William II of Sicily, in 1186. William died childless in 1189, and Barbarossa died on crusade in 1190. Henry now claimed both the empire and the kingdom of Sicily – the great fear of the anti-imperialists, the *unio regni ad imperium*, was now a reality. Henry conquered Sicily in 1194, the same year that Constance produced his heir, the future Frederick II. It looked as if Christendom might revert back to the situation before Gregory VII with the empire dominating the papacy. But too many changes had taken place for this to happen, and accidents also influence history. Henry VI died of fever in 1197. Three months later the changed political situation prompted the cardinals to elect as pope the able young cardinal Lothario Segni, who took the name Innocent III. Pope Innocent inherited the most favourable political situation of any pontiff for more than a century and his reign can be seen as the acme of the political influence of the medieval papacy.¹⁰

Joachim was born in Celico about 1135, the son of a notary.¹¹ As a young man he served as a chancery official in the Sicilian court, but a pilgrimage to the Holy Land, perhaps around 1167, turned him to the religious life. After a time as a wandering hermit, he entered the monastery of Corazzo in 1171. Within a few years he became abbot and worked to have the monastery incorporated into the Cistercian order. In the late 1170s Joachim began writing down the views on history – past, present, and future – that assiduous study of Scripture had begun to reveal to him. In 1183 he travelled to the Cistercian abbey of Casamari south of Rome to pursue the acceptance of Corazzo by the Cistercian order. The 18 months he spent at Casamari marked a turning point in his life. Two visionary experiences he had there spurred him to begin major writing projects to work out the spiritual understanding of the Bible and its message about history that God had revealed to him. Joachim's new theology had a powerful effect on the abbot and community of Casamari. It was doubtless through their influence that the hitherto-obscure abbot came to the attention of the papal court.

In May 1184 Joachim was invited to the court of Pope Lucius III, then at nearby Veroli, to interpret a mysterious Sibylline prophecy found in the

papers of a recently deceased cardinal. Joachim's short treatise *De prophetia ignota* marks the abbot's entry on the stage of papal politics.¹² Lucius was sufficiently impressed to encourage the abbot to continue setting forth his views in the three works he had begun at Casamari: the *Liber de Concordia*, which lays out his distinctive mode of biblical interpretation; the commentary on the Psalms called the *Psalterium decem chordarum*, and a long treatment of the Apocalypse, the *Expositio in Apocalypsim*. Not long after meeting with Joachim, Lucius left for northern Italy to meet with Barbarossa at Verona. The pope and the emperor were able to agree on two important issues: support for a new crusading effort to counter the threat to the kingdom of Jerusalem and a joint effort to halt the spread of heresy. Other issues remained unsettled. When Lucius III died, he was succeeded by a foe of Barbarossa, the archbishop of Milan, who took the name Urban III. Although Urban's policies were different from those of Lucius, he too continued papal favour for Joachim. It is likely that Joachim visited him at Verona in 1186.

The following brief pontificate of Gregory VIII in 1187 was taken up with plans for a new crusade, now grown more pressing in the light of the fall of Jerusalem to Saladin. The final two popes of this interim time – Clement III (1187–91) and Celestine III (1191–98) – sought to accommodate the empire where possible in the interests of supporting the crusade, but the threat found in the union of Sicily and Germany under Henry VI remained an important issue.¹³ Both popes continued to favour, and quite likely to consult, the increasingly famous Joachim.

Joachim's career from 1186 until his death in 1202 presents a good example of the paradox of a monastic whose desire for separation from the world was inextricably tied to an important role in public events. The abbot's fame as a prophet of things to come made him something of an authority for many who sought to unravel the meaning of the dramatic conflicts of the time: papacy vs. empire; Muslim vs. Christian; heresy vs. orthodoxy. Joachim himself was not hesitant to proclaim his message to those ready to hear him. In the winter of 1191 Richard I of England, stopping over in Messina before sailing on to the Holy Land, asked the abbot to expound his views on the seven-headed dragon of Apocalypse 12, hoping to gain insight into the outcome of his crusading venture. According to some chronicle accounts, Joachim predicted a successful outcome for

Richard's venture and also made startling claims about the future of the papacy.¹⁴

In the late 1180s Joachim gradually began to abandon his Cistercian commitment, leaving Corazzo for monastic retreats where he could spend more time on his writing. In late 1189 he first went to the Sila to explore a possible site for a new monastery. As the author of an anonymous contemporary *Vita* puts it: 'It pleased him to ascend the mountain of the Sila and there, although in the coldest high hills, to seek a spot where the monks could still dwell in some fashion.'¹⁵ By 1190 Joachim's main residence was in this remote location, though the distance did not prevent him from descending the mountain of contemplation to meet with a succession of important political leaders. Although Joachim had been condemned as a renegade by the Cistercian General Chapter in 1192, he continued to have strong papal support, as witnessed by the letter of 25 August 1196, in which Celestine III approved the new Florentine order headquartered in San Giovanni.

As death drew near for the abbot of Fiore, he reaffirmed his desire for papal approbation for his writings in the Testament he prefixed to his works. The letter begins: 'Brother Joachim, called Abbot of Fiore, wishes eternal salvation in the Lord to all to whom this letter may be shown. As can be known from the letters of the former Pope Clement that we have, and from the orders of Pope Lucius and Pope Urban, I have composed certain works and I am still writing to the extent that this labor recommends itself to the glory of God and the profit of readers.' Joachim submitted his writings to the Apostolic See for correction and final approval. 'I have always been prepared,' he wrote, 'to hold what it commanded or will command. I would defend no view of mine against its holy faith, fully believing what it believes, receiving its correction in morals as well as in doctrine, rejecting whom it rejects, accepting whom it accepts, and firmly believing that the gates of hell will not prevail against it.'¹⁶

The influence of Joachim's views on the popes and papal curia during his lifetime and immediately after is evident from an unlikely source. Since Innocent III oversaw the Fourth Lateran Council of 1215, it was long supposed that the council's condemnation of Joachim's attack on Peter Lombard demonstrated that Innocent, unlike his predecessors, was opposed to the abbot's views.¹⁷ The picture appears more complicated. Joachim may not have had the same personal contact with Innocent that he had with

earlier popes,¹⁸ but recent research has shown that not only were associates of Joachim, like Rainier of Ponza and Gerald of Casamari, part of Innocent's inner circle,¹⁹ but that the Pope himself had apparently read Joachim and used his ideas in a number of letters and sermons.²⁰ In late 1204 and early 1205 Innocent turned to Joachim's vision of history to make sense of the unexpected conquest of Constantinople as a sign of the coming end, though he seems later to have abandoned this view.²¹ It is even possible that the condemnation of Joachim at IV Lateran, since it specifically singles out only the abbot's attack on the Lombard as worthy of condemnation, sparing his person, represents a compromise worked out between Innocent and Joachim's foes.²²

What did these popes hope for from Joachim? As men of their time, they certainly believed in God's power to convey messages about the future through visions, prophecies, and the gift of scriptural interpretation. How far they would have allowed such messages to influence their day-to-day decisions cannot be known. What we can know is what Joachim wanted to tell the popes about the role of the papacy in his own troubled times. The abbot of Fiore took a strong stance on how present popes should react to the crises of the day; he also did not shrink from making predictions, at least veiled ones, about the future of the papacy and the church.

In order to understand the Abbot Joachim's view of the role of the papacy, it is necessary to grasp the main lines of his theory of salvation history. The relation between the two great eras of God's dealing with humanity, the time of the Old Testament and that of the new, first appears to have attracted Joachim's attention in the mid-1170s. His earliest surviving writing, dating from 1176, is a brief exploration of the parallels between events of the Old Testament and those in the history of the church – parallels that he was later to call *concordiae*.²³ Though there were some precedents for this approach, Joachim's intensive exploration of how the events of the Old Testament provide paradigms for what will happen in the time of the new was the first of his major innovations. In the later *Liberde Concordia*, where he perfected this technique of letter-to-letter comparisons, he summarized it this way: 'We will better show forth new things if we carefully investigate the old.'²⁴

It seems to have been during the time he spent at Casamari, partly as a result of the visions he experienced there, that Joachim made a second and even greater discovery – the Trinitarian structure of history.²⁵ The Calabrian

abbot has come down to posterity as the progenitor of the three-age view of sacred history, according to which the time of the Old Testament is ascribed to the Father, the time of the new Testament to the Son, and a coming third age will belong to the Holy Spirit. But Joachim's view of how God had revealed the meaning of history (*ratio ordinis*) in the Bible is far too subtle and complicated to be compressed into any one single pattern.²⁶ What he called the 'first definition' (*prima diffinitio*), illustrated by the three-sided Greek *alpha*, the structure of three interlocking eras relating to the three persons of the Trinity, cannot be separated from the *secunda diffinitio*, the Greek Omega, according to which the two times of the Old Testament and of the new give rise to the spiritual understanding of both testaments given by the Holy Spirit. Both patterns contain elements that are traditional, along with applications that are novel and challenging. These patterns form the foundation for the intricate exegesis and number symbolism that express Joachim's theology of history.

In order to understand what Joachim had to say to the popes of his time and why they were ready to listen to him, it will be helpful to reflect on two essential aspects of the abbot's thought: first, Joachim as a monastic reformer; and second, Joachim as an apocalyptic prophet. Despite his interest in political events as evidenced in his concern for the parallels between rulers and events in the Old and the new Testaments, Joachim believed that the true meaning of history was within, not outside, the soul. It was rooted in interior reformation achieved through growth of the spiritual understanding of the Bible as the foundation for a life of contemplation. The lay state that manifested the person of the Father and the clerical life that portrayed the Son were to find their culmination in the monastic life that expressed the Holy Spirit, proceeding from both Father and Son, and therefore present, at least in germ, both in the time of the Old Testament and of the New. Joachim saw the triumph of the monastic life in the Cistercian order, especially in its leader Bernard of Clairvaux, as the first dawn of the monastic utopia to come.²⁷ But the Cistercian order was only a stepping-stone, one that Joachim himself abandoned in expectation of the better monasticism of the future.²⁸ Unlike previous monastic reformers, Joachim did not strive to refashion the fallen world according to a contemporary monastic model of poverty, virtue, and peace. Like the apocalyptic thinkers of early Christianity, he believed that the coming transmutation

(*transmigratio*) would be the work of God, not of man, and its form would be a divinely given new and higher type of monastic life.

This apocalyptic perspective is the second key to Joachim's distinctive message. The apocalyptic view of history has always been a mixture of pessimism and optimism – pessimism about the current state of affairs in which the forces of evil press ever more strongly against the elect, along with optimism about imminent divine intervention to reward the just for their suffering in an earthly millennial state. Joachim's reinvention of apocalyptic theology conforms to this model.

How did the abbot view the role of the papacy from his reformist apocalyptic perspective? Joachim's view of the papacy, that is, the papacy of the second *status* of history, was Gregorian, and not Gelasian, in terms of the broad models sketched above.²⁹ Like Bernard of Clairvaux and Innocent III, he saw Melchisedech, both priest and king, as the Old Testament prototype of the popes.³⁰ Following Augustine, who held that political domination was a result of Adam's Fall,³¹ the abbot of Fiore rejected sacral authorization for the imperial office. Divine predestination makes use of good rulers to help further its plan; bad rulers are also part of the grand design, but only for purposes of chastisement of the elect lest they be tempted to pride and self-confidence. Kingship as such has no special claim of relation to God. Joachim was convinced, however, that the concords between the persecutions inflicted on God's people by the rulers of Old Testament times and the current sufferings of the church revealed how to conduct oneself in the present and what to expect for the future.

Joachim's concern to interpret the relation of popes and emperors in light of God's plan for history is evident from his earliest writings. In the *Genealogia* of 1176, and the somewhat later diagrams he made to illustrate it, we find lists of popes and emperors aligned by generation to help determine the connection between contemporary events and the seven persecutions to come before Judgement Day. Joachim was already experimenting with the prophetic import of such calculations: 'Since at this time forty generations have already been completed from Christ's nativity, that is, 1176 years, there are only two generations left, that is sixty years, or twice thirty, in which what is said about Antichrist and the end of the world must be fulfilled.'³² Joachim's earliest study of the papacy's place in history reflects on how the concords of matching persecutions in Old and new Testaments convey the message that contemporary popes should not resort

to arms in their struggles against the emperors, but should accept their God-given role as suffering servant. Like Gregory VII and Bernard, Joachim was a proponent of papal supremacy, but his view of papal ‘fullness of power’ (*plenitudo potestatis*) was based on humility and suffering, not on intervention in the world of power politics.³³

Joachim advanced this programme for the papacy in two of his most interesting short works, treatises designed for the papal curia, as well as in some of his *figurae*, the diagrams he created to explain his complex views³⁴ The *De prophetia ignota* explores the concord of double seven persecutions, showing how the seven trials of the Jews in the Old Testament foreshadowed the seven persecutions of the church. Joachim is most concerned with the last three trials, seeing his own time as that of the fifth persecution, the attack of the Babylonian, that is German, Empire, against the clergy – ‘There remains for us the fifth persecution of that other and more evil Babylon, in which Mother Sion [i.e., the church] will be led into Babylon.’³⁵ Two final persecutions loom – the sixth, that of ten pagan kings who will destroy the German Empire; and the final seventh persecution of Antichrist that will shake the whole church. At no place in his commentary does Joachim counsel resistance to these attacks – the papacy’s mission is not to take up the world’s weapons, but to fight with the spiritual arms of prayer and preaching.³⁶ Trough patient endurance by way of suffering and preaching to the pagan kings the pope of the last time of persecution will bring relief to Christendom, though even he will falter when Antichrist appears. Joachim had already begun to speculate on the role of the papacy in the imminent time of the end in this early treatise.³⁷

The brief treatise called the *Intelligentia super calathis* interprets the meaning of the baskets of good and bad figs that Jeremiah saw at the entrance to the Temple (Jer. 24). Addressed to his critic Geoffrey of Auxerre, Joachim mounts a defence of his method of exegesis by concords and also an explanation of his policy of papal non-resistance to imperial attacks.³⁸ We are not sure when the work was written, but Herbert Grundmann dated it to early 1191 when the newly elected Celestine III was faced with Henry VI’s invasion of Italy.³⁹ A major issue of the treatise is *libertas ecclesiae*, the Gregorian theme; but, unlike Gregory VII, Joachim’s notion of the freedom of the church is essentially one of humility and suffering, not of self-assertion and militancy. For Joachim, the Early

Christian church that had once been typologically equated with Israel had decayed into Egypt, and now into the even worse Babylon.⁴⁰

In this treatise Joachim does not deny that some of the political concessions the papacy made in the past have lessened its freedom, but he insists that taking up the sword at this time would be an even worse loss of freedom, rather than a move in the right direction. Like Peter, the pope must obey Christ who commands, 'Put your sword in its scabbard' (John 18:11). Joachim argues:

You should not fight for the truth in such a manner, but more by prayer and fasting, waiting for help from on high, from him who can provide Christ with more than twelve legions of angels that the Scriptures might be fulfilled ... Leave behind the world and what belongs to the world and you will be free and unbound, building up Jerusalem left desolate not according to that freedom which you had previously, which the king of Babylon could take away from you, but according to that freedom by which you need not fear him nor anyone else.⁴¹

For Joachim, good freedom is based on humility and penance for sin; bad freedom is the work of pride.⁴²

Joachim also discussed the papacy's role in current history in his major works, those which detail the interlocking patterns of *alpha* and *omega* for understanding the course of salvation history. It will not be possible to give more than a sampling of the many passages that concern the role of the throne of Peter here. In the *Liber de Concordia* we can contrast two detailed treatments of the relation of papacy and empire – one of a more pessimistic strain, the other more optimistic.⁴³ Discussing the *omega* pattern of two in Book Four, Joachim constructs a lengthy concordance between the two exiles of the Jews to Babylon in the thirty-sixth through fortieth generations of the Old Testament and the events of the papal history during the matching generations of the new Testament.⁴⁴ In the paired thirty-sixth generation Pope Leo IX, who began the reform movement in 1050, equates with the good king Josiah. Generations 37 through 39 follow the parallels between the kings of Judah and the popes down to Alexander III, with the exile under king Zedekiah announcing the schism between Alexander and Barbarossa. Now, in the fortieth generation, Joachim fears that the peace established between Alexander and the emperor is tottering under Popes Lucius and Urban, a bad portent for the final two generations. Just as the old Babylon was destroyed during these generations, the new Babylon comprising German persecutors and the wicked church sunk in sin and simony will soon face the last two persecutions already sketched out in the

De prophetia ignota. Like the apocalyptic seers of old, Joachim puts the blame for these coming terrors squarely on the sins of the people, saying:

Concerning the critical situation of our time, we have suffered much from the days of Pope Leo and Henry of the Germans. We ought not to pass over in silence what is our own fault. Rather, we ought to set forth with heartfelt groans and sorrow the fact that every word of the prophet Jeremiah's reproach when he numbered the sins of the Jews redounds upon us who call ourselves Christians but are really not.⁴⁵

In chapter 39 Joachim concludes that the church of Peter, made empress of the world in the days of Constantine, is now empty and full of aliens, not sons of the Heavenly Jerusalem but of the earthly Babylon.⁴⁶

In the apocalyptic scenario the course of history is always an intricate mixture of decline and renewal. At the same time that the church descends into the corruption of Babylon there are signs of coming freedom, a new exodus of God's people from Egypt. When Joachim turns back to illustrating the *prima diffinitio*, or three-*status* pattern, in the second part of Book Four of the *Liber de Concordia*, he constructs a concordance of three exoduses to match the three eras of history.⁴⁷ In the exodus of the first *status* Moses and Aaron led the children of Israel forth from Egypt; at the beginning of the second *status* John the Baptist and Jesus led the exodus out of the synagogue. Now the abbot proclaims that an exodus is in process in the monastic life, a journey that will find its completion in the coming *status* of the Holy Spirit and the full triumph of the monastic life in the spiritualized church. At the end of the eleventh century Robert of Molesmes founded the Cistercian order, but the 'new monastery' remained sterile until the arrival of St Bernard. In the spiritual multiplication of the family of Cîteaux, Bernard 'was made like another Moses, who led not so much his sons, as his brothers and brothers' sons out of Egypt because the Lord made him great before Pharaoh.'⁴⁸ Together with 'another Aaron,' that is, Pope Eugene III, he summoned a great multitude to leave Egypt through his preaching of the Second Crusade, but because of their sins they perished in the desert. Bernard was not fated to lead the people into the promised land, but the journey begun in him and in the Cistercian monastic reform would find its successful completion in the coming 'spiritual men' (*virī spirituales*) and the courageous pope of the end of the second *status*.

Given the importance of the papal office in Joachim's theology of history, it is no surprise that from at least the time of the *De prophetia ignota* he believed that a current or coming pope would serve as the spiritual leader at

the time of the persecution of the Antichrist. What may come as more surprising, but is an idea that fits the negative side of his apocalyptic scenario quite well, is the abbot's growing fear that the papacy itself would be infected by Antichrist, the Great Deceiver.⁴⁹ Joachim's suspicions are cautiously expressed in his writings but are nonetheless real. His view of Antichrist, both in collective and individual manifestations, and at the end of the second as well as in the third *status*, resist easy summary. Since Antichrist is the reverse image of Christ, the abbot held that the last enemy of humanity would be an insidious parody of Christ's three offices of king, priest, and prophet.⁵⁰ Hence, Joachim feared that Antichrist, in at least one of his manifestations, would appear as the chief priest of Christendom, that is, a false pope.

According to the English chronicler Roger of Howden, Joachim told Richard I in 1191 that Antichrist had already been born in Rome and that he would attain the Apostolic Chair.⁵¹ (Rome here is a symbol of the evil Babylon–Rome of the present church.) Though this statement goes beyond anything explicitly found in Joachim's writings, it is confirmed by passages in the *Expositio in Apocalypsim* where the abbot not only affirms Antichrist is already born,⁵² but also hints that Antichrist, or at least one of his forerunners or manifestations, will gain the papal office. In another place Joachim says: 'Just as the beast from the sea [Rev. 13:1] is held to be a great king ... who is like Nero and almost emperor of the whole world, so the beast ascending from the earth [Rev. 13:11] is like a great prelate who will be like Simon Magus and like a universal pope of the entire world. He is that Antichrist of whom Paul said that he would be lifted up and opposed to everything that is said to be God [2 Thess. 2:4]'⁵³ Thus, the abbot of Fiore broke with tradition in thinking that the final persecutor of this era was to be born in the West not in the East; a renegade and heretical Christian, not a Jew; more a religious deceiver than an overpowering tyrant.

Joachim's teaching about the apocalyptic destiny of the papacy became even more complex during the last decade of his life, as he sought to correlate his concordist exegesis with the changing politics of the day. Gian-Luca Potestà's recent detailed study of the abbot's life and writings against their historical background provides some answers to old problems,⁵⁴ but much remains unclear about Joachim's concept of the role of the papacy in the imminent crisis of the second *status*, as well as in the contemplative age to come.

The abbot of Fiore never used the term *pastor angelicus*, but his picture of the holy pope who would resist Antichrist through prayer, preaching, and redemptive suffering at the imminent conclusion of the second *status* was important in the development of the apocalyptic dimensions of the papacy in the later Middle Ages. Present in brief treatises like the *De prophetia ignota*, we also find portraits of this suffering pope in the major works. In both the *Expositio in Apocalypsim* and the *Liber de Concordia*, for example, Joachim establishes a concord between the Archangel Michael as defender of the people of Israel (Dan. 12:1) and the *Romanus Pontifex* who remains firm against the onslaught of Antichrist, like Judas Maccabeus in the days of the evil Antiochus.⁵⁵ Joachim's discussion in the *Concordia* also interprets Dan. 12:2–3 as predicting the coming age of contemplation, though he does not talk specifically about a papal role in this era. Given how often Joachim spoke of the pope of the end of the era of the Son, it is puzzling that in one of the abbot's last discussions of the final persecutions of the church, the tract *De ultimis tribulationibus*, there is no reference to the role of the papacy at the time of the persecution of Antichrist.⁵⁶ Should this be read as a sign that Joachim had lost faith in the aging Pope Celestine III's ability to withstand Antichrist at the approach of the fateful year 1200,⁵⁷ or does his silence point to a prudent decision not to speak directly about a prophecy that may have been under attack?

Texts that say nothing about a papal role at the time of Antichrist hint at a more troubling issue regarding Joachim's attitude toward the papacy, one that has been much debated over the past century: Did Joachim think that the papacy was an institution fated to pass away at the dawn of a purely spiritual church (*ecclesia contemplativa*) under the leadership of the *ordo monasticus*? A few passages in the abbot's last major work, the *Tractatus super quatuor evangelia*, seem to suggest this, though their interpretation has been controversial. I cannot give a full answer to this important question here, but any summary of Joachim's view of the papacy cannot avoid considering it.

The role of popes and the papal office in the *tertius status* itself (as against the transition period of the end of the second *status*) is difficult to determine. Joachim was chary of saying much about the age to come, a reticence that does not appear to have detracted from his reputation as a prophet. In a noted passage in the *Liber de Concordia* he announced that a spiritual pope, a *novus dux*, would arise from the Babylon (i.e., the corrupt

church of his own age). This ‘universal pontiff of the new Jerusalem’, foretold in the Apocalypse as the angel ascending from the rising sun with the sign of the living God (Rev. 7:2), ‘will be given full freedom to renew the Christian religion and to preach the word. Then the Lord of Hosts will already begin to reign over the whole earth.’⁵⁸ This figure is obviously papal; but it is not clear how much he belongs to the second age and how much to the third, though the note of renewing the Christian religion points toward the third *status*.

A famous text in the *Tractatus super quatuor evangelia* has been cited to buttress claims that the papacy will not survive in the third *status*. Commenting on Christ’s presentation in the Temple (Luke 2:25–30), Joachim establishes a concord in which the infant John the Baptist ‘signifies Christ with the order of clerics’, while the infant Jesus is ‘the gift of the Holy Spirit with the order of monks’, and the aged Simeon who takes Christ in his arms to bless him ‘designates the prelates of the Roman Church in whom by the grace of God “the promise remains unto the very end” [Heb. 6:11–12].’⁵⁹ The succession of Peter, says Joachim, longs to see the promised gift of the Spirit given to the church in the renewed monastic life signified by the infant Jesus. ‘Tat holy order which the spiritual church births’ will be welcomed by ‘the succession of Peter’ because they recognize that the new order will preach the gospel of the kingdom (Matt. 24:14), which is identical with the *evangelium eternum* foretold by John in the Apocalypse (Rev. 14:6). The new order succeeds the order of prelates in the same way that John the Evangelist succeeded Peter. Joachim expresses this with strong language, though not without ambiguity:

He [the successor of Peter] cannot bewail his dissolution since he knows that he remains [*permanere*] in a better succession. We know that it is not difference in faith but the character of the religious life that allows one order to be designated in a predecessor and another in a successor ... Can someone who sees such fruit to succeed him be sad because a particular perfection fades away in him where a universal perfection follows? no, no, let this be far from Peter’s succession! Let any envy of the perfection of the spiritual order melt away ...⁶⁰

Joachim goes on to note that ‘spiritual prelates and the church of those who live in a spiritual fashion’ will bless and admire the new order. ‘It belongs to the Roman Pontiff, who is the father of all (*qui pater est omnium*), to bless his younger followers and to give the hoped for blessing to all the faithful.’⁶¹

Although Joachim does use the term *dissolutio* here to describe the line of Peter, *successio* is more central to the logic of the passage. The abbot distinguishes between succession in the same form and succession in a better form, that is, a transition, development, or change for the better (*commutantur in melius*: ed. 100.8), in which Peter's succession somehow 'remains' (*permanere*).⁶² This seems to rule out a total disappearance of the papacy in the third age, as some have claimed;⁶³ but it does not clarify what aspects of the papacy will remain in the spiritual era. Two other passages may help gain further insight into what Joachim may have had in mind.

The first of these occurs later in the *Tractatus* in the abbot's exegesis of Luke's passage about the apostles bringing their boats to shore, leaving all things, and following Jesus (Luke 5:11). Joachim says that in order to catch humans rather than fish the apostles do not lose their boats and nets, but 'change them' (*mutavit*). Peter's 'little boat' will come to an end 'when the *status* of the present church will be brought to port at the coming of Elijah.' But Peter is then described, somewhat mysteriously, as transferring into John's boat to participate with him in the final haul of fish. Joachim puts it as follows:

... The other little boat will be restored to the other apostle [John]. In it – I speak to those who already know – Peter together with John will catch those 'large fish' of which it is said, 'Although there were so many, the net was not broken' [John 21:11]. Two little boats are left behind and one is restored, so that when all things have been achieved in oneness 'there will be one flock and one shepherd' [John 10:16].⁶⁴

This passage, which echoes some other texts on the relation of Peter and John in Joachim's writings,⁶⁵ seems to point to a role for a spiritualized papal succession in the Johannine church of the third *status*.

A further hint about such a spiritual papacy may appear in the mysterious leader who stands at the centre of the *figura* labelled the *Dispositio novi ordinis pertinens ad tertium statum ad instar celestis Hierusalem*, Joachim's vivid model of the monastic utopia of the third age.⁶⁶ In the middle of the seven oratories pictured in the diagram stands the 'oratory of the Most Holy Mother of God', which is also ascribed to the dove (symbol of the Holy Spirit), the seat of God, the spirit of counsel (highest of the seven gifts of the Spirit), and the nose among the senses. 'This house', says the inscription, 'will be the mother of all. The spiritual father (*pater spiritualis*) who will be over all will be in it; all will obey his direction and authority.' The spiritual father determines who is fit to move to higher oratories, a task

involving spiritual discretion (perhaps the reason for the nose). To be sure, this *pater spiritualis* is not described as a pope and his duties are purely inner-monastic, not outward and political. While it is impossible to assert unequivocally that the spiritual father is a monastic pope of the age to come, if Joachim really believed, as he claimed, that something of the Petrine office will remain in the *tertius status* in order to work alongside the succession of John in reaping the harvest of souls, the *spiritualis pater* seems a good candidate.⁶⁷

The reform of the papacy during the long twelfth century fundamentally altered European society, elevating the bishop of Rome to a role of religious leadership second to none. Because the Christian view of history is fundamentally teleological in the sense that present events acquire meaning primarily in relation to their final goal, the new position of the papacy called out for apocalyptic validation. What would be the role of the papacy in the last days? The proof of Joachim of Fiore's stature as a major apocalyptic thinker was the fact that he was the first to recognize this. His theology of history put the papacy, not the German Empire, at the centre of world events. The abbot's view of the papacy of the last days, however, was a mixture of good and evil. His ardent hopes for a spiritual pope, a man of prayer and penance who would resist the coming Antichrist, were balanced by his foreboding that the forces of evil, even Antichrist himself, might come to control the throne of Peter and lead the faithful astray at the end of this age of history. But, for Joachim, good must finally win through. When the purgation of the second age will have been completed, Joachim looked forward to a millennial age, however brief. The exact role of the papacy in that age is controversial, but the abbot's faith in the universal historical role of the papacy is evident in a passage that comes at the end of *Expositio* in his comment on the Heavenly Jerusalem (Rev. 21:22). Although the Trinity itself replaces any temple in heaven, it is not so on earth. In the Old Testament, Solomon built a physical temple in which pontiffs and priests taught. 'Much worthier' is that 'ecclesiastical dignity' (*capitulum*) that was established at Rome to replace the ancient temple 'in which and where', says Joachim, 'the Supreme Pontiff bears Christ's place on earth until he comes who is himself the Supreme Pontiff.'⁶⁸

Notes

¹ Thomas Merton, 'Marxism and Monastic Perspectives', in *The Asian Journal of Thomas Merton*, ed. Naomi Burton, Brother Patrick Hart and James Laughlin (New York, 1973), 330 and 341.

² The connection between monastic reform and broader models of reform of Christian society was first laid out by Gerhart B. Ladner, *The Idea of Reform: Its Impact on Christian Thought and Action in the Age of the Fathers* (Cambridge, Mass., 1959).

³ Gelasius I, Letter 12. For a partial translation and comments, see Brian Tierney, *The Crisis of Church and State, 1050–1300* (Englewood Cliffs, NJ, 1964), 13–15.

⁴ Gregory VII, Register VIII.21. For a translation, see Ephraim Emerton, *The Correspondence of Pope Gregory VII. Selected Letters from the Registrum* (New York, 1969), 166–75, at 167–8.

⁵ Gregory VII, Register IX.3 in Emerton, *The Correspondence*, 179.

⁶ Gerd Tellenbach, *Church, State and Christian Society at the Time of the Investiture Controversy* (New York, 1959), 126 (German original 1936).

⁷ Two major histories of the papacy during this period make this clear: Colin Morris, *The Papal Monarchy: The Western Church from 1050 to 1250* (Oxford, 1989) and I.S. Robinson, *The Papacy, 1073–1198: Continuity and Innovation* (Cambridge, 1990).

⁸ Frederick I, Letter of March 1152, cited in Morris, *The Papal Monarchy*, 188.

⁹ Three recent works include chapters which significantly modify older views of this period, such as those found in Morris and Robinson. See *Adrian IV, the English Pope (1154–1159). Studies and Texts*, ed. Brenda Bolton and Anne J. Duggan (Aldershot, 2003); *Pope Celestine III (1191–1198): Diplomat and Pastor*, ed. John Doran and Damian J. Smith (Aldershot, 2007), and *Alexander III (1159–1181): The Art of Survival*, ed. Peter D. Clarke and Anne J. Duggan (Farnham, 2012).

¹⁰ For a recent account of Innocent's papacy, see John C. Moore, *Pope Innocent III (1160/61–1216): To Root Up and to Plant* (Leiden, 2003).

¹¹ The most detailed study of Joachim's career, with abundant detail on his relations to the papacy, is Gian Luca Potestà, *Il Tempo dell'Apocalisse. Vita di Gioacchino da Fiore* (Rome and Bari, 2004).

¹² For an edition and study of this work, see Matthias Kaup, *De prophetia ignota. Eine frühe Schrift Joachims von Fiore*, MGH Studien und Texte 19 (Hannover, 1998).

¹³ Robinson, *The Papacy*, 506–222, highlights the 'ambiguous policy' (513) of Celestine III who tried to negotiate peace with Henry VI at the same time as he supported the emperor's foes in Sicily and beyond. See also Piero Zerbi, *Papato, Impero e 'Respublica Romana' dal 1187 al 1198* (Milan, 1955); Volkert Pfaff, 'Das Papsttum in der Weltpolitik des endenden 12. Jahrhunderts', *Mitteilungen des Instituts für Österreichische Geschichtsforschung*, 82 (1974), 338–76. For a more recent account, see *Pope Celestine III (1191–1198). Diplomat and Pastor*.

¹⁴ Much has been written about the meeting between Joachim and Richard; see, esp., the recent account in Potestà, *Il tempo dell'apocalisse*, 241–4.

¹⁵ From the Anonymous *Vita Joachimi* edited by Herbert Grundmann, 'Zur Biographie Joachims von Fiore und Rainer von Ponza', *Deutsches Archiv für Erforschung des Mittelalters*, 16 (1960), 437–546, at 535, repr. in id., *Ausgewählte Aufsätze*, 2, *Joachim von Fiore*, *Schriften der Monumenta Germaniae Historica* 25/2 (Stuttgart, 1977), 255–360, at 348: 'Placuit igitur ascendere montem Sile et inter frigidissimas licet alpes locum quaerere, in quo possent quomodolibet habitare'.

¹⁶ Joachim's Testament appears as the 'Epistola prologalis' in the *Expositio in Apocalypsim* (Venice, 1527, repr. Frankfurt/Main, 1964), unnumbered folio. For a translation, see Bernard McGinn, *Visions of the End: Apocalyptic Traditions in the Middle Ages* (2nd edn, New York, 1998), 140–41. For a discussion of the context, see Potestà, *Il Tempo dell'Apocalisse*, 356–9.

¹⁷ On the condemnation of Joachim at IV Lateran the most recent treatment is that of Fiona Robb, 'The Fourth Lateran Council's Definition of Trinitarian Orthodoxy', *Journal of Ecclesiastical History*, 48 (1997), 22–43.

¹⁸ Potestà, *Il Tempo dell'Apocalisse*, 360–64, detects some veiled criticisms of Innocent in Joachim's revisions to his last work, the *Tractatus super quatuor evangelia*, but these are at best indirect.

¹⁹ On Rainier of Ponza, the *socius* of Joachim, see the four articles in the section 'Gioacchino da Fiore e Raniero da Ponza', in *Florensia*, 11 (1997), 69–152. On Gerald abbot of Casamari, see Brenda Bolton, 'Gerald of Casamari between Joachim of Fiore and Innocent III', *Florensia*, 13/14 (1999–2000), 31–43. Rainier's only surviving work, a letter to Arnald of Cîteaux, shows the influence of Joachim; see Bruno Griesser, 'Rainer von Fossanova und sein Brief an Abt Arnald von Cîteaux', *Cistercienser Chronik*, 60 (1953), 151–67.

²⁰ See Christoph Egger, 'Joachim von Fiore, Rainer von Ponza und die römische kurie', in *Gioacchino da Fiore tra Bernardo di Clairvaux e Innocenzo III. Atti del 5° Congresso internazionale di studi gioachimiti, S. Giovanni in Fiore, 16–21 settembre 1999*, ed. Roberto Rusconi, Opere di Gioacchino da Fiore: testi e strumenti 13 (Rome, 2001), 134–62, and Fiona Robb, 'Joachimist Exegesis in the Theology of Innocent III and Rainer of Ponza', *Florensia*, 11 (1997), 137–52.

²¹ See Moore, *Pope Innocent III*, 133–9, 154, and 254.

²² As argued by Fiona Robb, 'Did Innocent III Personally Condemn Joachim?', *Florensia*, 7 (1993), 77–91.

²³ Previously known as *Epistula subsequentium figurarum* and believed to be pseudepigraphic, the text was first published by Jeanne Bignami Odier, 'notes sur deux manuscrits de la Bibliothèque du Vatican contenant des traités inédits de Joachim de Flore', *Mélanges d'archéologie et d'histoire*, 54 [1937], 211–41, at 224–6. Stephen E. Wessley, 'A new Writing of Joachim of Fiore: Preliminary Observations', in *Prophecy and Eschatology*, ed. Michael Wilks, Studies in Church History. Subsidia 10 (Oxford, 1994), 15–27, also in *Florensia*, 7 (1993, 39–58) declared it to be authentic. For an edition and further study of Joachim's first work, see Gian-Luca Potestà, 'Die Genealogia. Ein frühes Werk Joachims von Fiore und die Anfänge seines Geschichtsbildes', *Deutsches Archiv für Erforschung des Mittelalters*, 56 (2000), 55–101.

²⁴ Joachim of Fiore, *Concordia ac Veteris Testamenti*, lib. iii, cap. 1 (Venice, 1519, repr. Frankfurt/Main, 1964), fol. 25vb: 'Set melius ostendimus noua, si diligentius uetera perscrutamur'. For an edition of the first four books of this work, see E. Randolph Daniel, *Abbot Joachim of Fiore. Liber de Concordia Noui ac Veteris Testamenti* (Philadelphia, 1983), 210–11 for this text.

²⁵ For a study of this important shift in the abbot's thinking, see Gian-Luca Potestà, 'La visione della storia di Gioacchino: dal modello binario ai modelli alfa e omega', *Gioacchino da Fiore tra Bernardo di Clairvaux e Innocenzo III*, 183–208.

²⁶ On history's divinely given *vivens ratio ordinis*, see Bernard McGinn, 'Ratio and Visio: Refections on Joachim of Fiore's Place in Twelfth-century Theology', in *Gioacchino da Fiore tra Bernardo di Clairvaux e Innocenzo III*, 27–46.

²⁷ See Bernard McGinn, "'Alter Moysis": Il ruolo di Bernardo di Clairvaux nel pensiero di Gioacchino da Fiore', *Florensia*, 5 (1991), 7–26.

²⁸ On Joachim's understanding of monasticism, see, esp., Stephen E. Wessley, *Joachim of Fiore and Monastic Reform* (New York, 1990).

²⁹ See, e.g., his discussion of papal *plenitudo potestatis* in the *Concordia*, lib. v, cap. 61, fol. 92va.

³⁰ See Robert E. Lerner, 'Joachim of Fiore as a Link between St. Bernard and Innocent III on the Figural Significance of Melchisedech', *Mediaeval Studies*, 42 (1980), 471–6.

³¹ Augustine, *De civitate Dei*, lib. iv, cap. 3–4, *CCSL*, 48, 100–102, and lib. xiv, 28 *CCSL*, 48, 451–2.

³² Potestà, 'Die Genealogia', 92, 33–7.

³³ Joachim's role as an advocate of a non-aggressive view of the papacy's role was first advanced by Herbert Grundmann, 'kirchenfreiheit und kaisermacht in der Sicht Joachims von Fiore',

Deutsches Archiv für Erforschung des Mittelalters, 19 (1963), 353–96, repr. in id., *Ausgewählte Aufsätze*, 361–402. For a recent detailed study, see [Chapter 8](#). Chiesa e potere imperiale: resistere o subire?, in Potestà, *Il Tempo dell'Apocalisse*, 191–218.

³⁴ This is the case, e.g., with the *figura* of the two trees representing Jerusalem/Babylon and Ecclesia/Rome. See Alexander Patschovsky, 'Il diagramma di Gioacchino da Fiore dei due alberi Gerusalemme/Babilonia ed Ecclesia/Roma', *Florensia*, 16/17 (2002–3), 7–23.

³⁵ From the edition in Kaup, *De prophetia ignota*, 188, 6–7: Manet ergo in nos alterius et deterioris Babilonis quinta persecutio, in qua mater Syon ducitur in Babilonem.

³⁶ A point emphasized by Kaup, *De prophetia ignota*, 18–21; see also Bernard McGinn, 'Joachim and the Sibyl. An Early Work of Joachim of Fiore from MS 322 of the Biblioteca Antoniana in Padua', *Cîteaux*, 34 (1973), 97–137; and Potestà, *Il Tempo dell'Apocalisse*, 57–67.

³⁷ For Joachim's notion of the pope of the last days, see the edition in *De prophetia ignota*, 212–16, and kaup's comments on 52–6. For an overview of the traditions concerning the role of the papacy at the end of time, see Marjorie Reeves, *The Influence of Prophecy in the Later Middle Ages: A Study in Joachimism* (Oxford, 1969, repr. Notre Dame, 1993), Part Four. Angelic Pope and *Renovatio Mundi*, and Bernard McGinn, 'Angel Pope and Papal Antichrist', *Church History*, 47 (1978), 153–73.

³⁸ For a preliminary edition, see Pietro De Leo, *Gioacchino da Fiore, aspetti inediti della vita e delle opere* (Cosenza, 1988), 125–48.

³⁹ Grundmann, 'kirchenfreiheit und kaisermacht'. Recently, Alexander Patschovsky has suggested a date of c.1187, the time of Barbarossa's threats against Urban III; see 'Il diagramma di Gioacchino da Fiore dei due alberi', 20–21. Gian-Luca Potestà, 'Ger 24 nell'interpretazione di Gioacchino da Fiore', in *La cattura della fine. Variazioni dell'escatologia in regime di cristianità*, ed. Giuseppe Ruggieri, Istituto per le scienze religiose di Bologna, Testi e ricerche di Scienze religiose, n.s. 7 (Genoa, 1992), 63–88, dates the work to between 1188 and 1192. See also Potestà, *Il Tempo dell'Apocalisse*, 202–12.

⁴⁰ From the edition in De Leo, *Gioacchino da Fiore*, 143, 23–9.

⁴¹ From the edition in De Leo, *Gioacchino da Fiore*, 144, 3–17.

⁴² The treatise ends with summary of the abbot's teaching on the difference between *bona et sancta libertas* and *mala libertas* (De Leo, *Gioacchino da Fiore*, 146, 24 – 147, 30). The teaching about the central role of pride and humility in the course of salvation history is also strong in another of the abbot's early works, the *Dialogi de praescientia et praedestinatione*, as noted by Potestà, 'Ger 24', 85–7.

⁴³ For an outline of these concordances and their reformist agenda, see E. Randolph Daniel, 'A new Understanding of Joachim: The Concords, the Exile, and the Exodus', in *Gioacchino da Fiore tra Bernard di Clairvaux e Innocenzo III*, 209–22, especially at 213–18, repr. in id., *Abbot Joachim of Fiore and Joachimism. Selected Articles* (Farnham, 2011), V.

⁴⁴ *Liber de Concordia*, lib. iv, pars i, cap. 28–40 (ed. Daniel, 373–98). This concordance is also at the basis of the *Intelligentia super calathis* (ed. De Leo, 135–42). As Daniel puts it, 'The exile was the paradigm that shaped Joachim's perception of history since 1049' ('A new Understanding of Joachim', 216).

⁴⁵ *Liber de Concordia*, lib. iv, pars i, cap. 38 (ed. Daniel, 388, 14–18). On the role of the Emperor Henry I in Joachim's scenario of persecuting rulers, see Alexander Patschovsky, 'The Holy Emperor Henry "The First" as One of the Dragon's Heads of the Apocalypse: On the Image of the Roman Empire under German Rule in the Tradition of Joachim of Fiore', *Viator*, 29 (1998), 291–322, and Julia Eva Wannenmacher, *Hermeneutik der Heilsgeschichte. De septem sigillis und die sieben Siegel im Werk Joachims von Fiore*, Studies in the History of Christian Traditions 118 (Leiden and Boston, 2005), 138–57.

⁴⁶ *Liber de Concordia*, lib. iv, pars i, cap. 39 (ed. Daniel, 390, 1–9).

⁴⁷ *Liber de Concordia*, lib. iv, pars ii, cap. 1–2 (ed. Daniel, 405–22).

⁴⁸ *Liber de Concordia*, lib. iv, pars ii, cap. 2 (ed. Daniel, 417, 187–92).

⁴⁹ For a brief summary of Joachim's view of Antichrist, see Bernard McGinn, *Antichrist: Two Thousand Years of the Human Fascination with Evil* (2nd edn, new York, 2000), 135–42. See also Robert E. Lerner, 'Antichrists and Antichrist in Joachim of Fiore', *Speculum*, 60 (1985), 553–70, and Julia Eva Wannenmacher, 'Die Macht des Bösen. Zur Rolle und Bedeutung des Antichristen in der Eschatologie Joachims von Fiore', *Gioacchino da Fiore tra Bernardo di Clairvaux e Innocenzo III*, 365–78.

⁵⁰ *Expositio in Apocalypsim*, fol. 10vb.

⁵¹ Roger of Howden in the Pseudo-Benedict of Peterborough version of the *Gesta Regis Ricardi* (RS, 49.2), 153–4.

⁵² E.g., *Expositio in Apocalypsim*, fol. 133ra.

⁵³ *Expositio in Apocalypsim*, fol. 168ra.

⁵⁴ Potestà, *Il Tempo dell'Apocalisse*, Chapter 12: 'L'apocalittico prudente'.

⁵⁵ *Liber Concordie*, lib. v, cap. 117, fol. 132v; cf. *Expositio in Apocalypsim*, fol. 158vb, which specifically refers back to the discussion in the *Concordia*.

⁵⁶ The *De ultimis tribulationibus* has been edited by Kurt-Victor Selge, 'Ein Traktat Joachim von Fiore über die Drangsale der Endzeit: "De ultimis tribulationibus"', *Florensia*, 7 (1993), 7–35. For a discussion, see Potestà, *Il Tempo dell'Apocalisse*, 334–9.

⁵⁷ This is the view of Potestà, *Il Tempo dell'Apocalisse*, 337. Many passages in the *Expositio* indicate that the abbot thought that the year 1200 would mark the beginning of the transition between the second and third ages.

⁵⁸ *Liber de Concordia*, lib. iv, pars i, cap. 45 (ed. Daniel, 402, 3–9): '... ascendet quasi nouus dux de Babilone, uniuersalis scilicet pontifex noue Ierusalem, hoc est sancta matris ecclesiae; in cuius typo scriptum est in Apocalipsi: "vidi angelum ascendentem ab ortu solis, habentem signum dei uiui"; ... sed quia dabitur ei plena libertas ad inouandum christianam religionem et ad precandum uerbum dei...' For more on the glorification of the papacy in withstanding Antichrist, see *Liber Concordie*, lib. v, cap. 92 and 117, fol. 122r–v and 132va).

⁵⁹ *Ioachim Abbas Florentis. Tractatus super Quatuor Evangelia*, ed. Francesco Santi (Rome, 2002), Tractatus I, 6 (97–101). The text cited is on 98, 4–12. This whole passage on Simeon has been a bone of contention in the interpretation of Joachim almost from the beginning, as is shown by the fact that it was quoted and attacked in the 1255 Protocol of Anagni; see Heinrich Denifle, 'Das Evangelium Aeternum und die Commission zu Anagni', *Archiv für Literatur- und Kirchengeschichte des Mittelalters*, 1 (1885), 49–142, at 110–12.

⁶⁰ *Tractatus I*, 6 (ed. Santi, 100, 1–13).

⁶¹ *Tractatus I*, 6 (ed. Santi, 101, 15–17).

⁶² A passage in *Expositio*, fol. 77va, discussing the relation of Peter and John, explicitly says that *successio* does not necessarily imply *deficere*. On this issue, see Potestà, *Il Tempo dell'Apocalisse*, 359–60.

⁶³ This is not the place for a full discussion of those interpreters of Joachim who have used this passage, among others, to see Joachim as envisaging the end of the papacy in the coming age, though naturally this claim has been advanced in different ways and often with many nuances. See, e.g., Herbert Grundmann, *Studien über Joachim von Fiore* (Leipzig and Berlin, 1927), 107–28 (Grundmann characterizes Joachim's view as 'nicht eigentlich antikatholisch, aber sozusagen transkatholisch,' 127–8); Ernst Benz, *Ecclesia Spiritualis* (Stuttgart, 1934), 20–26; and Henry Mottu, *La Manifestation de l'Esprit selon Joachim de Fiore* (Neuchâtel, 1977), 129–46. The latest treatment

is that of Potestà, *Il Tempo dell'Apocalisse*, 349–55. I believe that Potestà goes too far when he says that the Roman hierarchy ‘... non ha infine altro destino che quello di un *ordo* senescente, da cui escono e cui si sostituiscono nuove energie religiose’ (352).

⁶⁴ *Tractatus* II, 12 (ed. Santi, 248, 8–16).

⁶⁵ Joachim often discussed the respective roles of Peter and John; one classic account is in the *Liber introductorius* to the *Expositio*, fol. 22r–23v. A full study of the many passages on this theme would contribute much to our understanding of the role of the papacy in the coming age.

⁶⁶ A facsimile of this figure can be found in Leone Tondelli, Marjorie Reeves, and Beatrice Hirsch-Reich, *Il Libro delle Figure dell'Abate Gioachino da Fiore*, 2 vols (Turin, 1953), vol. ii, tav. XII. There is an English translation in Bernard McGinn, *Apocalyptic Spirituality* (New York, 1979), 142–8. For a detailed study, see Marjorie Reeves and Beatrice Hirsch-Reich, *The Figurae of Joachim of Fiore*, Oxford-Warburg Studies (Oxford, 1972), 234–48.

⁶⁷ In earlier works I have suggested the identification of the *pater spiritualis* with a spiritualized form of the papacy; see, e.g., Bernard McGinn, *The Calabrian Abbot. Joachim of Fiore in the History of Western Thought* (New York, 1985), 113–15. This identification has been questioned by Augustine Roberts, ‘A Reinterpretation of Joachim of Fiore’s *Dispositio novi ordinis* from the *Liber figurarum*’, *Cîteaux*, 33 (1982), 202.

⁶⁸ *Expositio*, pars viii, fol. 220vb.

Chapter 3

Joachim of Fiore and the Theology of the new Testament

Christopher Rowland

It was an enormous privilege to have the work of Joachim of Fiore and the scriptural interpretation which he initiated introduced to me by Marjorie Reeves. A lifetime's research and delight in this underestimated medieval scriptural scholar infused a series of wide-ranging tutorials in which Marjorie Reeves, with an enviable lucidity and the economy of presentation, expounded the *Figurae*,¹ and explained the distinctiveness of Joachim to me. Reeves's tuition pointed me towards writers of whom I had never even heard, such as Peter John Olivi, yet whose names have since become a familiar part of the apocalyptic story that I have been exploring in recent years. This reminiscence is the context of this essay. Marjorie Reeves enabled me to glimpse why Joachim of Fiore deserves to be placed with the 'greats' in the history of Christian theology. This is because in Joachim's work there is a reading of the Christian tradition which manages to encapsulate things about that tradition which are missed by them and their successors, whether Protestant or Catholic. Joachim therefore offers an understanding of the heart of new Testament theology which few had grasped.²

Joachim's interpretation of the Apocalypse is not easy to categorize. The origin of his understanding of it occurs in a visionary or even mystical experience, akin to the later visionaries, when he, like John on the Lord's

Day, understands the meaning of the text, as mystical insight comes to him after a long period of struggling to make sense of the text. Joachim's Casamari experience echoes the importance of a divinely initiated insight into the meaning of both events and Scripture in new Testament writings. This was an important moment in his life, when he was struggling to make sense of the Apocalypse, yet, in the middle of the night, as he was meditating on the text of the Apocalypse, 'the fullness of this book and of the entire agreement of the Old and new Testaments was perceived by a clarity of understanding'.³ By means of this gracious insight Joachim describes how he found in the Apocalypse the key to the inner meaning of Scripture and the whole history of salvation, an experience paralleled later in what happened to Joachim's major interpreter Peter John Olivi.⁴ For Joachim, the Apocalypse itself, its structure and visions, became the key to the interpretation of the whole of Scripture. In the meditation upon the Apocalypse, the spiritual insight that informed the prophets of old was again at work; as Joachim explained to the Cistercian abbot Adam of Perseigne, 'God who once gave the spirit of prophecy to the prophets has given me the spirit of understanding to grasp with great clarity in his Spirit all the mysteries of sacred Scripture'.⁵ This approach to the meaning of Scripture is echoed in the new Testament, where insight into the divine mystery does not always come by means of ingenious or sophisticated scriptural exegesis. The wisdom to understand the mystery of Christ is a gift from God. In the Gospel of Matthew, for example, according to Peter's Confession, perception of the identity of Jesus comes through divine revelation (Matt. 16:17), and in the infancy narratives, dreams open the mystery of the divine purposes (Matt. 1:20; 2:13; 2:19; cf. 27:19).

Visionary Insight

Visionary insight has a foundation of religious understanding running like a thread through the new Testament. Jesus' report of seeing 'Satan fall like lightning from heaven' (Luke 10:18) suggests a visionary anticipation of all that was being experienced in the struggle with the evil powers in the actions of both himself and the disciples. This is an indication that a moment of ultimate apocalyptic importance has happened with Jesus and his immediate companions (Luke 10:21-4).⁶ In the Acts of the Apostles, as with the dreams in the opening chapters of Matthew's Gospel, visions

provide the dynamic for the spread of the gospel. Paul's experience on the Damascus road, repeated three times, emphasizes the providential nature of this event in the divine economy. Likewise, Peter's vision of the descending sail and instruction to sacrifice and eat animals without regard for their ritual cleanness prepares him for his journey to Cornelius, explanation of which is required by the elders in Jerusalem in Acts 11.

In his letter to the Galatians, Paul emphasizes the importance of visionary elements as the basis of his practice (Gal. 1:12 and 1:16; cf. Acts 22:17). It is the mysterious world of apocalyptic vision which explains that shattering moment in Paul's life. He believed that Jesus of Nazareth, seated at the right hand of God, and 'who will be manifested in glory at the close of the age' (1 Cor. 1:7), had been revealed to him already in the old age. This revelation had ceased to be something just for a learned elite, but was available to all who could discern the wisdom of God in the crucified Christ (1 Cor. 1:18; cf. Matt. 11:25–7). In the revelation of this mystery, Paul regarded himself and his companions as stewards in the divine palace, with the privilege of administering the divine secrets (1 Cor. 4:1). The struggle to make sense of the significance of his ancestral traditions required an epistemological shift matching the shift in the ages that Paul believed he had seen in Christ.⁷

In this age, when one can only see in a glass darkly, one needs Scripture as assistance in the search for the gateway to divine truth. It is the revelatory, divine Spirit, however, which guides into all truth and announces that which is to come (cf. John 16:13). Scripture thereby points to this greater truth and provides a resource for the discernment of the character of life 'at the end of the ages' (1 Cor. 10:11; Rom. 15:4). nevertheless, its meaning is opaque, and it might also be a veil that prevents understanding (2 Cor. 3:14–18). With the benefit of the divine Spirit, however, the reader can pierce the letter to see what the Spirit might be saying through the words (2 Cor. 3:6). This kind of hermeneutic should not surprise us given Paul's mention of what he calls an allegorical use of Scripture in Galatians 4:24. Here, the literal sense of Scripture points to a 'deeper', 'transcendent', perhaps we should say 'allegorical', meaning in the contrast between two cities and two covenants, and Paul challenges readers to identify with the Jerusalem which is above, while also that which is to come.⁸

This particular approach to Scripture has its context in Second Temple apocalypses that offer examples of those moments when perceptions of

other dimensions of existence and other perspectives on ordinary life are opened up.⁹ At first sight, they suggest modes of reading that may differ from those typical of the various midrashic methods, within which interpretative ingenuity is required to ‘penetrate the subtleties of parables, seeking out the hidden meanings of proverbs and being at home with the obscurities of parables’, to quote Jesus ben Sirach’s sketch of scribal activity (Ecclus. 39). With some forms of apocalyptic interpretation, however, Ben Sirach was much less comfortable: ‘Do not meddle in what is beyond your tasks, for matters too great for human understanding have been shown you’ (Ecclus. 3:23).

Among such matters ‘too great for human understanding’ might be the visionary exegesis of the first chapter of Ezekiel. Here, in some forms of the interpretation, the meaning of the text involved a ‘seeing again’ of what Ezekiel saw.¹⁰ For John the visionary on Patmos, instead of an explanation of the details of what Ezekiel saw, the visionary’s own experience becomes context itself for the interpretation of the text. This prompted its own creative interpretation, such as the Lamb sharing the throne, absent from the original. Such an exercise of imagination involves the visualization in the mind of objects, inspired by what is read in texts or in the external world. In this kind of interpretation, we are not dealing with a kind of careful, analytical exegesis. Instead, it is a rather indirect relationship with the Scriptures, one in which the words become the catalyst for exercise of imagination; text is taken up and the imagination infused. Such imaginative exegesis has always been an important part of the reading of Scripture.¹¹ In antiquity and the medieval period, memorization and meditation were closely linked. Recalled texts yielded new meaning by process of spontaneous interconnections through meditation. This started from deliberate thought, as in the case of Joachim. The very process of recollection is conceived of anew in meditative imagination.

In the interpretation of the *merkabah* vision of Ezekiel (Ezek. 1) – indeed, from the very beginning of its interpretation – there has been an imaginative appropriation by visionaries; in some circles, this opening chapter has been the springboard for visionary experience. Such an exercise of imagination probably involved the visualization in the mind of the various objects described in Ezekiel’s vision: the parts of the chariot, the living creatures, the throne, the meaning of the enigmatic word, *hashmal*, and, particularly, the human figure. John’s apocalypse is itself part of the

story of the visionary ‘appropriation’ of Ezekiel’s *merkabah* vision.¹² Ezekiel’s vision is a crucial part of John’s vision and is the means whereby John sees the eschatological role of the Lamb who opens the book with seven seals. John’s vision is itself also an interpretation of the biblical text, where the language of Ezekiel merges with other parts of Scripture, as well as, possibly, aspects of a *merkabah* tradition which are now extinct, so to offer that particular amalgam of images in John’s vision of heaven. This resembles, and yet differs in several respects from, contemporary visions of God in the apocalypses. A key difference, however, is the decisive impact of Jesus Christ on the visionary’s imagination: in the insertion of ‘the lamb that was slain’ into the *merkabah* scene, and also the eschatological judgement, which ensues from that heavenly event.

The Apocalypse as a Key to New Testament Theology

The Book of Revelation seems at first sight to stand apart from the rest of the new Testament, as it is the only full-length apocalypse. It has the reputation for preoccupation with the cataclysmic, the penultimate as well as the ultimate, extravagant symbolism, and the fantastic retreat from reality.¹³ The Apocalypse’s link with the end of the world has obscured other preoccupations perhaps more evident in contemporary Jewish apocalypses. While one should not ignore the preoccupation with endings, its contents should not be reduced solely to the eschatological, if by that we mean only the distant future.

Apocalypse is not primarily about cataclysmic events, however. It is, as the word implies, about revelation and concerns the unmasking of the reality lying beneath the surface of the society and personal attitudes. The Apocalypse sets out to reveal things as they really are in both the life of the tiny Christian groups and the world at large. In so doing, it gives little comfort to the complacent adepts or the powerful world. For both, it has a prophetic message of judgement and doom. The work is hardly a detailed social analysis, but its evocative images are pregnant with meaning, ready for use in numerous situations of a similar kind. It is a critique of ideology. The iniquity of the present is offered by the use of a contrast between the glories of the future and the inadequacies of the present. It manifests, perhaps more than any other new Testament book, an interest in human history. The fact that these purposes reveal themselves in divine judgement

against humanity is a consequence of the alienation of human society from the justice of God. Unseen to the human eye, yet laid bare by the apocalyptic seer, the hand of God is seen to be behind the dissolution of the stability of the cosmos and society.

The Apocalypse has characteristics which mark it off from the utopian tract that offers its readers a blueprint of some future, ideal society. Hope inspires action, readiness to suffer, and urgent need of repentance in the face of catastrophe. Acceptance or rejection of its message is nothing less than the difference between heaven and hell. That demand is evident in the letters to the churches, which introduce the vision of hope, and in the concluding admonitions, which stress the authority of the text and the imminence of the fulfilment of its message. The readers of the Apocalypse are not allowed to dream about eschatological bliss without being brought face to face with the obstacles that stand in the way of its fulfilment, and the costly part to be played by them in that process: they have to wash their robes and make them white in the blood of the Lamb, and avoid being marked with the mark of Beast.

The Book of Revelation thus offers a timely reminder about supposing that its preoccupation with eschatological matters offers an opportunity to avoid the more challenging preoccupations of the present. The involvement of the seer in Revelation 10, when he is instructed to eat the scroll and commanded to prophesy, is a direct call to participate in a cosmic drama, rather than merely be a passive spectator of it. The present is a penultimate time when there is the groaning and travail which must precede the messianic age. The theme of witness in the period of penultimacy is expounded in Revelation 11.¹⁴ The vision of the two witnesses comes immediately after a renewed commission to John to prophesy again about many peoples and nations, languages and kings (Rev. 10:11). In the space between the sixth and seventh trumpet blasts, John is called to prophesy. Like the Lamb, he is instructed to take a scroll, though this time he consumes it. The character of the prophetic witness is exemplified by the two witnesses who offer their testimony in the midst of the time of the trampling of the holy places by the nations. In the penultimate period, prophetic witness is necessary as a central part of the life of the community. This is despite the letters to the angels of the churches revealing the extent of their incapacity to fulfil this role, and John and his companions' function as a prophetic remnant, an example of endurance as they keep the

commandments of God and the faith of Jesus (Rev. 14:12). Even if no firm date is offered for the fulfilment of the various events described, the reader is left in no doubt that the present moment is one of great significance that demands a response in order to ensure that readers do not find themselves identified with the Beast and the destruction predicted for it and its followers. Revelation is insistent that the role of the martyr or witness is of central importance. Jesus of Nazareth is the paradigm, ‘the faithful witness’ (Rev. 1:5), and his followers have to continue that testimony of Jesus (Rev. 19:10).

The appreciation of this aspect of the Apocalypse enables us to see why it proved to be such a subversive book. not only did it offer a critique of the contemporary order and hope for a better world, but it also gave to the present moment in history a critical, eschatological, importance. So, the Book of Revelation offered resources to those who would challenge the accommodation with the powers that be. As a result, many have viewed it with suspicion, or hostility, and sought to tame a vision which is typical of the historical horizon of hope of much of the earliest Christian eschatology.¹⁵

***Kairos*: New Testament Theology and the Sense of the Opportune Moment in the Divine Economy**

In Joachim’s, and later, Olivi’s, interpretations of the Apocalypse, the sixth and seventh, penultimate ages assume great importance as a time of anticipation and struggle.¹⁶ The period represents a space for conflict with the forces of Antichrist, which evokes an outburst of spiritual activity in the form of spiritual renewal. In this penultimate period persecution and renewal, exile and prophetic witness, jostle one with another. The sense of anticipation prompted various patterns of moral renewal, and this should remind us that Olivi’s eschatological reading of Scripture was not about learned prognostications but, instead, intimately linked with the renewal of the church as the witness to the coming kingdom.

A glance at Joachim’s *figura* of the dragon with seven heads indicates that, alongside the historically sequential explanation, there is also the recognition that this threat is both eschatological and historical: what will be the case at the end-time is a constant part of human history.¹⁷ As such it needs to be part of that on-going engagement with the Apocalypse of every

generation, an engagement that enables it to see its part in that struggle between good and evil at the heart of human history.¹⁸

Joachim of Fiore's *figurae* sought to encapsulate imagery from the Apocalypse in diagrammatic form. The inspiration for the *figura* of the dragon with seven heads was provided by Revelation 12:3. The seven heads are identified as Herod, Nero, Constantius, Muhammad, Mesemoth, Saladin, and one yet to come. The final Antichrist, indicated by the tail of the dragon, is Gog.¹⁹ Between the long necks of the dragon's heads appear captions detailing the seven persecutions of the church; Saladin, the contemporary tyrant, is represented as a larger head. Joachim interprets history, relating the pressing crisis of his own time as a sign of the eschatological times. It is this decisive move which initiates that extraordinary outburst of self-aware eschatological enthusiasm, in which persons and events became the signs of hope, or agents of Antichrist. The illumination of history by mystical insight and revelation, and the presenting of the critical significance of the present, are characteristic most particularly of the Book of Revelation.

Joachim's eschatological reading of the Apocalypse represents key elements of the heart of new Testament theology. His strong sense of his time as of great significance in human history, and in particular the emphasis on penultimacy, is crucial to most new Testament writers' sense of their role and identity in the divine purposes. Messianic and eschatological doctrines are central to early Christianity also (e.g. 1 Pet. 1:11–12; Heb. 1:1–4). The first Christians, in their diverse social settings, were encouraged to believe that they were privileged to be 'the ones on whom the ends of the ages had come' (1 Cor. 10:11). For them, the present had become the critical moment; history and eschatology had become inextricably intertwined. Jesus of Nazareth proclaimed the present as decisive in God's purposes and himself as the messianic agent. In a similar vein, Paul regarded himself as God's agent whereby the nations are offered their part in the last days, possibly the role that made him such a problematic figure to some of his Jewish and Christian contemporaries. This sense of present history as one pregnant with eschatological opportunity waned, however. By the time the Montanist movement appeared,²⁰ which was in effect a recrudescence of the earliest Christian practice and expectation, such an outlook proved to be incompatible with an

understanding of history. Eschatological agency was by then a matter of past and future, but not of the present.

In the new Testament we have documents which are saturated with hope and the conviction that an insight of ultimate significance has been vouchsafed; an insight that relativizes all other claims. Eschatology was a controlling and dominant theme in early Christian belief: for most new Testament writers there is still an unfulfilled element in the process of salvation. The believer may have tasted of the heavenly gift and participated in the Holy Spirit (Heb. 6:4), yet the fullness of salvation is still to be experienced by the individual and manifested in the world (Rom. 8:18–25; 1 John 3:2). In the early Christian writings, the eschatological dimensions of salvation are apparent. The belief in the resurrection of Jesus, for example, has become a cornerstone of Christian faith within the new Testament itself. It was a proleptic event, in which a feature of the end-time becomes a reality in the old aeon. Thus the first Christians were affirming that for them the future hope was already in the process of fulfilment; it was not merely an item of faith still to be realized at some future point.

The early Christians believed that the eschatological salvation was not wholly future, particularly since the new Age had broken into the old in the resurrection of Jesus. Many Jews thought of the Spirit's activity as part of the past, the Spirit frequently being linked with prophecy. Inspiration by the Spirit was confined to the era of the prophets and would therefore only be operative again when new prophets arose, in the Messianic Age. Paul hints that experience of the Spirit is closely linked with the eschatological hope. Thus, in outlining the present period of travail in Romans 8:18–23, he speaks of Christians being the ones who have the first fruits of the Spirit (8:23). In Acts 2:17 the writer of Acts indicates that the pouring out of the Spirit on the day of Pentecost is a fulfilment of an eschatological promise from the Book of Joel (Joel 2:28–9). The quotation in Acts interprets the phrase 'afterwards' by the words 'in the last days', an indication that the phenomenon at Pentecost was a fulfilment of the eschatological promise of the return of the Spirit. The experience of the Spirit was thus seen as the present expression in the life of the individual and the community of that eschatological reality which had been manifested in the resurrection of Jesus of Nazareth from the dead.

Throughout the new Testament there is a strong sense of being part of the penultimate, being on the brink of the fulfilment of anticipated

eschatological events that are seen as, at least in part, already taking place. That sense of anticipation qualifies certainty in a situation, for there is still waiting to be done before knowledge and fulfilment finally come. The sense of the 'not yet' does not, therefore, allow the complete closure of hermeneutical possibility in engaging with the scriptural narratives. Eschatological reading of Scripture does have a tendency to exclusivity. The sense of fulfilment and anticipation therefore brought their own problems. It is not surprising that in various texts the need for discernment (1 Cor. 12:10, 30; 14:5, 13), testing the spirits (1 John 4:1; 1 Thess. 5:21–2; 1 Tim. 4:1) and a communally balanced reading are all stressed (if that is what is meant by 2 Pet. 1:20).

A central component of the future hope in Second Temple Jewish texts was the belief that, before the age to come finally arrived, there must be a time of great distress on the earth, when the elect may be expected to suffer. It is a theme echoed in the eschatological discourses in the Gospels (Mark 13 and parallels, especially verses 7–13). Paul often writes of tribulations, as, for example, in Romans 2:9, Romans 8:18–23 and 35, and in 1 Thessalonians 3:3 and 7 (cf. Rev. 2:22; 7:14). The travail and persecution endured by believers is viewed by Paul as their undergoing of that tribulation which is a necessary prelude to the arrival of the new age. Christians can therefore rejoice in their present sufferings (Rom. 5:3).

There are significant strands within the new Testament exhibiting an outlook which invests present persons and events with a decisive role in the fulfilment of the Last Things. In various texts of the new Testament there are signs that the present becomes a moment of opportunity for transforming the imperfect into the perfect, history and eschatology become inextricably intertwined, and the elect stand on the brink of the millennium itself (not a term, it should be noted, used by new Testament writers themselves). Of course, the event of Jesus' life in due course became hallowed as the irruption of the divine into history. nevertheless, in many of the stories told about him, he is presented as proclaiming the present as decisive in God's purposes and himself as the messianic agent for change. not, though, as some dreamer awaiting the apocalyptic miracle wrought by God alone. It has been wrongly assumed that Jesus', and the early Christians', eschatological expectation was for an act of God brought in by God alone, without any human agency; humankind being, according to this view, merely passive spectators of a vast divine drama with the cosmos as its

stage. The foundation documents of Christianity suggest a different story. For many of the new Testament writers, history is illuminated by apocalypse; vision opens ultimate possibilities and responsibilities which others could only dream of. They are thereby equipped with insight hidden to others and privileged to enjoy a role in history denied even to the greatest figures of the past. 1 Pet. 1:11–12 speaks for the outlook of many other new Testament documents in its emphasis on the privilege of the writer's time: 'It was revealed to the prophets that they were serving you in the things that have been announced to you ... things which angels long to look on'.

Paul had the burning conviction that he had been set apart as the apostle to the Gentiles, commissioned by the Messiah himself to preach the good news to the nations (Gal. 1:16). Paul believed that he and the communities of believers dotted around the Eastern Mediterranean were themselves living in a critical period (1 Cor. 10:11). The belief that a quota of Gentiles would be allowed to participate in the new age was shared by Paul (Rom. 11:25) with other Jews. Paul, however, claimed the right to bring the Gentiles into the divine covenant himself, since he considered himself the agent of the divine plan to fulfil this eschatological event as a result of his call. What is more, he considered that it was not necessary for those Gentiles whom he brought into the covenant to practise the totality of the Jewish law, as the Law was part of a past aeon and now obsolete in the light of Christ. This was even if they recognized that Law as a general guide to practice (Rom. 15:4).

The new Testament writings communicate to their readers that they are in a time of historical transition in which the coming age of salvation is not imminent yet intrudes into, and already affects, life in the present. There is an important proviso: the time of perfection in knowledge, insight, and practice is still to come. A distinctive genius of new Testament theology is the puzzle of the 'now' and the 'not yet', and the sense that accompanies this of being on the brink of something important, an anticipatory mode if you will. In this sense, Joachim and the new Testament writers want people to live in the light of that conviction. A characteristic of the theology of the new Testament is precisely this sense of anticipation, of the present as a decisive moment in God's saving purposes and the opportunity, which exists for the people of God to act in the present, as they wait for the coming of the messianic reign. It is the time when the Spirit of prophecy offers testimony to the 'now' of the day of salvation (2 Cor. 6:2).

This situation led to a radically new outlook and approach to the religious life. The penultimate age was the age of the divine Spirit, in Paul's language, the 'down payment' of the glory which is to come (2 Cor. 1:22; Rom. 8: 23). The Pauline communities enjoyed the new age of the Spirit that Christ's coming had initiated. This age was marked by prophecy and communities living under the guidance of the Spirit (1 Cor. 12–14; 1 Thess. 5:19–20). Evidence of the work of the eschatological Spirit can be found throughout the new Testament; what is distinctive about the Pauline letters is that the Spirit is regarded as the motor for moral change and the ethical life. Romans 8:1–11 and 1 Corinthians 2:10–16 commend a life prompted by the indwelling, eschatological Spirit that places them above the obligations of any external law code (though Paul expects that the life of the Spirit will be in some sense in continuity with the obedience due to God that the Law required; cf. Rom. 8:3). In 1 Corinthians 2:10–16, Paul claims that life in the Spirit enables a person to have the mind of Christ and to understand the deepest things of God. Consequently, there is now no need for a law code for such a person, for they have the Spirit to guide them, akin to the law written on the heart prophesied by Jeremiah (31:34) and Ezekiel (36:26–7; cf. 2 Cor. 3:3). This is antinomian in the strict sense of that word, a life without the Law, lived in accord with the divine, at work in the human heart, prompting and directing.²¹ Such a Spirit-led life could easily produce the kind of discord found in Corinth, however, manifesting characteristics which Paul regards as antithetical to the life of the Spirit (Gal. 5:16–26). Therefore, in the second half of 1 Corinthians, Paul resorts to the role of a rabbi, and offers, in the apostolic counsel, to guide his Corinthian readers, as he seeks to oversee the consequences of their eschatological enthusiasm.

Eschatological convictions had practical consequences in the ways writers viewed the crises within their communities. What goes amiss is a sign of the work of Antichrist or the fulfilment of dire eschatological predictions (e.g. 1 Tim. 4:1–2; 1 John 4:1; Jude 18). In 1 John, for example, the presence of dissent and separation marks out the identity of Antichrist as an all too human presence in the midst of the community. The application of apocalyptic imagery to contemporary institutions and events is one of countless examples from the Christian tradition. Antichrist, therefore, is no remote supernatural figure, but stalks the earth confronting those with the insight to behold the apocalyptic danger. This is exactly what we would expect when the solitary new Testament appearance of Antichrist

refers not to supernatural figures but the heretical and immoral opponents of the writer of 1 John. In this work the language of eschatology is appropriated for the understanding of the contemporary world: 'Children it is the last hour and so you know that antichrist is coming, so now many antichrists have come ... they went out from us ... that it might be plain that they all are not of us' (1 John 2:18–20). Such an application is daring and potentially far more dangerous than its relegation to de facto irrelevance in a remote eschatological future. The present has a critical character; it is a moment of utter significance within history and cannot be regarded with detached equanimity.

The sense of eschatological destiny, which pervades Paul's self-understanding and activity, actually enabled his thinking to cohere. This is the outlook of one who believed himself called to be an agent in the dawn of the new age, the means by which the Gentiles became fellow heirs of the commonwealth of Israel. This is most clearly expressed in Ephesians, where not only the Apostle's, but also the church's role as the bearers of the divine mysteries is stressed (Eph. 3:5–12). As Ephesians indicates, it was possible for a later generation to keep alive that framework of thought, provided that there was a clear understanding of the soteriological role of apostle and community. Once that sense of being part of the 'propitious moment' disappeared, however, the understanding of present activity as an integral part of that drama and its relationship with the future consummation of the divine purposes gradually disappeared also.

Paul's theology reflects the conviction that God had revealed the mystery of salvation to him and his part in it (Gal. 1:12 and 16).²² In that penultimate period beset by the messianic woes, a peculiar fulcrum in history has witnessed a significant change and a new era has forced itself upon both apostles and their communities. They are the ones 'upon whom the ends of the ages have come' (1 Cor. 10:11). The mission to the Gentiles, and probably also the collection for the saints in Jerusalem, are intimately linked with the framework of an eschatological drama in which Paul is a crucial actor.²³ Just as the coming of John the Baptist had signalled to Jesus a shift in the aeons (Luke 16:16), so, for Paul, the vision of the resurrected Christ event was intimately linked with Paul's own sense of mission within the overall scheme of salvation history. Paul thinks of himself as an, perhaps even the, eschatological agent, like the twelve, who were, and were told by Jesus that they would sit on twelve thrones judging the twelve tribes

of Israel (Matt. 19:28). John 21:23 indicates the shock that the community suffered when the death of its contact with Jesus took place. Paul, like the Beloved Disciple, places himself as part of the special group who ‘had seen the Lord’ (1 Cor. 15: 3–7; cf. 9:1). For Paul, the present moment is the moment to take decisive, eschatological action. We can find, therefore, an area of early Christian experience where the passing of time led to a diminution of that special moment *Kairos*, which characterized the age of the apostles. With their passing, we find a different ethos emerging, one in which the present becomes less infused with eschatological significance, and where the eschatological came to be linked only with the far distant future, and not with the day of salvation, which had dawned in the present. Inaugurated eschatology gradually diminished, to be replaced by that longing for the kingdom whose coming was detached from the life of the Christian communities in the present.

This peculiar characteristic of early Christian writings, which is shared by interpreters in the Joachite tradition, is captured in Karl Mannheim’s sketch of the characteristics of what he terms ‘the chiliastic mentality’.²⁴ Mannheim based his assessment on late medieval radicals like the Hussites, and on Thomas Müntzer and the Anabaptists. nevertheless, there are strong links between them and both the early Christians and those who espoused Joachim’s historical apocalypticism. ‘The chiliastic mentality’ is that sense of living at a moment of critical significance in salvation history, when eschatological beliefs were being actualized, that connects many of the new Testament writers and Joachim and his followers. Mannheim’s summary of the characteristics is as follows:

- i. ‘the impossible gives birth to the possible and the absolute interferes with the world and conditions actual events.’²⁵
- ii. ‘for the real Chiliast, the present becomes the breach through which what was previously inward bursts out suddenly, takes hold of the outer world and transforms it.’²⁶
- iii. ‘the Chiliast expects a union with the immediate present ... He is always on his toes awaiting the propitious moment.. He is not actually concerned with the millennium to come; what is important for him is that it has happened here and now.. the chiliastic mentality has no sense for the process of becoming; it was sensitive only to the abrupt moment, the present pregnant with meaning.’²⁷

- iv. 'Chiliastic mentality severs all relationships with those phases of historical existence which are in daily process of becoming in our midst. It tends at every moment to turn into hostility towards the world, its culture, and all its works and earthly achievements, and to regard them as only premature gratification of a more fundamental striving which can only be adequately satisfied in Kairos.'²⁸
- v. 'For Chiasm the spirit is a force which suffuses and expresses itself through us. For humanitarian liberalism it is that "other realm" which when absorbed in our moral conscience, inspires us.'²⁹
- vi. 'Whereas originally Chiliastic experience manifested a robust and corporeal drive, when repressed it became rather sweetly innocuous and vaporous, it became watered down into mere enthusiasm, and the ecstatic element came to life once more, though in a gently soothing form, only in the Pietistic experience of awakening.'³⁰

In theological terms, what Mannheim sets out here is a description of a realized eschatology at work, in which hopes for a changed world are set in the context of the present and are not just articles of faith to be asserted. They pervade through action and disrupt patterns of behaviour and relating, which is exactly what we find in the ethos of earliest Christianity. What is more, time is in some sense hallowed, as the present becomes a particular 'propitious' moment. For both the new Testament writers, and those who followed Joachim, the present moment might not be the climax of history, yet was of peculiar importance along the way. To the extent that he grasped the revolutionary potential of this millennial spirit, Norman Cohn was correct to see in it a powerful force in Western religion.³¹ What he failed to do was to differentiate both the violent from the non-violent and those who espoused an entirely realized eschatology from those who, whatever their conviction about the eschatological significance of the present moment, did not consider that the totality of millennial glory had already arrived.

Concluding Comments

One of the features of messianic and millenarian thinking and practice is that it represents a clear alternative to conventional wisdom and custom. To be part of a messianic movement means to be part of social change, often of an unpredictable form. However well mapped out future hopes may have been, and however strong conventional practice, the eschatological

experience challenges that belief system and leads to new responses that push adherents along an uncharted path of religious and social experiment. In most cases, however, there is probably little guidance. Indeed, if the Jewish material now extant is anything to go by, primitive Christians who believed that a new order had dawned with Jesus had little information to go on, as they set out to explore the implications of what they were doing and saying for the culture they were a part of. The heady enthusiasm that characterizes the initial outburst tends to be quenched by disappointment or the need for consolidation and accommodation, not least as the radicalism of the Jesus movement moved into the urban environment of the Eastern Roman Empire.³² The fiery radicalism of Galatians is significantly tempered in the Corinthian correspondence, and even more in the, probably deutero-Pauline, Pastoral Epistles.

In Joachite tradition, and in the early Christian texts, the nature of hope differs markedly from the character of hope within other areas of Christian tradition. It is a hope for this world rather than some transcendent realm. The future does not function merely as a regulative ideal which acts as a stimulus to action; it is also an inner dynamism which acts as a driving force to bring about radical change and fulfil the hope for a new order in the present. When the hope for God's kingdom on earth was not realized, the present ceased to be the moment of *Kairos* for the world. Instead, it offered a realization of that future hope, in the individual's communion with God, or in the common life of the worshipping community as it shared in the foretaste of the heavenly banquet. Within the Pauline corpus of writings in the new Testament, there is a clear shift from the horizontal to the vertical, evident in the letters to the Colossians and the Ephesians. In the Gospel of John, the destiny of the believer to share in the vision of God in heaven (John 17:24) paves the way for the classic eschatological doctrine of the Christian church, in which eschatology is equated solely with life in heaven. The kingdom of God becomes a celestial entity, and the 'pilgrim's progress' is not to seek a new order in this world, but through this vale of tears in the life hereafter.

The conviction that the divine indwells the human and the process of human history is, nevertheless, manifest in Paul's doctrine of the Spirit, and his conviction that the believer is closely identified with Christ: 'not I but Christ in me' (Gal. 2:20). With an inaugurated eschatology, hope is not merely an article of faith for the future, but in some sense already present

either in the life of the elect group, or as a phenomenon within the historical process which demands a response from them. There is a refusal to remain content with the letter of Scripture, and at times a subordination of it to the inner understanding that comes through the Spirit. This is backed by the prophetic consciousness of being called by God, and the references to visionary experience are typical.

The medieval apocalyptists in Joachite tradition understood something absolutely central about the eschatology of the new Testament. They took seriously aspects of the early Christian reading of Scripture, in which God's address to humans and the inspiration of the Spirit were central to their understanding of that Scripture. What characterized early Christianity was its genius of allowing the immediate and the inspirational to complement the received wisdom of tradition. This is evident all over the new Testament. Whatever may have been the case in the earliest phase of Christianity's existence (and we can only surmise from various hints of enthusiasm we find in passages like Acts, such as the utopian practice in Acts 2:44 and 4:34, and 1 Cor. 12–14), by the time Paul was writing his letters, his eschatological beliefs had been tempered with an expectation that the nascent communities must await a consummation still to come. Some indeed may have thought that the time was already present (as 1 Cor. 4:8 suggests),³³ and others thought that it was imminent (2 Thess. 2:3–6).³⁴ The various layers of the theology and ethics of the new Testament are saturated with a perspective which recognizes the peculiar 'penultimacy' of the *Kairos*, and the 'extraordinary' privilege belonging to those who found themselves at that significant moment in history. visionary experience was a motor of the early Christian movement. Early Christianity was not only indebted to apocalyptic terminology, but its very identity was also formed by the dialectical tension between the above and below, the seen and the unseen, in addition to the eschatological tension of the now and the not yet. All of these are typical features of the language and genre of the apocalypses. Furthermore, one cannot understand Christian origins, or new Testament theology, without attention to eschatology. There is hardly a central theological theme that does not owe its inspiration to the complex of hopes for the future found in Second Temple Jewish texts. Joachim's theological insight was to have grasped this fact and the understanding of history, which he held in common with the new Testament writers. Joachim's Trinitarian view of history, linked with an understanding of

salvation history, offered by the Book of Revelation, led him to an emphasis on the present, innovatory role of the divine Spirit and hope for future change, which brilliantly captures that mix of fulfilment and anticipation which are at the heart of early Christian religion and made it the subversive force it was in the last years of Second Temple Judaism.

Notes

¹ Marjorie Reeves and Beatrice Hirsch-Reich, *The Figurae of Joachim of Fiore*, Oxford-Warburg Studies (Oxford, 1972).

² See further: Christopher Rowland, *Christian Origins: An Account of the Setting and Character of the Most Important Messianic Sect of Judaism* (London, 2002); Dale Allison, *The End of the Ages Has Come* (Edinburgh, 1987); John J. Collins, *The Encyclopedia of Apocalypticism*, 3 vols (new York, 2000), i.

³ Joachim of Fiore, *Expositio in Apocalypsim*, pars i (venice, 1527, repr. Frankfurt/Main, 1964), fol. 39va; Bernard McGinn, *Visions of the End: Apocalyptic Traditions in the Middle Ages* (new York, 1998), 130.

⁴ David Burr, *Olivi's Peaceable Kingdom: A Reading of the Apocalypse Commentary* (Philadelphia, 1993), 122–4; Wayne Lewis, 'Peter John Olivi, Prophet of the Year 2000: Ecclesiology and Eschatology in the "Lectura super Apocalipsim"', Introduction to a Critical Edition of the Text', diss. (Tübingen, 1976).

⁵ Ralph of Coggeshall, *Chronicon Anglicanum*, ed. Joseph Stevenson, RS 66 (London, 1875), 68; Bernard McGinn, *Apocalyptic Spirituality: Treatises and Letters of Lactantius, Adso of Montier-en-Der, Joachim of Fiore, the Franciscan Spirituals, Savonarola* (London, 1979), 100; Gian Luca Potestà, "'Intelligentia Scripturarum' und Kritik des Prophetismus bei Joachim of Fiore', in *Neue Richtungen in der hoch- und spätmittelalterlichen Bibelexege*, ed. Robert E. Lerner (Munich, 1996), 105–12. For Adam's interview with Joachim, see in this volume, 145–78.

⁶ Christopher Rowland, *The Open Heaven: A Study of Apocalyptic in Judaism and Early Christianity* (London, 1982), 365; Christopher Rowland and Christopher R.A. Morray-Jones, *The Mystery of God: Early Jewish Mysticism and the New Testament*. *Compendia Rerum Judaicarum ad novum Testamentum*, 12 (Leiden and Boston, 2009).

⁷ James Louis Martyn, *Galatians: A New Translation with Introduction and Commentary*, The Anchor Bible, 33A (new York, 1997).

⁸ Daniel Boyarin, *A Radical Jew: Paul and the Politics of Identity*. *Contraversions: Critical Studies in Jewish Literature, Culture, and Society* 1 (Berkeley, 1994), 86–105.

⁹ Michael A. Fishbane, *Biblical Interpretation in Ancient Israel* (Oxford, 1985, repr. 2004).

¹⁰ See David J. Halperin, *The Faces of the Chariot: Early Jewish Responses to Ezekiel's Vision*. *Texte und Studien zum antiken Judentum* 16 (Tübingen, 1988), 70–78; Elliot R. Wolfson, *Trough a Speculum that Shines: Vision and Imagination in Medieval Jewish Mysticism* (Princeton, 1994, repr. 1997); *Paradise Now: Essays on Early Jewish and Christian Mysticism*, Symposium Series/Society of Biblical Literature 11, ed. April D. DeConick (Leiden and Boston, 2006).

¹¹ See Mary J. Carruthers, *The Book of Memory*, Cambridge Studies in Medieval Literature 10 (Cambridge, 1990, repr. 2004); ead., *The Craft of Thought: Meditation, Rhetoric and the Making of Images 400–1200*, Cambridge Studies in Medieval Literature 34 (Cambridge, 1998, repr. 2003).

¹² Christopher Rowland, 'The visions of God in Apocalyptic Literature', *Journal for the Study of Judaism*, 10 (1979), 138–54; id., *The Open Heaven*, 269–358; id., 'The Book of Revelation', in *New*

Interpreter's Bible, 12 vols (Nashville, 1998), xii.

¹³ For a survey of interpretations, see Judith Kovacs and Christopher Rowland, *Revelation: The Apocalypse of Jesus Christ* (Oxford, 2004).

¹⁴ Richard Bauckham, *The Theology of the Book of Revelation*, new Testament Theology (Cambridge, 1993, repr. 2003), 84–8.

¹⁵ For a summary of the pervasiveness of this-worldly expectation, see Brian E. Daley, *The Hope of the Early Church: A Handbook of Patristic Eschatology* (Cambridge, 1991, repr. Peabody, Mass., 2003), 5–32.

¹⁶ Burr, *Olivi's Peaceable Kingdom*, 117–18.

¹⁷ The best representation of the dragon is to be found in Oxford, Corpus Christi College, MS 255A, fol. 7r; cf. <http://image.ox.ac.uk/show?collection=corpus&manuscript=ms255a>; the dragon of the manuscript in Reggio Emilia is depicted in Leone Tondelli, Marjorie Reeves, and Beatrice Hirsch-Reich, *Il libro delle figure dell'abate Gioacchino da Fiore*, 2 vols (Turin, 1953), ii, tav. xiv.

¹⁸ Reeves and Hirsch-Reich, *The Figurae*, 146–52 and pl. 21.

¹⁹ On Gog as the last and ultimate Antichrist, see Robert E. Lerner, 'Antichrists and Antichrist in Joachim of Fiore', *Speculum*, 60 (1985), 553–70; Julia Eva Wannenmacher, *Hermeneutik der Heilsgeschichte. De septem sigillis und das Motiv der sieben Siegel im Werk Joachims von Fiore*, Studies in the History of Christian Traditions 118 (Leiden and Boston, 2005), 210–30.

²⁰ Christine Trevett, *Montanism: Gender, Authority and the New Prophecy* (Cambridge, 1996, repr. 2003).

²¹ For the antinomian currents in late medieval piety, see, e.g., Robert E. Lerner, *The Heresy of the Free Spirit in the Later Middle Ages* (Berkeley, 1972).

²² Johan Christiaan Beker, *Paul the Apostle: The Triumph of God in Life and Thought* (Edinburgh, 1980, 5th edn Philadelphia, 1992), 114–23; Martyn, *Galatians*.

²³ Dieter Georgi, *Remembering the Poor: The History of Paul's Collection for Jerusalem* (Nashville, 1992); Johannes Munck, *Paul and the Salvation of Mankind* (London, 1959, repr. Richmond, va., 1986).

²⁴ Karl Mannheim, *Ideology and Utopia: An Introduction to the Sociology of Knowledge* (London, 1936, repr. 1960); Christopher Rowland, *Blake and the Bible* (new Haven, 2011), esp. 88–9 and 120–56.

²⁵ Karl Mannheim, *Ideology and Utopia*, 192.

²⁶ *Ibid.*, 193.

²⁷ *Ibid.*, 195, 202.

²⁸ *Ibid.*, 198.

²⁹ *Ibid.*, 198.

³⁰ *Ibid.*, 213.

³¹ Norman Cohn, *The Pursuit of the Millennium* (London, 1957, repr. 2004).

³² Wayne Atherton Meeks, *The First Urban Christians: The Social World of the Apostle Paul* (new Haven, 1983, 2nd edn new Haven, 2003); David G. Horrell, *The Social Ethos of the Corinthian Correspondence: Interests and Ideology from 1 Corinthians to 1 Clement*, Studies of the new Testament and Its World (Edinburgh, 1996); and *Social-Scientific Approaches to New Testament Interpretation*, ed. David G. Horrell (Edinburgh, 1999).

³³ Antoinette Clark Wire, *The Corinthian Women Prophets: A Reconstruction through Paul's Rhetoric* (Philadelphia, 1990, 2nd edn, Minneapolis, 1995); Anthony C. Thiselton, 'Realised Eschatology at Corinth', *New Testament Studies*, 24 (1977–78), 510–26.

³⁴ Robert Jewett, *The Thessalonian Correspondence: Pauline Rhetoric and Millenarian Piety* (Philadelphia, 1986).

Chapter 4

Joachim of Fiore as Political Thinker

Matthias Riedl

The Middle Ages and the Concept of ‘the Political’

According to Marjorie Reeves, Joachim of Fiore was not a political thinker. If in the following pages I attempt to show that political reflection is not at the periphery but at the centre of Joachim’s thought, this is not to dispute the results of Marjorie Reeves’s research. I only wish to suggest that it may be possible to use the concept of ‘the political’ in another way.

Like many historians, Marjorie Reeves applied the concept of the political almost exclusively to secular powers while she spoke of the church as the sphere of religion. Consequently, she described Joachim of Fiore primarily as a religious thinker whose prophecies have some political implications insofar as they predict the collapse of all worldly power. She describes the abbot’s vision of the third *status* as purely religious because it depicts a Christian society organized as the monastic *ecclesia spiritualis* – a purified church which will emerge after the decline of all worldly kingdoms, beyond the political stages of history.¹ From this perspective, prophecies that refer to Joachim of Fiore and include the dimension of worldly power in their vision of the final stage of history would appear to be an abuse of the abbot’s teachings for political purposes.²

In her studies *The Influence of Prophecy in the Later Middle Ages* and *Joachim of Fiore and the Prophetic Future*, which remain the standard works on Joachimism to date, Reeves recounts the fate of Joachim’s

teachings in the centuries after his death. She identifies two traditions of prophetic thought, both of which used and transformed Joachim's predictions. The tradition of political Joachimism' emerged among Swabian supporters of Frederick II and the Ghibellines who hoped for the *renovatio* of the German Empire by the Hohenstaufen dynasty; it combines ancient prophecies of the Last Emperor with Joachim's expectation of a peaceful universal society in the last stage of history.³ As Reeves showed, this tradition continued in the later Middle Ages and was used to justify the new forms of national rulership, first of all in France. On the other hand, Reeves observed a tradition of religious prophecy which predicted a spiritual reformation of the institutions of the church or even a spiritual revolution, bringing about an Angelic Pope. This spiritual Joachimism', which seems to have its first social basis in the movement of the Spiritual Franciscans, has, according to Marjorie Reeves, a greater right to refer to the works of Joachim of Fiore.⁴

It is not my intention to refute these results and I also agree in its essentials with Reeves's differentiation between a papal' and an 'imperial' tradition of Joachimism; I only suggest that we should call both of these traditions political. Eric Voegelin has shown that the modern use of the concepts of 'the religious' and 'the political' is the result of the emancipation of the nation-state from the *sacrum Imperium* and implies more or less the institutional separation of church and state.⁵ Therefore the concepts cannot be applied to the high Middle Ages without appearing anachronistic. The restriction of applying the concept of the political to the sphere of the 'state' neglects the fact that in the Middle Ages the world was seen as a 'compact and massive unity of the religious and the political'.⁶ The primary symbols by which Western medieval society articulates its self-understanding, *ecclesia* as the *corpus Christi*, and, since the eleventh century, *christianitas* or *societas Christiana*, include the temporal powers as well as the church hierarchy.⁷

In the case of the investiture controversy, for example, in which the Hohenstaufen idea of sacred kingship confronts the Gregorian idea of papal hierocracy, it would be hard to decide if this is a case of a political or a religious conflict. As Walter Ullmann pointed out, the pope and the emperor refer both to the spiritual sphere because at the basis of their conflict lies a single question: Who is the true vicar of Christ on earth?⁸ The question presupposes the spiritual' question of the nature of Christ's heavenly rule. If

the nature of this rule is the *ordo Melchisedech*, the unity of kingship and priesthood in the same person, a number of 'political' questions arise: Is the royal priest in heaven to be represented by two *officia* on earth, the *regnum* and the *sacerdotium*, held by different persons? Or must there be only one earthly *regale sacerdotium*, just as there is only one in heaven? In other words, are emperor and pope endowed with equal powers and yet rule over different spheres of *christianitas*? Or is the pope the true possessor of the spiritual and the temporal sword, who can delegate his temporal powers to secular rulers? Like all other political thinkers of the medieval West, Joachim of Fiore is deeply concerned with these questions, drawing his terminology from the standard sources such as the treatises of the popes Gelasius I and Gregory VII or from Bernard of Clairvaux's *De consideratione ad Eugenium papam*.

In the theoretical discussions which took place in the Latin West, the concept of the political (*politician*) could not have played a role until after the twelfth century. When in the course of the rediscovery of Aristotle's *Politics* in the thirteenth century, it came into use again it could only have the anthropological meaning which it formerly held in classical philosophy and which, in its essential core, is not restricted to a certain cultural or historical context. Thomas Aquinas described man as the *animal sociale et politicum*, a being that because of its political nature differs from all other animals, who are merely social in nature.⁹ Humans do not just gather to survive, but to live a good life, a life that has a meaning beyond mere subsistence. Since humans are also the only animals whose social gatherings are not determined by their instincts but have the capacity to articulate their thoughts rationally, they are capable of jointly deliberating the ends of their society, the purpose governing their social order. Such anthropological understanding of the political is a definition which is closer to the historical origins of the concept than the modern state-centred understanding and can still be used by medieval historians without the danger of anachronism. Expressed in more theoretical terms, the political is the symbolic order by which a society expresses its self-interpretation. It is the meaningful dimension of human society. The political manifests itself in the social order of concrete historical societies; and these manifestations vary according to the experiences of order humans have in all dimensions of their existence, including the spiritual dimension.¹⁰

The Political Significance of Joachim's *Principium Concordiarum*¹¹

If the political is the meaningful dimension of human social order, then it follows that this manifests itself in church order as well as in the order of the empire. And even the order of *christianitas*, which encompasses temporal and spiritual powers, must be regarded as a political order. Consequently, one of the central problems of Christian political thought is the question of the relationship between temporal and spiritual powers within the order of *christianitas*.¹² The investiture controversy revealed that the pope and the emperor had very different views on the problem. These differences determined their self-understanding and consequently their politics. Gregory VII and his theological entourage promoted a new concept of *ecclesia* which downplayed the role of worldly rulers as charismatic members of the *corpus mysticum*. Rather, the papal side successively restricted the meaning of *ecclesia* to the clergy, the *ordo ecclesiasticus*, and treated the emperor as a lay person. This new understanding of *ecclesia* enabled the Gregorian movement to launch the struggle for the *libertas ecclesiae*, the liberation of the church from the hands of laymen.¹³ Another important political consequence of this conceptual shift was that the kings and emperors could now be seen as enemies of the church, even if they were Christians. But if they were indeed enemies of the church, they no longer differed significantly from others such as the pagan Roman emperors, the Jews, the Goths, the Vandals, and later the Lombards and the Muslims.

The new concept of the church as a sacred community which suffers persecution by worldly powers led also to a new, apocalyptical understanding of history. The non-apocalyptical reading of the Revelation of St John as found in Augustine's *City of God* determined its orthodox interpretation until the eleventh century. Augustine himself denied that the meaning of profane history could be understood by humans.¹⁴ He argued that it was possible to make judgements about the moral character of earthly powers, since the members of the *civitas Dei* and the *civitas terrena* are dispersed among all peoples and kingdoms. Profane history, according to Augustine, is determined by the fact that good and bad human beings are mixed up together (*hominum bonorum et malorum nunc permixtione*).¹⁵ The Day of Judgement alone would reveal the meaning of historical events.¹⁶

The millennium would only be a symbol for the Christian era and all calculations of history would be determined to fail.¹⁷

But this interpretation was to alter significantly as a result of the investiture controversy. The violent struggle between emperor and pope destroyed the symbolical unity of spiritual and temporal powers within the Christian *sacrum Imperium*. Commentators on the Apocalypse, such as Bruno of Segni, Rupert of Deutz, Anselm of Havelberg, and Gerhoch of Reichersberg, tried to discover the meaning of the contemporary conflicts in the prophetic verses of the Revelation of John.¹⁸ Gradually the idea became predominant that the Apocalypse contained in encoded form the entire history of the church, including future events. According to the new generation of commentators, the conflicts between church and empire were to be regarded as episodes in the struggle between the people of God and the worldly forces, directed by the Antichrist. As Bernard McGinn has emphasized, apocalyptic prophecy in the high Middle Ages was not primarily a heretical phenomenon; indeed, many of the commentators on the apocalypse, including Joachim of Fiore, served as political advisors to the popes: 'Rather than representing a semi-educated and alienated fringe of society, most of the major apocalyptic thinkers of the twelfth century were figures situated in high echelons of intellectual and political power. They sought to make their views effective both on a popular level through preaching and also with the leadership of *christianitas*, especially with the popes of the era.'¹⁹

Joachim of Fiore claimed to have found a key to the code of the Apocalypse, which would allow him to reveal the meaning of past, present, and future events more precisely. In one of his later writings, he called this methodological key the *principium concordiarum*.²⁰ *Concordia* means the structural equivalence of Old and New Testament, whereby 'New Testament' signifies the whole course of church history. Joachim himself defined *concordia* as the similarity of equal proportions (*similitudo eque proportionis*).²¹ According to this principle, every period, event, or person described in the Old Testament corresponds to an equivalent period, event, or person in the New Testament.

Joachim refers to the vision of John of Patmos, in which Christ receives from the Father a book with seven seals. Like other commentators, Joachim recognizes the seven seals as the basic structure of the Apocalypse. He explains that every major tribulation found in the Old Testament is

symbolically represented by one of the seals and every seal opened by Christ means an analogous tribulation in the history of Christianity.²² Consequently, the series of the seven seals (*sigilla*) and seven openings (*apertiones*) constitutes the parallel structures of the Old and the New Testament. In other words, the Old Testament is the key to understanding the enigmatic prophecies of the Apocalypse. Already in his first known work, the *Genealogia*, the abbot shows that all major attacks carried out by the worldly powers against the church, the new people of God, are anticipated in the history of Israel, the old people of God:

In the Old Testament, the first fight was with the Egyptians; the second with the Cananeans; the third with Syrians, the fourth with the Assyrians; the fifth with the Chaldeans; the sixth fight was the one the Medes fought against the Babylonians and then against the children of Israel; the seventh was the fight with the Greeks, when Antiochus expelled [the Jews from] Jerusalem. These seven tribulations were the seven seals, that is, the hidden seals of the things to come. Because nobody knew how to open them until Christ came.

These wars were fought against the children of Israel. In a similar way, the Jews waged a war against the church when the first seal was opened; the second war was the persecution by the pagans; the Syrians can be compared to the Persians, Goths, Vandals, and Lombards, who attacked the church; at the fourth seal, the Saracens rose up against the church; at the fifth seal the new Chaldeans and the new Babylon rose up against the spiritual Jerusalem; at the sixth seal happens the destruction of Babylon, that is Rome. As I said above, seven tribulations happened [in the Old Testament], but the last two are to be understood as one. The tribulation of Antiochus can be compared to the one that will be done by the Antichrist.²³

After Joachim in this way decoded the basic structure of church history, he developed more exact methods in order to make his interpretation of past and present events, as well as his prediction of future events, more precise. Using a complicated exegetical procedure, he calculated two parallel lines of generations (*generationes*). The length of the carnal generations of the Old Testament depends on the length of the lives of the patriarchs or the duration of the governments of the rulers. The spiritual generations of the New Testament last exactly 30 years, according to the time that passed between the incarnation of Christ and his procreation of spiritual children by public preaching. Here the political significance of Joachim's exegesis becomes clear. With the help of the *principium concordiarium* it would be possible to identify which Old Testament rulers corresponded to those in the present day. Moreover, it became possible to predict the future development of contemporary conflicts and give advice to popes or rulers accordingly.

For example, in his later work *Intelligentia super calathis*, Joachim drew a parallel between the situation of the papal court in the year 1191 and that

of Israel in the year 587 BC. The German troops were to be regarded as the new Babylonians, and King Henry VI as the new Nebuchadnezzar. Joachim himself acted as the new Jeremiah. He brought the prophecies of his predecessor' up to date and told the curia how to react to the recent demands of the German king: the will of the king has to be done and he has to be crowned Emperor of the Romano-German Empire, since it was the will of God that Israel had obeyed the command of Nebuchadnezzar and accepted the Babylonian captivity.²⁴

This example also points to another political dimension of Joachim's reading of the Apocalypse. The abbot contradicts the self-understanding of those Christian kings who used to regard themselves as the successors of the anointed kings of Israel. According to Joachim's exegesis, the popes were the true successors of the Jewish kings of the Old Testament, since they are true rulers of the new people of God. Jesus Christ, who, according to the Gospel of Matthew, is heir to King David, brings to a close the line of the Old Testament rulers and, at the same time, founds the royal priesthood of the popes. The worldly rulers, on the other hand, correspond to the pagan rulers of the Old Testament who were on either good or bad terms with Israel. Of course, this interpretation of worldly rule was a consequence of the new Gregorian concept of the church. If the church consists primarily of its ordained members, the kings and emperors cannot play a significant role in the government of *christianitas*. As Joachim writes, rulers have to offer their services (*ministeria*) to the church.²⁵ But if they act against the will of the curia, they have to be put on a level with the enemies of Israel.

In other words, Joachim's early interpretation of the Bible and church history has a clear political agenda: It provides an exegetical basis for the legitimation of papal leadership and the downgrading of the earthly rulers in the charismatic order of the *corpus Christi*. Joachim clearly takes sides in the symbolical struggle between emperor and pope. The royal priesthood (*sacerdotium regale*) is the inheritance of the popes. The pope is not only the successor of Peter but also the vicar of Christ on earth. However, he unites the highest spiritual and temporal powers in his person; but Joachim agrees with Bernard of Clairvaux that the pope should delegate his temporal power to the secular rulers. Joachim sums up his political agenda in the *Liber Concordiae*, commenting on the Sylvester legend, a story which he and his contemporaries perceived as a historical fact:

One has to know that the man Jesus Christ, who is anointed by the Holy Spirit and rules the Christian people, is at the same time king and priest. Consequently, Peter tells the ones who belong to Christ: 'But you are a chosen race, a royal priesthood [*regale sacerdotium*]', since the royal majesty belongs to the divinity [of Christ], the humility of the priest to his humanity. Therefore, the Psalmist said: 'You are a priest for ever after the order of Melchisedech, since Melchisedech was a priest of the Lord and king of Salem. Accordingly, the Roman pope had to be king and priest at the same time. Emperor Constantine, who understood this, voluntarily offered to the holy pope Sylvester the dignity which he seemed to hold as if he owed it to Christ. But since the kingship of Christ is not of this world, it appeared to the popes as if they always had received their due power [*debita potestas*] from Christ. Nevertheless, they were forced to leave the temporal use of their kingship – or better: the bodily burden of their government [*regimen*] – to the ones who strive for the glory of this world. So, according to the apostle, the ones that strive for God will not be involved in temporal business.'²⁶

Psalterium Decern Chordarum: The Paradigm of Heavenly Order

An adequate study of Joachim's main works, the *Liber Concordiae*, the *Psalterium decern chordarum*, and the *Exposition in Apocalypsim*, must recognize the fact that the abbot relates all his exegetical novelties to visionary or mystical experiences. Already the *principium concordiarum* is, according to Joachim, the result of a vision.²⁷ The *Psalterium decern chordarum*, on the other hand, is the interpretation of another vision which Joachim recounts in the preface of the book. In 1183 Joachim was a guest at the Cistercian monastery of Casamari during Pentecost. While he was reciting the Psalms, he suddenly felt doubts about the doctrine of the Holy Trinity, namely that there are three persons but only one God. He invoked the Holy Spirit to come to his aid in his crisis and indeed had a vision:

Without delay the form of the ten-stringed psaltery appeared in my mind, and in it the very mystery of the Holy Trinity, so bright and clear, that I was immediately forced to exclaim: 'What god is great like our God? Thou art the God who workest wonders', and: 'Great is our Lord, and abundant in power; his understanding is beyond measure'.²⁸

The ten-stringed psaltery, the instrument King David used to accompany his singing of the Psalms, appeared in Joachim's vision as an image of the divine Trinity and the entire heavenly order.²⁹ Table XIII of the *Liber figurarum*, which is directly related to Joachim's vision, shows a triangular string instrument with a flattened top corner.³⁰ According to Joachim, the flattened top represents the Father, the origin of all being, and the two corners at the bottom represent the Son and the Spirit. The perfect circle of the sound hole symbolizes the perfect unity (*unitas perfecta*) of the Trinity.³¹ The 10 strings represent the 10 ranks of the heavenly order. The

strings of the psaltery become shorter towards the top, representing the hierarchy of the heavenly society. The masses dwell in the lower ranks while elites occupy the upper ranks.³² Nevertheless, all ranks unite to praise God; and the sound of their songs permeates the whole psaltery and resonates in the corners of the instrument to please all three persons of the Trinity.

By symbolizing the heavenly order in the psaltery, Joachim shows that he agrees with the general medieval idea of creation: the meaning of creation is to praise the creator. The heavenly order of praise was perfect until Satan and the apostate angels rebelled against their creator and fell out of the order. God created man to fill this gap in the heavenly choir of praise and, once proving himself worthy, even stand above the nine angelic ranks of the heavenly order.³³ This is why, in the image of psaltery as found in the *Liber figurarum*, Joachim calls the tenth and highest string *homo*. The fall of Adam sabotaged the divine plan. However, it could not prevent its final fulfilment because God decided to reveal himself to mankind in the long process of history in order to remind them of the meaning of their existence. Consequently, history has one single goal: mankind must gradually regain the condition which makes it worthy of entering the afterlife and joining in with the heavenly hymns of praise.

Accordingly, the paradigm of the heavenly order determines the meaning and end of the human social order in this world. Joachim was convinced that only someone to whom the Holy Spirit had given the charismatically gift of insight into the invisible things (*invisibilia*) of heaven, knows how the visible things (*visibilia*) on earth should be ordered to satisfy the divine will. Therefore it is impossible to distinguish between theological and political ideas in Joachim's thought of order. His teachings about human society spring from his contemplative and visionary insights into the divine order: Christianity is perfectly ordered if it praises God in the most perfect way.

The heavenly paradigm prompts Joachim to reformulate the model of medieval society. He rearranges the three orders according to the principle of achievement. Only monks, who dedicate their life to God and manage to sing all 150 Psalms in one day, deserve the highest social rank. Clerics, who engage in the *vita activa* and are burdened with preaching and pastoral care, must be of a lower rank. Lay people, who have to take care of bodily needs

and have only little time to praise God, find themselves at the bottom of society.³⁴

Joachim, of course, realizes that the social reality of his time does not fit the paradigm, but is convinced that such a society will be achieved in the future, as soon as the divine process of revelation and education has come to an end. A few words about Joachim's theology of revelation will make his argument clearer. In accordance with doctrine, he believed that Father, Son, and Holy Spirit are three persons but one essence. Therefore the divine persons do not differ in substance, quality, and quantity; rather their individual property (*proprietas*) is determined by their relation (*relatio*) to the other persons.³⁵ Joachim describes the *proprietates* as processions (*processiones*) within the divinity, according to the image of the psaltery: the two lines that take their starting point from the flattened corner of the Father symbolize the two *processiones* by which the Son and the Holy Spirit proceed from the Father. The property of the Father is that he does not proceed from another person but the two other persons proceed from him. The property of the Son is that he proceeds from the Father while the Holy Spirit proceeds from him. Finally, the property of the Holy Spirit is that it proceeds from the Father and the Son (*filioque*).³⁶ However, all these processions are eternal and do not happen in time since the coeternity (*coaeternitas*) of the three persons follows from their being of the same substance,

In order to appear to intelligible man, who exists in time, the eternal processions must manifest themselves in the historical process of divine revelation. Consequently, the processions inside the divinity correspond to the temporal missions (*missiones*) of the Son and the Holy Spirit. Joachim believed that these missions, too, were shown to him on the occasion of the vision of the psaltery:

The fact that this [flattened] corner is the principal one and apparently differs slightly from the other two seems to teach us that the Father, since he does not proceed from any other [person], will never be sent to man; at any rate he has no origin [*principium*] from which he could be sent. But the Son and the Spirit, who flow into the heavenly city and fill the nine choirs of the angels with their grace, flow further down like the current of a river in order to redeem mankind.³⁷

The missions of the Son and the Spirit reveal to man an increasing knowledge about the divine reality. In this way, mankind gradually progresses from the ignorance which resulted from the fall of Adam. At the

end of this process mankind will enter heaven, climb the tenth string of the psaltery, and rank above the nine choirs of the angels. To Joachim, redemption means participation in the eternal praise of God – as it is said in Psalm 84: ‘Blessed are those who dwell in thy house, ever singing thy praise!’³⁸

Joachim’s interpretation of his vision of the psaltery raised two significant questions. First, how will it come about that the earthly institution of the future church corresponds to the heavenly paradigm? How can monks, who contribute the greatest part to the praise of God, take the highest position of Christian society? Second, if the New Testament recounts the temporal mission of the Son, how will the mission of the Spirit become manifest? Only another unexpected illumination would solve these problems.

The Easter Experience

When he started working on the *Psalterium decern chordarum*, Joachim had already begun to write a complete commentary on the Revelation of John. However, he did not progress very far because he was unable to disclose the meaning of the tenth verse of the first chapter. In this verse John of Patmos describes the pneumatic experience which initiated his apocalyptic visions: ‘I was in the Spirit on the Lord’s day (*fui in spiritu in dominica die*)’. Then, during the Easter of 1185, the breakthrough happened. Joachim reports the event as follows:

About the middle of the night’s silence, as I think, the hour when it is thought that our Lion of the tribe of Judah rose from the dead, as I was meditating, suddenly something of the fullness of the book and of the entire harmony of the Old and New Testaments was perceived with clarity of understanding in my mind’s eye.³⁹

Joachim explicitly says that he received a revelation (*mihi revelatio facta est*), though its content is not important for the present discussion. The harmony of the testaments had always been the foundation of his exegetical work. As with the ‘fullness’ (*plenitudo*) of the Apocalypse, Joachim’s conviction had always been that the Revelation of John contains in encoded form all sacred history. What is important is that he believed that he had repeated the pneumatic experience of John of Patmos. Joachim himself was ‘in the spirit on the Lord’s day’.⁴⁰

Looking back, Joachim related a number of decisive insights to his Easter experience. One of these insights is of particular interest: Joachim says that he learned that ‘Christ, who leaves his grave, signifies the spirit that proceeds from the letter [*Christus de monumento egrediens spiritum de littera signaverit processurus*]’.⁴¹ The fact that Joachim speaks again of the procession of the spirit points to the processions inside the divinity which he described in the *Psalterium decern chordarum*. Joachim now believed that he had understood the way in which God manifests his Trinitarian essence in the process of revelation.

Just as the Son proceeds from the Father, the letter of the New Testament proceeds from the letter of the Old Testament. Just as the Spirit proceeds from the Father and the Son, spiritual understanding (*intellectus spiritualis*) proceeds from the Old and the New Testaments. The Father reveals himself particularly in the Old Testament and the Son in the New Testament. The Spirit, however, will have its own time, in which human understanding will transcend the letter of the Bible. Joachim refers to the Gospel of John where Christ says: ‘I have yet many things to say to you, but you cannot bear them now. When the Spirit of truth comes, he will guide you into all the truth; for he will not speak on his own authority, but whatever he hears he will speak, and he will declare to you the things that are to come.’⁴² At the end of the revelatory process mankind will regain the knowledge which it had lost because of Adam’s sin:

Thus it is proper for mankind after the guilt of the first man to return gradually [*gradatim*] to the cognition of its creator; so it may be rooted in the first time of the Father, grow in the second time of the Son and experience the sweet fruit in the third age of the Holy Spirit.⁴³

The Easter of 1185 marks the beginning of this new stage in the process of revelation, the beginning of the third age of the world (*tertius status mundi*). Joachim was so much convinced about the significance of his Easter experience that he regarded himself as being positioned at the beginning of the third *status* (*in initio tertii status positi sumus*).⁴⁴ Just as the first Easter event, the resurrection of Christ, initiated the second *status* the second Easter event, Joachim’s revelation, initiated the third *status*. Joachim even says that his lifetime is the end of the old times and the beginning of the new times (*quantum ad vetera finis [...] et quantum ad nova principium subsequentium saeculorum*).⁴⁵ In the *Liber concordiae*, he expresses his consciousness of progress with an almost endless number of metaphors.⁴⁶

It is evident that Joachim's consciousness of epoch contradicts the traditional Augustinian idea of history. The age of the church, initiated by Christ, is no longer an age which is passing away (*saeculum senescens*); rather it is the preliminary stage for a time of spiritual fullness (*plenitudo intellectus*) which anticipates the heavenly *visio Dei*. Consequently, Joachim had to revise Augustine's doctrine of world ages. According to Augustine, the time between Adam and Christ comprised five ages (*aetates*) and with Christ started the sixth age. The seventh age, the sabbath of the people of God, signified the eternal bliss of the beyond.⁴⁷ Joachim, on the other hand, transferred the seventh *aetas* into this world and identified it with the third *status*, whereas the final redemption in the beyond was to be seen as an eighth age. The seventh age, however, would anticipate the glory of the heavenly Jerusalem (*pars quaedam claritatis Ierusalem manifesta erit in septima, et tota generaliter in octava*) and bring about a social order which would, even in details, correspond to the heavenly paradigm.⁴⁸

[...] in the seventh age, even the smallest detail of the structure of Jerusalem will be completed just as the convocation of all the people that will dwell in it [*perficiatur in septima, quicquid minus erit in structura Ierusalem, et vocatione universi populi, qui futurus est in ea*] – insofar as in the future world, which will be like an eighth age, everything will evidently be fulfilled, which is related to this [convocation].⁴⁹

Thus, after the Easter experience, the main task of Joachim's exegetical efforts was no longer to show the harmony between the two testaments, but to interpret the Bible in order to 'make known the order and the progress by which God directs his works toward the end of times [*ut ostenderemus, quo ordine et quo profectus deus perduxerit opera sua ad fines saeculorum*]'.⁵⁰

Joachim's Idea of Social Progress

The Easter experience created a new self-understanding. Joachim was now convinced that he was one of the spiritual men (*viri spirituales*) poised at the watershed of times and about to receive a higher spiritual knowledge which will gradually become knowledge common to all in the third *status*. But if knowledge about the divine order in heaven was to increase, so, too, would knowledge about the ideal order of earthly society. Joachim recognizes that neither the social order of the clergy nor the monastic orders corresponded to the heavenly paradigm. Not even the Cistercian order, which had achieved the most in praising God, was part of the paradigm.

Joachim draws the practical consequences, gathers a number of his adherents, and climbs the Sila Mountains to found the new Florentian order. The Florentians regard themselves as the avant-garde of the third *status*; they anticipate the developments that would soon take place in the entire church.⁵¹ Joachim prophesies that in the near future Christianity will transform itself into a universal spiritual church (*ecclesia spiritualis*) dominated by monks, by those who devote their life to the praise of God.

Joachim understands an historically changing Christian society as the expression of the increasing knowledge provided by God's gradual self-revelation. In other words, the more God reveals about himself, the more perfect the social order becomes – until finally the society of the spiritual church mirrors the heavenly order. In this way, Joachim of Fiore is the first political thinker to work out a theory of social progress. He goes even further when he predicts that the order of mankind in the third *status* will be perfect and fulfil the will of God in every respect (*perfectio hominum illius status, in quibus fient omnia ordinatae secundum praeceptum domini*), even though he has to admit that this perfection is limited like all earthly things and is only a temporal anticipation of the eternal perfection in the beyond.⁵² The following paragraphs will take a closer look at the single stages in Joachim's theory of social progress.

After the Fall

Joachim describes the *conditio humana* after the fall as a dark night of ignorance.⁵³ The expulsion from Paradise means primarily an intellectual loss, since the human beings lost knowledge of the creator, and consequently knowledge of the meaning of their existence. They only have a faint idea of a superior power, experiencing their situation only in terms of punishment. God does not yet reveal himself to a chosen people but only to individuals such as Noah. At this stage of history it is hardly possible to speak of social order because all ordering of society is the result of the knowledge about the divine. According to their faint and diffuse idea of God, mankind looks like a single undifferentiated and unstructured mass.⁵⁴

The First Status

The fall of man cannot prevent God from fulfilling his plan. Man is the summit of creation and created according in the image of God. He is

supposed to fill the gap caused by the fall of Satan and his adherents, and to adorn the heavenly court for the glory of God. That is why the creator starts to reveal himself and to commend the knowledge about the divine things. Of course, at this point of history mankind is in a childlike stage of its development and can never comprehend the fullness of the triune divinity. Therefore, God first reveals himself as the Father because he has to teach discipline to mankind and make it obedient by means of his fatherly punishment. Only hereafter can mankind progress to higher stages of understanding.⁵⁵ God now reveals himself first of all to the chosen people. Just as with a child, he provides Israel with the simple rules of the Ten Commandments in order to show it how to behave according to the will of the Father.⁵⁶ The first *status* already starts with Abraham, who receives the commandment of circumcision. The symbolic meaning of the circumcision is that the ancient people of God still have carnal knowledge of divine revelation. Because Israel knows nothing of the perfection of society in the afterlife, its political goal is to establish a messianic empire on earth. Abraham and his family are the paradigm of the social order in the first *status*. Since God first revealed himself as the Father, the social form of Israel is patriarchal.⁵⁷

The Second Status

The mission of the Son initiates a new stage in the process of revelation. Christ reveals to humans the otherworldly goal of their lives, the eternal life. The new people of God no longer strive for a messianic empire on earth but for the heavenly Jerusalem, even though knowledge of heavenly things is still incomplete. The new order of clerics emerges and assumes a social form according to the model of Christ himself. The clerics imitate not only the priesthood of Christ but also his continence. Like Christ, the clerics are procreated but do not procreate. Instead, they create spiritual offspring by preaching and administering the sacraments.⁵⁸

The Third Status

In the future age of the Spirit a higher knowledge, which is already at work in spiritual men like Joachim, will proceed from the Bible:

Just as the letter of the Old Testament seems, because of a certain proper similarity, to correspond to the Father, and the letter of the New Testament corresponds to the Son, the

spiritual intelligence [*spiritualis intelligentia*], which proceeds from the two, corresponds to the Holy Spirit.⁵⁹

A number of passages in the work of Joachim suggest that the new spiritual understanding differs decisively from all other forms of gaining knowledge. The reading of books, including the Bible, will no longer be necessary where the divine Spirit provides immediate knowledge about the heavenly things.⁶⁰ The celebration of the sacraments will lose its importance because the mysteries, which are enclosed in the sacraments, will be open and completely understandable.⁶¹

It must be acknowledged that in the third status the mysteries will lie naked and open before the eyes of the believers because, in the course of the ages of the world, knowledge will be multiplied [*scientia multiplicatur*].⁶²

This peculiar form of knowledge determines the society of the third *status*. Clerics will lose their eminent position while monks will dominate the new spiritual church. Nevertheless, the social orders of the previous two *status*, the clerics and the laity, will continue to exist. Lay people will still be necessary for the bodily procreation of children and in order to secure the material subsistence of the other two orders. But if there are lay people, there must also be clerics who engage in pastoral care. In other words, the church of the third *status* has to be regarded as a hierarchical society which is divided into three orders. But this society meets all requirements of a perfect order. Firstly, it corresponds to the hierarchical order of the heavenly paradigm. Secondly, the social rank of the individual orders is determined by their achievements in praising God, with monks occupying the top rank, clerics an intermediate position, and lay people the lowest.

Joachim's conception of a perfect society is guided by the biblical word that God created man in his own image.⁶³ In the third *status*, at the end of a long historical process of revelation and education, man will regain his likeness with the creator, which he lost after the fall. But man will regain this likeness not as an individual but within the collective of the Christian society. Of course, at the end of history, Christian society will comprehend virtually all mankind. As was shown above, each of the three social orders has a special relation to one of the three persons of the Trinity but the unity of Christian society corresponds to the unity of the divinity:

[...] just as the order of the married [lay] people [*ordo coniugatorum*], which becomes manifest in the first age, seems to correspond to the Father because of his proper similarity,

and just as the order of the preachers [*ordo praedicatorum*], which becomes manifest in the second age, corresponds to the Son, the order of the monks [*ordo monachorum*], to which are particularly given the last ages, corresponds to the Holy Spirit. Accordingly, the first status is ascribed to the Father, the second to the Son, and the third to the Holy Spirit; but one must also say, that there is just one status of the world and only one people of the elect, and that all [orders] pertain at the same time to the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit.⁶⁴

Joachim's theory of progress in human society is even more complex. As a monk himself, he has to demonstrate why the monastic order already exists in early Christianity instead of emerging at the beginning of the third *status*. Therefore, Joachim includes in the doctrine of the three *status* the idea of certain starting times (*initiationes*), in which a social avant-garde anticipates the dominating order of the following *status*.⁶⁵ The idea implies that the avant-garde anticipates the revelation which, in the future, will be available to everybody. Accordingly, Joachim says that God reveals himself to a small number of elect even before Abraham. In this way, Noah becomes a forerunner of the patriarchs of Israel. In the first *status*, King Uzziah forced his way into the temple and tried to usurp priestly powers, and, like Melchizedek, the king of Salem, he anticipated the royal priesthood of Christ and the clerics.⁶⁶ In another way, the priestly tribe of the Levites also anticipates the clerical order of the second *status*. The monastic order, however, must have two starting times, just as the Spirit proceeds from the Father and the Son. Joachim writes that the monastic order proceeds not only from the clerical church of the second *status* but also from the lay people of Israel. The prophets of the Old Testament anticipate the monastic way of living. Elijah is the Archetype of the anchorites as well as Elisha and his students practise an early form of cloistered living.⁶⁷

Conclusion

Since the political has been described above as the meaningful dimension of social order, the basic idea of Joachim's political thought can be expressed as follows. The progressive self-revelation of God motivates and determines the historical process of social advancement. In the final stage of the third *status*, this process will bring about the perfect political order which corresponds to the paradigm of heavenly order and reflects the essence of God. What the perfect political order exactly looks like can be studied in the detailed sketch of a constitution, which Joachim provides in

the *Liber figurarum*.⁶⁸ The title of the constitution shows that the political perfection anticipates the order of the beyond. It says: ‘The Constitution of the New Order Pertaining to the Third Status after the Model of the Heavenly Jerusalem [*Dispositio novi ordinis pertinens ad tertium statum ad instar supernae Ierusalem*]’.

The details of Joachim’s constitution cannot be discussed here; it is more important to reconstruct the essential steps of his political thought after the spiritual experiences of the Pentecost of 1183 and the Easter of 1185. It is obvious that all of Joachim’s political and social ideas are deduced from his insight into things invisible:

1. *Processiones*, the transcendental sphere of divine reality. The paramount reality is the triune essence of the divinity, into which Joachim gained insight at the occasion of the Pentecostal vision of the psalter. It is the transcendent sphere of the eternal processions (*processiones*) which determine the properties of the divine persons: a) the Father proceeds from no other person, but Son and Spirit proceed from him; b) the Son proceeds from the Father while the Spirit proceeds from him, and c) the Spirit proceeds from the Son and the Father.
2. *Missiones*, the historical sphere of divine self-revelation. As a result of Adam’s fall, man lost his knowledge of his creator and God began a long process of re-education. The missions (*missiones*) that happen in the course of the revelatory process correspond to the processions inside the transcendent sphere: a) there is no mission of the Father, but the Father sends the Son and the Spirit; b) the Son is sent on his mission by the Father while he himself sends the Spirit, together with the Father, and c) the Spirit is sent by the Father and the Son.
3. *Littera* and *intellectus*, the sphere of human understanding. The missions find their expressions in the letter (*littera*) of the Bible. The more God reveals about himself the greater is the human understanding (*intellectus*) of the mysteries hidden in the text: a) the revelation of the Father manifests itself in the letter of the Old Testament; b) from the letter of the Old Testament proceeds the letter of the New Testament, revealing a deeper meaning of the Old Testament, and c) from the letter of the Old and the New Testament proceeds spiritual understanding, the most profound understanding of the revelatory text.

4. *Ordines*, the sphere of social order. The increasing knowledge about divine revelation manifests itself in the social structure of the people of God and its orders (*ordines*): a) knowledge of the Father manifests itself in the patriarchal order of Israel; b) knowledge of the Son lets the clerical order proceed from the lay people, and c) from the orders of the clerics and the laity proceeds the order of the monks.

Joachim's prophecies about the future of Christian society are obviously influenced by contemporary developments. On the one hand, the abbot stands in the tradition of the Gregorian reform movement and papal policy since the investiture controversy: the liberty of the church (*libertas ecclesiae*) was to be accomplished by depriving the laity of all control. On the other hand, Joachim observed the Cistercian movement as well as the manifold forms of monasticism which spread, with as yet unknown speed, across the West. Therefore, in two respects Joachim goes beyond the goals of the Gregorian reformers. Firstly, the purification of the clergy is not enough; the church must become a monastic and spiritual church. Secondly, it is not sufficient to liberate the church from the hands of lay rulers; the liberty of the church will be complete only once worldly power no longer exists.

By interpreting the Bible and his own spiritual experiences, Joachim finally found an answer to the fundamental political question which occupies him in all of his main works: What must Christianity look like if it is perfectly ordered and differentiated (*si religio Christiana perfecte esset ordinata et distincta*)?⁶⁹

Notes

¹ 'Politically, Joachim's expectation for the future struck a deterministic note. [...] The Roman Empire had been ordained to hold back barbarian hordes, but when God's Sixth Angel poured his phial on the Euphrates (i.e. the Roman Empire), it would collapse, an event already foreshadowed in the disaster of Frederick Barbarossa and his crusade army in 1187. There was no future political order in Joachim's Sabbath Age: significantly, when he used the symbol of David's triumphal assumption of power in Jerusalem, it was together with the papacy that he placed him in concord. [...] There was to be no salvation through political agencies.' Marjorie Reeves, *Joachim of Fiore and the Prophetic Future* (London, 1976, 2nd rev. edn Stroud, Gloucestershire, 1999), 59.

² 'Political hopes and rivalries soon entered eschatological history. The temptation to allot the roles of worst tyrant and most glorious emperor was irresistible. Thus when, about the middle of the thirteenth century, Joachimites began to realize the implications of Joachim's third *status*, they immediately sought to apply these politically. In contrast to the Abbot's own works, the pseudo-Joachimist writings are full of political prophecy.' Marjorie Reeves, *The Influence of Prophecy in the Later Middle Ages: A Study in Joachimism* (Oxford, 1969, repr. Notre Dame, 1993), 306.

³ 'Here for the first time we meet Joachim's third *status* recast in political terms, with the second great luminary of the world substituted for the papacy in the work of renewal. So the two streams – of Joachimism and of the ancient World Emperor tradition – meet in this political programme to bring in the seventh age.' Reeves, *Joachim of Fiore*, 62; cf. ead., *Influence*, 311.

⁴ Reeves, *Joachim of Fiore*, 72–82; ead., *Influence*, 393–508.

⁵ 'The state and secular spirit conquered their spheres of power in the fierce battle against the Romano-German Empire of the Middle Ages, and in the course of this struggle linguistic symbols developed, which do not reflect reality as such but which seek to capture and defend the opposite positions of the struggle. The concepts of religion and politics followed the institutions and their symbols: They entered the battlefield and placed themselves under the authority of the linguistic symbols used in the struggle. For this reason, cognition today still involves the contrasts formed under the pressure of their conceptual instruments, although a critical look might reveal merely different examples of the effectiveness of closely related fundamental human forces. The currently prevalent concepts of religion and state in general European usage as well as in a more limited research-based usage are oriented towards certain models whose significance can be traced back to the intellectual struggles waged in Europe. By religion one understands such phenomena as Christianity and the other great redemptive religions; by state one means the political organizations of the type of the modern nation-state.' Eric Voegelin, 'The Political Religions', in *The Collected Works of Eric Voegelin*, vol. 5 (Columbia, NY, and London, 2000), 19–73, at 27–8.

⁶ Friedrich Heer, *Aufgang Europas. Eine Studie zu den Zusammenhängen zwischen politischer Religiosität, Frömmigkeitsstil und dem Werden Europas im 12. Jahrhundert* (Vienna and Zurich, 1948), 10.

⁷ Friedrich Kempf, 'Das Problem der Christianitas im 12. und 13. Jahrhundert,' *Historisches Jahrbuch der Görres-Gesellschaft*, 79 (1960), 104–23.

⁸ Walter Ullmann, *The Growth of Papal Government in the Middle Ages: A Study in the Ideological Relation of Clerical to Lay Power* (London, 1970), 264; cf. the discussion in Richard W. Southern, *Western Society and the Church in the Middle Ages* (Harmondsworth, 1970), 15–34.

⁹ Thomas Aquinas, *De regno*, i, 1, cit. *Divi Thomae Aquinatis De regimine principum ad regem Cypri et De regimine Judaeorum ad ducissam Brabantiae: politica opuscula duo* (Turin, 1924), 1; cf. Aristode, *Politics*, 1253a.

¹⁰ 'Das Politische umgreift und durchformt [...] die verschiedenen sozialen Lebenssphären ungeachtet des jeweiligen Differenzierungsgrades, insofern jedes politisch-symbolische Ordnungsgefüge die Gesamtexistenz des Menschen repräsentiert. Das heißt, alle politischen Gestaltungen artikulieren in unterschiedlicher Konstellation die Dimensionen des Menschlichen, die leiblich-physische, die affekt-psychische ebenso wie die intellektuelle und spirituell-religiöse Dimension.' Jürgen Gebhardt, 'Was ist der Gegenstand einer empirisch-hermeneutischen Theorie des Politischen?', in *Politische Theorie – heute. Ansätze und Perspektiven*, ed. Michael Th. Greven and Rainer Schmalz-Bruns (Baden-Baden, 1999), 101–19, at 109; 'Im Politischen offenbart sich jene der menschlichen Existenz eigene Dimension des Geistes und der Freiheit jenseits der biologischen Bedingtheit, der sich die Humanität des Menschen verdankt.' Ibid., 117; cf. Eric Voegelin, *Anamnesis. Theorie der Geschichte und der Politik* (Munich, 1966), 283–354.

¹¹ For a more detailed discussion, see my monograph *Joachim von Fiore – Denker der vollendeten Menschheit* (Würzburg, 2004).

¹² For an excellent overview of the medieval debates concerning this problem, see John A. Watt, 'Spiritual and Temporal Powers', in *The Cambridge History of Medieval Political Thought*, c. 350–c. 1450, ed. James H. Burns (Cambridge, 1988), 367–423.

¹³ Joseph Lortz, *Geschichte der Kirche in ideengeschichtlicher Betrachtung*, vol. 1: *Altertum und Mittelalter* (Münster, 1962), 296.

- ¹⁴ Augustine, *De civitate Dei*, lib. xx, cap. 2, CCSL 48, 701.
- ¹⁵ Augustine, *De civitate Dei*, lib. xx, cap. 5, CCSL 48, 703f.
- ¹⁶ Augustine, *De civitate Dei*, lib. xx, cap. 2, CCSL 48, 701.
- ¹⁷ Augustine, *De civitate Dei*, lib. xx, cap. 7, CCSL 48, 710–12; lib. xx, cap. 9, 718.
- ¹⁸ The best overview of the shifts in the interpretation of the Revelation of John is still to be found in: Wilhelm Kamlah, *Apokalypse und Geschichtstheologie. Die mittelalterliche Auslegung der Apokalypse vor Joachim von Fiore* (Berlin, 1935).
- ¹⁹ Bernard McGinn, 'Apocalypticism and Church Reform: 1100–1500', in *The Encyclopedia of Apocalypticism, vol 2: Apocalypticism in Western History and Culture*, ed. Bernard McGinn (New York, 1999), 74–109, at 85.
- ²⁰ Joachim of Fiore, *Intelligentia super calathis*, ed. Pietro de Leo, *Gioacchino da Fiore. Aspetti inediti della vita e dell'opere* (Soveria Mannelli, 1988), 135–48, at 135.
- ²¹ 'Concordiam proprie esse dicimus similitudinem eque proportionis noui ac ueteris testamenti; eque dico quo ad numerum, non quo ad dignitatem; cum uidelicet persona et persona, ordo et ordo, bellum et bellum ex paritate quadam mutuis se uultibus intuentur: utpote Abraham et Zacharias, Sara et Elisabeth, Isaac et Iohannes baptista, Iacob et homo Christus Ihesus, duodecim patriarche et numeri eiusdem apostoli [...].', Joachim of Fiore, *Fiber de Concordia Noui ac Veteris Testamenti*, ed. E. Randolph Daniel, *Transactions of the American Philosophical Society*, 73/8 (Philadelphia, 1983), 3–435, at 62.
- ²² Rev. 5:1–7; 6; 8:1–5
- ²³ Joachim of Fiore, *Genealogia*, ed. Gian Luca Potestà, 'Die Genealogia. Ein frühes Werk Joachims von Fiore und die Anfänge seines Geschichtsbildes', *Deutsches Archiv für Erforschung des Mittelalters*, 56 (2000), 55–101, at 95–6. Unless indicated otherwise, all translations from Joachim are my own.
- ²⁴ For interpretations of the *Intelligentia super calathis*, see Herbert Grundmann, 'Kirchenfreiheit und Kaisermacht um 1190' in id., *Ausgewählte Aufsätze Teil 2: Joachim von Fiore*, Schriften der Monumenta Germaniae Historica 25/2 (Stuttgart, 1977), 360–402; Riedl, *Joachim von Fiore*, 168–203; Julia Eva Wannenmacher, *Hermeneutik der Heilsgeschichte. De Septem sigillis und das Motiv der sieben Siegel im Werk Joachims von Fiore*, Studies in the History of Christian Traditions, 118 (Leiden and Boston, 2005), 148–55.
- ²⁵ Joachim of Fiore, *Intelligentia*, 136. The edition of De Leo has *misteria* instead of *ministeria*. For a correction of the text, see Grundmann, 'Kirchenfreiheit', 372–3.
- ²⁶ Joachim of Fiore, *Concordia*, ed. Daniel, 329; cf. 1 Pet. 2:9; Ps. 110:4; Gen. 14: 18; John 18:36; 2 Tim. 2:4.
- ²⁷ Joachim of Fiore, *Concordia*, ed. Daniel, 146.
- ²⁸ Joachim of Fiore, *Psalterium decem chordarum* (Venice, 1527), fol. 227va; ed. Kurt-Victor Selge, *Joachim von Fiore. Psalterium decem cordarum, MGH, Quellen zur Geistesgeschichte des Mittelalters* 20 (Hannover, 2009), 6–355, at 10, Ps. 77:14–15; 147: 5.
- ²⁹ See Ps. 33:2; 92:4.
- ³⁰ Joachim of Fiore, *Fiber figurarum*, ed. Leone Tondelli, Marjorie Reeves and Beatrice Hirsch-Reich, *Il libro delle figure dell'abate Gioacchino da Fiore*, 2 vols (Turin, 1953), ii, tav. xiii.
- ³¹ Joachim of Fiore, *Psalterium*, fol. 232vb–233ra, ed. Selge, 43.
- ³² Joachim of Fiore, *Isalterium*, fol. 243ra–rb, ed. Selge, 111.
- ³³ 'Nota quod homo prelatus est omnibus ordinibus angelorum propter verbum patris humanam carnem assumens, ut gradum chorde decimum qui corrui restauraret.' (Ps.-) Joachim of Fiore, *Psalterium* (re vera *Praemissiones*), fol. 226r, cf. ed. Selge, LXIX.
- ³⁴ Joachim of Fiore, *Psalterium*, fol. 245ra–va, ed. Selge, 122–5.

- ³⁵ Joachim of Fiore, *Psalterium*, fol. 230vb, 258va, ed. Selge, 28–30, 206–7.
- ³⁶ The formula ‘the Spirit proceeds from the Father and the Son’, the so-called ‘Filioque’ was the occasion of the Greek schism and again heavily debated in Joachim’s time. At the Fourth Lateran Council of 1215 the ‘Filioque’ was declared Catholic doctrine. Cf. Bernd Oberdorfer, *Filioque. Geschichte und Theologie eines ökumenischen Problems*, Forschungen zur systematischen und ökumenischen Theologie 96 (Göttingen, 2001), and Peter Gemeinhardt, ‘Joachim the Theologian. Trinitarian Speculation and Doctrinal Debate’ in *Companion to Joachim of Fiore*, ed. Matthias Riedl and Julia Eva Wannenmacher (forthcoming).
- ³⁷ Joachim of Fiore, *Psalterium*, fol. 236ra, ed. Selge, 63–4.
- ³⁸ Joachim of Fiore, *Psalterium*, fol. 227ra, ed. Selge, 7.
- ³⁹ Joachim of Fiore, *Expositio in Apocalypsim* (Venice, 1527), fol. 39va. The English translation of this quotation is taken from Bernard McGinn, *The Calabrian Abbot: Joachim of Fiore in the History of Western Thought* (New York, 1985), 21–2.
- ⁴⁰ Cf. Robert Lerner, ‘Joachim of Fiore’s Breakthrough to Chiliasm’, *Cristianesimo nella storia*, 6 (1985), 459–512, at 494.
- ⁴¹ Joachim of Fiore, *Expositio*, fol. 39va.
- ⁴² John 16:12–13; cf. Joachim of Fiore, *Liber concordiae Novi ac Veteris Testamenti* (Venice, 1519), fol. 112rb; Joachim of Fiore, *Expositio*, fol. 86rb–va.
- ⁴³ Joachim of Fiore, *Praephatio super Apocalypsim*, ed. Kurt-Victor Selge, ‘Eine Einführung Joachims von Fiore in die Johannesapokalypse’, *Deutsches Archiv für Erforschung des Mittelalters*, 46/1 (1990), 85–131, at 102.
- ⁴⁴ Joachim of Fiore, *Expositio*, fol. 39rb.
- ⁴⁵ Joachim of Fiore, *Expositio*, fol. 39vb.
- ⁴⁶ ‘Tres denique mundi status nobis, ut iam scripsimus in hoc opere, divine pagine sacramenta commendant. primum, in quo fuimus sub lege; secundum, in quo sumus sub gratia; tertium, quod e vicino expectamus, sub ampliori gratia, quia gratiam, inquit Iohannes, pro gratia dedit nobis, fidem scilicet pro caritate, etsi simul utrumque. primus ergo status in scientia fuit, secundus in parte sapientie, tertius in plenitudine intellectus. primus in Servitute servili, secundus in Servitute filiali, tertius in libertate. primus in flagellis, secundus in actione, tertius in contemplatione. primus in timore, secundus in fide, tertius in caritate. primus status servorum est, secundus liberorum, tertius amicorum. primus puerorum, secundus iuvenum, tertius senum. primus in luce syderum, secundus in aurora, tertius in perfecto die. primus in hyeme, secundus in exordio veris, tertius in estate. primus protulet Urticas, secundus rosas, tertius lilia. primus herbas, secundus spicas, tertius triticum. primus aquam, secundus vinum, tertius oleum.’ Joachim of Fiore, *Concordia*, fol. 112rb–va.
- ⁴⁷ Augustine, *De civitate Dei*, lib. xxii, 30, CCSL 48, 866.
- ⁴⁸ Joachim of Fiore, *Enchiridion super Apocalypsim*, ed. Edward Kilian Burger, *Pontifical Institute of Mediaeval Studies and Texts* 78 (Toronto, 1986), 49.
- ⁴⁹ Joachim of Fiore, *Expositio*, fol. 221rb.
- ⁵⁰ Joachim of Fiore, *Concordia*, ed. Daniel, 306.
- ⁵¹ Cf. Stephen E. Wessley, “‘Bonum est Benedicto mutare locum’: The Role of the “Life of Saint Benedict” in Joachim of Fiore’s Monastic Reform,” *Revue Bénédictine*, 90 (1980), 314–28.
- ⁵² Joachim of Fiore, *Concordia*, fol. 96rb.
- ⁵³ Joachim of Fiore, *Expositio*, fol. 5va–vb.
- ⁵⁴ Joachim of Fiore, *Enchiridion*, 23.
- ⁵⁵ Joachim of Fiore, *Expositio*, fol. 67vb; *Psalterium*, fol. 246vb, ed. Selge, 133–5.

⁵⁶ Joachim of Fiore, *Concordia*, fol. 111ra; Joachim of Fiore, *Tractatus super quatuor evangelia*, ed. Francesco Santi, *Joachim abbas Florensis Opera Omnia* 5, Fonti per la storia dell' Italia medievale (Rome, 2002), 25.

⁵⁷ Joachim of Fiore, *Expositio*, fol. 18vb.

⁵⁸ Joachim of Fiore, *Concordia*, ed. Daniel, 256–8 and 406; *Expositio*, fol. 18vb.

⁵⁹ Joachim of Fiore, *Expositio*, fol. 5rb.

⁶⁰ Cf., e.g., Joachim of Fiore, *Concordia*, fol. 103va, *Pracphatio*, 103.

⁶¹ Cf. Herbert Grundmann, 'Lex und Sacramentum bei Joachim von Fiore', in idem., *Ausgewählte Aufsätze Teil2*, 403–20.

⁶² Joachim of Fiore, *Concordia*, fol. 96va.

⁶³ Gen. 1:27.

⁶⁴ Joachim of Fiore, *Expositio*, fol. 5rb–va.

⁶⁵ Joachim of Fiore, *Expositio*, fol. 5rb ; Joachim of Fiore, *Concordia*, ed. Daniel, 66–7; *Concordia*, fol. 65va.

⁶⁶ Joachim of Fiore, *Concordia*, ed. Daniel, 68, 84, and 93; cf. 2 Kgs. 14:21–2; 15:1–7; 2 Chr. 26:1–27: 2; Gen. 14:18.

⁶⁷ Joachim of Fiore, *Concordia*, ed. Daniel, 74–5 and 77.

⁶⁸ Joachim of Fiore, *Liber figurarum*, tav. xii. An English translation of the constitution can be found in Bernard McGinn, *Apocalyptic Spirituality: Treatises and Letters of Lactantius, Adso of Montier-en-Der, Joachim of Fiore, the Spiritual Franciscans, Savonarola* (Mahwah, NJ, 1979), 142–8. A German translation and commentary is included in Riedl, *Joachim von Fiore*, 309–34.

⁶⁹ Joachim of Fiore, *Concordia*, fol. 71rb.

Chapter 5

Prophecy and Exegesis in the *Visio* Attributed to Joachim of Fiore¹

John V. Fleming

Marjorie Reeves taught us that as a body of thought the principal genre of the works of Joachim of Fiore is that of scriptural exegesis. That is to say, in many instances, that his books constitute a certain kind of criticism or appreciation of sacred poetry as we find it in the Psalms, the great prophets, or the Revelation of John. Joachim's mind combined speculative daring and an appetite for taxonomies with the imagination of a poet to create the thematically opulent books that have enthralled so many readers, modern and medieval alike. But was he an actual poet? The principal subject of my contribution to the memory of a great scholar will be one of the only two poems to have been ascribed to him: an eschatological vision of the state of souls after death in 118 lines. Yet I must enter it in a somewhat oblique manner through the brief consideration of two broader topics: the traditional relationship between poetry and prophecy on the one hand, and on the other some of the techniques used by medieval poets to infuse their composition with the prophetic energies of exegetical images.

Of course, if Joachim did not write any poetry, he was an eccentric among 'prophets', ancient *or* medieval. The wedding of prophecy and poetry is more ancient even than the Sibylline books themselves. It is a union to be found in the rich connotations of the word 'vates'. But it is a

most problematic union, as the sooth of the soothsayer struggles with the opacity of his mode of saying.

Furthermore, there is in ancient literature a connection between prophecy and the eschatological topics that are the principal stuff of the medieval ‘vision’. The most famous example of such union, doubtless, is the interview of Aeneas with the Cumaean Sybil in the sixth book of the *Aeneid*. The hero approaches his momentous meeting with the Sibyl through a landscape of doubt and ambiguity. Carved upon the temple of Apollo founded by Daedalus are a series of four episodes from Athenian and Cretan history, the two latter being the cognate emblems of the Minotaur and of the Labyrinth. The language in which the labyrinth is identified rather than described is perhaps particularly suggestive of Virgil’s strategy:

*hic labor ille domus et inextricabilis error;
magnum reginae sed enim miseratus amorem
Daedalus ipse dolos tecti ambagesque resolvit,
caeca regens filo vestigia. (27–30)*

Margaret de G. Verrall long ago pointed out the particular thematic significance of the image of the labyrinth in the context of Aeneas’ own situation: ‘the labyrinth—the entangled maze from which return is impossible, save with the clue given by its maker—must be intentionally suggestive of the underworld, where Aeneas was to wander under the guidance of the Sibyl ...’².

Verrall goes on to point out that the line ‘Hic labor ille domus et inextricabilis error’ is certainly echoed a hundred lines later in what was in the Middle Ages perhaps the most frequently quoted passage from the sixth book in which the Sybil contrasts the ease with which Hell can be reached on the one hand with the great difficulty with which it can be escaped on the other:

*facilis decensus Averno ...
sed revocare gradum superasque evadere ad auras,
hoc opus, hic labor est. (126, 128–9)*

Virgil is here doubtless addressing the human condition of mortality. Fletcher puts it eloquently: ‘To go down to that world [of the dead] is easy: mankind are passing thither night and day through the gate of death. But for them it is a country from whose bourn no traveler returns. The difficulty is

to go as Orpheus and those others went, without dying, *and to return.*' ³ Here we find an important disjunction between the ancient and the medieval, for of course in the medieval vision literature the traveller always returns. There is necessarily in the medieval eschatological journey some echo of the Resurrection, for the first 'Christian' to make that pilgrimage was Christ himself, in the Harrowing of Hell. Dante brilliantly dramatizes this idea in the fourth canto of the *Inferno* in which the pilgrim guardedly asks Virgil, his guide, whether 'ever anyone, either by his own merit or another's, go out hence and come afterwards to bliss?' Virgil responds that, yes, shortly after his own arrival in Hell a mighty one ('possente') came and led out the ancient just ones. He adds 'And I would have thee know that before these no human soul was saved' – a statement that implicitly condemns Aeneas to the comparative triviality of fiction.⁴

There is another parallelism revealed by the language, a parallel between the labyrinth and the difficult, often deceitful, language of oracular prophecy – particularly when the prophecy comes in *poetic* form. Forewarned by Helenus, Aeneas knows to request that the oracle be given in oral rather than in written form.

foliis tantum ne carmina manda,
ne turbata volent rapidis ludibria ventis
ipsa canas oro. (6.74–6)

The motive here will be clear to anyone familiar with the legend of the Sybil. She has all knowledge stored within her cave, written down on brittle leaves that long since have shattered into shifting piles of fine leaf mould.

Talibus ex adyto dictis Cumaea Sibylla
Horrendas canit ambages antroque remugit,
Obscures uera inuoluens (6.98–100)

This is among the most famous passages in the *Aeneid*. But it raises, or should raise, a serious problem of interpretation. For in the event there is neither terror nor ambiguity in the Sybil's prophecy, which is clear, coherent, historically comprehensible. Another way of saying this is that her prophecy is problematically unenigmatic. Prophecies are supposed to be dark and mysterious. The word the poet uses – but in the event fails to justify – is *ambages*. 'Ambages' are studied, artful, intentional ambiguities characteristic of the pronouncements of the ancient oracles. When Chaucer introduced the word 'ambage' into the English language – by way of

Boccaccio, who had taken it from Dante, who had taken it from Virgil – he knew he must define it: ‘a *sly* double-word, a word with two faces’.⁵ The only thing sly about the Sibylline prophecy in the sixth book of the *Aeneid* is that it is a ‘prediction’ of events that have already happened, and everybody knows have happened. For a moment, Virgil falls into the mode of Joachim of Fiore: he sets out to write a history of the future; but, unlike Joachim, he cheats.

Elsewhere, of course, in the fourth eclogue, Virgil satisfied a more obvious role as a prophet of Christ. The role of the Cumaean Sybil in the sixth *Aeneid* is to announce the unfolding of the secular history of the Roman Empire. A more sacred apocalypticism was to be found in the ‘ultima ætas’ of which Virgil wrote in the fourth eclogue:

Ultima Cumaei uenit iam carminis ætas ...
Iam noua progenies caelo demittitur alto. (4.5, 8)

As James Kugel asks, ‘... did not the “truth” of the Sybil’s vaticinations ... solidify once and for all the identification of poet and prophet, hexameter and revelation, and bind tightly together two offices that under different circumstances might have gone on to pursue quite separate and distinct careers?’⁶ The great pre-Christian poet and prophet of sacred tradition was, of course, king David. David was the author of the Psalms, and the Psalms were at the very centre of medieval monastic life, thought, and worship. It is only to be expected that all of the prophet Joachim’s works are richly informed by the monastic experience of the Psalms, but he was distinctive in actually using the conception of the *psalterium* as a heuristic device in constructing his historical system.

These brief general remarks concerning poetry and prophecy must suffice to lead us to a second preliminary consideration. That is the specific feature of medieval ‘prophetic’ poetry as revealed by its characteristic use of implicit arguments and implied ideas based in the spiritual sense of Scripture. Miss Reeves, a Corresponding Fellow of the Medieval Academy, made her last trip to America in 1998 to attend the academy meeting at Stanford University. The programme included a special session in her honour. On that occasion I offered a paper that touched upon Joachimite influences in certain works of early Franciscan literature, and I would briefly return to two of them now. The first is the *Dies Iræ*, among the best-known ‘apocalyptic’ works of the Christian tradition. The union of the

sacred and the secular prophetic traditions is articulate in its opening strophe:

Dies irae, dies illa
solvat saeculum in favilla,
teste David cum Sibilla.⁷

This poem, too, is of somewhat uncertain attribution. For a long time, it has been ascribed to Thomas of Celano, who, as the author of early and authoritative biographies of Francis of Assisi, was one of the giants of early Franciscan literature.⁸ The *Dies Irae*, which came to be the appointed sequence for All Souls' Day and requiem masses generally, is among the best known of medieval hymns. Indeed, according to one authority 'It has attracted more attention than any other single hymn.'⁹ Certainly the *Dies Irae* has exercised a memorable impact on famous post-medieval writers like Goethe, who uses it powerfully in the first part of *Faust*, and Walter Scott, who in the 'Lay of the Last Minstrel' translated 'the awful burthen of the song'.

No poem early appropriated for the Mass of the Dead is likely to be sprightly or light-hearted, and the *Dies Irae* is indeed impressively sombre, and perhaps even terrifying, in its conjuration of the awful last Day of Judgement. But there are very important aspects of the text, actually quite typical of medieval treatments of 'apocalyptic' themes that tend to the hopeful and the optimistic. It has perhaps been insufficiently appreciated that the *Dies Irae* is a *personal* poem. That is, it has, or comes to have, a personal first-person voice that, appearing about a third of the way through the poem, plays an increasingly important dramatic role. The twin subjects of the *Dies Irae* are the fear of judgement and the hope of salvation. There is plenty of eschatological terror in the text, but also an articulate voice of hopeful penitence. After calling forth a tremendous scene of destruction by fire, the text turns its focus to an increasingly present, singular personage whose presence is made known in a sequence of understated but insistent personal pronouns. The initial appearance of this first person is in the seventh strophe.

(7) Quid *sum* miser tunc dicturus,
quem patronum rogaturus
dum vix justus sit securus ?

(8) Rex tremendae majestatis,

qui salvandos salvas gratis,
salva *me*, fons pietatis.

(9) Recordare Jesu pie,
quod *sum* causa tuae viae,
ne *me* perdas illa die.

Miser means something like ‘wretch’ in a moral or a psychological sense, but we must remember that in the Franciscan context it also can mean a ‘poor man’. The form is here masculine, as would befit the indeterminate status, but as we shall see presently that voice can be feminine. The *miser*, however guilty and fearful, is not, however, without hope. He – or she – audaciously reminds Christ, now imagined as present in His role as judge, that ‘I am the reason for your pilgrimage’. This curious phrase will bring us to the theological heart of the poem. The grounds for hope, explicitly stated, are previous examples of Christ’s forgiveness of conspicuous sinners – Mary Magdalene and the penitent thief:

(13) Qui Mariam absolvisti,
et latronem exaudisti,
mihi quoque spem dedisti.

But it is to another strophe, the tenth, that I would draw attention.

(10) Quærens *me* sedisti lassus,
Redemisti crucem passus;
tantus labor non sit cassus.

I translate this as follows: ‘Seeking me, you sat down exhausted; you redeemed me, suffering the cross; let not such a labour be in vain.’ This has proved to be a somewhat obscure passage in the poem. As is frequently the case with widely disseminated sacred poetry, the textual history of the sequence is considerably troubled; and we find numerous variants. The formidable monastic hymnologist Hermann Daniel published as definitive a so-called ‘Mantuan text’ in which the first line of the tenth strophe reads ‘quærens me *venisti* lassus’ – ‘Seeking me, you *came*, exhausted.’¹⁰ But if we recognize that the tenth strophe, like at least 12 others (of a total of 17) is specifically grounded in scriptural language, we must prefer the reading ‘*sedisti*’ and acknowledge its source in the evangelist John’s account of Jesus’ meeting with the Samaritan woman at the well (John 4:4–42).¹¹ Jesus, travelling with his disciples through Samaria comes to Sychar, the location of the ancient ‘well of Jacob’, around midday. Sending his

disciples to the village in search of sustenance, he himself, tired from his journey, sits down on the wellhead. It is there that he engages in conversation a Samaritan woman who comes to draw water, asking her for a drink. The relevant Vulgate text reads as follows: ‘Venit ergo in civitatem Samariae quae dicitur Sychar iuxta praedium quod dedit Iacob Ioseph filio suo; erat autem ibi fons Iacob. Iesus ergo fatigatus ex itinere sedebat sic super fontem; hora erat quasi sexta.’ – ‘He came to the city of Samaria, which is called Sychar, near the parcel of ground that Jacob gave to his son Joseph. Now Jacob’s well was there. So Jesus, exhausted from his journey, sat down at the well; and it was about the sixth hour’ (John 4:5–6). In terms of its generative powers in poetry and the visual arts the story of the Samaritan woman was most fecund both in the Middle Ages and later.

What is its special relevance for the argument of the *Dies Iræ*? The answer will be found in the Augustinian exegetical tradition. The fatiguing journey undertaken by Jesus is, in its spiritual sense, the Incarnation itself. God’s active plan for man’s salvation involves the condescension of taking on human flesh. The Samaritan woman to whom Christ offers living water is one triply despised: as a woman, as an outsider, as a notorious sinner. She is therefore the perfect emblem of erring humanity, and the appropriate subjective voice of the *Dies Iræ*. That God should take human flesh in order to seek out such a one is good news’ indeed. In his monastic sermon on this passage Augustine makes clear his conviction that the Samaritan woman is a figure for humankind in its totality, and he specifies the implication of this fact for each of his hearers individually: ‘Tibi fatigatus est ab itinere Jesus.’¹² The voice of the sequence fully grasps this personal application: ‘Quaerens *me* sedisti lassus’. The word for ‘journey’ used in the scriptural passage is *iter*. The synonym that the poetic voice has already used in the ninth strophe is *via*: *sum causa tuae viae*’ – ‘I am the cause of your pilgrimage.’ Bonaventure several times uses the idea of Christ’s redeeming mission as a journey. In one of his most widely read books, the *Breviloquium*, he speaks of Christ’s human Incarnation as a state of pilgrimage’: ‘Postremo, quia tantorum charismatum plenitudo necessario ponebat in Christo summam et perfectam felicitatem secundum sui partem superiorem licet dispensative propter nos esset in statu viae ... quia non gloriam et beatudinem animae concreatam, quae naturaliter in ipso omne meritum anteibat, sed solum illa, cum quibus status viae stare non poterat, sicut stolam carnis cum glorificatione suae excellentissimae dignitatis.’¹³

Particularly important in the exegesis of the story of the Samaritan woman is Augustine's discussion of its temporal aspect. John tells us that Jesus sat down, fatigued, 'about the sixth hour'. 'Why the sixth hour?' he asks, then immediately answers: 'because it means the sixth age of the world.' He then outlines the large historiographical scheme of the six ages that was of necessity of such great importance to all medieval millennial thinkers. The elements of Augustine's historical reading we have already seen from their reflection in Bonaventure: in the last age God humbles himself in the Incarnation for the salvation of peccant humanity.

How easily such ideas accommodated themselves to the more overtly 'apocalyptic' side of Franciscan spirituality is evidenced by the *Sacrum Commercium*, among the greatest and most original literary works of early Franciscanism. There is a remarkable passage toward its end in which the friars lead Lady Poverty down from the mountain to their modest habitation where they propose to share their meal with her. She asks, with rhetorical irony, to be shown their oratory, cloister, refectory, kitchen, dormitory, stables, their fine chairs and polished tables.¹⁴ That the friars have no such luxuries pleases Poverty. She then asks for water and a towel, in order to wash her hands before eating. They are able to provide only a common clay container of water – 'medium quiddam terreum vasculum quia perfectum non erat ibi' – and as they have no towels, they must use a tunic to dry their hands. That the author of the *Sacrum Commercium* has in mind the interview of Jesus and the Samaritan woman at the well is strongly suggested by contextual details. The woman had said to Jesus (John 4:11) that he had nothing in which to fetch water. More telling is that Jesus, the friars, and Lady Poverty herself are all three fatigued from their journey. 'Domina et regina nostra, [say the friars to Poverty] nos servi tui ex longo itinere fatigati sumus, et tu nobiscum veniens non modicum laborasti.'

There is throughout the *Sacrum Commercium* an articulate apocalyptic theme set within its historic scheme. Poverty responds to the invitation of the friars in the words of the apocalyptic Christ: 'Ecce, venio!' (Rev. 22:12). These are very nearly the last words in the Bible, and the actual last words, a few verses later, are a response to them. The suggestion is that time nears its fulfilment, but the specific time is the time of the Samaritan woman. 'Et descendentes de monte duxerunt dominam Paupertatem ad locum in quo manebant: hora enim erat quasi sexta.'

I want to stress that the author of the *Sacrum Commercium* is not ‘quoting’ Scripture, nor even alluding to it in the normal sense in which we think of literary allusion. It is rather the case that the language of the Scriptures, together with exegetical valences universally shared within his reading community, naturally comes to his mind within a certain ideographic framework. In the *Sacrum Commercium* that framework is unequivocally ‘Joachimite’ in a general sense. The author’s assumptions – unstated because they are shared with his immediate Franciscan audience – is that the Last Times have arrived or are just around the corner, that Francis was an apocalyptic messenger of ecclesiastical *renovatio*, and that the seal of evangelical perfection is evangelical poverty.

This has perhaps proven ‘a long preamble of a tale’, as Chaucer’s friar says, but it has seemed to me a necessary procedure if I am to avoid the difficulties of a demonstration of the *ignotum per ignotius*. If the techniques of artistic appropriation and deployment of exegetical images in medieval poetry are largely unfamiliar to all medievalists, the visionary poetry of Joachim (or Pseudo Joachim) of Fiore is scarcely known at all.

In 1978 Marjorie Reeves and I published a little book entitled *Two Poems Attributed to Joachim of Fiore*.¹⁵ Our collaboration grew out of old friendship. My wife had been an undergraduate at St Anne’s College, Oxford, at the time that Miss Reeves was Vice Principal in that college. Later Miss Reeves was instrumental in helping my wife, then my fiancée, emigrate and find work in the United States. She was very helpful to me personally in the early phases of my study of Franciscan literature. When I founded a private press (The Pilgrim Press, Sometimes Called the Prince Fred Printers) in Princeton, New Jersey, Miss Reeves proposed to me the project of bringing out a ‘fine’ edition of two poems (*Visionem admirande ordinarie historie* and *O felix regnum patrie superne*) attributed to Joachim of Fiore. For purposes of economy I refer to these two poems, respectively, as the *Visio* and the *Patria celestis*.¹⁶ I did the hand-setting of the type for the texts of the two poems, as well as the presswork and the binding of the finished copies. My cousin Robert Crowe in Chicago set the introduction in Linotype.

These poems had been included in the Venetian edition of Joachim’s *Psalterium decem chordarum* in 1527, but that fact alone, of course, was not compelling evidence for their authenticity. They were again published in 1845, by Fr. Böhmer, from a Frankfurt manuscript of Peter Comestor’s

Historia scholastica, where they apparently appeared together but without authorial attribution on a flyleaf.¹⁷ This manuscript has disappeared, but there are two more manuscript sources. Both poems are to be found in a fourteenth-century Florentine anthology.¹⁸ The *Patria celestis* (without the *Visio*) appears in a very late copy in the Alessandrina in Rome.¹⁹ There is little to add to the information we offered in the introduction to our edition concerning the other places one or another of the poems has appeared in print or the divided opinion among experts concerning their authenticity. This is perhaps to say that the poems continue to earn that adjective so beloved by scholars – ‘neglected’.

Marjorie Reeves had long been of the opinion that the two poems were *probably* authentic works of Joachim of Fiore. Both of them are ‘apocalyptic’ visions that in their verbal iconography seem to reflect a good deal of Joachim’s typical visionary imagery. Both are visions of Heaven. The *Visio*, which pretends to narrate the eschatological experience of a holy ascetic, falls into a widely documented hagiographic genre: a voyage or pilgrimage to the afterlife. Yet the essence of the poem is of course not the story’ but the anthology of images of the New Jerusalem that the story frames. In the *Felix Regnum* the thin veneer of narrative disappears altogether in lyrical and imagistic effusions of trope or hymn that constitute a kind of protreptic to penance.

The present essay will not pursue the issue of the authorship of the poems directly, except to reaffirm Miss Reeves’s assertion that the two poems employ a number of Joachim’s characteristic images. The *explicit* found in the Venice edition accurately speaks of a relationship of ‘correspondence’ between the poem and Joachim’s thought as exposed more fully in the exegetical works: ‘Explicit visio seu hymnus de celesti patria: Correspondens Psalterio decem chordarum et libro Apocalipsis venerabilis abbatis Joachim.’ Space will allow me to examine only one of the poems, the *Visio*. Since all previous editions (including our own) are generally available only in major research libraries, I supply the text in an appendix. There will be perhaps an implicit argument in favour of Joachim’s authorship of the *Visio* in a demonstration of its considerable theological sophistication and exegetical wit, but if so, it is merely incidental. My aim will be to analyse some of the poetic techniques, shared with a good deal of medieval monastic verse, by which certain biblical and exegetical ideas are put to the service of lyric or narrative argument.

The *Visio* belongs to the very large body of medieval ‘visionary’ literature dealing with the state of souls after death.²⁰ It is therefore a distant relation of the most famous of all medieval poems, the *Commedia* of Dante Alighieri, though it barely achieves the length of the shortest of Dante’s hundred cantos. The opening lines of the *Visio* are at once an anthology of poetic and scriptural clichés and a dense and complex exegetical site’ of some significance. The story’ being recalled in the poem is a vision experienced by the nearly statutorily vague holy man (‘vir religiosus, fama non incognitus’). It is in fact a kind of eschatological journey involving an inverted hexaameron. Its principal images are taken from cognate passages in the Gospel of Luke, especially the story of the Good Samaritan. The setting is a hostile, desert place, where there is no path and no way through, an eremitic version of Dante’s ‘selva oscura’. Such is the setting for a six days’ passage to death.

On the first day the visionary falls among thieves, who bind him and leave him nearly dead. On the second, half alive, he suffers the stings of scorpions. On the third he walks the path of exile. On the fourth he suffers various tribulations, hunger, thirst, the heat of the desert. On the fifth he suffers the mauling of wild beasts. On the sixth he enters ‘the regions of final misery’, an abode of lynxes and griffons.

This is a thoroughly familiar ascetic geography, but it is grounded in a specific biblical image. The trackless and hostile desert through which he moves (‘ambulat per inuia’) recalls that waterless landscape through which the exorcized spirit wanders seeking a rest he cannot find: ‘Cum immundus spiritus exierit de homine *perambulat per loca inaquosa* quaerens requiem et non inueniens ...’ (Luke 11:24). As we shall see, this general site in Luke is frequently echoed in the opening lines of the *Visio*.

On the first day the visionary pilgrim ‘fell among thieves’ (‘in latrones incidit’). This is an obvious invocation of that ‘certain man’ who is the victim of the story of the Good Samaritan: ‘homo quidam descendabat ab Hierusalem in Hiericho et incidit in latrones’ (Luke 10:30). In the gospel parable the Good Samaritan comes upon this man lying wounded in the ditch. He binds up his wounds, medicating them with oil and wine, before taking him to a hostel to rest. In the *Visio* he receives not curative unguents but the bites of scorpions: ‘non curandum sed mactandum scorpionum ictibus’ (10). Yet the thematic as opposed to the narrative unity with the story of the Good Samaritan is unbroken, linked with the word *semivivum*’

(Luke 10:30 and line 10). If we ask where the scorpions came from, the answer may well be found in another cognate text in Luke (10:19) in which Jesus gives his commissioned disciples power to tread upon serpents and scorpions: ‘ecce dedi vobis potestatem calcandi supra serpentes et scorpiones.’

While I detect no rigorous numerical scheme in the poem, there are unexplored implications in its obvious tripartite narrative structure. There are three distinct movements, roughly equal in length. Until line 28 the experience described is singular – that is, it records the individual journey of the ‘vir religiosus’ (3); but now the verbs become plural. What is being described is the experience of many observed souls after death, damned and blessed alike. The opening movement of the poem is, in effect, a vision of Hell; but by the thirty-sixth line we are in a new place, the homeland (‘ducatus patriae’). While this is not manifestly a purgatorial landscape, it does seem to be a place of preliminary or propadeutic blessedness. The singular pilgrim now returns, and as in Dante’s *Purgatorio* the journey continues through spiral or meandering ascent:

Sed et via per amfractus inerat disposita
Per quam poterat ascendi ad camporum menia. (41–2)

He walks for many days along the demarcating river (55) and from that vantage point can view both the torments of the damned and the rewards of the just (56). He is aware, however, of a further destination yet more blessed:

Querit ultra pertransire ut interna nosceret. (58)

He is separated from this desired destination by a high mountain, and to reach it he must ascend a ladder placed against the cliff side, arriving at line 76, or two-thirds of the way into the poem, ‘in regis palatio’. This is, of course, the heavenly Jerusalem of John’s Revelation – and of Joachim and other apocalyptic commentators. So, in summary, the three movements of the poem are (1) a vision of Hell much informed by the language of the narrative of the Good Samaritan; (2) the pilgrim’s experience across the river at the base of the mountain, and (3) the vision of the holy City.

As we noted in the introduction to our edition, it seems likely that the *Visio* has been constructed on some kind of Sabbatarian model. The compressed action, if we may call it that, of the first six days is clearly

indicated by the use of ordinal numbers. On the sixth day the visionary arrives in the place of ultimate misery', characterized by the presence of feral beasts and hissing serpents. It is not entirely clear how this place differs from that of the fifth, with its attacks by serpents and beasts. Miss Reeves was of the opinion that the 'scenery' probably revealed parallels with Joachim's imagery of the *fifth* persecution and the *sixth* age of the church.²¹ All this, incidentally, took the poet less than 25 lines. It is clear that his intellectual emphasis is on what happens at the end – the end of life, and the end of history.

At this point, however, the temporal scheme seems to become as vague as it earlier was certain. The word 'seventh' does not appear in the poem, though it is implied in line 25, 'In hac ipsa tamen hora qua solvitur corpora'. At that moment – the very moment of death, one is invited to believe – the visionary sees a fiery river surmounted by a narrow bridge, the sole route to safety. Some such bridge is a not infrequent feature of the eschatological architecture of medieval visions. There is a notable one in early Franciscan literature, in the *Fioretti* and *the Actus*; and Howard Patch sought to associate it with the *Visio*, the ascription of which to Joachim he did not contest.²² However, it is not clear in the *Visio* that the bridge is meant as an emblem of the soul's transition in death. It could be, in terms of Joachim's characteristic thought, the transition to the sabbath age – in Trinitarian terms the third *status*. If so, it is a preliminary step toward the enjoyment of the actual heavenly vision, just as the crossing of the Jordan was preliminary to the possession of the promised land. At this point the action of the *Visio*, while ambiguous, likewise unfolds in two stages.

Prima hora ultra flumen supra muri verticem
trahebantur in immensum spatiorum limitem. (45–6)

This is a 'locus amoenus' in which the blessed take their rest in a floral landscape free of all noxious beasts. But if this is indeed the 'seventh day', we have entered a new time scheme. For the visionary now walks 'for many days' ('per multos dies' [55]) by the side of the roiling river, viewing now the punishment of the damned, now the reward of the saved.

But it is only at this point that the poem begins its final visionary moment. The *Visio* is one 118 lines long. At precisely its midpoint (i.e., line 59), the pilgrim comes to a high silver mountain against which a ladder is placed. He climbs the ladder into the poem's final geography, a Trinitarian

apocalypse that is the site of the Palace of the King. Thus a full half of the poem is given over to an effusive beatific vision.

Sed cum multa perlustrasset ad radicem ducitur
montis alti cuius rupis murus est argenteus.
Vidit scalam elevatam supra montis verticem,
per quam scandit et justorum contemplatur speciem ... (59–62)

That the ‘scala’ is some kind of poetic reflex of Jacob’s Ladder is, within the context of a monastic poem, rather obvious. In his dream (Gen. 28:12) Jacob saw ‘a ladder set upon the earth and the top of it touching heaven’ (‘viditque in somnis scalam stantem super terram et cacumen illius tangens caelum’). Even well before the composition of the famous *Scala Paradisi* of John Climacus at the beginning of the seventh century, this ladder had served as an emblem of the ascetic enterprise, but with the diffusion of that famous work the exegetical association became nearly universal. The Fall was a dramatic, fatal, moral descent. Monastic theology held that only by an arduous, gradual, ascetic exertion could that lost ground be recaptured. Having forfeited his angelic birthright, carnal man can regain angelic life only through a monastic life that is its type or shadow. The spiritual homesickness of fallen humanity represents nostalgia for that paradise once lost.²³

There is a close connection between the otherworldly vision and the ascetic ideal, even when, like Dante himself, the narrator is not a professed religious. The ‘persona’ of the narrator of the *Vision of Tnugdal*, for example, is perhaps better known from the medieval literature of miracles than that of visions: a secular subject of wicked or irreligious life converted, by an extraordinary intervention, to the ascetic life. According to the account of Brother Marcus, Tnugdal was a worldly young Irish knight, endowed with physical strength and beauty, but woefully negligent of spiritual matters: ‘quanto confidebat in forma corporis et fortitudine, tanto minus curabat de anime sue eterna salute’.²⁴ He is thus the iconographic equivalent of the knight ‘riding for a fall’ as an emblem of pride on the exterior of Chartres or one of the haughty young falconers in the well-known image of ‘The Three Living and the Three Dead’. After his complicated pilgrimage through the realms of darkness and light, Tnugdal begs not to have to return to his body, only to be told that the high order of bliss of which he has been allowed a glimpse is reserved for virgins.

Returned to the flesh, ‘he distributed everything he had to the poor and ordered the sign of the cross to be applied to the clothes he wore.’²⁵

This is a practical and ‘tropological’ aspect of apocalyptic vision rather in tune with Jerome’s understanding of Jacob’s Ladder, according to which the angels who climb the ladder into Heaven, also climb down carrying with them those heavenly medicines needed in the fallen world.²⁶ The gospel story of Lazarus and the rich man (Luke 16), in which the rich man in hellfire begs of Abraham that he send Lazarus to testify to his five brothers that they might avoid his eschatological torment, is apocalyptic in content but practical of intention. This gospel mini-apocalypse, incidentally, had very widespread ascetic application – the rather crude idea being that those who suffer (ascetic) deprivations on earth are likely to enjoy all the greater rewards in Heaven. Not every monastic’s hope for moral superiority was as outrageous as that of Chaucer’s hypocritical friar:

Than burel folk, although they weren kynges.
We lyve in poverte and in abstinence,
And burrel folk in riches and despenche
Of mete and drynke, and in hir foul delit.
We ha this worldes lust al in despit.
Lazar and Dives lyvenden diversly
And divers gerdon hadden they thereby.²⁷

There are in the *Visio* several layers of anonymity. There is in the first place the first-person narrator, so effaced that his presence is merely technical and grammatical, of the opening lines. The story he tells is repeated after some man of religion’ (‘quidam vir religiosus’), who himself is reporting the experience that another someone’ (‘quidam’) actually had. Furthermore, the experience itself hovers in a vague space of ‘ecstasy’ between the corporeal and the incorporeal. In all this we may suspect the textual influence of the medieval ecstatic vision *par excellence*, that of St Paul (2 Cor. 12). Although Paul is there certainly speaking of his own personal experience, he distances himself from any claim of special status by saying that ‘I know a man’ to whom the experience came. But he is unable to say whether the experience came ‘in the body’ or ‘outside of the body’. This topos is quite common in medieval visionary literature. Carozzi has drawn attention to it in reference to a vision of St Boniface.²⁸

Our *quidam* wanders in desolate places
... ambulat per invia;
nulla sibi patent campi, nulla loca pervia. (5–6)

Where is this hostile, unwelcoming landscape, and what is its significance? The poet expects an ascetic audience to be able to enter it, imaginatively, through the medium of the biblical language invoked.

Primo die moto gressu in latrones incidit. (7)

As already noted, this is in invocation of the parable of the Good Samaritan. A certain man ('homo quidam') went down from Jericho to Jerusalem and fell among thieves ('incidit in latrones'; Luke 10:30). The poet is not simply using a convenient or commonplace biblical phrase. That he means to invoke a biblical site is strongly suggested by the larger context, and particularly by the words 'ligatus' (8) and 'semivivum' (9). The biblical muggers leave their victim 'half alive' ('semivivo', Luke 10:30), and the Good Samaritan bound up his wounds ('alligavit', Luke 10:33).

We may note that the narrative focus of the allusion to the story of the Good Samaritan is not here on the Samaritan but upon the anonymous but implicitly Jewish victim of the robbers' attack. That is to say that, just as in the *Dies Irae* a subtlety of scriptural allusion draws attention to a nameless narrative subject (the *me* whom Christ is seeking), so also in the *Visio* the scriptural language identifies the anonymous visionary 'quidam' with the 'homo quidam' of Jesus' parable. Hence, we are invited to examine more closely the narrative details of the scriptural story and, in particular, the sole subjective role of the 'homo quidam'. He is the object of the robbers' violence; priest and Levite avoid him; the Good Samaritan binds his wounds; the remunerated hostler nurses him. The only sentence of which he is the subject is that with which the parable begins: *homo quidam descendebat ab Hierusalem in Hiericho et incidit in latrones* ('A certain man went down from Jerusalem to Jericho, and he fell among thieves ...').

One of the peculiarities of medieval scriptural interpretation, from the modern point of view, is that even Christ's parables were the objects of 'spiritual' interpretation. A parable is a figurative narrative, a story with an allegorical meaning, often made explicit within the parable itself, and in any case seldom taxing or enigmatic. It will seem to us self-evident that Jesus told the parable of the Good Samaritan in order to answer the question 'Who is my neighbour?'

The answer that the parable gives is that your neighbour – a word that in most languages carries with it the etymological implication of residential proximity, nearness – is the one who treats you charitably. The priest and

the Levite, bound to the fallen victim by ties of race and religion, were nonetheless not in a moral sense his neighbours. The Samaritan, member of an exogenous and even despised group, was his spiritual neighbour.

Medieval exegetes, however, often found what we might regard as secondary or contingent spiritual meanings' in such texts. Indeed, there is perhaps no subject that more quickly reveals the chasm between the 'mentalities' of medieval and modern scriptural exegesis than the approach to the parables. Among the most famous and influential commentaries on the parable of the Good Samaritan is that of Augustine.²⁹ Augustine finds in the parable the entire history of the fall and redemption of the human race. Here are merely a few of the allegorical elements. The man who fell among thieves is Adam. The thieves are demonic forces who stripped him of his immortality. The beast that carries the wounded man to the hostel is an emblem of Christ's Incarnation; the hostel itself is the church. An eminent theologian of the twentieth century, C.H. Dodd, used this 'famous example' of an exegetical approach to parable 'in which each term stood as a cryptogram for an idea, so that the whole had to be de-coded term by term', a method that 'prevailed down to the time of Archbishop Trench, who follows its main lines with even more ingenious elaboration ... To the ordinary person of intelligence who approaches the Gospels with some sense for literature this mystification must appear quite perverse.'³⁰ By the twelfth century the general outlines of Augustine's interpretation of the parable of the Good Samaritan amounted to an exegetical consensus probably nearly universal and instinctive. Many of its elements naturally were enshrined in the *Glossa ordinaria*. According to this very common reading of the parable, it contained not merely an allegory of the Fall of Man, but also suggestions of the laborious ascetic discipline needed to regain a paradise once lost. From Augustine the *Glossa* normalized the interpretation found in Augustine – that the *quidam homo* of the parable was Adam, and by extension the entire human race.³¹

As the soteriological interpretation of the parable of the Good Samaritan is central to the implicit ascetic argument of the *Visio*, it may be useful to note its presence in other, more familiar works of medieval literature and pictorial art. Avril Henry has convincingly suggested that the author of *Piers Plowman* – a work with many well-documented connections with the 'school' of Joachim of Fiore – is almost certainly invoking the exegetical consensus in his treatment of the Good Samaritan in *passus* xvii.³² Probably

better known are the cognate stained-glass windows to be found in several of the greatest of the French cathedrals, those at Bourges, Chartres, and Sens.³³ All three of these windows enshrine the ‘Augustinian’ interpretation of the parable within the tripartite historical scheme of human history before the Law, under the Law, and under Grace. The Sens window is particularly interesting for our purposes. It is composed of 12 visual roundels organized in parallel columns and separated into three distinct groupings by having a square, turned on its diagonal, set centrally at the juncture of each set of four. These three tilted squares, each with an episode of the story of the Good Samaritan are thus literally superimposed upon the subsidiary circular scenes, covering roughly a fifth of the area of each. Each grouping thus is actually composed of five images arranged as a kind of modified quincunx, like the ‘five’ on the face of a die, with the central image conspicuous both for its distinctive square shape and for its superimposition. At the very top, in an oval formed by the way in which the round top of the window’s frame cuts through a single circular form placed centrally atop the two narrative columns, is the city of Jerusalem, from which ‘quidam homo’ has departed – of the same argentine hue, incidentally, as that described in the *Visio*. The window is to be ‘read’ in descending fashion, even as the story it tells begins with the descent from Jerusalem to Jericho.

The first quincunx deals with history before the Law. Its subject is the Fall. In the subsidiary roundels are scenes in which Adam and Eve (a) are shown the forbidden tree; (b) eat from it; (c) then try to hide, and (d) are expelled by the archangel. The square image is of the wayfarer set upon by brigands. There are *five* brigands. This, too, is possibly a ‘voluntary’ allegory on the part of the visual artist himself, to suggest the five senses. In the simple allegory of the *Liber consolationis et consilii*, Albertanus of Brescia, the three enemies (world, flesh, and devil) attack the house of Melibeus (the ‘honey-drinker’, i.e., worldly man) and fatally wound his daughter in five places – hands (touch), eyes, ears, mouth, and nose.³⁴

The second set records human history under the Law. The central scene is of the priest and the Levite, dressed in what are pretty obviously Christian sacerdotal vestments, next to the wounded man lying in the road. The simple verbal caption beneath the victim is ‘HOMO’ – the perfect emblem of fallen mankind. The subsidiary Old Testament scenes, indicative of the ambiguous efficacy of ancient Jewish religion, show (in chronological

order) Moses at the burning bush, Moses with Aaron before Pharaoh, the brazen serpent, and the adoration of the golden calf. In the quincunx devoted to the Age of Grace the central square shows the Good Samaritan leading a donkey bearing the wounded wayfarer to the door of an inn. The host stands within the doorframe. The supporting roundels are three scenes from the Passion (Christ before Pilate, Flagellation, and Crucifixion), and the Resurrection from the tomb.

Though by no means so elaborate in its development in the *Visio*, the story of the Good Samaritan here plays a similar theological role. The geographical components of the exegetical allegory are the basis of their coherent use in the *Visio*. Jerusalem is of course the heavenly *patria*, the native land from which we have through sin been exiled. Among the particular meanings of Jericho was the moral blindness characteristic of fallen man. Hence to descend from Jerusalem to Jericho was to fall from an original state of grace into sin. The particular idea of blindness comes from another chapter in the Gospel of Luke, the story of Jesus and Zacchaeus (Luke 18–19). Jesus visited Zacchaeus in Jericho, and, as he was approaching the town, he encountered a blind beggar, whom he miraculously healed. ‘Factum est autem cum adpropinquaret Hiericho cæcus quidam sedebat secus viam mendicans ...’ (Luke 18:11). So Jericho is the realm of the blind, but the blind can be healed by Christ. Within the city of Jericho itself, Zacchaeus, a rich man and notorious sinner, and a man too short of stature to see Jesus amid the crowd thronged about him, climbed a sycamore tree in order to gain a view of the teacher. Jesus ordered him down from the tree, saying ‘Hurry down, for I must stay at your house today.’ At first the pious were shocked that Jesus would seek hospitality from a known sinner. But Zacchaeus himself underwent a dramatic moral transformation on the spot, and Jesus said, ‘The Son of Man came to seek out and save the lost’. Certain well-established allegories surrounding this passage are also highly relevant to the *Visio*, as for example the interpretation of the sycamore tree that Zacchaeus climbs. According to the *Glossa*, the sycamore tree was an emblem of the cross.³⁵ The applied meaning of such an allegory requires some thought. The wealthy sinner Zacchaeus mounts the sycamore in order to see Christ. This is to say, at the spiritual level, that he undertakes a penitential self-crucifixion.

In the Gospel of Luke the story of Zacchaeus comes in close proximity to the story of Jesus' interview with the rich young man or ruler, most famously recorded in the nineteenth chapter of Matthew. As both stories involve Jesus' dealing with rich people, they were frequently invoked in the literature of the poverty controversy in the thirteenth and fourteenth centuries; and some of the most interesting exegesis surrounding them will be found in Franciscan writers. St Bonaventure succinctly summarizes the interpretation of the elements of the parable of the Good Samaritan that had become commonplace among ascetic theologians:

Alia etiam potest elici secundum sensum spiritualem, ut persona indigens ex miseria intelligatur genus humanum, quod in Adam peccante descendit ab Ierusalem in Iericho, id est a paradiso in mundum, et incidit in latrones, id est in potestatem daemonum, qui spoliaverunt eum gratuitis et vulneraverunt in naturalibus. Et reliquerunt semivivum, qui, subtracta similitudo, remansit sola imago; ut vero possit dici illud Psalmi [48:21] 'Homo, cum in honore esset, non intellexit; comparatus est iumentis insipientibus' etc.³⁶

What 'prophecy' meant to Joachim of Fiore, as it would also mean to Bonaventure and other orthodox 'apocalyptic' after him, was the plenary unfolding of the Scriptures. Whatever his *soi-disant* followers might do with his 'system', Joachim found in the Scriptures an affirmative and optimistic meaning in history – future history no less than past history – defined by an active, one might almost say proactive, divinity even swifter to plan the reparation of human degradation than men themselves were to effect their own ruin.

It is probably true that the two great engines of medieval religion were the fear of Hell and the hope of Heaven. Man's just reward is damnation; Christ's gracious gift is salvation. The conflict between man's deserving and Christ's merit was implicit in a famous verse of the eighty-fourth psalm:

miserecordia et Veritas obviaverunt sibi:
iustitia et pax osculatae sunt (Ps. 84:11)

Miserecordia, Veritas, Justitia and Pax – these, according to a vast medieval literature, learned and popular alike, were the 'four daughters of God', whose 'debate' pitted the literal claims of truth and justice against the spiritual implications of mercy and peace.³⁷

One profound literary site of the debate is in the fourteenth-century English allegory *Piers Plowman*.³⁸ In this poem Peace claims to have been

sent by Love (i.e., Christ) himself:

Love, that is my lemman, swiche lettres me sente
That Mercy, my suster, and I mankynde sholde save,
And that God hath forgyven and graunted me, Pees, and Mercy
To be mannes meynpernour for evermoore after.' (18.182–4)³⁹

There is inevitably in medieval 'apocalyptic' literature a good deal of fire and brimstone, and scholars, including some who have specialized in Joachim of Fiore, have sometimes granted it a final authority which its authors would have recognized as provisional. The context in which Joachim developed his theories, and in which typically apocalyptic themes and images appear in the *Visio*, was the context of ascetic theology. Mankind is indeed in an unhappy state of his own creation, but the means of reparation are fully available. They are strenuous means, but also effective ones, the life of penance and self-mortification:

Sed felices qui seipsos luxu privant seculi
et coercent studiose a carnis illecebris,
qui seipsos crucifigunt cum nature viciis
et induti vite penis exuunt spurciciis. (31–4)

As a more famous medieval poem, the celebrated *Cantico* of Francis of Assisi, puts it:

Laudato si, misignore, per sora nostra morte corporale,
da la quale nullu homo vivente pò skappare.
Guai acquelli ke morrano ne le peccata mortali.
Beati quelli ke trovarà ne le tue sanctissime voluntati,
ka la morte secunda nol farrà male.⁴⁰

Only those menaced by the second death' need fear the 'transitus' of the soul from the body. Those who 'crucify themselves with their natural vices', those who conform themselves to God's most holy will, are indeed 'felices' and 'beati'.

How capacious was the celestial homeland for which medieval monks longed so fervently? That is the implicit issue at debate at various cardinal moments of Christian history. Whether we regard the number 144,000 (Rev. 7:1–8) as a large number or a small one, as an emblem or as a strict quota, we shall find nothing in all Joachim's writings that would ration divine grace or suggest a limit to the efficacy of the Incarnation.

It is probable that Joachim wrote the *Visio*, but whether or not that is the case it is a genuine Joachimist poem in its fidelity to the more irenic side of Joachim's apocalypticism.⁴¹ Its covert and prophetic dimension, which is profound, has nothing to do with the Sybil's terrible *ambages*. It is very much a public poem whose deeper theological meaning will be found, barely covert, in the exegetical associations of the parable of the Good Samaritan. Its author doubtless imagined his poem within a framework radically ascetical, yet it has a universal application. For each and every one of us has come down from Jerusalem to Jericho and fallen among thieves.

Appendix

The text of the *Visio*

Visionem admirande ordiar historie,
et succincte scribam testum felicitis memorie.
Quidam vir religiosus, fama non incognitus,
scripsit rem quam vidit quidam in estasi positus.
Ductus animi excessu ambulat per invia;
nulla sibi patent campi, nulla loca pervia.
Primo die moto gressu in latrones incidit,
et ligatus strictis loris, pene vita deficit.
His solutum lux secunda semivivum suscipit,
non curandum sed mactandum scorpionum ictibus.

[10]

Tertia his liberatus traditur exilio,
iter agit destitutus hominum consilio.
Nichil minus quarto die patitur discriminis;
fame, siti, et fervore maceratur heremis.
Quinto asperis ferarum laniatur unguibus
et frequenter laciatur bestiarum morsibus,
sed hoc totum se perpessum arbitratur venie.
Dum in sexto intrat loca ultime miserie,
inde lince, hinc hiene et griforum feritas
procedendi ultra sibi interdiciunt semitas;
hinc leones, hinc drachones minantur interitum;
aspides et basilisci tristem formant sibilum,
horum dentibus attritus cogitur deponere,
erumpnosum carnis honus quo gravatur pondere.
In hac ipsa tamen hora qua solvitur corpore,
videt flumen spumans igne et corrupto sulphure
ibi pons est constitutus artus in examine,
per quem transeunt invite miserorum anime;
qui non norunt artam vitam a pontis cacumine,
corruentes in profundum absorbentur flumine.

[20]

[30]

Sed felices qui seipsos luxu privant seculi
et coercent studiose a carnis illecebris,
qui seipsos crucifigunt cum nature viciis
et induti vite penis exuunt spurciciis.
Hi securi et veloces ac si leves aquile
transeunt per artum pontem in ducatum patrie.
Erat autem mums ingens juxta flumen positus
et in summitate muri campus amenissimus.
Ipse murus velut eris protendebat speciem,
sine manu consitutus a summo artifice.

[40]

Sed et via per amfractus inerat disposita
per quam poterat ascendi ad camporum menia.
Ergo cum illuc transiret vir prefatus spiritu
vidit beatorum turbas tripartitas gradibus.
Prima hora ultra flumen supra muri verticem
trahebantur in immensum spatiorum limitem.
Ibi loca spaciosa illustrata lumine,
et in ipsis gens beata fruens pacis requie;
ibi silve quam condempse diversarum arborum;
poma ferunt universe saporum suavium
alte valde ut excedant ceterarum species,
umbra quarum fit jocunda colorum temperies.

[50]

Abest anguis, abest rana, abest mala bestia;
totum pulchrum, totum tutum, totum plena gloria.
Ambulans per multos dies prope amnem turbidum
videt hinc reorum penam, hinc justorum premium;
his perspectis in his locis et ad primum rediens,
querit ultra pertransire ut interna nosceret.
Sed cum multa perlustrasset ad radicem ducitur
montis alti cujus rupis murus est argenteus.

[60]

Vidit scalam elevatam supra montis verticem,
per quam scandit et justorum contemplatur speciem,
ibiquoque spatiosam perspicit planiciem,
speciose visionis exhibens blandiciem.
Inter species herbarum prata viridencia,
liliorum et rosarum redolet fraglantia.
Ibi multi dividuntur rivulorum impetus,

qui de fonte vite fluunt in mille meatibus;
sed et loca infra scripta irrigantes influunt,
et fecundant universa infra muri ambitum.

[70]

Verum sursum juxta rivos arbores pulcherrime,
fronde flore decorate et pomis uberrime.

Querit tarnen aque fontem per pratarum intima,
et ad altioris montis ducitur initia.

Tunc ascendit dato sibi restis amminiculo,
et se cernit constitutum in regis palatio;
cujus muri errant structi ex viridi jaspide
et ornate universi precioso lapide;
cujus tectum aurum purum supra vitrum lucidum
et in ipso splendens thronus unde flumen oritur.

[80]

Ipsa sedes preciosis rutilat lapidibus
et choruscat admirandis gemmarum ordinibus;
in sublimi constituta solis vincit radios,
et illustrat infra sitos electorum cuneos.

In circuitu sedis hujus plurima sedilia,
et in ipsis seniores decernunt judicia.

Ibi pulchra super luna residet ecclesia
quasi sponsa viro suo circumdata gloria.

Ante sedem assistebant puerorum milia
quorum vestes margarite et corone lilia;

[90]

citharizant et decantant canticorum cantica,
et letificabant trina electorum agmina.

De sedenti super sedem non est loqui facile;
superat non modo visum, sed et mentis aciem.

Sed cum trine mansionis intellectum quereret,
edocetur quid per ipsam expedit perpendere;
primo gradu continentur electorum populi,
profitentes fidem trini et unius domini,
qui in humiliori vita placant deum munere
laudis et oblationis et fideli opere.

[100]

Horum vita conjugalis portat eris precium,
per quod suum servi domus implent ministerium.
Estat viridis coloris per quam fides noscitur
designare in quam vivit quisquis deo jungitur.

In secundo manent illi qui per sancta studia,
modo verbo, nunc exemplo, edificant agmina.
Horum vita per argentum designari creditur,
cujus nitor dat splendorem salvandorum cetibus.
In supremo manent illi qui contempta gloria
mundi solum querunt regem cernere in patria;
quorum vita auri puri estimatur similis,
et virtutum ornamenta preciosis lapidis.
Tria sunt ergo veneranda electorum genera,
in vicis et suburbanis et in urbe consita.
Trina voce simul cantant inaudita cantica
et collaudent regem celi, qui fecit hec omnia.
Trino deo trina turba electorum carmina
modulatur et exultat per eterna secula.

[101]

Notes

- ¹ This essay was written in 2005. The bibliography has been carefully updated.
- ² Margaret de G. Verrall, 'Two Instances of Symbolism in the Sixth *Aeneid*', *Classical Review*, 24 (1910), 44.
- ³ *Aeneid*, vi, ed. Sir Frank Fletcher (Oxford, 1941), 41.
- ⁴ *Inferno*, iv, 46–63.
- ⁵ *Troilus and Criseyde*, 5.897–9: 'And but if Calkas lede us with ambages—/ that is to seyn, with double wordes slye, / swiche as men clepen a word with two visages— ...'
- ⁶ James L. Kugel, 'Poets and Prophets: An Overview,' in id. (ed.), *Poetry and Prophecy: The Beginnings of a Literary Tradition* (Ithaca, 1990), 18.
- ⁷ Texts of the *Dies irae* are widely available. For convenience I shall cite that in *The Oxford Book of Medieval Latin Verse*, ed. Stephen Gaselee (Oxford, 1928), 149–51.
- ⁸ On the origin and dating of the *Dies irae*, see S.J.P. van Dijk, *The Origins of the Roman Liturgy, the Liturgy of the Papal Court and the Franciscan Order in the Thirteenth Century* (London, 1960), 144.
- ⁹ Samuel Willoughby Duffield, *The Latin Hymn-Writers and Their Hymns* (new York, 1889), 240.
- ¹⁰ *Thesaurus hymnologicus* (Leipzig, 1855), II, 104.
- ¹¹ See *Sacred Latin Poetry*, ed. Richard C. Trench (London, 1872), 305, John 4:6; and Filippo Ermini, *Il 'Dies Irae'* (Geneva, 1928), 98–9.
- ¹² Augustine, *In Iohannis Evangelium Tractatus CXXIV*, tract. xv, par. 6, CCSL 36, 152, cited by Trench.
- ¹³ Bonaventure, *Breviloquium*, 4.7, ed. Quaracchi, vol. v, 248: '... even though providentially, for our sake, He lived in the state of pilgrimage ... He merited only those things which could not coexist with the state of pilgrimage, that is, the glory of the body along with its exaltation to a higher dignity': *The Works of Bonaventure*, trans. José de Vinck (Paterson, NJ, 1963), 165–6.

¹⁴ *Sacrum commercium S. Francisci cum Domina Paupertate* (ed. Quarrachi, 1929), 70. The precise phrase regarding the tables, ‘*expolitas mensas*’, is particularly telling. In medieval literature a finished table, as opposed to boards temporarily set across trestles, is an indicator of luxury, magnificence, power, wealth. While it is expected in the great houses of the high and mighty, it can elsewhere signal culpable materialism. Hence the force of Chaucer’s satirical remark concerning his ‘Epicurean Franklin’: ‘His table dormant in his halle alwey / Stood redy covered al the longe day.’

¹⁵ Marjorie Reeves and John V. Fleming, *Two Poems Attributed to Joachim of Fiore* (Princeton, 1978). Until today, this remains the only study on the subject of the two poems.

¹⁶ The *Visio* is catalogued by Hans Walther in his *Initia Carminum* (no. 20643). For some reason he seems to have missed the *Patria celestis*.

¹⁷ Fr. Böhmer, ‘Zwei lateinische Gedichte aus dem Mittelalter’, *Zeitschrift für deutsches Alterthum*, 5 (1945), 463–70.

¹⁸ Biblioteca Laurenziana, MS Plut. ix, destr. xi, fol. 66.

¹⁹ Biblioteca Alessandrina, MS 99, fol. 92–3.

²⁰ A recent excellent book is devoted to the Latin part of this literature: Claude Carozzi, *Le Voyage de l’âme dans l’au-delà d’après la littérature latine* (Rome, 1994). It would be impossible to treat such a vast literature absolutely comprehensively, and, unlike Patch (see n. 22 below), Carozzi does not notice the *Visio* attributed to Joachim.

²¹ *Two Poems*, 19.

²² Howard Roland Patch, *The Other World according to Descriptions in Medieval Literature* (Cambridge, Mass., 1950), 124–6.

²³ This theme was beautifully explored in a book by a monk of Montserrat in Catalonia, Garcia M. Colombás, *Paraíso y vida angélica: sentido escatológico de la vocación cristiana* (Montserrat, 1958).

²⁴ *Visio Tnugdali lateinisch und altdeutsch*, ed. Albrecht Wagner (Erlangen, 1882), 6–7; see Brigitte Pfeil, *Die ‘Vision des Tnugdali’ Albers von Windberg: Literatur- und Frömmigkeitsgeschichte im ausgehenden 12. Jahrhundert; mit einer Edition der lateinischen ‘Visio Tnugdali’ aus Clm 22254*, Mikrokosmos 54 (Frankfurt/Main, 1999).

²⁵ *The Vision of Tnugdali*, trans. Jean-Michel Picard (Dublin, 1989), 156. The actions taken are the response to the implied ascetic command of Christ to the ‘rich [young] man’ (Mark 10:17–27, Matt. 19:16–26, Luke 18:18–27): ‘Vade quaecumque habes vende et da pauperibus...et sequere me’ (Mark 10:21), as influenced by three other passages (Matt. 10:38, Matt. 16:24, and Luke 9:23) in which ‘following Jesus’ and ‘taking up one’s cross’ are equated. In the famous episode in which Francis of Assisi stripped himself before the episcopal consistory, Francis ‘took up his cross’ in analogous fashion, by marking the garment the bishop gave him with a cross.

²⁶ Jerome’s notes on Psalm 19, edited by Germain Morin in *Anecdota Maredsolana* 3, I, 221.

²⁷ Geoffrey Chaucer, ‘The Summoner’s Tale’ (1871–1878), *The Canterbury Tales*, 7 vols (Norman, Okla., 1979–2002), ii/7.

²⁸ Carozzi, *Le Voyage de l’âme*, 200.

²⁹ Augustine, *Quaestiones evangeliorum*, ii, 19, CCSL 44B, 62–3.

³⁰ Charles Harold Dodd, *The Parables of the Kingdom* (London, 1936, repr. 1978), 11–13.

³¹ ‘Homo iste Adam intelligitur in genere humano’, *PL* 114, col. 286.

³² Avril Henry, ‘Some Aspects of Biblical Imagery in *Piers Plowman*’, in *Langland, the Mystics and the Medieval English Religious Tradition: Essays in Honour of S. S. Hussey*, ed. Helen Phillips (Cambridge, 1990), esp. 51–2.

³³ For a very thorough photographic record with schematic narrative identifications, see Colette Manhes and Jean-Paul Deremble, *Le Vitrail du bon samaritain: Chartres, Sens, Bourges* (Paris, n.d.).

³⁴ Chaucer includes this tale as one of his ‘own’ contributions to the *Canterbury Tales*. He was, however, translating an intermediary French version (the *Livre de Melibée et de Dame Prudence* of Renaud de Louens), and he follows the Frenchman’s howler of translating *oculis* as *piez*, thus losing the somewhat tedious point.

³⁵ ‘Sycomorus arbor est, moro folia milis, sed altitudine præstans, et interpretatur *ficus fatua*, id est crux’, *PL* 114, col. 325–6.

³⁶ Bonaventure in Luke 10, vii, 271.

³⁷ See Hope Traver, *The Four Daughters of God* (Bryn Mawr, 1907).

³⁸ *Passus* 18, ll. 110ff. In this poem the allegorical presentation of the debate of the Four Daughters follows a protracted allegorical presentation of the parable of the Good Samaritan in the seventeenth *passus*. In 1962 the distinguished Harvard medievalist Morton Bloomfield, Marjorie Reeves’s friend and one-time collaborator, published an important book entitled *Piers Plowman as a Fourteenth-century Apocalypse* (New Brunswick, 1962).

³⁹ *The Vision of Piers Plowman*, ed. Aubrey V.C. Schmidt (London, 1978), 225.

⁴⁰ *Opuscula S. Francisci et scripta S. Clarae Assisiensium* (Assisi, 1978), 268.

⁴¹ See Denis Costa, *Irenic Apocalypse: Some Uses of Apocalyptic in Dante, Petrarch and Rabelais* (Saratoga, Calif., 1981), 19, where, however, ‘the problem for a figure like Joachim’ there alluded to seems to me to belong to the author rather than Joachim.

PART II

Joachim of Fiore's Influence in the Later Middle Ages

Chapter 6

Teste David cum Sibylla: The Tiburtine Sibyl at the Court of Sancho el Fuerte

Fabio Troncarelli

Prophecy in the Middle Ages

During the Middle Ages a lengthy debate took place as to the nature and characteristics of prophecy and to its agent, the prophet. Theologians were attempting to define who could be described as a visionary and also to determine whether the interpretation of the Bible might have a prophetic character. Their discussion centred on two fundamental questions: Did the era of the prophets really end with John the Baptist as Christ promised in the Gospels or had another kind of prophecy come into being after His advent? The answers of the theologians were divergent, some arguing that the prophets had ceased with the Old Testament, others that the Apostolic Age offered the possibility of a new type of prophecy, without differentiating the identity of the prophet as such. Viewed from this perspective, while the prophet's nature might remain the same over time, the divine message addressed to the multitude of believers could vary according to the general dynamics of salvation history.

In medieval theological thought the Augustinian conception of the vision as set out in the twelfth book of *De Genesi ad Litteram* was taken as the starting point of the origin and nature of prophecy.¹ When Augustine comments on the incident of Paul's flight to the third heaven (2 Cor. 12), he attempts to distinguish between the various different forms of vision. For him, vision is closely related to prophecy and it is the greatest prophet who experiences a really spiritual 'vision'. But vision alone is insufficient: the true prophet is one who not only sees but also knows how to interpret the vision he has experienced and is thereby empowered to understand the visions of others. In any case, for Augustine the prophets were firmly located in the Old Testament while the New Testament was instead the time of the exegetes and theologians of Scripture.

Medieval theologians subsequently developed and elaborated Augustine's theories. According to Cassiodorus, prophecy was a divine inspiration that encouraged comment on God's truth and its proclamation to others.² In this sense, therefore, even valid interpreters of Scripture were to be regarded as prophets. For Gregory the Great, however, prophecy did not predict the future, but instead served to reveal that which is hidden ('non ... praedicat uentura, sed ... prodat occulta'³). The prophet is thus the one to whom the divine plan, hidden from others, has been revealed. Seen from this perspective, the most commanding prophetic figure in medieval theology is St John the Evangelist. John is able to reveal the mysteries sealed in the Book of the Revelation, because he alone can observe God with sharp eyes: like his symbol, the eagle, he knows how to rise to the heavens to see the heights of the divine mystery and communicate these to the world.

If this is the accepted role of the prophet, then it should not come as a surprise that the most knowledgeable of the medieval theologians often assigned a marginal role to popular prophecies claiming to reveal the future or to predict specific events. While recognizing the importance of some of these texts, they stressed that predictions such as these ought not to be read too literally but instead could be used more generally to indicate the future course of events, such as the occurrence of disasters before the final struggle with Antichrist. Even in the case of exact predictions of specific events, the more conscientious theologians tended to interpret these texts as exceptions to, rather than the rule of prophecy. But, despite the significance of certain prominent theologians, another view was beginning to gain

ground, namely, the search for exact predictions about the present or the immediate future in those texts written by obscure Christian prophets and pagans. This explains the proliferation in the period of well-known yet enigmatic prophecies, such as those of Merlin, which were revised and readjusted several times to match contemporary events, and of those prophecies attributed to the ancient Sibyls, who were among the most fascinating legendary figures of classical antiquity.

Oracula Sibyllina

The Sibyls, said to have been inspired by Apollo himself, were regarded as possessing the power to forecast the future. In contrast to the institutional prophesying of the Pythia within the permanent and well-regulated sanctuary at Delphi, the Sibyl prophesied in unusual places that had nothing to do with a temple – on a rock or in a cave – and without ornaments and decorations. It was widely thought that the Sibyls were not subject to the passage of time but instead lived out mysterious lives beyond the sight of man. While some argued for the existence of a single immortal figure who moved from place to place, Varro identified no fewer than 10 Sibyls – the Persian, the Libyan, the Delphian, the Erythrean, the Samian, the Hellespontine, the Phrygian, the Tiburtine, the Cimmerian, and the Cumaean, this list being widely circulated in the Middle Ages through Lactantius' *Institutiones*⁴ and Isidorus' *Etymologiae*.⁵

Enigmatic by definition, the Sibylline prophecies were highly regarded from ancient times. We know, for example, that Tarquin Priscus gathered together the so-called Sibylline Books, a collection of prophecies, written on palm leaves in Greek hexameters, the care of which he entrusted to two special colleges of priests. By the dictatorship of Sulla (d. 78 BC), as many as 15 such colleges had come into existence, in which the priests, bound to the utmost secrecy, were called upon to examine and explain the oracles to the Senate in times of crisis. By 83 BC the books, stored at that period in the temple of Jupiter, had suffered total destruction in a great fire on the Capitol. Subsequently, however, the collection was recreated, gathering together oracles from Greece and Asia and, on the orders of Octavian Augustus, they were henceforth to be kept in the temple of Apollo on the Palatine. The cult of the Sibyl, however, once so vibrant in archaic religiosity, had begun to experience such a deep decline by the first century

AD that, in his *Satyricon*, Petronius was able to depict the Cumaean Sibyl as a decrepit old woman to whom Apollo gave immortality but not eternal youth.⁶

The final destruction of the Sibylline Books took place in the fourth century AD at the hands of Stilicho. However, even his attempt to obliterate them failed to prevent the subsequent creation of numerous collections of Sibylline oracles in Greek and Latin, the most important of which came from the Judeo-Hellenic culture of Alexandria and revealed a significant Christian reworking. These collections suggested that some of the mythical Sibyls had foretold the coming of Christ and it was for this reason that so many of the Church Fathers took their message seriously. Other medieval authors considered them as the heralds of Christianity, even when their texts bore no clear references to the faith.

The Sibyls thus became a popular subject of religious iconography from the Middle Ages to the Renaissance where figures of Old Testament prophets were brought together with saints who possessed the gift of prophecy. One such clear example occurs in the fresco cycle of the church of Sant'Angelo in Formis near Capua, dating from the abbacy of Desiderius of Montecassino (1058–86). The iconographic attributes of the pagan Sibyls generally took the form of books, veils, plates, or scrolls in which the future was written down and was to be read. In the case of those Sibyls who were claimed to have an explicit relationship with Christianity, we find the sword, the lily, and the cornucopia.

The Pamplona Bible

Having briefly sketched some of the widespread opinions offered on prophets and Sibyls during the Middle Ages, we turn now to the main theme of this chapter, the discussion of a hitherto neglected representation of the Tiburtine Sibyl in the Pamplona Bible.⁷

The First Bible of Pamplona, made for Sancho VII el Fuerte (the Strong), king of Navarre (1194–1234), was completed in 1197.⁸ It is presently catalogued as manuscript Latin 108 in the Bibliothèque municipale of Amiens and was the prototype for the so-called Second Bible of Pamplona, commissioned by Sancho for a noblewoman, perhaps his sister, Berenguela, on the occasion of her wedding to Richard I of England, or his mother, Sancha of Castile.⁹ Both bibles are attributed to Ferrando Petri de Funes,

canon of the cathedral of Calahorra, formerly chancellor (1192–94) to Sancho VI The Wise (1150–94) and director of the *scriptorium* in Pamplona where they were made. It is the Second Bible, however, which concerns us here, and again Ferrando Petri was probably also responsible for the selection and adaptation of the texts and for ordering the illustrations to be made.¹⁰ This was no mere copy of the First Bible but a more magnificent, expanded version, using only the finest of materials in order to illustrate the importance of the commission.

The Second Bible of Pamplona is presently held by the University Library of Augsburg, Codex I, 2, 4°15. Both bibles are exceptional in their use of full- or half-page miniatures of scenes from the Vulgate, with the characters who appear in each image being identified by name. Subsequently, short explanatory texts in Gothic lower-case script have been added beneath the illustrations. In the Second Bible, however, Ferrando Petri directed the illuminators to modify almost half of the scenes, adding a further 91 not present in the previous version, and he was also probably responsible for selecting and adapting the texts and arranging the illustrations. Besides the use of a much finer-quality parchment, more gold and costlier pigments were employed. The second Pamplona Bible is composed of 271 parchment leaves, bearing images of 33 out of the 46 books of the Bible. The whole work contains some 976 scenes from the Old and New Testaments, including the lives of many saints and martyrs. The miniatures, drawn with a fine pen, are painted in green, yellow, and ochre watercolours, with gold leaf in 61 figures. Specialists now believe the work to have been undertaken by three scribes and at least four painters.¹¹ These bibles were executed in a clear Romanesque style, rooted, as were other examples of High Medieval Spanish paintings and miniatures, in earlier traditions of a variety of different periods and origins.

The codex contains the Old and New Testaments including a genealogy of Christ and representations of the lives of 203 saints in chronological order, some closely linked to the kingdom of Navarre such as San Miguel de Aralar, St Saturnino, St Nicholas, St Martin, St Zoilo, and two female saints, Nunilona and Alodia. At the end of the text, an apocalyptic section addresses the Second Coming of Christ. This basically depends on texts from the Tiburtine Sibyl, Isaiah, the Gospels, and the apocryphal Acts of Pilate but – and this is a highly unusual feature for a Spanish manuscript – not on the Apocalypse of St John.

The miniatures are characterized by their dramatic representation and rapid movement through a narrative sequence.¹² The selection of episodes ‘depended both upon the theological importance and traditional popularity of the events and upon the direct moral implications that could be applied to Sancho el Fuerte’s personal life’.¹³ Another element is the violent representation of martyrdom: the martyr’s death is always tragic and realistic, ‘almost ferocious’. A similar fierceness ‘characterizes mass death, killings and maimings’.¹⁴

Rainier of Ponza

Rainier of Ponza was the close friend and collaborator of Joachim. He was sent as a legate by Innocent III to Navarre, Castile, and Leon in 1198. In 1196 the aged Celestine III had granted Sancho VII the royal title which the papacy had denied to the independent Navarrese rulers during more than 60 years from the death of Alfonso I of Aragón.¹⁵ But, even after this concession, Sancho allied himself with the Almohad rulers against King Alfonso VIII of Castile, who had been crushingly defeated by the Muslims at the battle of Alarcos on 19 July 1195. In 1197 Sancho VII attacked Castilian castles and for this it appears he was excommunicated by the papal legate Cardinal Gregory and his lands placed under interdict.¹⁶ In April 1198 Innocent called upon Rainier to uphold this sentence if it were found that Sancho had broken truces agreed with Castile and allied with the Saracens, unless Sancho gave satisfaction.¹⁷ In the meantime Alfonso VIII of Castile and Peter II of Aragón invaded Navarre, and Alfonso VIII would do so again in the following year at which point Sancho VII fled south to the territory of the Almohads, where he would remain during two years.¹⁸

It is not surprising that, on his travels, Rainier seized the opportunity to spread the ideas and manuscripts of Joachim in Iberia. Innocent III had solemnly charged him with the task of preaching against heretics and the legate performed the task with such skill that the memory of his sermons lingered on in Spain, many years after his death, as Ugolino, cardinal bishop of Ostia, recalled so dramatically.¹⁹ It is assumed that, during the course of his legatine commission in 1198, Rainier had recourse to the works and ideas of his friend, as indeed he enjoyed again in 1203, when he used and quoted Joachite ideas openly in a public controversy about the fate

of the Cistercian order, as is made clear in a letter addressed to Arnaud Amaury, abbot of Cîteaux.²⁰

Rainier appears to have used some Joachite manuscripts to preach to his new Iberian audience, his sermons charting the direction taken by Innocent III in the fight against heresy and his exhortation to crusade against the infidels helping to renew eschatological tensions. One of the manuscripts which Rainier probably brought with him is MS Latin 427, Paris, Bibliothèque nationale, including the *Psalterium decem cordarum*, the *Liber introductorius*, and a part of the *Expositio in Apocalypsim* of Joachim of Fiore. Dated to the first half of the thirteenth century and hypothetically assigned to southern Italy by Avril and Gousset, the manuscript is one of the oldest witnesses to the dissemination of works of the Calabrian abbot and merits a thorough palaeographic analysis.²¹

The presence of a hand of Italian origin in the margins of this manuscript has been attributed to a *scriptorium* strongly influenced by the script used in the *Patrimonium beati Petri*, confirming the hypothesis already expressed by other scholars. But this now appears not to be so. Some letters of the captions of at least one of the illustrations are in fact derived from Visigothic documentary letters, not yet forgotten by Spanish scribes working at the turn of the twelfth century.

The hypothesis of an Iberian origin for one or more scribes receives clear confirmation when comparison is made with documentary evidence from other late twelfth-century scribes. The so-called ‘Blessed of Navarre’, known as MS Escorial M III 2, now Paris, Bibliothèque nationale, Nouv. Acq. Lat. 1366, may perhaps be dated to 1188 in Toledo, while the Pamplona bibles with their graphic forms are in fact very similar to those of our manuscript, Paris Latin 427, showing the same type of ‘s’, crushed ‘d’, and the ‘g’ with the rounded lower edge typical of Carolingian minuscule, but also with the loose strokes used in Gothic script. Particularly illuminating is the comparison with the Pamplona bibles: the copyists of Paris Latin 427 are very similar to those who wrote the two volumes of the Scriptures between 1197 and 1198. We know of scribes working similarly in the Chancery of Sancho el Fuerte, under the direction of Ferrando Petri, while he was serving as Chancellor (1192–94) to Sancho VI The Wise.

Just as Joachim asked and obtained from the abbot of Casamari for the help of three scribes (one of whom was Luke of Cosenza),²² so Rainier could likewise have been assisted in the copying of Joachim’s manuscripts

by other such scribes, while he was at the court of Sancho in 1198, bringing the manuscript to France with him. Just as Joachim was accompanied in Calabria by Luke, the scribe, notwithstanding that both were monks at Casamari and were bound by their vow of stability,²³ so, too, Rainier could have obtained from Sancho the help and the assistance of his scribes. After 1198 these could have accompanied him on his travels in France, where he remained for a while before returning to Rome and thence to France where he remained until 1202.²⁴

The Emperor and the Sibylla

Just before the Apocalyptic section, the Second Pamplona Bible contains an illustration of the legendary meeting between the Tiburtine Sibyl and the Emperor Octavian Augustus. In subsequent figures, and also in the First Pamplona Bible in Amiens (although this omits the figure of the Sibyl), the prophecies of the Tiburtine Sibyl are combined with those of the Erythrean Sibyl, as quoted in Augustine's *City of God*,²⁵ in the captions over one of the following illustrations.²⁶

The legendary meeting between the Sibyl and the Emperor was linked to the famous Roman Church of Santa Maria on the Aracoeli hill and the widespread legend circulating by the mid-twelfth century.²⁷ 'It is a well-known legend that gave rise to the name of Aracoeli, which is reported in the *Mirabilia Urbis* ... One day the emperor Octavian consulted the Tiburtine Sibyl and he heard a voice saying: "Haec est Ara Primogeniti Dei". Then Octavian erected an altar on the Capitol, on which was later built a church, which since the twelfth century is called Ara filii Dei, then called Aracoeli.' The legend, however, is probably of Greek origin, because it occurs in the Byzantine *Suda*. It is also recorded by Nicephorus, and is included in an old Latin chronicle published by Mai, which could date from the seventh or eighth centuries.²⁸ ... Apparently under the veil of legend and the vision of Augustus lies the concept of the first Christian and solemn consecration of the ancient Roman Capitol ...'²⁹

The legend was set down in written form and was widely circulated, becoming associated with the so-called *Interpretation of the Dream of Hundred Roman Senators*, in which Octavian searched for the Sibyl because he sought to understand the vision experienced by a hundred

Roman Senators on the same night, who all dreamed the same dream in which the Child Jesus appeared in the sky over the Aracoeli.³⁰

By the thirteenth century, it had become usual to put the Tiburtine Sybil to one side or to replace her with the Virgin Mary, as we can see in the marble arch still preserved under the altar of St Helena on the church on the Aracoeli.³¹ Pietro Cavallini's complex representation of this was imitated in a later illumination:

La scène est divisée en deux plans. En bas, une architecture conventionnelle représente une grande porte flanquée de deux tours à double étage, surmontées de quelques édicules. C'est vraisemblablement la porte d'un palais ou d'une ville; on y reconnaîtrait difficilement l'image du Capitole même, où la légende était localisée. Devant cette porte se tiennent les deux personnages, vêtus à l'antique; l'Empereur, qui porte une couronne, et la Sibylle tenant un livre, s'entretiennent avec vivacité. Tous les deux montrent la figure de la Madone qui occupe le plan supérieur de la miniature. Assise sur un trône sans dossier, tenant sur ses genoux l'Enfant Jésus et, de chaque côté, un ange, la Madone est entourée d'une mandorle de nuages stylisés. La scène n'est accompagnée d'aucune inscription.³²

We have other examples of the same scene between the thirteenth and fifteenth centuries,³³ showing that the iconography of the Tiburtine Sibyl became increasingly significant during the Middle Ages and reached its maximum extent between the mid-fifteenth and early sixteenth centuries, enriched with symbolic attributes and frequently interchangeable meanings and increasingly relevant Christological themes.

That the medieval model evolved in Italy becomes clear through the wide diffusion of a very popular text by the Dominican Filippo de' Barbieri, namely, the *Discordantiae nonnullae inter sanctum et Hieronymum Augustinum* published in 1481.³⁴ In this, Barbieri describes the distinct physical characteristics of the prophetess as well as the symbols associated with each representation of her, while adding to Varro's canon two new Sibyls, the European and the Agrippinian.

The process of assimilation of an archaic pagan figure into the Christian spirituality was complete at the end of the fifteenth century, as is seen through the series of 10 Sibyls created on the floor of the Duomo of Siena in the period from 1482 to 1483, in a multi-coloured marble inlay. The prophetesses, delineated by an essential style, are represented in full length, wrapped in ample draperies, with a book or a scroll in their hands to signify their prophetic attribute. Each figure is accompanied by her name and the Latin verses which repeat the prophecy connected to her, but always related to the mystery of the incarnation of Christ. Each Sibyl is depicted with her

symbolic attribute and captions, together with tables on which are inscribed her name and the literary sources from which derives the Christological prophecy attributed to her.³⁵

Michelangelo, too, addresses the canons of this well-established tradition, much under the influence of the widespread prophetic atmosphere in Italy in the late fifteenth century. The Sibyls, alongside the majestic figures of the Hebrew prophets of the Sistine Chapel, are gathered together in sequence, organized within a tradition in which they have a key intermediary role between the old spirituality and the full affirmation of Christian values.³⁶

This distinct line of tradition is also found in the scene represented by the Spanish artist in the Second Pamplona Bible. The drawing itself is quite interesting and differs from other similar illustrations on the same episode. The Virgin Mary is absent from the scene and the meeting between the Sibyl and the Emperor appears to be more of a dialogue than a revelation (Figure 6.1).

This is not the only remarkable aspect of the illustration. In other examples, two figures, the one male, the other female, are wearing classical dress with symbols which provide a clue to their special status. To make it clearer that a bearded male figure represents the Emperor, he wears a crown indicating his power to rule; a king rather than an emperor. Nothing in the bearing of the young woman in front of him suggests to us that she is the Sibyl. As a matter of fact, these two appear similar to other men and women represented in the previous leaves of the manuscript. The Emperor is depicted as an Old Testament king. The Sibyl wears the same long habit with special sleeves and headdress as worn by Spanish ladies at this time. It is interesting that she raises her arms in an enigmatic way, appearing like a dancer in a moment of rest. Also the *optimates*, intended to represent Roman senators, are ambiguous: only one of them has a long beard while the two others appear to be very young.

The next scenes also display the same tendency to oversimplify complex texts and figures. To outline some specific points: the eschatological section avoids the rich symbolism of St John's Apocalypse and points out, with the help of quotations from the oracles of the Tiburtine Sibyl,³⁷ that the Antichrist will soon come, that the people of Gog and Magog will rise up from the north (even if some of them bear shields with the Muslim symbol, the half-moon), that the Antichrist will kill Enoch and Elijah and he will be

defeated by the Archangel Michael after a great fight. Then Christ will come for the second time and the dead who lie in the grave will rise again, the sinners being condemned to Hell while the just will dwell in eternal life.

‘A solid piety’³⁸

The simplified representation of the meeting between the Sibyl and the Emperor and the simplified version of the Second Coming of Christ corresponds to the general project carried on by the artists who realized the two Pamplona Bibles. As Franz Bucher wrote:

The simple style, the choice of subjects’ setting, the triumph of a vengeful God over his past and future enemies against the eternal rewards of rectitude and Christian heroism must be seen as a reflection of both the artistic and political atmosphere in Navarra and a summation of Sancho’s complex position. Both Bibles stress the cosmic and human battle between good and evil, and more specifically between the interests of the church represented by the chancellor and of the state represented by the royal house, piety.³⁹



Figure 6.1 *The Emperor and the Sibyl*, Second Pamplona Bible, Universitätsbibliothek Augsburg, Cod. I. 2. 4° 15, fol. 267 recto. By kind permission of the Universitätsbibliothek Augsburg.

The choice of biblical episodes and the selection of scene are full of political meaning. For Bucher, they are ‘a wordless echo’ of the charges

which were to be brought against Sancho VII, including neglect of his realm through absence, betrayal of the Christian kings of Spain, and blatant disregard for the commands of the pope. The images, as Bucher correctly noted, with their emphasis on David's personal courage, the bravery of the three youths in the fiery oven, the resurrected Christ, and the great heroes of Christianity are possibly didactic hints cautioning Sancho against his amicable relations with the Almohads.⁴⁰ Perhaps the culmination of warnings and recommendation about Sancho's future conduct comes with the monumental and straightforward testament of the Second Coming and the gigantic and powerful Antichrist.⁴¹

It is perhaps no coincidence that the triumph against the Antichrist was so appreciated by the court of Navarre as well as the predictions of the Tiburtine and Erythrean Sibyls, used as a commentary on the Apocalypse in the Pamplona Bible. Sancho el Fuerte tried to show to Rainier, the papal legate, that he was in harmony both with his own faith and with that of the Pope, thus dispelling the suspicions of disloyalty that Innocent III may well have harboured. In fact, Innocent greatly appreciated the prophecies of the Tiburtine Sibyl, as can be seen from the reference to the legend of the Tiburtine Sibyl in one of his sermons.⁴²

Teste David cum Sybilla

A role similar to that of the Sibyl was attributed to some other legendary characters, to magicians and to prophets as Hermes Trismegistus or Merlin, under whose names collections of writings circulated in the Middle Ages, being read and commented upon by many medieval theologians such as Joachim himself. Noteworthy among these comments is an *Exposition on the Sibyl and Merlin*, which circulated widely in the Middle Ages with the false attribution of Joachim of Fiore.

It was not, however, by mere chance that the name of a famous theologian such as Joachim, widely considered as a prophet inspired by God, became associated with such popular texts dealing with predictions of the future. Nevertheless, Joachim of Fiore's spirit was different. Taking for granted the views of Gregory the Great, he not only frequently states but also demonstrates within his own work that the task of the prophet is to reveal to mankind the hidden divine plan, rather than to be the herald of forthcoming events. The abbot of Fiore remains confident that the

exegetical method permits him to know what is hidden beneath the surface of history and to proclaim what the ancient prophets could only glimpse from afar. Thus, together with Augustine, while supporting the view that the time of the Old Testament prophets is over, he is confident of being able to see clearly what the prophets of the past could only glimpse. He is able to indicate broadly the future, describing the era of Antichrist, his temporary defeat and the rising of a subsequent brief age marked by new harmony in the world, before the final battle against Evil and the Judgement of Christ.

As Mariorie Reeves has pointed out, Joachim's contemporaries often considered him in a different way and were particularly interested in his ability to explain the *Prophetiae ignotae* and to reveal the signs that shows the next arrival of the Antichrist.⁴³ This interest was shared by those kings who were fortunate enough to meet the mysterious Joachim and who sought clear predictions about their fate. Both Richard Cœur de Lion⁴⁴ and Henry VI were pleased to be informed that their destiny was successful and full of glory, even if they were, in fact, simple tools in the hands of God.

King Sancho el Fuerte had a similar political interest in prophecy: meeting a friend of Joachim's, he never forgot his political role and papal warnings against the crown of Navarre. Therefore, he ordered the retelling of the stories of the Bible in such a way that he could reveal his attitude as a listener to the lessons of the prophets and of God Himself. Sancho would be another Octavian who was able to listen to the Sibyl, to refuse honours and build a temple in honour of a future that still remained hidden. This is what the representations of the Sibyl and the Emperor in the Pamplona Bible were intended to reveal. For this reason, the attractive power of a simple dialogue between a king and a woman with the power to forecast the future is not hard to understand. The true dilemma for Sancho was not his ability to listen to the Sibyl, but rather to change his life. But he did so to some extent and obtained papal approval. Afterwards, on 16 July 1212, he fought bravely against his old allies, the Almohads, alongside the kings of Castile and Aragon who had long been his main opponents, helping to win the great Christian victory of Las Navas de Tolosa.⁴⁵

Notes

¹ Augustine, *De Genesi ad litteram*, lib. xii, par. 9, CCSL 28/1, 391.

² Cassiodorus, *Expositio Psalmorum*, praef. i, CCSL 97, 7.

³ Gregory the Great, *Homiliae in Hiezechihelam prophetam*, lib. i, horn. i, CCSL 142, 5.

⁴ Lactantius, *Divinae institutiones*, lib. i, cap. 6, CSEL 19/1, 20–25.

⁵ Isidorus, *Etymologiarum siue Originum libri xx*, lib. viii, cap. 8, ed. Wallace Martin Lindsay, 2 vols (Oxford, 1911), i, n.p., PL 82, cols 309C–310A.

⁶ Petronius, *Satyricon*, *Cena Trimalchionis*, iii, 48 (numerous editions).

⁷ Francois Bucher, *The Pamplona Bibles: a facsimile compiled from two picture Bibles with martyrologies commissioned by King Sancho el Fuerte of Navarre (1194–1234)*, Amiens Manuscript Latin 108 and Harburg MS. 1, 2, Lat 4°, 75, 2 vols (New Haven and London, 1970), Hardo Hild, *Lateinische Handschriften in Quarto der Universitätsbibliothek Augsburg Die Signaturengruppe Cod. I. 2. 4° und Cod. II. 1. 4°* (Wiesbaden, 2007), 67–70. Also now *Die Pamplona-Bibel: die Bilderbibel des Königs Sancho el Fuerte (1153–1234) von Navarra. Universitätsbibliothek Augsburg, Sammlung Oettingen-Wallerstein, Cod. I. 2. 4° 15, vol. 1., Facsimile, und vol. 2., Kommentar, mit Beiträgen von G. Hägele, L., Karl, I. Schäfer und G. Bartz* (Stuttgart and Madrid, 2005), which includes especially relevant studies by Hägele ('Von Pamplona nach Augsburg. Die Spanische Bilderbibel in der Sammlung Oettingen-Wallerstein', 13–21) and Bartz ('Beschreibung der Handschrift', 27–267).

⁸ A colophon of MS Amiens (Bartz, 'Beschreibung der Handschrift', 44) indicates that 'Illustrissimus Sancius rex Navarre filius Sancii nobilissimi regis Navarrorum' had the book made ('fecit fieri') 'a Ferrando Petri de Funes' who 'composuit hunc librum ad honorem domini regis et ad preces ipsius prout melius potuit, precipue ut omnipotentis dei amorem acquirat et eiusdem regis Sancii possit gratiam invenire. Fuit autem consumatus hunc librum era MCCXXXV anno incarnationis domini MCLXXXVII'.

⁹ Other candidates (Hägele, 'Von Pamplona nach Augsburg' 19; Bartz, 'Beschreibung der Handschrift', 42–3) include Sancho's sister Teresa, who was promised by Sancho to Peter II of Aragón in 1197 to halt the Castilian–Aragonese invasion of his lands, though the marriage agreement was subsequently quashed by Innocent III (*La documentación pontificia hasta Inocencio III*, ed. Demetrio Mansilla (Rome, 1955): 197–8, no. 181); Sancho's other sister, Bianca, who would subsequently become countess of Champagne, and, finally, an unnamed Almohad princess, whom Sancho was supposed to have married after he fled to al-Andalus during a two-year period, following the Castilian–Aragonese invasion of his lands in 1198. (The absence is demonstrated by *Colección documental de Sancho VII el Fuerte (1194–1234)*, ed. J.M. Jimeno Jurío, 70–71, nos. 24–5.) The last story, lovingly told in the chronicle of Roger of Howden (*Chronica magistri Rogeri de Houedene*, ed. William Stubbs, 4 vols, RS 51 (1868–71), iii, 91; iv, 113) is extremely improbable (see, esp., Luis Fortún Pérez, *Sancho VII el Fuerte (1194–1234)* (Iruña, 1987), 165–74).

¹⁰ Amiens, Bibliothèque municipale, MS lat. 108, fol. 256v, Colophon of Ferrandus Petri de Funes.

¹¹ Bucher, *The Pamplona. Bibles*, I, 54.

¹² 'Quickness of eye and the ability to capture a decisive moment is a hallmark of the Pamplona workshop', *ibid.*, 53.

¹³ *Ibid.*

¹⁴ *Ibid.*

¹⁵ Fidel Fita, 'Bulas inéditas', *Boletín de la Real Academia de la Historia*, 27 (1895), 229–30.

¹⁶ Rodrigo of Toledo, *Historia de rebvs Hispanie sive Historia Gothica*, ed. J. Fernández Valverde, CCCM 72 (1987), Bk. VII, ch. 30; Lucas of Túy, *Chronicon Mundi*, ed. Emma Falque, CCCM 74 (2003), Bk. 4, ch. 83, 321–3; *La documentación pontificia hasta Inocencio III (965–1216)*, ed. Demetrio Mansilla (Rome, 1955), 169: no. 138.

¹⁷ *La documentación pontificia hasta Inocencio III*, 169: no. 138: 'Accepimus etiam, quod rex Navarrorum treugas cum dicto rege Castelle initas fregit et castella fidelitatis per violentiam occupavit, propter quod a dilecto filio nostro G. S. Angeli diacono cardinali tunc apostolice sedis

legato excommunicationis in personam eius et in terram interdicti fuit sententia promulgata. ... Super eo autem quod de rege Navarre dictum est, inquiras diligentius veritatem; et si sic inveneris, ut superius est expressum, latam in eum et terrain eius sententiam per totam Hispaniam publicari facias ec earn, nisi sufficienti staisfactione recepta, relaxes. Quod si forsan in eum vel regnum eius dicta non fuit sententia promulgata, nichilominus tarnen, si cum sarracenis contra christianos et precipue contra dictum regem Castelle, sicut dicitur, coniuravit, anathematis eum severitate percellas et terrain eius usque ad dignam satisfactionem subicias interdicto.'

¹⁸ Rodrigo of Toledo, *Historia de rebvs Hispanie*, Bk. VII, chs 30–32, 252–4; Lucas of Túy, *Chronicon Mundi*, Bk. 4, ch. 83.

¹⁹ E. Winkelmann, 'Analecta Heidelbergensia', *Archivio della Società romana di storia patria*, 2 (1879), Varietà, II, 363–7.

²⁰ Bruno Griesser, 'Rainer von Fossanova und sein Brief an Abt Arnald von Cîteaux (1203)', *Cistercienser Chronik*, 60 (1953), 151–67.

²¹ Fabio Troncarelli, 'Un autografo di Raniero da Ponza', in *Il ricordo del futuro. Gioacchino da Fiore e il gioachimismo attraverso la storia*, ed. Fabio Troncarelli (Bari, 2007), 47–53.

²² Lucas, O. Cist, in N. Kamp, *Kirche und Monarchie im Staufischen Königreich Sizilien*, 1/2: *Prosopographische Grundlegung: Bistümer und Bischöfe des Königreichs 1194–1266, Apulien und Kalahrien* (Munich, 1975), 833–9; B. Fornari, 'Luca Campano, un grande ciociaro', in *Luoghi e personaggi di Ciociaria: Atti del IV convegno, Guarcino, 14 novembre 1973*, 2 vols (Frosinone, 1974), 2: 37–45.

²³ On Luke as a scribe, see A.M. Adorisio, 'L'opera dimenticata di Luca di Casamari, archievescovo di Cosenza. Premessa all'edizione del *Liber usuum Ecclesiae Cusentinae*', in *Federico II e Casamari, Atti del convegno nazionale di studi per l'ottavo centenario della nascita di Federico II (1194–1250), Casamari, 16 settembre 1995* (Casamari, 1996), 81–96.

²⁴ The problem could arise if we assumed that the texts in Paris, BNF, MS 427 must have been completed by Joachim following Rainier's travels to Navarre. But this is a 'false problem'. Leaving Navarre in 1198, he stayed first in France, then Rome before returning to France again by 1202. He might have been ordered to transcribe Joachim manuscripts in the period 1198–1202 and the copyist could have worked on them even if he was not actually present besides them. Gian Luca Potestà dates the *Liber introductorius* to sometime before 1199: 'Un preciso elemento testuale permette di stabilire che il *Liber introductorius* venne steso non oltre il 1199', Gian Luca Potestà, *Il tempo dell'Apocalisse. Vita di Gioacchino da Fiore* (Bari and Rome, 2004), 328. The *Expositio* must have been completed before 1200 because Joachim mentions it in his *Festament* dated to 1200 (providing that this apologetic text is really authentic). In both cases, the texts were written before Rainier's last stay in France in 1202.

²⁵ Augustine, *De civitate Dei*, lib. xviii, cap. 23, *CCSL* 48, 613–14.

²⁶ Amiens, Bibliothèque municipale, MS lat. 108, fol. 215v; see Bucher, *The Pamplona Bibles*, ii, tav. 560; on the picture *ibid.*, i, 25.

²⁷ *Le Liber Censuum de l'Eglise Romaine*, ed. Paul Fabre and Louis Duchesne, 2 vols (Paris, 1905), i, 262–73; Heinrich Jordan, *Topographie der Stadt Rom im Altertum*, 2 vols (Berlin, 1871), ii, 605–43. The text of the *Mirabilia* is this: 'In the time of the emperor Octavian the senators, seeing him to be of such great beauty that none could look into his eyes and of such great prosperity and peace that he made all the world render tribute to him, said to him, "We desire to worship you because the godhead is in you; for if it were not so all things would not prosper with you as they do." But he was reluctant and demanded a delay and called the Sibyl of Tibur to him, and he repeated all that the senators had said. She begged for three days' time, during which she kept a strict fast, and then answered him after the third day. "These things, lord emperor, shall surely come to pass: Token of doom: the earth shall drip with sweat;

From heaven shall come the king for evermore,
And present in the flesh shall judge the world.”

And the other verses that follow. And while Octavian diligendy listened to the Sibyl, heaven opened, and a great brightness shone on him, and he saw in heaven a virgin exceedingly fair standing on an altar holding a man-child in her arms. Octavian marveled greedy at this, and he heard a voice from heaven saying: “This is the Virgin who shall conceive the Savior of the World.” And again he heard another voice from heaven saying, “This is the altar of the Son of God.” The emperor straightway fell to the ground and worshipped the Christ that should come. He showed this vision to the senators and they likewise marveled exceedingly. The vision took place in the chamber of Emperor Octavian where the Church of Santa Maria in Capitolio is now and where the Friars Minor are. Therefore it is called Santa Maria in Aracoeli.’ (translation by Frances Morgan Nichols, *The Marvels of Rome or a Picture of the Golden City: Mirabilia Urbis Romae*, 2nd edn [New York, 1986, orig. London, 1889], Part ii, section 1: ‘The Vision of Octavian and the Sibyl’s Answer’.). On this topic and on the legend, see Henri Leclercq, ‘Marie in Ara Coeli’, *Dictionnaire d’archéologie chrétienne et de liturgie*, 10, 2 (Paris, 1932), 2076–7.

²⁸ The oldest Latin manuscript in which we find an allusion to the story, Vatican City, BAV, MS Vat. Pal. 227, dates from the seventh century.

²⁹ Mariano Armellini, *Le Chiese di Roma* (Rome, 1891), 54. On this argument, see Domenico Comparetti, *Vergil in the Middle Ages* (Princeton, 1996; orig. *Virgilio nel medio evo* [Florence, 1937], repr. 1955), 313–14; Paul F. Burke, ‘Augustus and Christianity in Myth and Legend’ *New England Classical Journal*, 32.3 (2005), 213–20.

³⁰ Alfons Kurfess, *Sibyllinische Weissagungen* (Munich, 1951), 276–9.

³¹ Burke, ‘Augustus’, 215, figs 1–3.

³² Alexandru Busuioceanu, ‘Une miniature inédite du XIII^e siècle reproduisant une œuvre de Pietro Cavallini’, *Revue Archéologique*, 5th series, 27 (1928), 141–5.

³³ Lionello Venturi, ‘Una rappresentazione trecentesca della Leggenda di Augusto e della Sibilla Tiburtina’, *Ausonia*, I (1906), 93–5. An interesting case is the Italian translation of the *Mirabilia*: ‘Ne lo tempo de Octabiano imperatore, li senatori vedeano esso de tanta belleze, lo quale nullo homo potea sostenere ne li oculi loro, et de tanta prosperitate et de tanta pace ka tutto lo munno facea ad sì tributo; et dixero ka lo voleano adorare, ka santitate era in sì, et se vero non forse, non vènnera prospere tutte le cose ad esso. Et Octabiano dixè, et ademannaio termine da li senatori et fece vocare la Sibylla Tybertina ad esso, et tutto quello ke li senatori li aveano dicto, dixè ad la Sybilla. La quale petio termine tre dii. Et la Sibylla ieiunao tre dii in quello palazzo et poi respuse ad Octabiano et dixè: “Misère imperatore, questo ène lo sinno de lo iudicio. Lo tuo sudore refonnerao la terra. De celo deo venire lo rege de lo munno, se licentia forse ad ti de vederelo”. Et incontenente fo aperto lo celo et molto splendore descese sopra esso, et Octabiano vide in celo una virgine coronata molto belledissima sopra una altare molto bella, et tenea in brachio uno infante. Et Octabiano senne deo molta mirabilia, et odio una voce così dicenno: “Questa ène l’altare de lo filio de Dio”. Et Octabiano incontenente se iectao in terra et adoraio Christo. La quale visione poi dixè ad li senatori, et quelli molta mirabilia senne diro. Et questa visione fo ne la camera de Octabiano imperatore la dov’ène la ecclesia de Sancta Maria in Capitolio, et da quello nanti fo clamata Sancta Maria in Ara Celi’ (*Le miracole de Roma (sec. XIII), adesp., Ms. Firenze – Biblioteca Mediceo-Laurenziana, cod. Gaddiano Rel. CXLVIII*, ed. E. Monaci, *Archivio della [R.] Società romana distoria patria*, 38 (1915), 551–90.

³⁴ Philippus de Barberiis, *Discordantiae Sanctorum doctorum Hieronymi et Augustini; Sybillarum et prophetarum de Christo vaticinia*[colophon:] Impressum Ro. [Giovanni Filippo La Legname], Die prima Mensis Decembris 1481.

³⁵ Enzo Carli, *Il Duomo di Siena* (Siena, 1979), 150–51.

³⁶ On this topic it is interesting to analyse the collections of portraits of the Sibyls published in the seventeenth century, summarizing ancient traditions, such as: Johannes Opsopaeus, *Sibyllina oracula ex uett. codd. aucta, renouata, et notis illustrata a D. Iohanne Opsopaeo brettano. Cum interpretation Latina Sebastiani Castalionis et Indice*. Parisijs, [Société typographique de Paris], 1607; David Blondel, *Des Sibylles celebrees tant par l'antiquite' payenne que par les saints peres, discours traittant des noms & du nombre des Sibylles, de leurs conditions, de la forme & matiere de leurs vers, des Liures qui portent jusq'aujourd'huy leurs noms, & de la consequence des suppositions que ces Liures contiennent, principalement touchant l'estat des hommes bons & mauuais apres la mort*, Paris rue Neufve Sainte Anne, près le Palais, au Roy de Suede, 1649; *Historia deorum fatidicorum, vatum, sibyllarum, phoebadum, apud priscos illustrium: Cum eorum Iconibus. Praeposita est dissertatio de diuinatione et oraculis*, Coloniae Allobrogum, Sumptibus Petri Chouët. 1675; *La vera, et famosa indovinatione della Sibilla Eritrea fatta ad istanza de principi di greci, quando gli domandarono consiglio intorno l'impresa di Troia. Nella quale non solamente vi si scopre il successo della rovina di troia, ma molte altre cose vi si dichiarano ancora appartenenti alla grandezza del cristianesimo, & di diverse altre parti del mondo. Particolarmente del regno turchesco ...* In Veneria, per Girolamo Albrizzi, 1570, new edition 1691. For another example, see in this volume Anke Holdenried, 253–81.

³⁷ Kurfess, *Sibyllinische Weissagungen*, 274–9, 341.

³⁸ Bucher, *The Pamplona Bibles*, i, 51–2.

³⁹ Ibid.

⁴⁰ Ibid.

⁴¹ Ibid., 53.

⁴² Innocentius III, *Sermones*, PL 217, col. 456 C.

⁴³ Marjorie Reeves, 'The Abbot Joachim's Disciples and the Cistercian Order' *Sophia*, 19 (1951), 355–71 (repr. *Joachim of Fiore in Christian Thought: Essays on the Influence of the Calabrian Prophet*, 2 vols [New York, 1975], i, 151–67); ead., *The Influence of Prophecy in Fater Middle Ages* (Oxford, 1969), 3–15.

⁴⁴ Roger of Howden, *Gesta Henrici II et Ricardi I*, ed. W. Stubbs, 2 vols, Rolls Series 49 (London, ii (1868–71), 151–2; id., *Chronica*, ed. W. Stubbs, 4 vols, Rolls Series 51 (London, 1867–71), iii (1868), 75–9.

⁴⁵ On which, see Fortún Pérez, *Sancho VII*, 217–44.

Chapter 7

Joachim or Joachimist? The Short
Excerpt Version of the *Psalterium
decem chordarum* in Context¹

Julia Eva Wannenmacher

A Most Interesting Book of Excerpts

Inevitably, Marjorie Reeves was first to have drawn attention to a ‘most interesting book of excerpts’.² One manuscript witness to this version of the *Psalterium decem chordarum* was discovered by Ernest Renan and Heinrich Denifle in the Bibliothèque nationale de France in Paris,³ while Denifle unearthed a second in the Biblioteca Ambrosiana in Milan⁴ and Miss Reeves herself identified a third copy in London.⁵ The book contains a collection of genuine and spurious writings by Joachim of Fiore, beginning with excerpts from his three main works: *Concordia veteris ac novi testamenti*, *Expositio super Apocalypsim*, and *Psalterium decem chordarum*. In the history of their reception all three have been copied, abridged, and excerpted many times. The *Psalterium*, for example, exists in three versions: the full version (its manuscripts preserving a vast multitude of parallel versions of numerous parts of it), a longer excerpt version preserved in two late medieval manuscripts, and a short excerpt version, part of the ‘most interesting book of excerpts’. In this essay, I will first discuss the role of the psaltery in Joachim’s work and in the Short Excerpt Version, then the excerpt set as a whole, and finally present an edition of the Short Excerpt Version of the *Psalterium decem chordarum*.

I. The Psaltery and Its Significance

1. The Psaltery in Joachim’s Work

“The Psaltery with ten strings is the most mystical of Joachim’s figures. [...] No other figure was introduced so elaborately by the mystic of Calabria, nor in such an exalted state of mind.”⁶ It is the main theme and title of one of Joachim’s three main works. However, of the many patterns and figures used by him, the psaltery is the only figure, the shape and full meaning of which we know that he conceived in a vision.⁷ Bearing in mind the effect of the visions in Joachim’s spiritual life and the impact that they had on both his writing and his self-esteem, this in itself demonstrates the important role of the psaltery and its implications for his work. Indeed, the importance of figures and numbers in Joachim’s thought can scarcely be exaggerated. According to Marjorie Reeves and Beatrice Hirsch-Reich, they reveal – and represent – the ‘artistic, intuitive, even mystical side’ of

the Calabrian abbot,⁸ contrasting and completing his personality as prophet, exegete, and apoclypt.

While the figure of the psaltery, both in the *Liber figurarum* and the additions to Joachim's other works (not only, but mainly, the *Psalterium*) can symbolize the three Persons of the Godhead, the book of the *Psalterium decem chordarum* is specifically dedicated to the third Person, the Holy Spirit. In general, the triangular figure of the psaltery symbolizes the inner-Trinitarian relations, or rather the relation between *unitas* and *trinitas*, between three Persons and one *essentia*, depicted in the three corners of the triangular instrument and the central circular cut-out space.

The 10 strings of the musical instrument have different meanings, according to the different stages of Joachim's interpretation of the instrument. On one hand, these are ascribed to the angelic choirs, and to Man singing and praising the Deity.⁹ On the other – which may also be understood literally, and exactly as they appear in the *Liber figurarum*¹⁰ – the 10 strings are ascribed to the seven gifts of the Holy Spirit and the three main virtues, faith, hope, and charity¹¹ Alternatively, the three virtues, together with patience and humility, mirror the five *opera Christi*, and thus again signify the 10 strings of the psaltery. These five virtues lead to the perfection necessary to receive the seven gifts of the Spirit. Here again we find the important combination of five and seven which Joachim treated in several of his major and minor works, in pairs of two or three times 12, and both with and without 'the implication of higher fulfilment in the seven'.¹²

Neither explanation of the 10 strings results from mere chance, nor do they occur without some inner relationship. Marjorie Reeves and Beatrice Hirsch-Reich were convinced that 'in finishing his *Psalterium* Joachim had reached exactly the same point in developing the relation of the five Virtues to the seven Gifts of the Spirit as in working out the relationship of Man to the angels.'¹³ It is characteristic of Joachim's thought that the love of learning and the praise of God are never to be found without each other.¹⁴

2. *The Psalterium in the Short Excerpt Version*

The Short Excerpt Version of the *Psalterium* consists of three parts or three subsequent excerpts, all originally to be found in the last section of the second book of Joachim's *Psalterium*. There Joachim explains the number of generations from Adam until the end of the world according to the

mystery of the psaltery. He counts 15 grades of 10 generations each. Together with the 10 strings of the musical instrument, these grades signify the perfection of 150, the number of the Psalms. According to Joachim's description at the beginning of the second book of the *Psalterium*, the 15 grades are the steps by which the faithful ascend the heights of heavenly contemplation.¹⁵ One hundred and fifty psalms can be divided into the three groups of 50 psalms each, according to three jubilees; the 15 grades can be attributed to the three *ordines* of laity, clerics, and monks,¹⁶ the three persons of the Deity, and the three ages: the time of the law before Christ, the period of grace from Jesus to the conversion of Israel, and from the conversion of Israel until the end. It comes, therefore, as no surprise that Marjorie Reeves could describe Joachim's imagination as 'kaleidoscopic'.¹⁷

The first part of the excerpt discusses the eleventh of these 15 grades.¹⁸ The grades signify the *modi loquendi*, that is the various senses of scripture, and are divided into three groups of three, five and seven grades; hence the eleventh is called the third of seven. Joachim explains the meaning of the three Old Testament patriarchs Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob according to the eleventh grade of understanding as three kinds of prelates from the order of the last monks which have appeared, are appearing, and will soon appear one after the other.

He continues to describe the subsequent appearance of five and seven churches, namely the five patriarchates and the seven churches mentioned in the Apocalypse, following the pattern of five and seven tribes accepting their heritage in the Old Testament, and proclaims that according to this pattern a certain number of monasteries will be forthcoming. But their arrival is not yet imminent, because, just as the patriarchates founded by St Peter had arisen before the seven churches attributed to St John,¹⁹ so these seven monasteries attributed to St John would appear only after the time of those attributed to St Peter. This first part of this excerpt ends with a copying error contained only in the excerpt version.²⁰

The second part of the excerpt is drawn from a whole paragraph on the meaning of the sabbath.²¹ The children of Israel pronounced a sabbath when they entered the promised land, as did Christians in the peaceful time of John the Evangelist. A third sabbath awaits the faithful when the labours of preaching are over. Then Joachim explains the celebration of sabbath according to 12 different senses, the five senses of Scripture, and the seven kinds of typical understanding. Again there is a combination of three, five,

and seven, both in the excerpt – though abbreviated – and in the complete version of the Psalter. The excerpt then focuses on the first and second kind of typical understanding, the first being the sabbath of the children of Israel ‘when they had laid down the service of the law and accepted the spirit of kinship’,²² while the second will be celebrated by the Christians after the labours of the second stage. Joachim then describes the motif of the two omer, tenths or ‘handfuls’ of corn [Exod. 16:22], which the children of Israel had collected on the sixth day signifying the two persecutions of the sixth time, thus freeing the seventh day from labour.²³ Consequently, Christians will experience two persecutions in the sixth time, each followed by a sabbath. Of these three sabbaths, each following a time of extreme labour, two are of similar and rather shorter length, while the third will be ‘full and perfect’²⁴. Strangely enough, the excerpt version, which ends here, provides clues to the following fourth kind of typical understanding, but omits the third. Though the text of these chapters of the second book underwent various minor and major changes, with whole paragraphs having been written and rewritten and existing in quite different versions, it is only the manuscripts of the excerpt version which, without exception, omit this sentence. But it can be argued that this is not just a slip which escaped the attention of the excerptist but is rather the result of a deliberate decision for, in the sentence describing the two omer of the sixth time, Joachim’s thought does indeed go back to the beginning of the second sabbath.

The third part of the excerpt returns once more to the end of the second *status*, this time discussing its exact duration and data with special reference to Joachim’s own presence.²⁵ Immediately before, he had been discussing the generations, their duration and numbering, and then the coming of Christ. The second *status* can not only be seen as divided into seven different times, but also – like the two other *status* – into 50 generations. This motif is again closely linked to the image of the psalter because of the 150 psalms, that is, three times 50. ‘150 generations indicate the wholeness of time.’²⁶ Here, the exact chronology presents Joachim with a certain problem, namely whether he should add the three decades or the generation of Christ’s lifetime to the time of the Old or the New Testament. For a while, however, he remains uncertain as to whether to continue down to his own period, which he places at the end of the second *status*, in which 49 or 50 generations are to be counted. Joachim seems to prefer to count Christ’s lifetime as a new generation, beginning from the day of His baptism, but

warns the reader not to be too casual about the rest of time, because the generations from Adam to the end will be ever shorter, and no one can know how long before the coming of the end.

Interestingly enough, not only the second and the third excerpts but also their context in the full version of the *Psaltery*, provide evident examples of the development of textual tradition. They bear witness to the various stages of this process as a result of a long and complicated evolution, during which the author himself was only the first among many to correct, add, and change whole paragraphs. The text which, in the Short Excerpt Version of the *Psalterium*, forms the third part of the excerpt²⁷ exists altogether in three different versions, two of which are contained in one manuscript of the *Psalterium*'s full text version. The first is preserved only in this same manuscript, while the other is witnessed by all other existing manuscripts, and – in a slightly modified version – also in the Short Excerpt Version. While in the majority of manuscripts, 49 generations and the major part of the present fiftieth generation are said to have passed, the excerpt version expresses Joachim's doubt as to whether the present is the forty-ninth or fiftieth generation, depending on whether the second *status* begins with Christ's birth or His baptism. In the latest version of this paragraph, Joachim declares 50 generations to have passed since Christ was born, thus neatly settling the matter.²⁸

Clearly, this version of the excerpts, though it appears in none of the manuscripts containing the text of the *Psalterium decem chordarum*, is not pseudo-epigraphical, but witnesses an authentic stage of textual development. Only the excerpts have retained this shade of doubt, a transient uncertainty in the process of rethinking, and they alone present us with this extraordinary glimpse into Joachim's own study.

II. The Excerpt Set

1. Habent sua fata libelli: *From Autograph to Excerpt*

As this example demonstrates, Joachim's writings were always a work in progress as long as he lived, dictated to his scribes and designed in his figures, and perhaps more often than we currently imagine they continued to be so even after the author's death. As a result, the extant manuscripts bear witness to several stages of textual development, reflecting those

changes which the texts underwent as a result of intervention both by their author and by their subsequent recipients. They survive, of course, in most manuscript witnesses. Each manuscript contains its own individual text, a fact that should – if seen in the light of modern philology, something which unfortunately is not yet applied to all critical editions – put an end to the attempt to restore the author's text and teach us to deal instead with each manuscript as its own original. We are, however, unable to restore Joachim's original text – or rather his texts, as he changed them continuously – and the time has now come to focus our interest on the manuscripts not only as media but as the indispensable context of the textual and manuscript tradition. In the long period between Joachim and the present, a whole variety of readers and copyists have been at work on his text. Writing pseudo-epigraphical texts, excerpting and updating Joachim to their own time and its needs, many of them became authors in their own right, though most continue to remain nameless.

Just how vivid and changeable Joachim's texts are, and always have been, can be demonstrated by the existence of three different introductions to his commentary on Revelation,²⁹ by his evidently unfinished treatise on the life of St Benedict,³⁰ and by the various excerpt versions of his three main works. In the case of the excerpts, this means that they should not only be treated as witnesses to *Concordia*, *Expositio*, *Psalterium*, or any other text they might contain but also as a whole, an entirely new entity, together with the manuscripts of which they form a part.

2. *The Text and Its Tradition*

When Marjorie Reeves first mentioned this set of excerpts, she was able to identify only three manuscript witnesses in London, Paris, and Milan. The manuscripts in St Petersburg³¹ and Weimar³² lay hidden behind what was then the Iron Curtain, to become available to Western scholars only in the early 1990s. In all five manuscripts which contain authentic and pseudo-epigraphical writings of or ascribed to the abbot, similar or even identical abridged versions of these three texts exist. All three have the same title. Each begins with a long excerpt from the *Concordia*, followed by a shorter excerpt version of the *Expositio* and an extremely short excerpt of the *Psalterium*. Four of the five manuscripts (with the exception of St Petersburg) contain Joachim's letter *Universis Christi fidelibus*. The

pseudo-epigraphical *De oneribus prophetarum* appears in three manuscripts (London, Milan, and Weimar). The Joachite *Super Sibillis et Merlino* and *Super Ieremiam* are also witnessed by three manuscripts each (London, Paris, and Weimar). All manuscripts contain both authentic works and pseudo-epigraphical texts, though in the case of St Petersburg, this applies only to the Joachite inclusions in Joachim's *Concordia* which were produced in England, France, and Italy over a period of at least about hundred years.

Who then selected the excerpted texts, when and where, and for what purpose? Did the three excerpts originally belong together? What might they have in common, if anything, that could tell us more of their origin and purpose? The fact that the excerpted texts have been copied almost identically in several manuscripts suggests that they were not chosen arbitrarily and must have served a special purpose by answering certain questions. Presumably, the short excerpt version of the *Psalterium decem chordarum* was produced by the same person (or in the same circle) and during the same process of compilation, together with the much longer excerpts of *Concordia* and *Expositio* which precede it in the manuscripts. They do not appear to be related to other excerpts, for example the long excerpt version of the *Psalterium* as preserved in Vat. lat. 4860 and Nuremberg, Stadtbibliothek Cent. II 51, the excerpts from *Concordia* and *Expositio* in Paris, Bibl. Nat. Lat. 3321, or the *Expositio-excerpts* of Vat. lat. 3822. It is, therefore, advisable to discuss what I shall refer to as the Excerpt Set of these three texts as a textual unit, instead of the Psaltery-excerpt alone. This task is made more difficult not only by the greater length of the other two excerpts but also because much research still remains to be done on the manuscript tradition of *Concordia* and *Expositio*.

3. *The Excerpt and the Excerpts*

Interestingly enough, the *Concordia-excerpt* of the five manuscripts containing the excerpt collection on which this paper focuses incorporates a fragment of the Joachite *Super Ieremiam*, a fact that has been hitherto undiscussed.³³ This links the questions raised by the excerpt version to the question about the author or the authors of *Super Ieremiam*, and states firmly that the date of the excerpt's composition was certainly not before –

roughly – the middle of the thirteenth century, the time when *Super Ieremiam* could have been written.³⁴

How original or authentic can the excerpts be, if at least the *Concordia*-excerpt allows us to date the *terminus ante quem* for the compilation of this excerpt ? Are we forced to conclude that any textual changes from full version to excerpt texts did not take place prior to the mid-thirteenth century?

The Short Excerpt Version of the *Psalterium* seems to prove that this is not necessarily the case, and certainly not for the third part of its excerpts. Of the three different extant versions of the discussion on the forty-ninth or fiftieth generations, it is evident that the version witnessed in the Short Excerpt Version, present in all its five manuscripts, has to be placed between Joachim's first approach to this problem, written *c.* 1185/86, and his final solution, written roughly a decade and a half later, which survived in the majority of manuscripts of the *Psalterium*'s full version.³⁵ However, the fact that the doubts about the generations appear only in the Short Excerpt Version does not imply that this was written by the compiler of the excerpt rather than by Joachim. It is obvious that here we have something like a still from a 'film' of theological thought in the making. Joachim composed this passage on the number of generations while agonizing over many uncertainties, and subsequently revised it when he reached a certain conclusion, later completing a final version containing the results of this lengthy process of thought. It is a matter of note that this final version survived as well as Joachim's first draft (in the earlier text of the manuscript of Padua) and – if only in the compilation of the Short Excerpt Version of the *Psalterium* – this transitory, but nonetheless doubtlessly authentic, version.

This sheds more light both on Joachim's methods and on the fate of writings which were being continuously amended and also copied and circulated long before their author had come to a final decision about what a certain paragraph should look like in the end. Joachim, so to speak, had no copyright to forbid readers and writers anywhere in the scholarly world to transmit versions of a paragraph that he himself had long since changed or even abandoned. And it is highly probable that the copyist of this very same paragraph on whether there were 49 or 50 generations had no idea that what he copied no longer represented the author's ultimate intentions.

This whole process should encourage us to put an end to the idea of the text as an entity, born from its author's creative mind as if Pallas Athene had sprung from the forehead of Zeus, fully formed and unchangeable, where all alteration means deterioration and the editor's goal is nothing other than to distinguish between worthy and useless witnesses and variations. Surely no medieval author teaches us this lesson more clearly than does Joachim of Fiore.

For the 'most interesting book of excerpts', much still remains to be done concerning the purpose, the composition, and circulation of the excerpts. In the case of the Short Excerpt Version of the *Psaltery*, it is evident that it was copied from a text which has not otherwise been preserved, but is doubtless Joachim's original, although this cannot be proved for all those mostly minor alterations of the text which appear only in the five witnesses of the Excerpt Set.³⁶ Future editors of *Expositio* and *Concordia* will be wise not to ignore the excerpt versions as mere later compilations.

Ernest Renan, Heinrich Denifle, and Marjorie Reeves thus form a chain linking the composition of the Excerpt Set as preserved in the Parisian manuscript to the drawing up of the Protocol of Anagni and the natural desire of Parisian scholars for first-hand information on Joachim and his writings. Their intentions might have been a mixture between genuine interest and the desire to know the enemy, rather than simply aiming at the damnation of Gerard of Borgo San Donnino and his followers. The same attitude between neutrality on the one hand and adversarial comment on the other could apply to the context in which other manuscripts of the Excerpt Set were copied. This is certainly true in regard to Richard Kilvington, the first known owner of the London manuscript, who was hostile to both the concept of evangelic poverty and to Franciscan ideals in general.³⁷ The need for information about the opponents' theories and their sources, or in general the textual basis of ongoing debates, might well have been reason enough not only for the copying of the London manuscript but also for the choice and composition of the Excerpt Set in the first place.

III. Edition

The editorial rules follow the principles of the *Opera omnia* of Joachim of Fiore. All extant manuscript witnesses of the excerpt set have been

respected, while the complete version of the *Psalterium* is referred to as a mode of comparison.

1. *The Manuscripts*

*L*₃ London, British Library, MS Royal 8 F XVI.

Vellum, English provenance, late fourteenth century.

The manuscript survives in two sections which were bound together in the late seventeenth century or later. It comes from the collection of John Theyer (d. 1673), some manuscripts of which were acquired by King Charles II. The second section certainly dates from the early fourteenth century and is probably written by an English hand, while the first probably emanates from the second half of the fourteenth or even the early fifteenth century and is certainly of English provenance. The manuscript had belonged to Richard Kilvington, Dean of St Paul's, London, who died in 1361 (fol. 3r etc.).

The binding formula is: $[4 \text{ VI}^{48} + \text{III}^{54}] + [\text{IV}^2 + (\text{II}+1)^{65}]^{38}$

Content of the first part³⁹ :

1ra Title of the Excerpts *Exceptiones librorum viri eruditissimi venerabilis ioachimprimiflorencium abbatis de pressuris seculi et mundi fine*.

1ra–24ra Joachim of Fiore, *Concordia veteris ac novi testamenti* (excerpt).⁴⁰

Inc.: Quia labentis ac perituri seculi Expl.: potens est enim deus clariora adhuc facere misteria sua.

24ra Joachim of Fiore, *Expositio in Apocalypsin*, Prologue (excerpt).⁴¹ Inc.: Quam propensioribus studiis. Expl.: Universa hystoria et memoria [sic].

24ra–29rb Joachim of Fiore, *Expositio in Apocalypsin*, *Liber introductorius* (excerpt). Inc.: Set frustra signaculorum septem. Expl.: non erit finis amen, hec succincte nimis etc.

29rb–vb Joachim of Fiore, *Psalterium decem chordarum* (short excerpt version). Inc.: Armonie genera et cetera. Liber secundus. Expl.: et in minori divisione et cetera.

29vb–35va Pseudo-Joachim of Fiore, *Verbaleremie* (excerpt).⁴² Inc.: Ut intelligat aut. Expl.: recedere de medio caldeorum.

35va–36rb Joachim of Fiore, *Universis Christi fidelibus*.⁴³ Inc.: Universis christi fidelibus ad quos. Expl.: qui salvum faciat.

36rb–37va Political Prophecy, inedited. Inc.: Postquam vero dissipatum fuerit Expl.: salvacionis nostri ihesu christi Amen.

37va–38rb Prophecy on Gog and Magog, inedited. Inc.: Gog et magog. Expl.: anxius non adducat.

38rb–44va Pseudo-Joachim of Fiore, *De oneribus prophetarum* (excerpt)⁴⁴ Inc.: Pie petis. Expl.: a christo cui addende sunt alie due.

44va–45rb Pseudo-Joachim of Fiore, *In Ezechielem*.⁴⁵ Inc.: Post Ieremiam prophetam quem lugubri stilo. Expl.: opus perfectionis exequitur.

45v–54v Protocol of the Comission of Anagni.⁴⁶ Inc.: Ecce, ventus tui. Expl. (fragment): (*illeg.*) ad.

Literature: George F. Warner and Julius P. Gilson, *British Museum, Catalogue of Western Manuscripts in the Old Royal and King's Collections*, Vol. I, Royal MSS I. A. I to II. E. XI (Oxford, 1921), 273.

Mi Milan, Biblioteca Ambrosiana, MS H 15 inf. misc.

Vellum, 160 fol., 290×210mm, thirteenth/fourteenth century, Italy or South France

The manuscript is incomplete and was written by different scribes. Originally it consisted of two separate manuscripts (fol. 1–64, 65–160). Coming from Avignon, it reached Milan in the early seventeenth century and was one of the first books in the collection of the Biblioteca Ambrosiana. It contains excerpts from Joachim's main works as well as several Joachite texts.

The binding formula is: [5 VI⁶⁰ + II⁶⁴] + 8 VI¹⁶⁰

Content:

1ra [*E*]xceptiones librorum viri eruditissimi venerabilis Ioachim primi florencium abbatis de pressuris seculi et mundi fine. De concordantia duorum testamentorum

1ra–37rb Joachim of Fiore, *Concordia veteris ac novi testamenti* (excerpt).⁴⁷ Inc.: Quia labentis ac perituri seculi Expl.: claria ad hec facere misteria sua.

37rb Joachim of Fiore, *Expositio in Apocalypsin*, Prologue (excerpt).⁴⁸ Inc.: [Q] uam pro pensoribus sic] studiis Expl.: non de meo quod non habeo etc.

37rb–45vb Joachim of Fiore, *Expositio in Apocalypsin*, Liber introductorius (excerpt).⁴⁹ Inc.: [S]ed frustra signaculorum septem. Expl.: et regnum eius non erit finis amen, hec succincte nimis etc.

45vb–47ra Joachim of Fiore, *Psalterium decem chordarum* (short excerpt version). Inc.: [A]rmonie genera et cetera. Liber secundus. Inter ceteros sollempnes et cetera Expl.: Et in minori divisione et cetera.

47ra–48rb Joachim of Fiore, *Universis Christi fidelibus*.⁵⁰ Inc.: [U]niversis christi fidelibus ad quos littere. Expl.: qui redimat neque quis alvum faciat. (48v empty).

49ra–51rb Political prophecy.⁵¹ Inc.: [P]ostquam vero dissipatum fuerit regnum persarum et deletum. Expl.: salvacionis nostri ihesu christi amen.

51rb–51va Prophecy on Gog and Magog, unedited. Inc.: [G]oget magog. Expl.: munera mittent. (51vb empty).

52ra–52vb Pseudo-Joachim of Fiore, *Super Sibillis et Merlino* (fragment).⁵² Inc.: quia destructa sunt Rainerius dicit quod tercia fiet ei restauratio Expl.: labor anxius non adducat.

52vb–62vb Pseudo-Joachim of Fiore, *De oneribus prophetarum* (fragment).⁵³ Inc.: [P]ie petis sed minus puto pie prosequeris Expl.: cui addende sunt alie due.

63ra–vb Pseudo(?)-Joachim of Fiore, *Liber figurarum* (fragment).⁵⁴ Inc.: [A]pocalipsis. Signum magnum apparuit in celo. Expl.: ilium esse mentiat qui venturus est iudicare vivos et mortuos et seculum per ignem.

64ra–vb Joachim of Fiore, *De Septem sigillis*.⁵⁵ Inc.: [S]ub hoc i° tempore continetur de abraham Expl.: et erit in ea gaudium sempiternum amen.

64vb Pseudo-Joachim of Fiore: A short list of persecutions, ordines and persecutors of the church. Inc.: Prima persecucio Iudeorum. Tempus apostolorum. Herodes. Expl.: supra quam credi potest universa vastabit.

65ra–160vb Joachim of Fiore, *Expositio super Apocalypsim* (incomplete).⁵⁶ Inc.: [Q]uam propensioribus studiis Expl.: accidere hoc ex permissione.

Literature: Heinrich Denifle, 'Das Evangelium aeternum und die Commission zu Anagni', *Archiv für Literatur- und Kirchengeschichte des Mittelalters*, 1 (1885), 94; *Inventario Cerruti dei Manoscritti della Biblioteca Ambrosiana*, 2 (Trezzano, 1975), 239–40; Leone Tondelli, Marjorie Reeves, and Beatrice Hirsch-Reich, *Il Libro dette Figure dell'abbate Gioacchino da Fiore*, 2 (Turin, 1953), 17; Achille Ratti, 'Manoscritti di Provenienza Francese nella Biblioteca Ambrosiana di Milano', in *Mélanges offerts à M. Emile Chatelain* (Paris, 1910), 591–5; Wannenmacher, *Hermeneutik der Heilsgeschichte*, 276–8.

P₉ Paris, Bibliothèque nationale de France, MS lat. 16397

Vellum, 156 fol., 230×165mm, thirteenth century, probably France.

The present manuscript consists of several originally separate parts (fol. 1–18, 19–60, 61–155) which are all described by Nicole Bériou; here the

focus is on the third manuscript alone. All three came from the collection of Cardinal Pierre de Limoges, by or in whose time they were bound together. The third part of the manuscript preserved its original numbering, but here I have used the more recent numbering of the combined manuscript. It has been written by two scribes, the second hand beginning on fol. 119rb.

Content of the last part:

61 ra Title of the Excerpts [*E*]xceptiones librorum viri erudissimi venerabilis Joachim primi florencium abbatis de pressuris seculi et mundi fine. De signis et terroribus erumpnis seu etiam de christianis et prophetis quorum plura scripta sunt in divinis sermonibus, sed idcirco non omnibus clara, quia multis sunt nodis perplexa et occultis misteriis que omnia spiritaliter intellecta ostenduntur vobis multa aut futura sunt novissimis diebus laboriosos scilicet rerum fines et post multos et magnos agones et certaminapacem victoribus impertiri.

61ra–98vb Joachim of Fiore, *Concordia veteris ac novi testamenti* (excerpt).⁵⁷ Inc.: [Q]uia labentis. Expl.: adhuc facere misteria sua.

98vb Joachim of Fiore, *Expositio in Apocalypsin*, Prologue (excerpt).⁵⁸ Inc.: [Q] uam propensioribus. Expl.: quod non habeo etc.

99ra–108rb Joachim of Fiore, *Expositio in Apocalypsin*, *Liber introductorius* (excerpt).⁵⁹ Inc.: Set frustra signaculorum septem Expl.: non erit finis amen, hec succincte nimis etc.

108rb–109rb Joachim of Fiore, *Psalterium decem chordarum* (short excerpt version). Inc.: armonie genera. Expl.: in minori divisione etc. Explicit psalterium decem cordarum.

109rb–119ra Pseudo-Joachim of Fiore, *Verba Ieremie* (excerpt).⁶⁰ Inc.: Verba ieremie etc. ut intelligatur de temporibus regum. Expl.: recedere de medio aldeorum.

119rb–123va Joachim of Fiore, *Universis christi fidelibus*.⁶¹ Inc.: [U]niversis christi fidelibus ad quos littere pervenerunt. Expl.: qui redimat neque qui salvum faciat. (123vb–124vb empty).

125ra–138va Pseudo-Joachim of Fiore, *De oneribus prophetarum* (excerpt).⁶² Inc.: forte perdet siciliam tunc cum volabit ad greciam. Expl.: in vento turbinis accipitur.

139r–154v *Extractiones de introductorio in evangelium eternum*. Inc.: Sed notavimus et extraximus. Expl.: in suo genere.

154v *Vol. pauperum magistrorum, de sorbona ex legato magistri petri de lemoutiis*.

Literature: Denifle, 'Das Evangelium aeternum', 97; Reeves, *Influence*, 91–2; Nicole Bériou, 'Pierre de Limoges et la fin des temps', *Mélanges de l'Ecole française de Rome, Moyen Age*, 98 (1986), 102–7; Claudio Caputano, 'Il De articulis fidei e la Professione fidei: preliminari intorno alla trasmissione dei testi di Gioacchino da Fiore', *Schola Salernitana*, 3–4 (1998/99), 178–9.

Pe St Petersburg, Russian National Library, MS lat. I. F. v. I, N° 37
Vellum, 1+44 fol., 230×304mm, fourteenth century, with the title: *Joachymil I^{mi} Florencium abbatis/Excerptiones Librorum de Pressuris saeculi et mundi Fine*, modern binding.

The manuscript was written by a single scribe, in two columns of 44 to 45 lines, 700×205mm each. In the eighteenth century, it belonged to the abbey of Saint-Germain-des-Prés, and was bought by Piotr Dubrovskii, member of the Russian embassy in France from 1780 to 1792 (as shown in his owner's mark on fol. 1r) between 1777 and 1792. In 1805 Dubrovskii sold his manuscript collection to the Russian Imperial Library at St Petersburg (in the twentieth century known as the Saltykov-Shchedrin-Library, now the Russian National Library).

The binding formula is: $V^{10} + 3 IV^{34} + (IV+2)^{44}$.

Fol. 43 and 44 are two single sheets, the ends of which are bound around the last layers.

Content:

1ra Title of the Excerpts *Exerpciones* [sic] *librorum viri erudissimi venerabilis Joachim primi florencium abbatis de pressuris seculi et mundi fine. De signis et terroribus erumpnis seu etiam de christianis et prophetis quorum plura scripta sunt in divinis sermonibus, sed idcirco non omnibus clara, quia multi* [sic] *sunt nodis perplexa et occultis misteriis que omnia spiritaliter intellecta ostenduntur vobis multa aut futura sunt novissimis diebus laboriosos scilicet rerum fines et post multos et magnos agones et certamina pacem victoribus impertiri.*

1ra–23ra Joachim of Fiore, *Concordia veteris ac novi testamenti* (excerpt).⁶³

Inc.: Quia labentis ac perituri Expl.: concordiam cum apocalipsis iohannis.

23rb–29va Pseudo-Joachim of Fiore, *Verba Ieremie* (excerpts).⁶⁴ Inc.: Verba Ieremie etc. ut intelligatur de temporibus regum iuda Expl.: cultus ecclesiasticus in tempore. (29vb empty).

30ra–36rb Joachim of Fiore, *Concordia veteris ac novi testamenti* (excerpts).⁶⁵ Inc.: Daniel propheta qui apud hebreos Expl.: clariora adhuc facere misteria sua.

36rb Joachim of Fiore, *Expositio in Apocalypsin*, Prologue (excerpt).⁶⁶ Inc.: Quam propensoribus [sic] studiis et cetera. Expl.: Non de meo quod non habeo etc.

36rb–43ra Joachim of Fiore, *Expositio in Apocalypsin*, *Liber introductorius* (excerpt).⁶⁷ Inc.: Sed frustra signaculorum septem Expl.: non erit finis amen, hec succincte nimis etc.

43ra–vb Joachim of Fiore, *Psalterium decem chordarum* (short excerpt version). Inc.: Armonie genera et cetera Expl.: et in minori divisione et cetera. 44r figure of the Psaltery.

44v in a modern handwriting: *Ce present manuscrit contient quarante quatre feuillets numérotés.*

Literature: T.P. Voronova, ‘P.P. Dubrowski 1754–1816, and the Saint Germain Manuscripts’, *The Book Collector*, 27 (1978), 469–78; P.Z. Thompson, ‘Biography of a Library: The Western European Manuscript Collection of Peter P. Dubrowski in Leningrad’, *The Journal of Library History*, 19 (1984), 477–503.

WWeimar, Herzogin Anna Amalia Bibliothek, MS Q 33⁶⁸

Vellum, 251+I fol., 225x165–170mm, binding c.1800, title *Ioachimi Proph, opuscula*.

The manuscript’s parts are probably from the thirteenth or fourteenth century and were probably written in Italy and France. Several parts of the manuscript are incomplete. Some gatherings of different size are later additions. The gatherings, too, have many additions and are not regular.

Johann Matthias Gesner (1691–1761), librarian between 1723 and 1728, reports that the manuscript came from the collection of Conrad Samuel Schurzfleisch (1641–1708), who was director of the library from 1706 to 1708. Since 1722 the manuscript has formed part of the library at Weimar.

The binding formula is:⁶⁹ 3 IV²⁴ + (IV-1)³¹ + IV³⁹ + (V-1)⁴⁸ + IV⁵⁶ + (I-1)⁵⁷ + 2 VI⁸¹ + (IV-1)⁸⁸ + VI¹⁰⁰ + III¹⁰⁶ + III¹¹² + (I-1)¹¹³ + V¹²³ + IV¹³¹ + III¹³⁷ + 2 IV¹⁵³ + II¹⁵⁷ + (IV-1)¹⁶⁴ + (IV-1)¹⁷¹ + 2 IV¹⁸⁷ + V¹⁹⁷ + IV²⁰⁵ + (II-1)²⁰⁸ + 5 IV²⁴⁸ + (II-1)²⁵¹

Content:

1ra Title of the Excerpts *Exceptiones librorum viri eruditissimi venerabilis Ioachim primi florencium abbatis de pressuris seculi et mundi fine.*

1ra–48 va Joachim of Fiore, *Concordia veteris ac novi testamenti* (excerpt).⁷⁰Inc.: Quia labentis ac perituri seculi. Expl.: deus clariora adhuc facere misteria sua. explicit concordia.

48bva–b Joachim of Fiore, *Expositio in Apocalypsin*, Prologue (excerpt).⁷¹Inc.: Quam propensoribus [sic] studiis etc. loquar ego Expl.: Non de meo quod non habeo etc.

48vb–57ra Joachim of Fiore, *Expositio in Apocalypsin, Liber introductorius* (excerpt).⁷²Inc.: Universa historiarum memoria etc. Sed frustra signaculorum Septem. Expl.: et regni eius non erit finis quomodo hec succincte nimis etc.

57ra–57vb Joachim of Fiore, *Psalterium decem chordarum* (short excerpt version). Inc.: Incipit Psalterium decem cordarum. Armonie genera et cetera. Liber secundus. Inter ceteros sollempnes et cetera. Expl.: et in minori divisione etc. Explicit Psalterium decem cordarum.

58r Image of the psaltery.

58va–59vb Joachim of Fiore, *De septem sigillis*.⁷³Inc.: Primum sigillum sub hoc tempore Expl.: et erit in ea gaudium domini sempiternum.

59vb–88ra Joachim of Fiore, *Enchiridion*.⁷⁴Inc.: Quam propensioribus studiis a viris catholicis et orthodoxis Expl.: magis autem ex tunc et usque in secula seculorum amen. Expliciunt [sic] encheridion super librum apochalipsis. (88rb–vb empty).

89ra–vb Pseudo-Joachim of Fiore, *Super Sibillis et Merlino* (excerpt). Inc.: quia destructa sunt Expl.: anxius non adducat.

89vb–98va Joachim of Fiore, *De oneribus prophetarum* (excerpt).⁷⁵Inc.: Pie petis sed minus pie Expl.: addende sunt alie due.

98va–100rb Pseudo-Joachim of Fiore, *In Iezechielem*.⁷⁶Inc.: Incipit prologus dompni abbatis Joachimi in expositione Iezechielis prophete. Post Jeremiam prophetam Expl.: potestatis in vento turbinis accipitur.

100v margin below: *Hugo venetianus* [?] *mihi ex una parte xxviiij solidos..*

101ra–102ra Joachim of Fiore, *Universis Christi fidelibus*.⁷⁷Inc.: Universis christi fidelibus ad quos littere iste Expl.: qui redimat neque qui salvum faciat.

102ra–104rb Political prophecy.⁷⁸ Inc.: Postquam vero dissipatum fuerit regnum persarum Expl.: sibi munera mittent.

104va–105ra Augustinus, *De civitate Dei* (fragment).⁷⁹ Inc.: De die ultimi iudicii Expl.: esse quod lateat (105rb–106vb empty).

107ra–va Hildegard of Bingen, *Epistula 84, Responsum Hildegardis* (excerpt).⁸⁰ Inc.: Ego paupercula ac indocta feminea forma quidam bestiam vidi cuius facies et anteriores pedes Expl.: qui in semetipsis confidentes de celesti gloria corruerunt.

107va–112rb Hildegard of Bingen, *On Revelation* (excerpt).⁸¹ Inc.: Sanctus iohannes in apokalipsi de lacrimabili tempore istorum Expl.: ipsi laus et imperium per immortalia secula seculorum. amen.

112rb–113va Hildegard of Bingen, *Liber divinorum operum simplicis hominis* (excerpt).⁸² Inc.: Prophetia quippe ut prefatum est tunc aperta erit Expl.: diviserunt sibi vestimenta mea et super vestem meam et cetera; Inc.: Denique cum incredule et horribiles gentes Expl.: quibus divino nutu prius affecti sunt.

113va–vb Hildegard of Bingen, *Scivias* (excerpt).⁸³ Inc.: Vidi ab aquilone et ibi quinque bestie stabant. de v. bestiis quarum una Expl.: debilitatis incurrere. alia autem.

114 margin below: *Iste liber est domini Egidii sacerdotis dicti de Leest.*

114ra–137ra Bonaventura, *Breviloquium pauperi in sacra scriptura*.⁸⁴ Inc.: [F] lecto genua mea ad patrem domini nostri iesu christi Expl.: qui est trinus et unus deus benedictus in secula seculorum amen.

137ra–vb Commentaries on the Gospels, by several authors.⁸⁵ Inc.: Igitur tractans illud verbum mathei xix ecce nos reliquimus etc. Expl.: vel saltem divini illius edulii reliquis saginavi.

138ra–157rb Alain of Lille, *De arte praedicatoria*.⁸⁶ Inc.: Vidit iacob scalam Expl.: unam petii a domino etc. (157v empty)

157rb Two additions to Petrus Comestor, *Historia scholastica*, on the five bleeding wounds of Christ and the five parts of the Mass, and the four divisions of Christ's clothing (excerpts)⁸⁷ Inc.: Prima effusio sanguis [sic] Expl.: ad embolismum; Inc.: Nota iii^{or} depositiones Expl.: vino et aqua resperguntur.

158ra–164rb Etienne Tempier, Bishop of Paris, list of errors, from 1277.⁸⁸ Inc.: Universis presentes litteras inspecturis Stephanus Expl.: diluvium ignis naturaliter (164v empty)

165r–171v Alexander Nequam, *De nominibus utensilium* (incomplete).⁸⁹ Inc.: Qui bene vult disponere Expl.: clavillam habet ne ob errorem.

172r *Prologus Hieronymi in epistolas canonicas*⁹⁰ with *Glossae*.⁹¹ Inc.: Non est ita apud grecos qui integre sapiunt Expl.: nec sancte scripturae veritatem poscentibus denegabo; Inc.: Canonice dieuntur iste epistole vel ideo quia in canone ecclesiastice Expl.: antequam ultio celestis invisibiliter vel etiam visibiliter irruens procellat.

172r–180r *Epistula Iacobi* with *Glossa ordinaria*.⁹² Inc.: Iacobus dei ac domini nostri ihesu christi servus Expl.: per hoc ampliora gaudia vite celestis sibi conquirat.

180v–188r *Epistula Petri I* with *Glossa Ordinaria*.⁹³ Inc.: Advenerunt latine, grece proseliti, sic appellabant iudei Expl.: et a pressura diaboli non potest esse immunus is.

188r–193r *Epistula Petri II* with *Glossa ordinaria*.⁹⁴ Inc.: Istam eisdem quibus et primam scribit epistolam Expl.: de ecclesia tolluntur. unde ad suam ipsorum perditionem est.

193v–201r *Epistula Iohannis I* with *Glossa ordinaria*.⁹⁵ Inc.: Scripserat iohannes evangelista adversus dogmata hereticorum qui de verbi eternitate Expl.: qui etiam mundum deo praeponunt idolatre sunt.

201v–202r *Epistula Iohannis II* with *Glossa ordinaria*.⁹⁶ Inc.: Cum quidam dubitent utrum haec due epistole Expl.: ego ex parte mea dico: Gratia tecum amen.

202v–203r *Epistula Iohannis III* with *Glossa ordinaria*.⁹⁷ Inc.: Gaius fide christi suscepta bonis in actibus Expl.: ut veritatis inimicos a salute monstret extraneos.

203v–205v *Epistula Iudae* with *Glossa ordinaria*.⁹⁸ Inc.: Judas qui et iudeus contra eosdem fidei corruptores Expl.: quam volentibus et potens cui nil resistit.

206ra–208va Commentary on the Prologue of Jerome on the Catholic Letters. Inc.: Qui integre quia in greco fuerat Expl.: corporis venialiter peccatur (208vb empty).

209ra–rb Prologue on Revelation. Inc.: Iohannes apostolus et evangelista dum tenetur in captione et exilio Expl.: post ea sibi videlicet sermo dei per angelum.

209rb–va *Glossa ordinaria, Prologus in Apocalipsim Iohannis*.⁹⁹ Inc.: Iohannes apostolus et evangelista a domino christo electus atque dilectus. Expl.: et querentibus laboris fructus et deo magisterii doctrina servetur.

209va Richard of St Victor, Prologue on Revelation.¹⁰⁰ Inc.: Asia minor maioris asie pars est continens. Expl.: ad confirmandam fidem quam

docuerat scripsit evangelium.

209va–210rb *Glossa ordinaria, Praefatio Gilberti Pictaviensis*.¹⁰¹ Inc.: Apocalipsis hec inter libros novi testamenti prophetia vocatur. Expl.: qui legit et qui audit verba prophetie huius idest apocalipsis.

210rb Gregory I, *Registrum epistularum* (excerpt).¹⁰² Inc.: Grave nimis et procul a sacerdotibus officio precium. Expl.: si ex cadaveribus stridetis quolibet modo querere compendium.

210v–250r Apocalypse with *Glossa ordinaria*.¹⁰³ Inc.: Preparat auditores benivolos et attentos sicut et ibi iohannes vii. ecclesias. Expl.: Amen confirmatio apostoli in verba christi.

250va–251rb *Glossa ordinaria, In Apocalypsim Iohannis cap. XXI* (excerpt).¹⁰⁴ Inc.: [Iaspis vi] ridis u [igorem fidei imma] rcescentem [significat] vel iaspis. Expl.: colorum uarietas uirtutum multiplicitas. Finit de duodecim lapidibus. (251v empty).

Literature: Johann Matthias Gesner, *Serenissimo principi ac domino Wilhelmo Ernesto, duci Saxoniae.. natalem sexagesimum secundum.. pie gratulatus de commissa fidei suae bibliotheca ducali, praesertim qua fuit Schurzfleischiana.. in appendice notitia bibliothecae Schurzfleischianae* (Weimar, 1723), 49–53, Wannenmacher, *Hermeneutik der Heilsgeschichte*, 295–301.

Sigla

L₃: London, British Library, MS Royal 8 FXVI, fol. 29rb–vb

Mi: Milan, Biblioteca Ambrosiana, H 15 inf. misc., fol. 45vb–47ra

P₉: Paris, Bibliothèque nationale de France, MS lat. 16397, fol. 108rb–109rb

Pe: St Petersburg, Russian National Library, MS lat. I. F. v. I, N^o 37, fol. 43ra–vb

W: Weimar, Herzogin Anna Amalia Bibliothek, MS Q 33, fol. 57ra–vb

Ed.: Psalterium decem chordarum, lib. ii, ed. Kurt-Victor Selge, *Ioachimi abbatis Florentis Opera omnia 1/MGH Quellen zur Geistesgeschichte 20* (Hannover, 2009)

Text

[**L₃**: fol. 29rb; **Mi**: fol. 45vb; **Pe**: fol. 43ra; **P₉**: fol. 108rb; **W**: fol. 57ra; **Ed.**:

12] Incipit Psalterium decem cordarum^a. [**Ed.**: 14]

Armonie genera et cetera. [**Ed.**: 115] Liber secundus. Inter ceteros sollempnes^b et cetera. [**Ed.**: 259]

In undecimo gradu, qui est tertius [**Mi**: fol. 46ra] inter septem, nondum possumus assignare nisi forte *ex parte* et hoc ipsum *in enigmatē*,¹ quia de opere inchoato et necdum vel in maiori parte [**Ed.**: 260] completo non potest quis de facili^c iudicare, etiam^d si aliqua indicia^e eius presumptionem facere videatur. Puto tamen in tribus illis^f viris significari^g tria genera^h prelatorum in ordine novissimorum monachorum sub regulaⁱ beati Benedicti, quorum^j aliquos precessisse arbitror, alios secutos esse, alios in proximo secuturos.

Sane ut quinque tribus et^k quinque ecclesie generales claruerunt^l a principio, ita et in ordine cisterciensi quinque domus prime aliarum omnium capita facte sunt, in quibus pars misterii huius videtur esse completa,² quod tamen Deus melius novit, qui facit alia post alia in temporibus suis.

Quia vero septem tribus minores in senectute Iosue acceperunt [**P₉**: fol. 108va] hereditatem, et post obitum Petri et Pauli et aliorum apostolorum, in quorum^a diebus fundatesunt quinque prime ecclesie - quarum una, que occasione Augusti vocata est processu temporis Constantinopolitana, sub nomine alterius ecclesie fundata fuit a Paulo sicut et alie multe -, [**Ed.**: 261]

et septem ecclesie que scripte sunt in Apocalipsi sub beato Iohanne evangelista claruisse noscuntur, non est mirum, si cenobia^b similia^c septem tribuum et septem ecclesiarum necdum claruerunt in mundo, quia manente adhuc tempore Petri non potest eo superstitie suas vires, ut ita dixerim, exercere Iohannes. Ubi autem pertransierit quod significat Petrus sequens Dominum^d cum cruce sua,³ succedet manifeste quod designat Iohannes.

In undecimo^e, tertio decimo et cetera. [Ed.: 285]

In prima specie intelligentie typice sabbatum habuerunt filii Israel, quando abolita servitute^f legis^g [L₃: fol. 29va] acceperunt [Mi: fol. 46rb] *spiritum* [Pe: fol. 43rb] *adoptionis*.⁴

In secunda specie sabbatizabunt Christiani, cum [W: fol. 57rb] consummato [Ed.: 286] labore huius secundi status, quem sustinent electi propter *verbum crucis*,⁵ rebelles quoque Iudei convertentur ad Deum^h, cum consummatis universis persecutionibus Sathane dabitur pax in toto orbe terrarum.

Puto autem, quod propterea erit in sexto tempore duplexⁱ tribulatio et requies post primam et requies post secundam, ut quasi duo gomor colligantur in sexto die ad consummationem misteriorum, ne iterum laborare cogerentur in sabbato. Erit ergo secundum sabbatum post sextam [Ed.: 287] tribulationem^j, que fiet per gentes infideles in tempore sexto, tertium autem^k post aliam tribulationem, que sequetur sub eodem tempore sexto et dominabitur^l, ut putatur^m, in sex senis mensibus aut septenis. De quo videlicet tertio sabbato videtur dicere scriptura: *Erit mensis ex mense et sabbatum ex sabbato*.⁶

Hanc posterions [P₉: fol. 108vb] tribulationis senariam, ut ita dixerim, fatigationem designat^a ille Iacob, qui^b post septem et septem annos servitutis sue, nato sibi^c Ioseph, decrevit reverti ad patriam suam⁷ et tamen revocato^d pacto servivit^e rursum pro gregibus annis sex.⁸ Sed et templum Domini prius edificatum a Salomone et destructum^f a rege Babilonis ceperunt edificare^g secundo filii transmigrationis et paulo post^h destiterunt;⁹ deinde accepta licentia edificandi in sex continuis annis consummationem accepit. [Ed.: 288]

Quocirca sicut puto, quemadmodum primus status post longum laborem meruit habere breve sabbatum, et secundus post longum similiter laborem nichilominus breve sabbatum habiturus est, ita ediverso tertius status brevis quidem temporis, sedⁱ non brevis laboris transitum habiturus est, sabbatum

autem integrum et perfectum. Et de hiis pro loco satis [**Mi: fol. 46va**] dictum est^j.

In quarta autem^k specie^l intelligentie typice et^m cetera. [**Ed.: 332**]

Sufficit nobis scire, quod in quatuor decadis generationum spiritualium sub brevioris satis temporis spatio consummandus est cursus huius secundi statusⁿ, acsi in sex ebdomadibus^o quadragesime, [**W: fol. 57va**] acsi in quadraginta diebus. Que videlicet generationes^p, coniuncte illis decem que inceperunt a Cyro^q, invenimus secundum Pentecosten, secundum quinquagenarium^r, secundum iubileum, in quo percutienda est nova Babilon, et^s mater ecclesia, que est nova Ierusalem, ab eius tyrannide liberanda. Nam sicut ibi percutienda erat^t vetus Babilon, ita et hic percutienda est nova, sicut scriptum est in libro Apocalipsis, ubi agitur de ea in specie [**Pe: fol. 43va; Ed.: 333**] magne meretricis,¹⁰ in cuius expositione omnes pene doctores concordare noscuntur.¹¹

Quam scilicet diem et horam,¹² non est tuum neque meum.¹³ Queris temporis vicinitatem^a? Scito [**P₉: fol. 109ra**] quod ab^b Abiud filio Zorobabel, sub quo videlicet Zorobabel fuit percussa vetus^c Babilon, aut quadragesima nona generatio agatur aut quinquagesima. [**L₃: fol. 29vb**] Dubito autem super hoc, quia nescio pro certo, utrum triginta anni^d Domini veteri testamento dandi sint an novo, ne forte ab^e anno, quo baptizatus est ipse, nova generatio computetur. Verumptamen et si hoc brevi, tamen terminus generationis presentis^f. [**Ed.: 334**] Si autem hec ipsa est generatio quinquagesima, consulo hiis, qui manent in medio Babilonis, ut fugiant^g de medio eius.¹⁴ Sed et sicut autem^h in fine quadraginta dierum celebratur memoria passionis Christi, ita in fine quadraginta generationum timendum est fidelibus *a facie arcus*.¹⁵ Prima etenim tribulatio delebit imperium Babilonis, secunda castigabit peccataⁱ delinquentibus ecclesie, et^j exinde quod restat temporis, velut a Pascha usque [**Mi: fol. 46vb**] ad Pentecosten, acsi in quinque decadis spiritualium generationum consummabitur [**Ed.: 335**] opus Dei, et super^k quindecim gradus^l decadas^m intrabimus in sancta sanctorum. [**Ed.: 337**]

Siquidem in centum quinquagintaⁿ generationibus universitas temporum, hoc est ab Adam usque ad consummationem seculi. Cave tamen, ne longum annorum spatium tibi proponas in hiis extremis quinque decadis generationum^o, nimirum, quia ab Adam usque ad^p Sem generationes decem sunt et a Sem usque ad Abraham decem similiter generationes, et tamen

numerus annorum inter duas illas^a etates in tantum dispar est, ut maior fuerit^b [**W: fol. 57vb**] sola generatio Noe¹⁶ quam tota illa una etas sub decem generationibus a Sem filio Noe usque ad Abraham.

Utrum ergo generationes iste^c future dierum sint an mensium an annorum, et quot annos sive menses per singulas, scient illi qui^d ibi^e futuri sunt. [**Ed.: 338**]

Ne autem illud, quod de^f tribus generationibus quas [**P₉: fol. 109rb**] superesse^g diximus,¹⁷ sollicitus^h sis, et scrupulus tibi aliquis remaneat super eis, scito esse magisⁱ misterii, ut ita tres ipse generationes excederent numerum decadarum, nec aliud quam illud quod in centum quinquaginta tribus piscibus paschalis et ultime piscationis Petri¹⁸ designatum^j est^k.¹⁹ Quod enim [**Ed.: 339**] supra singulos quinquagenarios presidet unusquilibet trium, patens est et perspicua causa rationis. Unus [**Pe: fol. 43vb**] est enim Deus Pater ad quem pertinet quinquagenarius primus, unus est Dei Filius ad quem pertinet quinquagenarius secundus, unus est Deus Spiritus sanctus ad quem pertinet quinquagenarius tertius. Et quia unus est omnipotens Deus, qui^l presidet super omnia in tribus personis, Pater et Filius et Spiritus sanctus, unus est^m etⁿ populus a principio^o usque in finem, et unus liber psalmodum, qui^p continet in se quinquagenarios^q tres.

Quia non unum tantum, sed plura psalteria decacorda David et Salomon fecisse scribuntur ad confitendum Domino^r,²⁰ liquet quod secundum numerum [**Mi: fol. 47ra**] graduum decadamque psalmodum [**Ed.: 340**] quindecim^s psalteria decacorda^a sub uno psalmodum libro^b accipienda sunt, ut enim^c unaqueque iustorum mansio²¹ psallat pariter^d in ordine suo, secundum quod eas superius, cum de celesti civitate loqui ageremus^e,²² distinximus. Quinque ergo pertinent ad primum statum, quinque ad secundum, quinque ad tertium. Et in minori divisione et cetera.

Explicit Psalterium decem cordarum^f.

Notes

¹ I am grateful to Matthias Kaup for his invaluable discussion of my essay and his suggestions for the edition.

² See Marjorie Reeves, *The Influence of Prophecy in the Later Middle Ages: A Study in Joachimism* (Oxford, 1969, repr. Notre Dame, 1993), 91–2, and *ibid.*, n. 6.

³ Paris, Bibliothèque nationale de France, MS Lat. 16397.

⁴ Milan, Biblioteca Ambrosiana, MS H 15 inf. misc.

⁵ London, British Library, MS Royal 8 F XVI; Reeves, *Influence*, 91–2, n. 6.

⁶ Marjorie Reeves and Beatrice Hirsch-Reich, *The Figurae of Joachim of Fiore*, Oxford-Warburg Studies (Oxford, 1972), 51.

⁷ See *ibid.*, 199.

⁸ See *ibid.*, vi.

⁹ Traditional exegesis since Augustine has usually seen them as the Ten Commandments, an interpretation to which Joachim refers in his *Expositio super Apocalypsin*, pars v (Venice, 1527, repr. Frankfurt/Main, 1964), fol. 183va, but nowhere in the psaltery of 10 chords.

¹⁰ See Reeves and Hirsch-Reich, *The Figurae*, 204.

¹¹ See *Psalterium decem chordarum*, ed. Kurt-Victor Selge, *Ioachimi abbatis Florentis Opera omnia* 1/MGH Quellen zur Geistesgeschichte 20 (Hannover, 2009), lib. ii, 224.

¹² *Ibid.*, 205; on Joachim's varying interpretations of five and seven in history, see Julia Eva Wannenmacher, *Hermeneutik der Heilsgeschichte. De Septem sigillis und die sieben Siegel im Werk Joachims von Fiore*, Studies in the History of Christian Traditions, 118 (Leiden and Boston, 2005), 65–86.

¹³ Reeves and Hirsch-Reich, *The Figurae*, 205.

¹⁴ See Wannenmacher, *Hermeneutik der Heilsgeschichte*, 21 n. 42.

¹⁵ See Joachim of Fiore, *Psalterium*, lib. ii, 116, 1.6–11.

¹⁶ See Joachim of Fiore, *Psalterium*, lib. ii, 122–3.

¹⁷ Reeves and Hirsch-Reich, *The Figurae*, 21.

¹⁸ See below, 137–8.

¹⁹ Joachim refers to the seven churches in Asia; see Rev. 1:4–3:22.

²⁰ All manuscripts write erroneously *undecimo* instead of *duodecimo*, see below, 138.

²¹ See below, 138–9.

²² See below, 138.

²³ See Wannenmacher, *Hermeneutik der Heilsgeschichte*, 161–5.

²⁴ See below, 139.

²⁵ See below, 139–42.

²⁶ See below, 140.

²⁷ See *Psalterium*, lib. ii, 332–40.

²⁸ See *Psalterium*, lib. ii, 333.

²⁹ See Joachim of Fiore, *Enchiridion super Apocalypsim*, ed. E.K. Burger, Pontifical Institute of Medieval Studies, Studies and Texts 78 (Toronto, 1986); *id.*, *Praephatio super Apocalypsin*, ed. K.-V. Selge, 'Eine Einführung Joachims in die Johannesapokalypse', *Deutsches Archiv für Erforschung des Mittelalters*, 46 (1990), 85–131; *id.*, *Liber introductorius, Expositio in Apocalypsin*, fol. 2vb–26va.

³⁰ See Joachim of Fiore, *Tractatus in expositionem vite et regule beati Benedicti*, cap. VII, ed. A. Patschovsky, *Ioachim Abbas Florentis. Opera Omnia* IV.4/ISIME Fonti Antiquitates 29 (Rome, 2008).

³¹ St Petersburg, Russian National Library, MS lat. I. F. v. I, N° 37.

³² Weimar, Herzogin Anna Amalia Bibliothek, MS Q33.

³³ In his list of fragment versions of the *Super Ieremiam*, Robert Moynihan mentions the manuscripts in London, Milan, and Paris as witnesses of the *Super Ieremiam*, besides three other manuscripts, but without reference to their context; see Robert Moynihan, 'The Development of the "Pseudo-Joachim" commentary "Super Hieremiam": New Manuscript Evidence', *Mélanges de l'Ecole française de Rome, Moyen Age – Temps modernes*, 98 (1986), 109–42, at 112, n. 7.

³⁴ From February to September 2012 a Fellowship of the International Consortium for Research in the Humanities “Fate, Freedom and Prognostication. Strategies for Coping with the Future in East Asia and Europe”, Friedrich-Alexander-Universität Erlangen-Nürnberg, enables me to do some research on the *Super Ieremiam* and to take the first steps towards a critical edition of the text.

³⁵ See *Psalterium*, lib. ii, 328–36.

³⁶ At least this cannot be said with certainty for those variations which don’t change the content of the text, which applies to most of them – with the exception of the above-discussed phrase. Though probably not all its insignificant variations, which as well could go back to copying mistakes, yet the core of this passage is authentic and genuine, if ‘outdated’ by Joachim’s final version.

³⁷ See below, Kerby-Fulton, ‘English Joachimism’ 184, 184 n. 4, 189–94 and above nn. 2–3.

³⁸ All manuscripts have been looked at *in situ*. I owe the binding formulas, save that from Weimar, to Christoph Egger.

³⁹ For a description of the whole manuscript, see [http://www.bl.uk/catalogues/manuscripts/HITS0001.ASP?](http://www.bl.uk/catalogues/manuscripts/HITS0001.ASP?VPath=html/38625.htm&Search=8+F+XVI&Highlight=F)

VPath=html/38625.htm&Search=8+F+XVI&Highlight=F (seen 15 January 2011)

⁴⁰ *Concordia novi ac veteris testamenti* (Venice, 1519, repr. Frankfurt/Main, 1964), Praephatio, fol. *2vb – lib. v, cap. 118, fol. 135rb (with omissions).

⁴¹ *Expositio*, Prologue, fol. lvb – Liber introductorius, fol. 2vb (with omissions).

⁴² Ed. Venice, 1516.

⁴³ See *Mi* fol. fol. 47–8, *Pg* fol. 119rb–123va, *W* 101ra–102ra; ed. (according to yet another manuscript witness) ; Jeanne Bignami Odier, ‘Notes sur deux manuscrits de la Bibliothèque du Vatican contenant des traités inédits de Joachim de Flore’, *Mélanges d’Archéologie et d’Histoire [Ecole française de Rome]*, 54 (1937), 220–23, N° 1. For other manuscript witnesses see Friedrich Stegmüller, *Repertorium biblicum medii aevi*, 3 (Madrid, 1951), 234, N° 4062, Reeves, *Influence*, 517, and Wannenmacher, *Hermeneutik der Heilsgeschichte*, 265, n. 20., 1.

⁴⁴ See *Mifol.* 52vb–62vb, *W* fol. 89vb–98va; for other manuscript witnesses, see Wannenmacher, *Hermeneutik der Heilsgeschichte*, 278, n. 65; for the text, see Stegmüller, *Repertorium biblicum medii aevi*, 3, 229, N° 4036; for the edition, see Oswald Holder-Egger, ‘Italienische Prophetien des 13. Jahrhunderts III’ *Neues Archiv der Gesellschaft für ältere deutsche Geschichtskunde*, 33 (1908), 95–187, at 139–70.

⁴⁵ Inedited. See also *Pg*, fol. 136r–138v, and *W* fol. 98va–100rb.

⁴⁶ See Heinrich Denifle, ‘Das Evangelium aeternum und die Commission zu Anagni’, *Archiv für Litteratur-und Kirchengeschichte des Mittelalters*, I (Berlin, 1885), 49–142.

⁴⁷ *Concordia*, Praephatio, fol. *2vb–lib. v, cap. 118, fol. 135rb (with omissions). It is probably an error that the *Inventario* attributes the tide only to the first few pages of the Excerpt Set and interprets the next excerpt from *Concordia* (fol. 5–37), from *Incipit Statuentibus nobis binc inde* down to *Explicit* (i.e. Joachim of Fiore, *Concordia*, lib. ii and v, fol. 24vb–135rb) as a new item.

⁴⁸ *Expositio*, Prologue, fol. 1vb–2rb (with omissions).

⁴⁹ *Expositio*, Liber introductorius, fol. 4ra–24vb (with omissions).

⁵⁰ See above, n. 42.

⁵¹ Also *W* fol. 102ra–104rb, immediately following *Universis Christi fidelibus*; inedited.

⁵² See *W* fol. 89ra–vb. This text is part of a Joachite commentary of the thirteenth century on the Erythraean and Samian Sibyls and the *Verba Merlini*, which are in similar manuscripts, as here and at Weimar, together with *De oneribus prophetarum*. Unedited.

⁵³ See above, n. 43.

⁵⁴ This text is actually the commentary on the illustration of the red dragon; see Leone Tondelli, Marjorie Reeves, and Beatrice Hirsch-Reich, *Il Libro delle Figure dell'abbate Gioacchino da Fiore*, 2 vols (Turin, 1953), ii, tav. XIV.

⁵⁵ Ed. Marjorie E. Reeves and Beatrice Hirsch-Reich, 'The Seven Seals in the Writings of Joachim of Fiore. with Special Reference to the Tract 'De Septem sigillis' *Recherches de Théologie ancienne et médiévale*, 21 (1954), 239–47, Wannenmacher, *Hermeneutik der Heilsgeschichte*, 333–55.

⁵⁶ *Expositio*, Prologue, fol. Ivb – pars viii, fol. 196vb. The text of this second part of the Milan manuscripts ends in part VI of the commentary

⁵⁷ *Concordia*, Praephatio, fol. *2vb – lib. v, cap. 118, fol. 135rb (with omissions).

⁵⁸ *Expositio*, Prologue, fol. Ivb–2rb (with omissions).

⁵⁹ *Expositio*, Liber introductorius, fol. 4ra–24vb (with omissions).

⁶⁰ See above, n. 41.

⁶¹ See above, n. 42.

⁶² See above, n. 43.

⁶³ *Concordia*, Praephatio, fol. *2vb–lib. v, cap. 108, fol. 126rb (with omissions).

⁶⁴ Pseudo-Joachim of Fiore, *Super Hieremiam*, Praephatio (Venice, 1516), fol. Orb (not numbered).

⁶⁵ *Concordia*, lib. v, cap. 109, fol. 126rb – cap. 118, fol. 135rb (with omissions).

⁶⁶ *Expositio*, Prologue, fol. Ivb–2rb (with omissions).

⁶⁷ *Expositio*, Liber introductorius, fol. 4ra–24vb (with omissions).

⁶⁸ For a more detailed description of the manuscript, see <http://www.manuscripta-mediaevalia.de/hs/projekt-Weimar-pdfs/Q-33.pdf> (seen 31 July 2012).

⁶⁹ I owe the binding formula and numerous details of the description to Betty Bushey and Matthias Eifler, who are preparing the manuscript catalogue of the Anna Amalia Library.

⁷⁰ *Concordia*, Praephatio, fol. *2vb – lib. v, cap. 118, fol. 135rb (with omissions).

⁷¹ *Expositio*, Prologue, fol. 1vb – Praephatio, fol. 2vb (with omissions).

⁷² *Expositio*, Liber introductorius, fol. 4ra–24vb (with omissions).

⁷³ See above, n. 54.

⁷⁴ See above, n. 28.

⁷⁵ See above, n. 43.

⁷⁶ Inedited. See also *L*₃, fol. 44va–45vb, and *P*₉, fol. 136r–138v.

⁷⁷ See above, n. 42.

⁷⁸ The same text as *Mi* fol. 49ra–52vb, likewise following *Universis Christi fidelibus*.

⁷⁹ *De civitate Dei*, lib. xx, cap. 1–2, *CCSL* 48, 699, l. 1–701, l. 50 (*PL* 41, 657–61).

⁸⁰ *CCCM* 91, 196, l. 225 – 198, l. 284 (*PL* 197, 264D–266A).

⁸¹ Possibly *Analecta Sanctae Hildegardis Opera*, ed. J.B. Pitra, *Analecta sacra* [Spicilegio Solesmensi parata] 8 (Paris, 1883, repr. 1966), 488.

⁸² *Liber divinorum operum simplicis hominis*, pars iii, visio 5, cap. 20–22, *CCCM* 92, 440, l. 32 – 443, l. 2, cap. 24–5, 444, l. 33 – 446, l. 30 (*PL* 197, 1022D–1024C, 1025C–1027A).

⁸³ *Scivias*, lib. iii, visio 11, *CCCM* 43A, 576, l. 75 – 579, l. 169 (*PL* 197, 709A–711A).

⁸⁴ Ed. *Opera omnia* 5 (Quaracchi, 1891), 201–91.

⁸⁵ Among the authors are, for example, Cyprian of Carthage and Gregory I; other quotations are part of the *Glossa ordinaria*.

⁸⁶ Ed. *PL* 210, 111A–191C (the present text differs enormously).

⁸⁷ Ed. *PL* 198, 1622BC and 1616D–1617A.

⁸⁸ See Roland Hissette, *Enquête sur les 219 articles condamnés à Paris le mars 1277*, Philosophes médiévaux 22 (Louvain and Paris, 1977) and Kurt Flasch, *Aufklärung im Mittelalter?*, Excerpta classica 6 (Mainz, 1989); on 1277: Fernand van Steenberghen, *Die Philosophie im 13. Jahrhundert* (Munich, Paderborn, and Vienna, 1977, first as *La Philosophie au XIIIe siècle*, Philosophes médiévaux 9 [Louvain and Paris, 1966]), 353–4, 452–7.

⁸⁹ Ed. A. Scheler, ‘Trois traités de lexicographie latine du XIIe et du XIIIe siècle’, *Jahrbuch für romanische und englische Literatur*, 7 (1866), 58–74, 155–73, esp. 60–74, 155–68.

⁹⁰ *Glossa ordinaria*, ed. Adolph Rusch (Strasbourg, 1480/81, repr. Turnhout, 1992), vol. 4, 511.

⁹¹ *Glossa ordinaria*, ed. Rusch, vol. 4, 511 in marg.

⁹² *Glossa ordinaria*, ed. Rusch, vol. 4, 512–19.

⁹³ *Glossa ordinaria*, ed. Rusch, vol. 4, 520 in marg. – 528 in marg.

⁹⁴ *Glossa ordinaria*, ed. Rusch, vol. 4, 528 in marg. – 533 in marg.

⁹⁵ *Glossa ordinaria*, ed. Rusch, vol. 4, 534 in marg. – 543 in marg.

⁹⁶ *Glossa ordinaria*, ed. Rusch, vol. 4, 543 in marg. – 544.

⁹⁷ *Glossa ordinaria*, ed. Rusch, vol. 4, 544 in marg. – 545 in marg.

⁹⁸ *Glossa ordinaria*, ed. Rusch, vol. 4, 545 in marg. – 547 in marg.

⁹⁹ *Glossa ordinaria*, ed. Rusch, vol. 4, 547.

¹⁰⁰ Richard of St Victor, *In Apocalypsim Iohannis*, *PL* 196, 684C–686A (with some minor changes only at the beginning of the present text).

¹⁰¹ Similiar to *Glossa ordinaria*, ed. Rusch, vol. 4, 548b–549a (in a different order).

¹⁰² *Registrum epistularum*, lib. VIII, ep. 35, ed. D. Norberg, *CCSL* 140A, 560, l. 5 – 561, l. 27, with a different numbering (lib. ix, ep. iii) *PL* 77, 940C–941B.

¹⁰³ *Glossa ordinaria*, ed. Rusch, vol. 4, 549 in marg. – 578 in marg.

¹⁰⁴ *Glossa ordinaria*, ed. Rusch, vol. 4, 576 in marg. (*PL* 114, 748–9).

^a concordarum *L*₃, Incipit – cordarum] *ab al. manu in pede pag. P*₉.

^b *add. numeros P*₉.

¹ See *I Cor.* 13:12.

^c *add. cogitare W*.

^d et *L*₃.

^e *indicia vel iudicia L*₃, *iudicia W*.

^f *tribus illis] illis tribus PeW*.

^g *corr. ex significare P*₉, *significare Pe*.

^h *om. Pe*.

ⁱ *om. Pe*.

^j *quos L*₃.

^k *quinque tribus et] in quinque tribus L*₃*P*₉.

^l *claruunt L*₃*P*₉, *clamaverunt PeW*, *claruerunt corr. ab al. man. ex clamaverunt P*₉.

² See Joachim of Fiore, *Tractatus in expositionem vite et regule beati Benedicti*!, *cap. VII*, ed. A. Patschovsky, *Ioachim Abbas Florentis. Opera Omnia IV4/ISIME Fonti Antiquitates* 29 (Rome, 2008), 154, l. 6–155, l. 6.

^a *corr. ab al. manu ex quibus W*.

^b senobia *MiPe*, spat. vac. *W*, add. al. man. in marg. senobia *W*.
^c cenobia similia] al. man. in marg. senobia similia *Pg*.
^d deum *Mi*.
³ See *John* 21:18–19.
^e duodecimo et *Ed*.
^f servituta *Pg*.
^g add. legis *L3* (dittogr.).
⁴ See *Rom.* 8:15.
⁵ See *1 Cor.* 1:18.
^h dominum *PeW*; add. In tertia specie sabbatum habebunt hii, qui in fine seculi convertentur ad Deum *Ed*.
ⁱ dux *L3*.
^j sextam tribulationem] tribulationem sextam *Mi*.
^k om. *Ed*.
^l durabit *Ed*.
^m putabitur *PeW*.
⁶ See *Isa.* 66:23.
^a designavit labor *Ed*.
^b quando *Ed*.
^c sue nato sibi] nato suo *L3*.
⁷ See *Gen.* 30:24–6.
^d renovato *Ed*.
^e serviunt *L3*.
⁸ See *Gen.* 30:31; 31:41.
^f destructum *MiPg*, destructurum *W*, destructuris *Pe*.
^g quidem reedificare *Ed*.
^h paulo post] post paulo *Mi*.
⁹ See *1 Ezra* 1:1–6:15.
ⁱ etsi *Ed*.
^j om. *Ed*.
^k quod *Pe*.
^l t(em)p(u)s *Pe*.
^m intelligentie typice] typice intelligentie *Ed*.
ⁿ secundi status] status secundi *Ed*.
^o ebdomadisque *L3*.
^p generatione *L3*.
^q tyro *L3*.
^r quadragenarium *L3*.
^s om. *L3*.
^t percutienda erat] percussa est *Ed*.

¹⁰ See Rev. 17:1.

¹¹ See the important eighth-century commentary by Ambrosius Autpertus, *Expositio in Apocalypsin*, lib. VIII, cap. XVII, v. 1, CCCM 27A, 638, l. 70–75: Quia autem haec meretrix nunc super aquas multas, nunc super bestiam coccineam, nunc super septem montes, qui sunt septem bestiae capita, sedere dicitur, cum hoc totum una sit meretrix, scilicet diaboli civitas Babylonis nomine designata, quam difficile sit minutias sacri eloqui ad liquidum cuilibet attingere, prudens lector facile animadvertit. *Rupert of Deutz*, *Commentaria in Evangelium Sancti Iohannis*, lib. IV, CCCM 9, 215, l. 1574–8 (PL 169, 369B): Qua de civitate quae vocatur spiritualiter sodoma et aegyptus sive babylonia meretrix, de civitate inquam diaboli quae civitati Dei supernae hierusalem semper adversatur exivit populus Dei deflens et confitens quod peregrinus sit et advena super terram.

¹² See Matt. 25:13.

¹³ See Acts 1:7: Non est vestrum nosse tempora vel momenta, quae Pater posuit in sua potestate. See also Matt. 24:35–6; 1 Macc. 13:31–2. See Matthias Kaup's contribution to this book (forthcoming, as a separate volume).

^a in civitatem P₉, t(ame)n civitatem Pe, corr. ab al. manu ex in civitatem P₉W.

^b om. L₃.

^c corr. ab al. manu ex fuit W.

^d om. L₃.

^e sub Pe.

^f aut quadragesima nona generatio agatur – presentis] complete sunt generationes quadraginta novem et maior pars quinquagesime quae et presens est Ed.

^g fugiat L₃.

¹⁴ See Rev. 18:4.

^h expunct. Mi, corr. Ed.

¹⁵ See Ps. 59:6.

ⁱ peccati Mi.

^j om. L₃Ed. (partim).

^k sunt L₃, sic per Ed.

^l add. vel Ed.

^m decadarum corr. ex decadas Mi.

ⁿ add. psalmis continetur psalterium et in centum quinquaginta Ed.

^o generationem L₃MiP₉, generationi W.

^p sic L₃Ed.; om. MiP₉PeW.

^a duas illas] illas duas PeW.

^b fuit PeW.

¹⁶ See Gen. 9:29.

^c generationes iste] iste generationes Pe.

^d quod MiP₉PeW.

^e sibi L₃.

^f om. L₃.

^g numerum decadarum excedere supra Ed.

¹⁷ See Joachim of Fiore, *Psalterium decem chordarum*, lib. ii, ed. K.-V. Selge, *Ioachimi abbatis Florentis Opera omnia 1/MGH Quellen zur Geistesgeschichte 20* (Hannover, 2009), 292, l. 5–16 (Venetian Edition fol. 272rab): Si enim numeramus per ordinem generationes seculorum incipientes ab Adam, qui primus omnium parens fuit, in singulis pene decadam generationum invenitur principium et ubique manifestum et lucidum sacre misterium Trinitatis. Quia vero non sunt plures trinitates, sed una, non oportebat singulum gradum habere tredecim personas, ut quasi in tribus primis assignaretur misterium Trinitatis, in decem autem sequentibus decem perfectiones secundum quod tria sunt cornua psalterii et decem corde, sed in uno tantum gradu supersunt tres, in quibus assignetur principaliter misterium Trinitatis et ostendatur, quia tres sunt tantum, qui operantur simul omnia in omnibus: Pater, Verbum et Spiritus sanctus.

^h sollicitus sis et scrupulus tibi aliquis remaneat super eis] remaneat indiscussum *Ed.*

ⁱ magni *Ed.*, esse magis] magis esse *PeW.*

¹⁸ See John 21:11.

^j cf. *Ed.*; designata *L₃MiP₉PeW.*

^k om. *L₃.*

¹⁹ See Augustine, *De Doctrina Christiana*, lib. ii, cap. XVI, par. 25, CCSL 32, 51, l. 79–87 (PL 34, 48): Deinde ita quaeritur, quomodo quinquagenarius de quinquagenario numero existat, qui non mediocriter in nostra religione sacratus est propter pentecosten et quomodo ter ductus... propter nomen Patris et Filii et Spiritus sancti adiuncta eminentius ipsa trinitate ad purgatissimae ecclesiae mysterium referatum perveniatque ad centum quinquaginta tres pisces, quos retia post resurrectionem Domini in dexteram partem missa ceperunt. Id., *De Diversis Quaestionibus Octoginta Tribus*, *quaest. LVII*, CCSL 44A, 100–101, l. 79–89 (PL 40, 41): Haec autem ecclesia, ad quam pertinet quinquagenarius numerus, sive quia ex tribus generibus hominum eliquatur, Iudaeis et gentibus et carnalibus Christianis, sive quia sacramento Trinitatis imbuitur, numero quo significatur ter ducto ad centenarium et quinquagenarium pervenit; quinquaginta enim ter ducta fiunt centum quinquaginta. Cui cum addideris ipsa tria, quia insigne et eminens debet esse quod in nomine Patris et Filii et Spiritus sancti lavacro regenerationis abluitur, fiunt centum quinquaginta tres. Qui numerus piscium invenitur, quia in dexteram partem missa sunt retia et ideo magnos, id est perfectos et regno caelorum aptos habet.

^l quoniam *PeW.*

^m add. est *Mi* (*dittogr.*).

ⁿ add. *Dei Ed.*

^o add. et *Pe.*

^p corr. ex quod *W*, quod *P₉.*

^q quinquagenarias generationes *L₃*, quinquageneraciones *P₉*, quingeneraciones *Pe*, generationes corr. ex quingeneraciones *W.*

^r fecisse scribuntur ad confitendum Domino] ad confitendum Domino fecisse scribuntur *Ed.*

²⁰ See 2 Chrom 9:11.

^s quinque *L₃.*

^a decada *Pe.*

^b quindecim psalteria decacorda sub uno psalmorum] *al. man. in marg. W.*

^c .u. *P₉.*

²¹ See John 14:2.

^d parte *W.*

^e loqui ageremus] memoriam faceremus vel ageremus *Ed.*

²² See *Joachim of Fiore*, *Psalterium decem chordarum*, *lib. ii* (as above, n. 17), 171, l. 2–7 (fol. 252va): Sed et domum, quam ille vendidit, possidet emptor et posteri eius in perpetuum, quia acquisitam mansionem contemplative sublimitatis et ille possidet, qui emulatus est eam in habentem, et hii, qui informati exemplis eius per quandam genitivam successionem imitantur eum usque ad consummationem seculi.

^f Explicit - cordarum] *om. L3*.

Chapter 8

A Pope without Successor: Ralph of Coggeshall, Ralph Niger, Robert of Auxerre, and the Early Reception of Joachim of Fiore's Ideas in England

Christoph Egger

Joachim of Fiore is one of the most original and also the more controversial authors of the higher Middle Ages. Already in his own day his contemporaries received his ideas with a mixture of amazement, fascination, and distrust, and soon after his death in 1202 his memory was tainted not only by the Fourth Lateran Council's condemnation of his criticism of Peter the Lombard's Trinitarian theology but also by the use made of the work and texts disseminated under his name by the Franciscan spirituals.¹ Therefore, early accounts of the reception of his ideas are most valuable and merit thorough study. Interestingly, while Joachim was active in the south of Italy, the earliest historiographical accounts of his career can be found in the chronicles of the English authors Ralph Niger, Roger of Howden, and Ralph of Coggeshall and of the French Premonstratensian Robert of Auxerre, all dating from the last 10 years of the twelfth and the first years of the thirteenth century.

Among these, the *Chronicon Anglicanum* of Ralph of Coggeshall has received particular attention for its extensive and vivid description of Joachim's doctrine and his conversation with the Cistercian abbot Adam of Perseigne. There is, however, a certain discrepancy between the prominence of this text in research on Joachim and the thoroughness of its scholarly treatment. Coggeshall's text became available in a more or less critical edition in 1875.² Although the textual problems of the narrative could have been clearly recognized from this edition, they were hardly ever taken into account.³ Instead of examining the narrative's position in the chronicle and by neglecting the palaeographical and codicological evidence, scholars usually relied on previous results, thus building a tradition of scholarship which became increasingly detached from the story that Coggeshall's *Chronicon* really has to tell. In particular, most scholars did not notice that the account of the *Chronicon* actually consists of two parts, an original narrative and an addition, which was not necessarily written at the same time. Because the original narrative is to be found as the last entry for the year 1195, it was widely assumed that the addition, the account of Adam of Perseigne's interview with Joachim, took place at about the same time. In his early work on Joachim, Herbert Grundmann argued that Adam and Joachim met at Rome 'um 1195'.⁴ Later he also considered 1196 as a possibility, as Joachim's presence at Rome for this year is also attested by documentary evidence.⁵ He even noticed that it would be difficult to explain the abbot's prediction that Pope Innocent III would not have a successor, had the account indeed been written in 1195, but surprisingly he did not follow this line of inquiry.⁶ For the same reason Marjorie Reeves suggested that Adam of Perseigne and Joachim met at Rome in or after 1198 and pointed out that the opening phrase of Ralph's account does not necessarily imply a precise dating to 1195.⁷ Although this was an excellent observation, it was widely ignored by later research. For instance, Kurt-Victor Selge dated the meeting to 1196, unfortunately relying on Grundmann rather than on a careful analysis of Coggeshall's text.⁸ Greater awareness of the textual complexities was shown by Robert Lerner, which nevertheless resulted in misleading conclusions.⁹ He discovered an excerpt from Coggeshall's *Chronicon* in Henry of Kirkstede's collection of prophetic texts,¹⁰ but interpreted it as further evidence for dating the text to 1195. Finally,

Gian Luca Potestà in his recent book about Joachim, after referring to the arguments of Grundmann, Selge, Reeves, and Lerner, decided to follow the last, again without the absolutely necessary close examination of the text itself.¹¹

In this essay a new reading of Coggeshall's narrative will be given, based on a codicological and palaeographical analysis of the extant manuscripts. I shall argue that Coggeshall's account of Joachim of Fiore consists of two parts which belong to different stages of the composition of the *Chronico*, separated by an interval of approximately 15 years. In connection with and partly following from these results, some suggestions for a new assessment of the chronological issues and of the text's sources and its relationship to the other contemporary historiographical accounts will be given.¹²

I

The abbey of Coggeshall was founded as a Savignac house by King Stephen and Queen Mathilda in c. 1140. After the incorporation of the Order of Savigny into the Cistercians in 1147 the abbey continued to exist as a rather small and economically fairly successful monastery.¹³ Very little is known about the *scriptorium* and library of Coggeshall. So far, no medieval inventory of the library has been identified, but a few medieval manuscripts originating from the monastery have survived.¹⁴

Nothing is known of Ralph's early life. He was a monk of the abbey and abbot from 1207, resigning in 1218 because of failing health, but living on until at least 1227.¹⁵ Though he successfully steered his abbey through the difficult times of King John's reign, his great fame comes from his *Chronicon Anglicanum*. Ralph himself mentioned another work which seems to have been a collection of miracles and visions¹⁶ but so far this has not been identified. He is also credited with the authorship of the *Visio Thurkill*,¹⁷ while the *Libellas de expugnatione terrae sanctae per Saladinu*¹⁸ and the *Distinctiones monasticae et morale*,¹⁹ sometimes ascribed to him, are definitely not by his hand. That he was very interested in miracles, visions, and stories of strange incidents is also obvious from the *Chronicon*. Although Ralph shares this interest in the supernatural with many English historiographers of the second half of the twelfth century,²⁰ it should be emphasized that the

inclusion of such stories in the *Chronico* did not serve merely anecdotal purposes, but is closely linked to his perception of the past and present. We will return to this point later.

The *Chronicon Anglicanu* is extant in at least six manuscripts. Among these the most important ones, written in the very late twelfth and the early thirteenth centuries probably at Coggeshall, are London, British Library, MS Cotton Vesp. D. X. and London, College of Arms, MS Arundel 11.

The Cotton manuscript is a composite volume, now of 143 leaves, put together in the library of Sir Robert Cotton from three formerly separate parts.²¹ This is not surprising, as it is a well-known fact that Cotton and his collaborators often changed the composition of manuscripts and reassembled them in new collections.²² Although none of the parts shows any indication of medieval provenance,²³ the close relationship of Ralph's *Chronico* to Coggeshall and an entry in a list of English kings, which mentions King Stephen as founder of the monastery,²⁴ points to the presence of at least fol. 4–128 in the abbey around 1300. Other than that, as the manuscript was restored and rather tightly rebound in 1961,²⁵ the exact composition of the quires is difficult to establish. This is unfortunate because the quires are quite irregular, and it is this irregularity which suggests the character of a working copy. This impression is further confirmed by the numerous additions in the margins and on inserted slips of parchment,²⁶ which are of particular importance in the context of this essay. The manuscript is generally considered to be rather close to the author, but it was certainly not written by Ralph alone, and several different hands participated in its composition. Ralph might well have been one of the scribes—which one is, at least for now, impossible to tell. With respect to the contents, the Cotton manuscript is closely linked to three other copies of Ralph's *Chronico*, which I shall, therefore, describe first before turning to the texts.

London, College of Arms, MS Arundel 11 is an early thirteenth-century manuscript of unknown provenance which in 1589 was in the hands of the antiquarian Lord William Howard of Naworth (1563–1640)²⁷ and then passed into the library of his nephew, Thomas Howard, the 14th Earl of Arundel.²⁸ As in the Cotton manuscript marginal notes and inserted parchment slips²⁹ appear throughout the text of the

Coggeshall chronicle. Interestingly, some of the notes in the margins of the Cotton manuscript also appear in the margins of the Arundel manuscript, while others are inserted in the text. The manuscript is believed to be ‘a fair copy’ of the Cotton manuscript,³⁰ but actually it might well be that it is another working copy.³¹ The exact nature of the relationship between the two manuscripts remains to be established.

Cambridge, Corpus Christi College, MS 343 is very probably a direct copy from the Arundel manuscript, written in England in the early fourteenth century. Again, the medieval provenance of this manuscript is not known; it was in the collection of Archbishop Matthew Parker (1504–75) and bequeathed by him to Corpus Christi College.³²

Paris, Bibliothèque nationale de France, MS lat. 15076 is another early thirteenth-century copy of Ralph’s chronicle. The manuscript is a composite volume formed before 1514 in the abbey of St Victor in Paris.³³ Only fol. 1–79, written by an English scribe, are relevant in the context of this essay. On the upper margin of fol. 1r there is an ex-libris inscription of a previous owner which carefully had been changed.³⁴ The text of the chronicle was perhaps copied from the Cotton manuscript, but is rather oddly fragmented and in disorder.³⁵ The exact relationship needs further examination, but is not relevant in the context of this essay.

The close relationship between these manuscripts is already obvious from the list of texts they contain.

	Cotton	Paris BNF	Arundel	Cambridge CCC
Libellus de expugnatione terre sancte per Saladinum ^a	---	fol. 1r–22v	fol. 1ra–15vb	fol. 72va–83ra
De ducibus Normannie et regibus Anglie ^b	---	---	fol. 15vb–16rb	fol. 83ra–83vb
Ralph Niger, <i>Chronica II</i> ^c	fol. 4r(1r)–39v (36v)	---	fol. 17ra–40vb	fol. 1va–20va
Continuation of Niger’s <i>Chronica</i> ^d	fol. 40r (37r)–45r (41r)	---	fol. 40vb–45ra	fol. 20va–23vb
Short annalistic notes from 1065 to 1225 ^e		---	fol. 45v–51vb	fol. 24ra–28va
List of English kings, added around 1300 ^f	fol. 45v (41v)	---	---	---
Ralph of Coggeshall, <i>Chronicon</i> ^g	fol. 46r (43r)–131v (128v)	fol. 22v–78v	fol. 51vb–108va	fol. 28va–71vb

	Cotton	Paris BNF	Arundel	Cambridge CCC
Short poem on chess ^h	---	---	fol. 109ra	fol. 72ra
Note about the price of corn, in French	---	---	fol. 109vb	fol. 72ra
Parodistic text ⁱ	---	---	---	fol. 72ra–rb

^a Ed. Stevenson, 209–62.

^b Inc.: *Primus Normannie dux qui Robertus in baptismo dictu....*; Expl.:... *qui regnauit XVII annis et V mensibus*.

^c *Radulfi Nigri Chronica. The Chronicles of Ralph Niger*, ed. Robert Anstruther, Publications of the Caxton Society, 13 (London, 1851, repr. New York, 1967), 105–78. Cf. Antonia Gransden, *Historical Writing in England* (London, 1974–82), 2 vols, i, 222; Hanna Krause, *Radulfus Niger – Chronica. Eine englische Weltchronik des 12. Jahrhunderts*, Europäische Hochschulschriften, III, 265 (Frankfurt/Main, Berne, and New York, 1985), 18*–22*.

^d Ed. Anstruther, 178–91. Notwithstanding an early modern note in the upper margin of fol. 40r of the Cotton manuscript: *Additiones monachi de Cogishale* (the same was written by an early modern hand in the margin of Cambridge, Corpus Christi College, MS 343, fol. 20va), these Annals probably have been compiled by the Augustinian canons at St Osyth's (Essex): Gransden, *Historical Writin*, i, 331.

^e Inc.: *MLXV. Beatus Edwardus rex anglorum obdormiui....*; Expl.:... *quos rex Iohannes pater suus eis prius concesserat et carta confirmauerat apud Runemaide*.

^f See above, 149.

^g Ed. Stevenson, 1–208.

^h Hans Walther, *Initia carminum acversuum mediiaeviposteriorislaitinorum. Alphabetisches Verzeichnis der Versanfänge mittellateinischer Dichtun*, Carmina Medii Aevi Posterioris Latina, I (Göttingen, 1959), 400 n. 7917; and id., *Ergänzungen und Berichtigungen zur 1. Auflage von 1959* (Göttingen, 1969), 1260.

ⁱ *Sequencia leti euuangelii secundum lucrum. In illo tempore erat quidam phariseus Lucius uoragine prineeps potatorum ... et opus illius coram ipso est. Credo in deum bacum patrem omnipotorum*. Printed from this manuscript in Paul Lehmann, *Die Parodie im Mittelalte* (2nd edn, Stuttgart, 1963), 250.

All manuscripts include the history of the Third Crusade except for the Cotton manuscript and one might wonder if this text was part of it, too, and later removed by Cotton.³⁶ Ralph Niger's chronicle and its continuation is extant in all the manuscripts except the Paris codex; but again it might well be that, given the fragmentary state of the manuscript, Niger's text had once been present. The Arundel and Corpus Christi manuscripts are very similar and from a comparison of

the variant readings it becomes highly probable that the latter is a direct copy of the former.

There are two more thirteenth-century manuscripts which include Coggeshall's *Chronico*, but the text is reworked and merged with Niger's chronicle: London, British Library, Royal MS 13. A XII, was owned by the London Carmelites in the Middle Ages,³⁷ while Dublin, Trinity College Library, MS 508 is of unknown provenance.³⁸ In addition, there are some abbreviations and excerpts,³⁹ of which only one is of greater significance in the context of this essay. Cambridge, Corpus Christi College, MS 404 is a collection of notes and excerpts written in the fourteenth century by the Benedictine monk and bibliographer Henry of Kirkestede of Bury St Edmunds.⁴⁰ The manuscript mirrors Henry's keen interest in prophecies and the Antichrist as it includes copies of many relevant texts, most of them written by Henry himself. Among these texts is a short excerpt from Coggeshall's description of Joachim of Fiore's opinions and his encounter with Adam of Perseigne. Kirkestede, while not mentioning Ralph or the title of the *Chronico*, gives an interesting hint at the source of his text: 'Hec in libro visionum apud Sibetone et apud Coggeshale.'⁴¹ Unfortunately, the library of the Cistercian abbey of Sibton is almost completely lost and there is no extant medieval catalogue,⁴² but the *Libe* might well have been either a version of the *Chronico* or a copy of the work Ralph referred to in the *Chronicon*.⁴³

II

In its extant form the *Chronico* can be divided into three parts,⁴⁴ distinguished by the method of compilation and the narrative style. The first part includes the years from 1066 to 1187. These years are covered by short annalistic notices which are to a great extent dependent on previous historiographical works such as Henry of Huntingdon, a continuation of Florence of Worcester and the Annals of Margam. The text becomes more detailed as the narrative moves towards the year 1187, where the second part starts. While in an entry to 1207 Ralph is explicitly named as the author of the chronicle from 1187 onwards,⁴⁵ this does not necessarily imply that he was not involved in the compilation of the first part. However the occasion which drove him to

write was the disastrous Christian defeat at Hattin, the loss of the True Cross and of the city of Jerusalem, and the events resulting from this catastrophe. The main objective of his historiographic efforts is to describe these events and to understand their deeper meaning. The inclusion of at least a superficial account of earlier history is therefore necessary for understanding the historiographical context. It can be shown that the first part as extant in the earliest manuscript⁴⁶ was not compiled before the middle of 1190⁴⁷ and perhaps as late as in 1198/99.⁴⁸ From 1187 Ralph continued his narrative in several stages until 1206. This part includes a detailed account of the Third Crusade, of Richard Is German captivity, his war and death in France, and of the first years of King John. Codicological evidence from the Cotton manuscript shows that Ralph frequently returned to his text, obviously adding new information when it became available. These additions can be found in the margins of the pages,⁴⁹ on inserted leaves,⁵⁰ on inserted sheets of parchment⁵¹ or on erasures of the original text.⁵² After 1206 the writing of the *Chronico* was interrupted, to be resumed in 1212. This third part, in which the narrative is carried forward until 1224, is rather uneven with respect to style and detail and it could therefore be questioned as to whether Ralph is indeed the only author or if there were collaborators.⁵³

Joachim of Fiore appears in the second part of Ralphs *Chronico* at the end of the entry for the year 1195.⁵⁴ The annal starts with a colourful account of the death of Duke Leopold V of Austria on 31 December 1194, interpreted as an act of divine vengeance for the capture of King Richard.⁵⁵ Then Emperor Henry VI's successful military actions in the kingdom of Sicily, the death of the unlawful King Tancred (count of Lecce) and Henry's marriage to the late King William II's aunt Constance, who was the lawful heir of the kingdom, are all mentioned.⁵⁶ Under the rubric 'De rege' follows a description of the massive Almohad invasion of Spain in 1195 and the disastrous effects on the Christian population.⁵⁷ The last and by far the longest entry for 1195 is headed with a new rubric 'De abbate Joachim'.

Before discussing the texts in detail it might be useful to set them out in a way which makes the composition of the parts more obviously visible than is the case in Stevenson's edition. What follows is a provisional edition, based on the Cotton manuscript (C, London, British

Library, Cotton MS Vesp. D I, fol. 69r–70r) and giving variant readings from the following manuscripts:

A London, College of Arms, MS Arundel 11, fol. 68va–69rb
V Paris, Bibliothèque nationale de France, MS lat. 15076, fol. 58r–59r
R London, British Library, Royal MS 13.A XII, fol. 56ra–57ra
P Cambridge, Corpus Christi College, MS 343, fol. 41rb–41vb
K Cambridge, Corpus Christi College, MS 404, fol. 66r–66v
Ed. Stevenson, 67–70

Text I: Cf. 69r–70r; Af. 68va–69rb; Vf. 58r–59r; Pf. 41rb–41vb; Rf. 56ra–57ra; Kf. 66r–66v

- 1 De abbate Ioachim^a
Hac tempestate^b extitit quidam abbas non longe ab urbe Roma^c ordinis cisterciensis^d sed cisterciensibus^e minime subiectus^f, qui quandam expositionem super VII uisiones apocalipsys edidit, accepta diuinitus – ut aiunt – sapientia,
5 cum fere esset prius^g illiteratus^h. In hac autem expositione euidenter ostendit uetus testamentum nouo testamento concordare, cronicis [C f. 69v] utriusque temporis adhibitis et diligenter supputatis. Ubi etiam probare nititur, quod quamdiu durauit lex circumcisionis solo precepto prius data et post scripto confirmata, tamdiu durabitⁱ gratia^j euangelica. Loquitur uero ibi secundum
- 10 differentiam VII^k uisionum^l de misterio VII sigillorum, ostendens ea fore clausa in ueteri testamento, reserata autem in nouo, assignans VI generales persecutiones hebreorum sex^m generalibus persecutionibus christianorum. Quintam uero persecutionem, quam sub quinta uisione et quinti sigilli apertione distinxit, dicit agi temporibus nostrisⁿ a Salaadino^o et eius
- 15 successoribus qui terram ierosolimitanam inuaserunt et matrem Syon^p a ciuitate sua Ierusalem transmigrare compulerunt, orbata sancta cruce, ciuitate et regno et christianorum cerimoniis et omni gloria sua illis in locis spoliata. Hanc autem persecutionem quintam quinte persecutioni ueteris testamenti non incongrue assignare uidetur, in qua muri Ierusalem euersi sunt et templum
- 20 concrematum est et populus in Babilonem a^q Nabuchodonosor^r

captius adductus fuit. Dicit etiam, quod anno dominice incarnationis M.C°.XC°.IX°. ^s incipiet sexta uisio et sexti ^t sigilli apertio. Sub qua uisione probat auctoritate apocalipsys, quod ^u complebitur omnis Antichristipersecutio et eiusdem mors et perditio. Sed ante eius persecutionem ^v dicit euangelium Christi

- 25 ubique predicandum et ecclesiam fidelium per omnes gentes dilatandam. Post Antichristi uero interitum quot annorum uel dierum fiet ^w expletio sigilli sexti, id est ^x mortuorum resurrectio, et septimi sigilli inchoatio, id est sanctorum eterna glorificatio, soli Deo cognitum esse fatetur ^y. [*] ^z Quid uero super huius uiri assertionem uel potius opinione ^{aa} sentiendum sit, successores nostri
- 30 certius diiudicare poterunt. Nos tamen iam uidemus, quod tipicum ^{bb} Babilonis regnum maximum in orbe optinet ^{cc} principatum, terras christianorum de die ^{dd} [C f. 70r] in diem ^{ee} occupando et erroris perniciem dilatando ^{ff}. Post mortem enim Heraclii imperatoris languescente ^{gg} Romano imperio Arabum atque Sarracenorum surrexit principatus, qui omnes impiissima secta Mahumeti ^{hh}
- 35 heresiarche infecti sunt. Qui ui armata maximas Asye partes et iam fere totam Asyam cum tota ⁱⁱ Affrica ^{jj} ac maximam partem Hyspanie occupantes, in subiectos sicut imperium sic et errorem suum transfuderunt. Que heresis diaboli quidem machinatione concepta, primo per Arrium seminata, deinde per Mahumet ^{kk} regem de Mecha longe lateque prouecta et multo
- 40 deformius adaucta, per Antichristum autem ^{ll} ex toto secundum diabolicam intentionem complebitur et per totum orbem diffundetur. Sed ut ^{mm} malignitas diabolice adinventionis iam propagata facilius per Antichristi seuissimam ⁿⁿ persecutionem possit in chisticolas ubique dilatari, credibile est primitus Sarracenos Antichristi precursores ^{oo} paulatim terras christianorum ^{pp} inuadere
- 45 et suo dominio subiugare, sicuti ^{qq} eos iam fecisse cernimus, ita ut nullus christianus princeps peccatis christianorum exigentibus adeo potens existat, qui Antichristi ^{rr} seuissime persecutioni et uesane ^{ss} tyrannidi audeat uel possit ^{tt} rebellando resistere ^{uu}.

^a De abbate Ioachim *om.* V K --- ^b Hac tempestate] Anno ab incarnatione Domini M°.C°.XCV° K --- ^c non – Roma] in Ytalia K --- ^d ordinis cisterciensis] de ordine cisterciense

K; cisterciensis P --- ^e cisterientibus A; cistertientibus P --- ^f sed – subiectus *om.* K --- ^g prius esset fere *tr.* K --- ^h illustratus P --- ⁱ condurabit R --- ^j gratia durabit *tr.* K --- ^k VII *add. in marg. dext.* K --- ^l de mysterio Septem visionum *add.* Ed. --- ^m VII R --- ⁿ illis K. --- ^o Saladino R K --- ^p et *add.* A P --- ^q a *om.* P --- ^r -h- *add. s.l.* C; Nabugodonosor A P; Nabugdenosor R; Nabugonosor K --- ^s M⁰.C⁰C⁰.IX^o R --- ^t sexta V --- ^u quod *add. s.l.* C --- ^v persecutionem eius *tr.* K --- ^w fieret Ed. --- ^x in R --- ^y *korr. e.* fatentur V; hic rome interro *add. in marg. dext.* A; *add. in text.* P --- ^z *inseritur textus 2 in marg. sin. C; olim inseritur sed nunc defici.* A; *in text.* V R K --- ^{aa} opinionem R --- ^{bb} tipum K --- ^{cc} tenet K --- ^{dd} de die *om.* K --- ^{ee} in diem] in dies K --- ^{ff} *korr. au.* dilando A --- ^{gg} languessens P --- ^{hh} maumeti P --- ⁱⁱ Asyam cum tota *om.* K --- ^{jj} Affricam K --- ^{kk} machumet P; Maheumet R; Mahumetum K --- ^{ll} et eius precessores *add. in marg. sin.* K --- ^{mm} ut *om.* R --- ⁿⁿ seuissimam *om.*, et precursorum suorum K --- ^{oo} precussores P --- ^{pp} christianorum terras *tr.* R --- ^{qq} sicut Ed. --- ^{rr} *add.* precursorum K --- ^{ss} uesanie K --- ^{tt} *korr. au.* posset A --- ^{uu} Hec in libro uisionum apud Sibetone et apud Coggeshale *add.* K; *sequitur textus 2 i. P.*

The asterisk in line 28 in text I marks the place where in C text II is added in the left margin and introduced into the text. While in manuscripts V, R, and K text I and II are merged accordingly, the situation is more complex in manuscripts A and R. While in manuscript A the insertion is absent, in manuscript P it follows at the end of text I. As P is very probably a direct copy of A this seems to be a rather unsettling observation. However, a close examination of A indicates, that text II must have been there, not in the margin as in C but on a parchment slip which was later lost.⁵⁸ When manuscript P was copied from A, the slip was still there but the scribe misplaced the inserted text.

Text II is witness to the only striking difference to the version known so far through the edition of Joseph Stevenson.⁵⁹ Against the evidence of all the manuscripts, he had decided to print ‘Innocentium Tertium successorem non habiturum’ instead of ‘Innocentius tertius successorem non sit habiturus.’ Contrary to Stevenson’s opinion that this is grammatically incorrect,⁶⁰ this sentence is perfectly correct if understood as a verbal quotation. As verbal quotations and direct speech occur in several instances in the text the decision to follow the consensus of all the manuscripts and to abstain from an emendation is definitely to be preferred.

Text II: C f. 69v in marg. sin.; A deficit; Vf. 58v; Pf. 41va–vb; Rf. 56va–vb; K f. 66v

- 1 Hic Rome interrogatus a uiro uenerabili et in Dei uerbo facundissimo

- et eque^a religioso^b abbate Persenne^c, quonam ausu talia^d prediceret, an^e ex prophetia^f an coniecturaseu reuelatione, respondit se neque prophetiam^g neque coniecturam^h neque reuelationem de his habere. ‘Sed Deus’, inquit, ‘qui olim deditⁱ prophetis
- 5 spiritum prophetie^j, mihi dedit spiritum intelligentie, ut in Dei spiritu omnia misteria sacre scripture clarissime intelligam, sicut sancti^k prophete intellexerunt, qui eam olim in Dei spiritu ediderunt’. Requisitus autem ab eodem abbate, quid sentiret de Antichristo, respondit ipsum iam esse adolescentem in urbe Roma. Cui cum obiceret patrum presagia, quod in Babilonia nasciturus^l prophetatus
- 10 sit^m, statim intulit Romam mystice Babilonemⁿ uocari iuxta illud beati Petri apostoli in fine epistole^o sue^p prime: ‘Salutat uos ecclesia, que est in Babilone electa’. Vnde expositor Romam Babiloniam uocat propter confusionem multiplicis ydolatrie^q. Predixit quoque^r: Innocentius III^{uss} successorem non sit habiturus^t. Requisitus autem, quoto dehinc anno regnaturus foret Antichristus,
- 15 respondit, quod nisi morte preueniretur^u, ipsum etatis permissu^v uidere^w posset. Videbatur autem fere^x sexagenarius^y.

^a *in – eque om.* K --- ^b *religiosissimo* P --- ^c *Persencie* P; *de Persenne* K --- ^d *talia ausu tr.* R --- ^e *an om.* R --- ^f *propheta* P --- ^g *prophetam* P --- ^h *proiecturam* R --- ⁱ *dedit olim tr.* K --- ^j *profesie* P --- ^k *sancti om.* K --- ^l *nasciturus om.* P --- ^m *korr. au. est* V --- ⁿ *biloniam* P --- ^o *apostole (!)* R --- ^p *sue add. s.l.* C --- ^q *multiplicem ydolatrie confusionem tr.* V --- ^r *quod add.* R --- ^s *quod add.* P --- ^t *Predixit-habitus added slightly later by the same han.* C; *Innocentium Tertium .. non habiturum* Ed. --- ^u *preueniret* R --- ^v *permissum* R --- ^w *uideret* R --- ^x *fore* P --- ^y *Requisitus – sexagenarius om.* K.

III

A careful reading of both texts shows that the insertion of II, although not fully arbitrary, breaks the flow of Ralph’s original narrative.⁶¹ Text I starts with basic information about Joachim of Fiore’s personality. He is a Cistercian abbot living not far away from the city of Rome whose relationship with his order is, however, a somehow loose one. According to some, he was poorly educated but received the gift of divine wisdom which enabled him to write a commentary on the seven visions of the Apocalypse. What follows is a brief but fairly accurate account of Joachim’s basic exegetical concepts. His key idea of the

concordance of Old and New Testament is mentioned and its application to the seven visions and the seven seals of the Apocalypse explained. According to the idea of concordance, the Old Testament persecutions of the Jews are linked to the persecutions of the Christians, a parallel which extends until the times of Ralph himself and into the future. The fifth persecution, the fifth vision of the Apocalypse, and the opening of the fifth seal are enacted in the capture of Jerusalem by Saladin and his successors. The Old Testament parallel is the capture of Jerusalem, the destruction of the Temple, and the deportation of the Jewish people to Babylonia by King Nebuchadnezzar ('Nabuchodonosor'). According to Joachim, the sixth vision and the opening of the sixth seal will start in 1199. There will be a period of universal missionary effort, followed by the coming, rule, and final defeat of the Antichrist. Only God knows the duration of this period and the time of the opening of the seventh seal. Ralph closes his account with a summary, which at a first glance looks rather reluctant and sceptical: 'What should be thought about this man's assertion or rather opinion, might be more safely decided by our successors' – but then the sentence turns into explicit agreement: 'We, however, can already observe the typical Babylonian rule gaining forces everywhere'. This process began during the reign of the Roman emperor Heraclius when the heresiarch Muhammad started to disseminate his teachings, inspired by the heresy of Arius, among the Arabs and Saracens. The resulting persecutions of the Christians are lasting until the very present, as can be seen from the Saracen invasions and occupation of Christian territory and the absence of any Christian prince sufficiently powerful and daring to resist them.

This paragraph is very remarkable indeed. Ralph not only gives an account of Joachim of Fiore's teachings but he also recognizes their fulfilment and thus confirmation in his own times. He is thus not only positive about Joachim's view of history, but he embraces it as a model of understanding contemporary history. In some sense, therefore, Ralph may be deemed to be Joachim of Fiore's first English follower.

Although text I marks the end of the entry for 1195, this by no means implies its dating to this year. Ralph's opening phrase 'Hac tempestate' rather suggests that Ralph did not mean the episode to have taken place precisely in that year but 'in these times'. The same wording – 'hac tempestate' – appears earlier in the chronicle, when Ralph at the end of

the entry for 1140 mentions the three great masters Peter Abelard (d. 1142), Gilbert of Poitiers (d. 1155), and Hugh of St Victor (d. 1141). Obviously, he did not mean the exact year but the period around 1140.⁶² Similar wording can be found throughout the chronicle.⁶³ Besides this, Stevenson had already noted a change in ink before the Joachim entry.⁶⁴ The assumption that at this point the composition of the text was interrupted for some time is further supported by an observation by F. M. Powicke: while the St Albans' chronicler Roger of Wendover drew heavily on Ralph's chronicle up to this point, there are no more parallels after the entry for 1195. It can, therefore, be assumed that the version of the chronicle available to Roger did not include annals for after 1195, and it very probably did not include Ralph's account of Joachim of Fiore, because Roger of Wendover's own account of Joachim shows absolutely no parallel to Ralph's.⁶⁵ Finally, as it already had been shown that the annals for the years up to 1195 also include information available only after that year,⁶⁶ this can be seen as further confirmation that when writing about Joachim Ralph did not have a particular event in mind but was using material available to him in an appropriate place. The question therefore should rather be: Why did Ralph include the Joachim narrative at exactly this point, and from where did he get the information? The first part of the question is easy to answer. The loss of the True Cross and the capture of Jerusalem, the dubious results of the Third Crusade, King Richard's German captivity, and the Muslim success in Spain all caused in Ralph a sense of doom and despair. Joachim's interpretation of history served as a perfect way of fitting the developments into the unfolding of sacred history; for Ralph it might even have helped to gain a glimpse into the immediate future.⁶⁷ So, while the episode cannot refer to an exact date, there is at least a possible *terminus post quem*. Joachim is called 'abbas.. ordinis cisterciensis, sed cisterciensibus minime subiectus.' This obviously reflects his steady alienation from the Cistercians, which culminated in the foundation of the monastery of San Giovanni in Fiore and the Florentine order. This must have taken place in c. 1192, when Joachim was summoned by the General Chapter to appear before it, otherwise he was to be treated as a fugitive.⁶⁸ As a Cistercian, Ralph of Coggeshall was probably aware of this statute. It has, however, to be emphasized that this *terminus post quer* does not refer to a particular event but rather

to the availability of certain information to Ralph, or to his becoming aware of the value of this information in the context of his chronicle.

The problem of Ralph's sources is much more complex and needs to be dealt with in a broader context. Here only a few observations can be given. It is remarkable that at about the same time four chroniclers wrote about Joachim of Fiore's ideas. Apart from Ralph of Coggeshall, these were Roger of Howden, Ralph Niger and Robert of Auxerre. While Roger of Howden seems to be independent of the other three authors, Coggeshall, Niger and Robert of Auxerre show common features which suggest either dependence or a common source.

Ralph of Coggeshall	Ralph Niger ^a	Robert of Auxerre ^b
Hac tempestate extitit quidam abbas non longe ab urbe Roma ordinis cisterciensis. sed cisterciensibus minime subiectus; qui quandam expositionem super VII uisiones apocalipsys edidit. accepta diuinitus ut aiunt sapientia. cum fere esset prius illiteratusQuid uero super huius uiri assertionem. uel potius opinione sentiendum sit successores nostri certius diiudicare poterunt. Nos tamen iam uidemus quod...	His diebus Ioachim quidam monachus Cisterciensis a fere illiterate) subito factus est intelligens , scripsit super Apocalipsim et apertiones sigillorum perpreteritas persecutiones distinguens, quodammodo Novum Testamentum Veteri Testamento comparavit et diem iudicii proxime futuram asseveravit, quia ultimi sigilli apertio, in quo Antichristus venturus erat, a limine iam immineret. Galfridus quoque Altisiodorensis, quondam abbas Clarevallensis, super Apocalipsim commentatus est, ut visum est, discretius.	Per hos dies venit ex Calabrie partibus ad Urbanum papam Verone morantem quidam abbas nomine Ioachim, de quo ferebant, quia, cum prius non plurimum didicisset, diuinitus acceperit intelligentie donum , adeo ut faeunde diserteque enodaret difficultates quaslibet scripturarum.... Id vero in libello eius pre ceteris notabile ac suspectum habetur, quod mundi diffinit terminum, et infra duas generationes, quae iuxta ipsum annos faciunt 60, arbitratur implendum quicquid de Antichristo legitur eventurum. Dicat quisque quod senserit, nos tutius iudicamus non discutere quam arguere quod neseimus et rei nobis incerte presagium iudicio relinquere posterorum.

^a *Radulfi Nigri Chronica. The Chronicles of Ralph Nige*, ed. Robert Anstruther, Publications of the Caxton Society 13 (London, 1851), 96–7; Hanna Krause, *Radulfus Niger, Chronica. Eine englische Weltchronik des 12. Jahrhunderts*, Europäische Hochschulschriften III/265 (Frankfurt/Main, 1985), 286–7.

^b Robert of Auxerre, *Chronico*, ed. Oswald Holder-Egger, *MGH.S*, 26 (Hannover, 1882), 226–76, at 248–9. Joachim appears for a second time in an entry for 1190; see below, [n. 85](#).

All three authors share the notion that Joachim was poorly educated but illuminated by the divine gift of understanding. The divine origin of his inspiration was emphasized by Joachim himself⁶⁹ and the motive was picked up by his biographers.⁷⁰ Another common feature is the critical note at the end of the respective accounts, but while Coggeshall's sentence is soon turned into agreement,⁷¹ Niger⁷² and Robert of Auxerre remain sceptical. In addition to the three historiographers' focus on Joachims exegetical principle of concords and his opinions about the coming of the Antichrist, they do not mention his controversial Trinitarian theology.

There are differences, too. With respect to contents, Ralph Niger's narrative is relatively brief and therefore rather superficial compared with that of Coggeshall and Robert. The strongest difference concerns the dating. Coggeshall, though adding the account at the end of the annal for 1195,⁷³ has no particular date in mind, and the same seems to apply to Niger.⁷⁴ Robert of Auxerre, however, not only enters his account at the end of the annal for 1186, but gives an exact indication of the date: in these times – *per hos die* a certain abbot named Joachim came from Calabria to Pope Urban III who was then staying at Verona. Urban was elected pope in Verona (25 November 1185) and remained there until shortly before his death on 20 October 1187.⁷⁵ Robert does not explain why Joachim came to Verona, but as it is known from other sources that the abbot received a papal mandate encouraging him to continue with the writing of his works,⁷⁶ at least it cannot be excluded that Joachim really did visit Urban III in person.⁷⁷

Robert of Auxerre, a Premonstratensian who worked on his chronicle from the late twelfth century until his death in 1212,⁷⁸ used an exceptionally wide range of sources. For his own time he also referred to his own perception of events and to what others had told him.⁷⁹ He was in close contact with the Cistercians (he used the library of the nearby abbey of Pontigny), who might have been among his 'oral' sources. Therefore, while a direct dependence from the chronicle of his contemporary Ralph of Coggeshall is rather improbable, it is well within the bounds of possibility that both authors drew on the same pool of information.⁸⁰ The same is possible for Ralph Niger, who, although he was not a Cistercian himself was very devoted to the order.⁸¹ He, too,

explicitly mentions trustworthy reports from others as sources for the up-to-date parts of his chronicle.⁸²

Before further investigating the nature of this supposed pool of information it might be useful to have a closer look at other evidence of early awareness of Joachim of Fiore's activities and writings. Of special significance in this respect is another historiographical and perhaps even eyewitness account, included in the chronicle of the royal cleric and Yorkshire parson Roger of Howden.⁸³ He refers to Joachim in the description of King Richard's journey to the Holy Land and his stay at Messina in the winter of 1190–91.⁸⁴ The abbot, about whose gift of prophecy Richard had heard many rumours, appeared upon the king's request in Messina – a meeting which was also briefly mentioned by Robert of Auxerre.⁸⁵ Roger's extensive account of Joachim's lecture before the king about two texts from the Apocalypse⁸⁶ and the debate with high-ranking clerics from the king's court about the exact time of the coming of the Antichrist cannot be dealt with in detail here.⁸⁷ That King Richard actively sought out Joachim can be understood as another hint at the abbot's relative prominence around 1190.⁸⁸

Another occasion which might have caused some publicity was Joachim's appearance before Pope Lucius III at Veroli in May 1184.⁸⁹ At that time Joachim was living and writing in the nearby Cistercian monastery of Casamari, when he was asked to explain a mysterious prophetic text which had been found among the books of a recently deceased cardinal. His exposition of this spectacular and unsettling text in front of an educated and curious audience was an opportunity for him to test publicly his exegetical method and resulted in the treatise *De prophetia ignota*.⁹⁰ As the papal Curia was an international meeting point, his appearance there might have caused an increased awareness of his ideas.

There are two more pieces of evidence which show that already in the 1180s Joachim was not unknown at least among theologians – who reacted to his ideas with open polemic. The first is a sermon which unfortunately is preserved only as a fragment, delivered by the Cistercian abbot and scholar Geoffrey of Auxerre⁹¹ at an unknown time and to an unknown audience. As sometime abbot of Fossanova (c. 1171–76) Geoffrey probably had personal knowledge of Joachim. In the sermon⁹² he attacks Joachim for his new method of prophesying – 'ex

habundanti scientia vel intelligentia scripturarum’ – and blames him for being of Jewish descent. The extant fragment of the sermon does not go into more detail, but notwithstanding its polemical stance the mentioning of the ‘understanding of Scripture’ as the main source for Joachim’s thought is correct. Interestingly, the *Intelligentia super Calathis*, an early treatise by Joachim, is directed to an abbot *Gafridus*, who probably is to be identified with Geoffrey of Auxerre.⁹³

Finally, a rather aggressive attack on Joachim’s ideas can be found in a commentary on the book of Exodus written in the 1180s in Paris by the theological master Peter the Chanter (d. 1197).⁹⁴ Again, the Chanter’s reference is openly polemical: ‘Ille Joachim’ is blamed for absurd comparisons between the state of the church before the coming of Christ and the state of the church after the coming of Christ, which allowed him to assert the immediate coming of the Antichrist. Though the text itself is really short, it suggests that Peter the Chanter knew about Joachim’s exegetical method of concords; and he disapproved of the speculations about the coming of the Antichrist, also ascribed to Joachim by other contemporary authors. Interestingly, the way the Chanter mentions Joachim suggests that his audience knew about whom he was talking.⁹⁵

All in all, it is therefore obvious that already in the 1180s Joachim was a rather well known if somewhat dubious and controversial author – although his main works, the *Concordia novi et veteris testamenti*, the *Psalterium decem cordarum*, and the *Expositio super Apocalypsim* had not yet been published. This awareness is also mirrored in the historiographic accounts of Ralph of Coggeshall, Ralph Niger, Robert of Auxerre, and Roger of Howden, but, apart from speculating about a pool’ of information, probably within the Cistercian order, the exact provenance of the information available to them is unknown. In the following, at least for Ralph of Coggeshall’s text I and for Robert of Auxerre, two very early writings of Joachim will be suggested as sources.⁹⁶

One of Joachim’s main innovations is the technique of illustrating abstract ideas and complex developments of thought through diagrams and images. This approach, although not without precedents in earlier authors,⁹⁷ was a real innovation, probably supported by the graphic character of many of the abbot’s ideas. Joachim already used diagrams

at a very early stage of his thought. Some were included in the *Concordia*, the *Expositio*, and the *Psalterium*. Their complexity and sophistication developed as Joachim's thought grew ever more elaborate. It is possible that at first they were kept on single sheets of parchment, which were used for meditation and instruction. Then the single leaves were collected in the *Liber figurarum* either by Joachim himself towards the end of his life or by a pupil soon after his death.⁹⁸

The separate circulation of some of the diagrams is obvious from the manuscript tradition. An example are the 'earlier tables of concords',⁹⁹ which form part of the *Liber figurarum*¹⁰⁰ but are also extant separately in at least two rather early manuscripts: Paris, Bibliothèque nationale de France, MS lat. 11864 is from the early thirteenth century and was kept in the Benedictine monastery of Corbie. The tables of concords (fol. 151v), a copy of Joachim's *De septem sigillis* (fol. 152r), his *Genealogia* (fol. 151v-152v), and his letter *Universis Christi fidelibus* (fol. 152v) are an early thirteenth-century addition to a twelfth-century copy of Isidore of Seville's *Etymologiae*.¹⁰¹ The second manuscript is of particular interest: Brussels, Bibliothèque royale, MS II 924 belonged to the Cistercian monastery of Villers (in Brabant). The earlier tables of concords and a text of Joachim's *De septem sigillis* are extant on a double leaf which was added later to a thirteenth-century manuscript of Jerome's letters. The handwriting of the Joachim texts is certainly earlier than that of the rest of the manuscript: it can be dated to around 1200 or perhaps even to the end of the twelfth century.¹⁰²

The earlier tables of concords are used to illustrate the relationship – *concordia* – between the two comings of Christ, the persecutions as described in biblical history (including the history of the church until the present and well into the future) and the apocalyptic seven seals (Old Testament) and their openings (New Testament, church history, future).¹⁰³ It will be remembered that Ralph of Coggeshall in his description of Joachim's ideas emphasized the method of concordance between the Old and New Testament persecutions and the apocalyptic seven seals, thus following a train of thought which seems to be similar to the one depicted in the diagram. A close comparison of the texts results in more than that: there are also textual parallels.

Ralph of Coggeshall, <i>Chronicon</i>	<i>Liber figumrum</i> , earlier table of Concords ^a

(l. 28) ... Quid uero super huius uiri assertionem uel potius opinione sentiendum sit, successores nostri certius diiudicare poterunt. Nos tamen iam uidemus quod tipicum Babilonis regnum maximum in orbe optinet principatum, terras christianorum de die in diem occupando et erroris perniciem dilatando... (l. 13) .. Quintam uero persecutionem. quam sub quinta uisione. et quinti sigilli apertione distinxit; dicit agi temporibus nostris a Salaadino et eius successoribus qui terram ierosolimitanam inuaserunt. et matrem Syon a ciuitate sua Ierusalem transmigrare compulerunt....	Quinta uero persecutio in qua nunc sumus quid facere ceperit uidimus (uidemus P¹⁰), quid futurum restet (restat P¹⁰) quisque sane sapiens uigilanter attendat. Iam enim (enim om. P¹⁰) tipicum babylonis regnum uires suas (suas uires tr. Ox P¹⁰) exercet, iam iam (iam enim Ed.) mater Syon ex sua ciuitate migrare compellitur....
(l. 25) .. Post Antichristi uero interitum quot annorum uel dierum fiet expletio sigilli sexti, id est mortuorum resurrectio, et septimi sigilli inchoatio, id est sanctorum eterna glorificatio, soli Deo cognitum esse fatetur.	Exinde autem usque ad casum Antichristi, etsi preteritorum exhibitio certitudinem facere uideatur, melius tamen numerus interim opinioni relinquitur. Breuitas autem temporis post Antichristi casum diuino iudicio penitus relinquenda est.

^a Oxford, Corpus Christi College, MS 255A, fol. 6r (Ox); Brussels, Bibliothèque royale, MS II924, fol. B recto (Br); Paris, BNF, MS lat. 11864, fol. 151v (P); *Liber figurarum*, ed. Tondelli, Reeves, and Hirsch-Reich, tav. X (Ed.).

Before drawing conclusions from this observation another textual parallel should be mentioned. The as yet earliest known work of Joachim of Fiore is the so-called *Genealogia*, also known as *Epistula subsequentium figurarum*,¹⁰⁴ extant in four manuscripts.¹⁰⁵ Already in this text the graphic character of Joachim's thought is obvious. The *Genealogia* pictures the history of salvation as two trees, the first with Adam as root and Christ as the top, the second branching from the first, with the prophet Isaiah as root and the ultimate coming of Christ as the top. The trunks of the trees are divided into 105 generations, counting 30 years each. Groups of these generations are linked to different periods of history,¹⁰⁶ to the seven ages and the seven parts of the Book of Revelation. Further, Joachim applies his method of concords and establishes parallel series of persecutions of the Jews and of the church, linked to the apocalyptic seven seals and their openings.

Interestingly, the short account of Joachim's ideas given by Robert of Auxerre seems to follow a similar concept, and indeed a comparison of the two texts results in two parallels:

Joachim, <i>Genealogia</i> (ed. Potestà)	Robert of Auxerre, <i>Chronicon</i>
[...](ll. 61–68) Quinque etates fuerunt ab Adam usque ad Christum, sexta a Christo ultra... Prima etas .. secunda finitur..., quinta in salvatore Christo; sexta in iudice. Apocalipsis exponit cursum sexte etatis.... Sexta etas in sex etatulis dividitur.... (ll. 34–37)... non restant nisi due generationes complende, id est anni LX: quasi duo terdenarii, in quibus impleri oportet quicquid de Antichristo dicitur et de consummatione seculi.	... Dick enim, quia, sicut scripturae veteris Testamenti quinque etatum seculi ab Adam usque ad Christum decursarum hystoriam continent, sic liber Apocalypsis etatis sexte a Christo inchoate cursum exponit, ipsamque etatem sextam in sex etatulas dispartitam earumque singulas singulis huius libri periodis satis congrue designatas...^a ... Id vero in libello eius pre ceteris notabile ac suspectum habetur, quod mundi diffinit terminum, et infra duas generationes, quae iuxta ipsum annos faciunt 60, arbitratur implendum quicquid de Antichristo legitur eventurum.^b

^a *Chronikon*, ed. Holder-Egger, 249 ll.4–8.

^b *Ibid.*, ll. 11–13.

In conclusion it can therefore be said that Ralph of Coggeshall and Robert of Auxerre in their respective descriptions of Joachim of Fiore's ideas are drawing on a common source. The textual parallels suggest that this common source probably was a version of Joachim's earlier tables of concords and his *Genealogia*. Both texts were copied together, as can be seen from the Paris manuscript. It might even be possible to speculate about the outlook of what Ralph and Robert were looking at. In the Brussels' manuscript the texts are extant on a double leaf, which originally was separate from the manuscript to which it now belongs. Recent research on the *De septem sigillis* suggested that this text was copied as a *carta* on single leaves and used in the context of monastic instruction.¹⁰⁷ The same might have applied to the original version of the tables of concords and the *Genealogia*. The leaf from the Brussels' manuscript could be understood as an example of such a *carta* and of what Ralph of Coggeshall and Robert of Auxerre might have had in mind when writing their texts.¹⁰⁸ If Robert of Auxerre's dating to 1186 is accurate, this would be proof that the texts in question were already available at that time. Although the text is too short to make a definite decision, it cannot be ruled out that Peter the Chanter's criticism of Joachim, to be dated to the 1180s and focusing on the concordance of persecutions of the Jews and the church, drew on the same sources.¹⁰⁹

IV

Ralph of Coggeshall's text II, inserted into the earlier narrative of Joachim's ideas, gives an account of an encounter at Rome between Joachim and another Cistercian abbot, Adam of Perseigne. Adam asks Joachim several questions about his teachings, especially about their authority and sources: Are they prophecies, or conjectures or revelations? Joachim replies that they are none of these but that he received the divine gift of understanding which enables him to explain all the secrets of Scripture. Another topic of the conversation is the coming of Antichrist, who according to Joachim is already living in the city of Rome. Confronted with the traditional opinion that the Antichrist was to be born in Babylon, Joachim reminds Adam of the interpretation of Rome as Babylon, as found in the letter of St Peter and in the writings of the biblical exegetes. Without further explanation there follows a reference to Pope Innocent III who, according to Joachim, would not have a successor. The interview closes with another statement about the Antichrist. Asked about the exact time of the beginning of the Antichrist's rule, Joachim replied that, should he not die before, then he would live to see it. According to the narrative, Joachim was then in his sixties.

Again, the first question to be asked concerns the position of the account in Ralph's chronicle. As has already been shown, it was added in the margins of the Cotton manuscript and on a now-lost parchment slip in the Arundel manuscript, while in all the other manuscripts it forms part of the text. It is therefore obvious that it belongs to a later stage of the composition of the chronicle than the original account. As the Cotton manuscript is very probably Ralph's working copy (and the same might apply to the Arundel manuscript),¹¹⁰ an examination of the handwriting could provide a hint at the approximate time when the addition was entered into the manuscript. Indeed, the hand which added the account on the margin of fol. 69v of the Cotton manuscript is very probably the same that wrote the text of the chronicle on fol. 113r–119v l. 15,¹¹¹ covering annals for the years 1212/13–16.¹¹² It can therefore be assumed that this scribe was active around or soon after 1216. A careful examination of the marginal note in the Cotton manuscript reveals another observation: the sentence 'Predixit quoque: Innocentius III^{us} successorem non sit habiturus'¹¹³ is an addition to the addition, but

written by the same hand.¹¹⁴ This observation possibly provides us with another chronological clue. It is difficult to imagine that the addition was written before Innocent's accession to the pontificate on 8 January 1198.¹¹⁵ On the other hand, it is most improbable that the chronicler would not have mentioned Honorius III's accession, had he written after Innocent's death on 16 July 1216. It is therefore likely that the note was added between c.1213, when the scribe started his work in the Cotton manuscript, and July 1216. Perhaps this period could be further narrowed by the observation that in text II there is no allusion whatsoever to Joachim's condemnation by the Fourth Lateran Council (November 1215), an event an author writing after that date probably would have included in his account.

Of course, this chronological framework tells us nothing about the actual date of Adam of Perseigne's meeting with Joachim. Obviously, it must have taken place before March 1202, when Joachim died. If the pope in question was indeed Innocent III, the earliest possible date is January 1198. Joachim was in close contact with the papacy from at least 1184, when he met Lucius III at Veroli,¹¹⁶ until the end of his life. In August 1198 Pope Innocent III appointed him preacher for the crusade. But, while this is another indication of the high esteem the pope held for Joachim, it does not necessarily imply the abbot's personal presence at the Curia, and indeed so far no evidence for a personal visit to Rome in Joachim's last years has come to light.¹¹⁷ However, given the fact that the sentence about Innocent III is an addition (though contemporary), it might well be that the meeting of the two abbots took place earlier.

The case is even more difficult for Adam of Perseigne, a Cistercian monk and, from 1188, abbot of the abbey of Perseigne near Le Mans. He was an influential personality with a close relationship to Kings Richard (whose confessor he might have been¹¹⁸) and John. Therefore the Pope¹¹⁹ and the Cistercians¹²⁰ frequently employed him as envoy to the royal court. He acted frequently as a papal judge delegate, especially in matters concerned with the reform of monastic institutions.¹²¹ He was close to the famous preacher Fulk of Neuilly and involved in the preparations for the Fourth Crusade¹²² in which he also participated. However, he did not travel with the main body of the crusader army and was therefore not involved in the capture of Zadar and Constantinople,

but reached the Holy Land in the company of Renaud de Dampierre and returned in 1203.¹²³ A collection of sermons testifies to his theological learning, while an extant letter collection provides insights into his network of friendship and advice.¹²⁴ Adam died in 1221. With respect to his busy life in close connection with the papacy, it is highly probable that he visited Rome and the papal Curia several times, but unfortunately no dates are known. One occasion might have been in summer 1202 when he was passing through Italy on his journey to the Holy Land,¹²⁵ but as Joachim had died on 30 March 1202, the two men could not have met then. Adam's biography therefore provides no clues for the exact date of the meeting with Joachim at Rome.

The text of Ralph of Coggeshall's account allows for some interesting observations. The conversation touches on two points: first the source, and therefore implicitly the authority, of Joachim's statements, and then Joachim's opinion concerning the coming of the Antichrist. Adam's first question is about the formal status of Joachim's statements: Are they prophecies, conjectures, or revelations? The language used in this question demonstrates a certain acquaintance with the technical language of twelfth-century theology. The terms *prophetia*, *coniectura*, and *revelatio* describe three modes of acquisition of theological knowledge. Although until the late twelfth century there was no explicit theory of theological knowledge, elements can be found as early as in Augustine, Cassiodorus, and John Cassian and were used by contemporary theologians like Peter Lombard.¹²⁶ Joachim's reply, however, offers a fourth approach: as prophecy has come to an end, it has now been replaced by *intellectus* – understanding. In the same way the prophets had received the gift of prophecy Joachim has received the gift of understanding, the *Spiritus intelligentiae*.¹²⁷ Interestingly, in Joachim's opinion prophecy and understanding are two different but equal approaches to divine self-revelation, an assertion which already can be found in Cassiodorus' commentary to the Psalms.¹²⁸ The emphasis on the active understanding of Scripture as a special divine gift matches Joachim's characterization in the two extant biographies and in the early historiographical accounts, among them Ralph of Coggeshall's first reference to the abbot.¹²⁹

Adam of Perseigne's second question concerns the coming of the Antichrist. It is interesting to note the striking similarity with respect to

wording and contents between this part of the text and a letter of Bernard of Clairvaux. At the end of the year 1124 Bernard wrote to Bishop Geoffrey of Chartres about a recent meeting with Norbert of Xanten. Among other things Bernard asked Norbert about his ideas concerning the Antichrist: 'Verum de Antichristo cum inquirerem quid sentiret ...' Norbert replied that he was most certain that the Antichrist was to appear during the lifetime of the present generation. This statement prompted Bernard to ask for the authority of Norbert's certainty, but the reply (which is not quoted) left him even more astonished, because Norbert asserted that he was not to die until a general persecution of the church had taken place.¹³⁰ Not only is the wording of Adam of Perseigne's question very similar to Bernard's text but also Joachim's reply seems to correspond with Norbert's, when he says that the Antichrist is already living as a youngster in Rome and that, if he does not die before, he will live to see him. The correspondence between the two texts suggests that in this place Ralph (or his source) is following a literary model. Although this does not necessarily imply that the account as a whole is fictitious, a critical stance would seem to be well founded here.

In contradistinction to Bernard's letter, in Ralph of Coggeshall's *Chronicon* an argumentative element is added, when Adam of Perseigne critically questions Joachim's certainty about the Antichrist already living in Rome. In common with the bishops in King Richard's entourage at Messina in their discussion with Joachim,¹³¹ Adam refers to the traditional opinion that the birthplace of the Antichrist is Babylon. Joachim, however, readily defends his assertion by pointing out that, according to what the apostle Peter says in his first epistle (1 Pet. 5:13), 'Babylon' is nothing else but an allegorical expression for Rome – an allegory already recognized in the exegetical literature, as proved by a quotation from Bede's commentary to the Catholic Epistles.¹³²

The following statement that Innocent III was to have no successor somehow interrupts the discussion between the two abbots,¹³³ the obvious continuation of which is Adam's question of when the reign of the Antichrist was to start. Again, Joachim's reply resembles Bernard of Clairvaux's report about Norbert of Xanten, who expected an imminent general persecution of the church in his own lifetime: if Joachim does not die before, he will live to see Antichrist's rule. The account in

Ralph's chronicle corresponds to Roger of Howden's description of the debate at Messina and also to Joachim's ideas in his own writings, although these are – of course – considerably more elaborated.¹³⁴ Again, one could ask if the parallel between the chronicles of Howden, Coggeshall (and Robert of Auxerre) can be interpreted as evidence for a common source.

The addition concerning Innocent III being a pope 'without successor' so far is rather difficult to explain. While the end of the succession of popes is another hint at the approaching end of history,¹³⁵ the fact that it has been added to the original text could be understood as evidence for the use of another source which only later came to the author's attention. In the context of Joachite thought the idea of a pope without successor is not so strange. In the tables of concords of the *Liber figurarum* Joachim establishes a parallel between two sequences of generations. The first, from Adam to the First Coming of Christ, consists of a series of Old Testament persons, while the second, from Azarias to the Second Coming of Christ, includes both biblical and historical personages. The latter are popes, starting with Peter and – in the Oxford copy of the *Liber figurarum* – ending with Alexander III.¹³⁶ However, not all the popes are mentioned by name but only some, each marking a generation counted as 30 years, and indicating the number of successors between themselves and the next named pope. The entries contemporaneous to Joachim's own time thus provide a possible hint at the approximate time of composition.¹³⁷ In the Oxford manuscript the last named pope is Alexander III and the number of successors, originally given as I or II, had been erased.¹³⁸ In other manuscripts sometimes the list had been updated, either by the original hand or by another scribe. In the Dresden manuscript of the *Liber figurarum* the last named pope is Celestine III with two successors,¹³⁹ in Paris, Bibliothèque nationale de France, MS lat. 11864 it is Innocent III with five successors (while for Alexander III no successors are given),¹⁴⁰ and in Brussels, Bibliothèque royale, MS II 924 Alexander III is named with no successors and Innocent III's name with two successors added by another hand.¹⁴¹ What has all this to do with the addition to text II in Ralph of Coggeshall's chronicle? It may be asked whether the source for the assertion that Innocent III was to have no successor was a version of Joachim's tables of concords which included Innocent III as

last named pope but did not give the number of successors. This would be another piece of evidence for the availability of this early work of Joachim in England in the very early thirteenth century.

The account closes with the remark that Joachim seemed to be in his sixties. This sentence is often used to argue that the abbot was born in 1135.¹⁴² However, the underlying assumption for this hypothesis is that Coggeshall's narrative is a textual unity and that the conversation between Adam of Perseigne and Joachim took place in 1195. It has already been argued that for codicological and textual reasons this assertion is wrong. Neither the date of the original text nor the date of the addition nor the exact date of the two abbots' conversation can be established with certainty. Therefore, unfortunately, the Coggeshall chronicle is of no use for establishing Joachim's date of birth.

V

This essay set out to offer a thorough reading of Ralph of Coggeshall's account about Joachim of Fiore in the context of the manuscript tradition, of Joachims own writings and of other contemporary historiographic accounts. A codicological and palaeographical examination of the two most important manuscripts (London, British Library, MS Cotton Vesp. D X, and College of Arms, MS Arundel 11) allows us to understand the narrative, actually consisting of two texts belonging to two different stages of the composition of the chronicle, in the context of the work's complex development. Although the text forms part of the entries for 1195, this year is not a date for any of the Joachim episodes. Rather, Ralph used information available to him in a place where a feeling of crisis and doom urged him to seek a deeper understanding of history. Joachim's view of history provided him with an appropriate means. Ralph of Coggeshall's chronicle therefore does not provide any certain foundation for chronological speculations with respect to Joachim's biography, but, together with the contemporary chronicle of the French Premonstratensian Robert of Auxerre, it is an important witness for an acquaintance with Joachim's *Genealogia* and tables of concords in Western Europe, perhaps as early as the second half of the 1180s. Ralph of Coggeshall's chronicle therefore contains important evidence for the early reception of Joachim of Fiore's works

not only in England but in general. In addition, it offers us telling insights into a late twelfth-century English Cistercian's world view, his perception of the history of his own times, and his attempts to fit it into an explanatory framework provided by Joachim's theology.

Notes

¹ The first point of reference is still Marjorie Reeves's masterly book *The Influence of Prophecy in the Later Middle Ages: A Study in Joachimism*. (Oxford 1969, repr. Notre Dame 1993). This essay would not have been possible without the encouragement of many friends, above all Brenda Bolton and Frances Andrews, and the support of many librarians in Great Britain and France. Special thanks are owed for their help to Robert Yorke, Archivist of the College of Arms, London, and Gill Cannell, Sub Librarian at the Parker Library, Corpus Christi College, Cambridge.

² Ralph of Coggeshall, *Chronicon Anglicanu*, ed. Joseph Stevenson, RS 66 (London 1875).

³ *Chronicon*, 67–70 see, esp., 67 n. 3, 68 n. 2, and 69 n. 5.

⁴ Herbert Grundmann, 'Kleine Beiträge über Joachim von Fiore', in id., *Ausgewählte Aufsätze 2: Joachim von Fior*, Schriften der Monumenta Germaniae Historica 25/2 (Stuttgart, 1977), 70–100, at 82 n. 30 (first in: *Zeitschrift für Kirchengeschicht*, 48 [1929], 137–65); id., 'Dante und Joachim von Fiore. Zu Paradiso x–xii, 1' in ibid., 166–210, at 175 n. 20 (first in: *Deutsches Fante-Jahrbuc*, 14 [1932], 210–56).

⁵ Id., *Neue Forschungen über Joachim von Fior*, Münstersche Forschungen 1 (Marburg, 1950), 37; id., 'Zur Biographie Joachims von Fiore und Rainers von Ponza' in id., *Ausgewählte Aufsätze*, 255–360, at 297 (first in: *F* 16 [1960], 437–546). The document is Celestine III's confirmation of the Florentian monastery, dated 25 August 1196 (JL 17425), which explicitly mentions Joachims presence at the Curia.

⁶ Ibid., 323–4.

⁷ Reeves, *Influence*, 13 n. 1, quoting Coggeshall, *Chronico*, 67: 'Hac tempestate exstitit quidam abbas ...'

⁸ Kurt-Victor Selge, 'L'origine delle opere di Gioacchino da Fiore', in *L'attesa della fine dei tempi nel Medioev*, ed. Ovidio Capitani and Jürgen Miethke, Annali del'Istituto storico italo-germanico: Quaderni 28 (Bologna, 1990), 87–131, at 116–17 n. 64.

⁹ Robert Lerner, *Powers of Prophecy: The Cedar of Lebanon Vision from the Mongol Onslaught to the Dawn of the Enlightenmen* (Berkeley, 1983), 96 n. 27.

¹⁰ Cambridge, Corpus Christi College, MS 404, fol. 66r–66v. See below, 152.

¹¹ Gian Luca Potestà, *Il tempo dell'Apocalisse. Vita di Gioacchino da Fiore* (Bari, 2004), 284, 371 n. 1. Other authors who have written about Coggeshall's account of Joachim's ideas include Enrico Pispisa, *Gioacchino da Fiore e i cronisti medieval*, Historica 1 (Messina, 1988), 24–32, and Elizabeth Freeman, *Narratives of a New Order: Cistercian Historical Writing in England, 1150–122*, Medieval Church Studies 2 (Turnhout, 2002), 179–213, esp. 186–8. Of all authors so far Freeman has given the best interpretation of the text.

¹² Many of the questions asked in this essay were already put forward in an important article by Morton W. Bloomfield and Marjorie Reeves, 'The Penetration of Joachimism into Northern Europe', *Speculu*, 29 (1954), 772–93.

¹³ Guy N. Hartcher, 'Ralph of Coggeshall's "Chronicon Anglicanum": An Investigative Analysis', Ph.D. thesis, Catholic University of America (Washington, DC, 1979); id.,

‘Coggeshall Abbey: The First Hundred Years’, *Journal of Religious Histor*, 12 (1982), 125–39 (a chapter from his thesis). The almost unique source for the abbey’s early history is Ralph’s *Chronicon*. For the foundation, see *Chronico*, ed. Stevenson, 11.

¹⁴ *The Libraries of the Cistercians, Gilbertines and Premonstratensian*, ed. David N. Bell, *Corpus of British Medieval Library Catalogues*, 3 (London, 1992), 13–14; extant manuscripts are listed in Neil R. Ker, *Medieval Libraries of Great Britain: A List of Surviving Books*, Royal Historical Society. Guides and Handbooks 3 (2nd edn, London, 1964), 52–3. There are no additions in Andrew G. Watson, *Supplement to the Second Editio*, Royal Historical Society. Guides and Handbooks 15 (London, 1987).

¹⁵ Hartcher, ‘Coggeshall Abbey’, 132–4; David Corner, ‘Coggeshall, Ralph of, in *Oxford Dictionary of National Biography* (Oxford, 2004), <http://www.oxforddnb.com/view/article/5816> (seen 3 September 2007).

¹⁶ In *Chronicon anglicanu*, ed. Stevenson, 36–7, Ralph gives two miracle stories but refrains from elaborating: *quae omnia quia alibi literis plenius mandavimus, hic etiam replicare fastidiosum duximus*. Cf. a similar reference at the end of the text of the vision of the monk of Evesham, *ibid.*, 72.

¹⁷ *Visio Thurkilli, relatore, ut videtur, Radulpho de Coggeshal*, ed. Paul Gerhard Schmidt (Leipzig, 1978); Paul Gerhard Schmidt, ‘The Vision of Thurkill’, *Journal of the Warburg and Courtauld Institute*, 41 (1978), 50–64.

¹⁸ Richard Sharpe, *A Handlist of the Latin Writers of Great Britain and Ireland before 154*, *Publications of the Journal of Medieval Latin*, 1 (Turnhout, 1997), 445–6; *id.*, *A Handlist of the Latin Writers of Great Britain and Ireland before 1540. Additions and Corrections (1997–2001)* (Turnhout, 2001), 931.

¹⁹ Germain Morin, ‘Le cistercien Ralph de Coggeshall et l’auteur des *Distinctiones monasticae* utilisées par Dom Pitra’ *Revue bénédictine*, 47 (1935), 348–55, uses a textual parallel between Ralph’s account about Joachim and the explanation of *Babylo* in the *Distinctione* as an argument for his authorship; but André Wilmart, ‘Un répertoire d’exégèse composé en Angleterre vers le début du XIII^e siècle’ *Mémorial Lagrang* (Paris, 1940) 307–46 convincingly rejects Morin’s thesis. Cf. Richard W. Hunt, ‘Notes on the *Distinctiones monasticae et morales*’, *Liber Floridus. Mittellateinische Studien Paul Lehmann zum 65. Geburtstag gewidme*, ed. Bernhard Bischoff and Suso Brechter (St Ottilien, 1950), 355–62.

²⁰ C.S. Watkins, *History and the Supernatural in Medieval England*, *Cambridge Studies in Medieval Life and Thought*, 4th ser. 66 (Cambridge, 2007).

²¹ Colin G.C. Tite, *The Early Records of Sir Robert Cotton’s Library: Formation, Cataloguing, Use* (London, 2003), 183. There are two parallel foliations in the manuscript, one more recent in pencil and an older one in ink. References in this essay will be to the more recent foliation.

²² Cf. James P. Carley, and Colin C.G. Tite, ‘Sir Robert Cotton as Collector of manuscripts and the Question of Dismemberment: British Library MSS Royal 13 D.I and Cotton Otho D.VIII’ *The Librarian*, 6th ser. 14 (1992), 94–9.

²³ Some manuscripts from Coggeshall bear characteristic tables of contents combined with ownership marks, for instance Cambridge, Corpus Christi College, MS 31, fol. Iv; MS 54 fol. IIIv and MS 89, inside front cover.

²⁴ ‘Stephanus fundator domus de Coggeshale.’ The list was entered by a late thirteenth-century hand on the previously empty fol. 45v and names the kings from Alfred to Edward I, ‘per quem omnes Iudei eiecti sunt de Anglia.’ As Edward’s death is not mentioned, the list was probably copied after 1290 and before 1307.

²⁵ Note in the inner side of the back cover.

²⁶ These slips are now mounted on paper: fol. 59, 61, 95.

²⁷ His name, the year and his mark of ownership (the Howard lion) are on the lower margin of fol. 1r.

²⁸ [William Henry Black,] *Catalogue of the Arundel Manuscripts in the Library of the College of Arm* (London, 1829), 17–18.

²⁹ Between fol. 19 and 20, 56 and 57, 85 and 86.

³⁰ David Carpenter, ‘Abbot Ralph of Coggeshall’s Account of the Last Years of King Richard and the First Years of King John’, *English Historical Review*, 113 (1998), 1210–30, at 1213 n. 1.

³¹ This would by no means be exceptional. Another example is Gervase of Tilbury who, like his contemporary Ralph, worked on his *Otia Imperiali* for a very long time and used two, perhaps even three, working manuscripts simultaneously Cf. Gervase of Tilbury, *Otia Imperiali*, ed. S.E. Banks and J.W. Binns, Oxford Medieval Texts (Oxford, 2002), lxxix–lxxxv.

³² Montague R. James, *A Descriptive Catalogue of the Manuscripts in the Library of Corpus Christi College, Cambridge* (Cambridge, 1912), ii, 176–178.

³³ Léopold Delisle, ‘Inventaires des manuscrits latins de Saint-Victor, conservés à la Bibliothèque impériale sous les numéros 14232–15175’, *Bibliothèque de l’Ecole des Chartes*, 30 (1869), 1–79, at 70; Gilbert Ouy, *Les Manuscrits de l’abbaye de Saint-Victor. Catalogue établi sur la base du répertoire de Claude de Grandrue (1514)*, Bibliotheca Victorina 10/1–2 (Turnhout, 1999), ii, 436.

³⁴ ‘Hic est liber ecclesie beati Victoris parisiensis. uem qui ei abstulerit vel super eo fraudem fecerit sit anathema maranatha.’ The words ‘Victoris parisiensis’ are written by another hand on an erasure.

³⁵ See Carpenter, ‘Account’ 1213 n. 1.

³⁶ The *Libellu* is extant in another composite manuscript, assembled in the Cotton library: MS Cleop. B I. The part containing the *Libellu* (fol. 2r–23v) was certainly written at the same time as the Cotton manuscript of Ralph’s chronicle and layout and handwriting are very similar. More research on this problem is needed.

³⁷ George F. Warner and Julius P. Gilson, *Catalogue of Western Manuscripts in the Old Royal and Kings Collection* (London, 1921), ii, 81–2; Ker, *Medieval Libraries of Great Britain*, 124–5. In 1542 the volume was in the Royal Library (*The Libraries of Henry VII*, ed. James P. Carley, Corpus of British Medieval Library Catalogues 7 [London, 2000], 183, H2.1022). The text breaks off in the narrative for 1213 (ed. Stevenson, 167).

³⁸ Marvin L. Colker, *Trinity College Library Dublin. Descriptive Catalogue of the Mediaeval and Renaissance Latin Manuscript* (Aldershot, 1991), ii, 941–2. So far I have not been able to see this manuscript.

³⁹ For instance London, College of Arms, MS Arundel 24; London, Lambeth Palace Library, MS 371 (from Reading); Cambridge, Trinity College, MS R. 5. 10 (James 704); Dublin, Trinity College, MS 634.

⁴⁰ James, *A Descriptive Catalogue of the Manuscripts in the Library of Corpus Christi College, Cambridge*, ii, 269–77; Reeves, *Influenc*, 93–4; Henry of Kirkestede, *Catalogus de libris authenticis et apocryph*, ed. Richard H. and Mary A. Rouse, Corpus of British Medieval Library Catalogues 11 (London, 2004), lxxvii–lxxxii; and see Kathryn Kerby-Fulton’s essay, in this volume 210; and see Richard H. Rouse, ‘Kirkestede, Henry’, in *Oxford Dictionary of National Biography* (Oxford, 2004), <http://www.oxforddnb.com/view/article/2942> (seen 6 March 2010).

⁴¹ Cambridge, Corpus Christi College, MS 404, fol. 66v.

⁴² Ker, *Medieval Libraries of Great Britain*, 180.

⁴³ See above, n. 16.

⁴⁴ Gransden, *Historical Writing in Englan*, i, 322–31; Hartcher, *Ralph of Coggeshal*, 86–189; Carpenter, ‘Account’; Freeman, *Narratives of a New Orde*, 179–213.

⁴⁵ ‘Anno MCCVII obiit domnus Thomas, abbas quintus de Cogeshal, cui successit domnus Radulfus, monachus ejusdem loci, qui hanc chronicam a captione Sanctae Crucis usque ad annum undecimum Henrici regis III., filii regis Johannis, descripsit, ac quasdam visiones quas a venerabilibus viris audivit, fideliter annotare ob multorum aedificationem curavit.’ Ed. Stevenson, 162–3; Cotton MS, fol. 112r. This note is something of a puzzle, because in its extant form the *Chronico* ends in 1224, not in 1227.

⁴⁶ London, BL, MS Cotton Vesp. D X; see above.

⁴⁷ For instance, the annal for 1137 mentions the marriage of Mary, daughter of King Louis VII of France, to Count Henry I of Champagne; their son Henry II ‘cum rege Philippo profectus est Hierosolymam’ (ed. Stevenson, 10–11; Cotton MS. fol. 48v–49r). This could not have been written before May 1190. The account of how Count Henry II became king of Jerusalem on the instigation of King Richard (May 1192) is added after this sentence in the margin of the Cotton manuscript but is in the text in the Arundel manuscript (ed. Stevenson, 11 n. 1). In the entry for 1181 about the death of king Louis VII, Isabel of Hainault, the first wife of his son Philip II, is mentioned as having died ‘eodem videlicet anno quo idem rex Philippus iter suum in Hierosolymam arripuit’ (ibid., 20; Cotton MS. fol. 52r). Isabel died on 15 March 1190. This entry, however, could belong to a later redaction as fol. 52–3 of the Cotton manuscript have been inserted later, replacing an earlier and shorter version of the text. See below, n. 50.

⁴⁸ In the entry for 1154 Ralph gives the names of King Henry II’s sons and daughters. While in the Cotton manuscript, fol. 50r, the word ‘rege’ for John, possible only after May 1199, is written on an erasure (ed. Stevenson, 14 n. 6; Carpenter, ‘Account, 1214’), it is stated that Matilda’s husband Henry the Lion lost the duchy of Saxony because of his rebellion against Emperor Frederick I, but that it was regained by his son – probably Henry, Count Palatine of the Rhine. This was only possible after summer 1198, when Henry had returned from the crusade and his brother Otto had been crowned German king. See Bernd Ulrich Hucker, *Kaiser Otto I, Monumenta Germaniae Historica: Schriften* 34 (Hannover, 1990), 40–41; Claudia Naumann, *Der Kreuzzug Kaiser Heinrichs VI* (Frankfurt/Main, 1994), 238.

⁴⁹ For instance fol. 58v, ed. Stevenson, 41–2 (42 n. 1).

⁵⁰ Fol. 52–3 have been inserted later. As the annal for 1187 is part of the text on these leaves, Ralph probably added information to a much briefer original account of the loss of the True Cross, the capture of Jerusalem, and the early crusading endeavours. Cf. ed. Stevenson, 19–24 and 19 n. 6. The two folios must have been added at least after June 1190, because Emperor Frederick I’s death is already known (ibid., 24); they might have been added as late as in 1204, because King Philip Augustus of France is called ‘victoriosissimus rex’ (ibid., 19; Carpenter, ‘Account’ 1214 n. 3).

⁵¹ Fol. 59r–v; ed. Stevenson, 38–41.

⁵² This is most striking on fol. 64v–65r, where Ralph considerably increased the account of King Richard’s capture in Austria; as a marginal addition suggests, the new information was gained from ‘Anselmus capellanus, quia haec omnia nobis, ut vidit et audivit, retulit.’ (ed. Stevenson, 53–5, at 54 n. 3).

⁵³ Gransden, *Historical Writin*, i, 323 with n. 23, and Carpenter, ‘Account’, 1227–8, describing the complex codicological situation in the Cotton manuscript.

⁵⁴ Ed. Stevenson, 67–70.

⁵⁵ Ibid., 66: ‘... Talis igitur ultio in ducem suosque divinitus processit.’

⁵⁶ Ibid., 66. Tancred died on 20 February 1194. Henry's and Constance's marriage took place in January 1186. Ralph wrongly states that William II (d. 18 November 1189) was Constance's brother, while she actually was a daughter of King Roger II and therefore his aunt.

⁵⁷ Ibid., 67. On 18 July 1195 the Christian army, led by King Alfonso VIII of Castile, suffered a crushing defeat at Alarcos. Ralph's account includes an interesting reference to a source: 'sicut principes terrae illius capitulo Cisterciensi flebiliter intimaverunt.'

⁵⁸ In A fol. 69ra there is a sign above the words 'esse fatetur' (text I); in the left margin another hand has added the beginning of text II. The same sign can also be found on fol. 85v where it refers the reader to the continuation of the text on an inserted slip of parchment. Fol. 68v-69r are the middle leaves of a quire, the loss of the parchment slip can thus be easily explained.

⁵⁹ Apart from text I, l. 10, which obviously is a printing error.

⁶⁰ Ed. Stevenson, 69 n. 4.

⁶¹ Text II, for which see below, introduces the story of Adam of Perseigne's encounter with Joachim at Rome. Although it supplements the explanation of Joachim's ideas, it clearly interrupts the original narrative and its train of thought. Therefore some scholars even missed Ralph's summary statement, which continues text I after the insertion and believed him to be reluctant with respect to Joachim's perception of history. See, e.g., Grundmann, 'Zur Biographie' 324.

⁶² Ibid., 11: 'Hac tempestate magister Petrus Abaelardus extitit, et magister Gilebertus Porreie, episcopus Pictavis, et Hugo de Sancto Victore.' Gilbert became bishop of Poitiers in 1142.

⁶³ For instance ibid. 36 'Ea vero tempestate'; ibid. 80 'Circa hoc tempus' 'Per idem tempus'.

⁶⁴ Stevenson, 67 n. 3. He also observes a change of the style of writing, but Gransden, *Historical Writin*, i, 323 n. 22 doubts this and I agree with her.

⁶⁵ Frederick Maurice Powicke, 'Roger of Wendover and the Coggeshall Chronicle', *English Historical Review*, 21 (1906), 286–96; Carpenter, 'Account' 1221. The last parallel is Ralph's account of the Muslim invasion in Spain, immediately before the Joachim entry (Stevenson, 67), in Roger Wendover, *The Flowers of History*, ed. Henry G. Hewlett, RS 84/1–3 (London, 1886–89), i, 239. Roger mentions Joachim and his criticism of Peter the Lombard's Trinitarian theology in his account of the Third Lateran Council, but the text is clearly influenced by the text of the Fourth Lateran Council's condemnation of this criticism and it explicitly refers to the conciliar decree: ibid., i, 120–23.

⁶⁶ See above, nn. 48 and 50.

⁶⁷ Freeman, *Narratives of a New Order*, 188.

⁶⁸ 'Pro euocando Joachim dudum Abbate, et Rainerio Monacho, a Generali Capitulo Litterae dirigantur. Si vero usque ad festum Beati Johannis Baptistae [24 June 1193] Cistercium venire contempserint, omnes Abbates et fratres Ordinis nostri eos ut fugitivos deuitent. Hoc autem illis denuntiet aliquis ad D. Papae curiam dirigendus.' *Twelfth-century Statutes from the Cistercian General Chapter*, ed. Chrysogonus Waddell, *Commentarii Cistercienses: Studia et documenta* 12 (Cîteaux, 2002), 250–51 n. 38.

⁶⁹ Cf. the 'Easter vision' (Joachim of Fiore, *Expositio in Apocalypsi* [Venice, 1527], fol. 39va) and the 'Pentecost vision' (Joachim of Fiore, *Psalterium decem cordarum*, ed. Kurt-Victor Selge, MGH Quellen zur Geistesgeschichte des Mittelalters, 20 [Hannover, 2009], 9–10). There is some debate about the exact dates of these visions and which occurred first but this need not concern us here. Cf. Reeves, *Influenc*, 23 n. 1; Robert E. Lerner, *The Feast of Saint Abraham: Medieval Millenarians and the Jew* (Philadelphia, 2001), 8–10; Potestà, *Il Tempo dell'Apocaliss*, 15–16; Julia Eva Wannenmacher, *Hermeneutik der Heilsgeschichte. De septem sigillis und die*

sieben Siegel im Werk Joachims von Fiore, *Studies in the History of Christian Traditions*, 118 (Leiden and Boston, 2005), 22–4; Joachim, *Psalteriu*, ed. Selge, xiv–xvi n. 5.

⁷⁰ *Vita anonyma b. Joachimi abbati*, ed. Grundmann in id., ‘Zur Biographie’ 342–52, at 345–6: While abbot of Corazzo ‘... omnis prudentia eius in spiritalis profectus exercitio versabatur, nullatenus negligere volens gratiam quam accepit; sed meditabatur, eloquebatur et commentabatur in data sibi desuper intelligentia scripturarum ...’; Lucas of Cosenza, *Vita Joachim*, ed. Grundmann, *ibid.*, 352–8, at 353: during his stay at Casamari, Joachim was honoured by all ‘obtentu sapientiae et intelligentiae a Domino sibi datae.’

⁷¹ See above, 156 l.28–32.

⁷² He refers the reader to another commentary to the Apocalypse, written by the Cistercian and early critic of Joachim, Geoffrey of Auxerre (Clairvaux, Hautcombe; died after 1188). See Goffredo di Auxerre, *Super Apocalypsi*, ed. Ferruccio Gastaldelli, *Terni e testi*, 17 (Rome, 1970); and Ferruccio Gastaldelli, ‘Goffredo di Auxerre e Gioacchino da Fiore. Testi e personaggi a confronto,’ in id., *Studi su san Bernardo e Goffredo di Auxerr*, *Millennio Medievale* 30 (Florence, 2001), 375–422 (first in: *Annali della Facoltà di lettere e filosofia. Università di Macerata*, 30–31 [1997–98], 9–60]; and below, n. 91.

⁷³ See above, 159.

⁷⁴ The entry follows a long description of decline and crisis (capture of the Holy Cross and siege of Jerusalem, conflict between Emperor Frederick I and Popes Alexander III and Urban III, decline of monastic discipline and the morals of the people): *Chronic*, ed. Krause, 282–6; Anstruther, 95–6. Because Richard’s accession to the English throne (summer 1189) is mentioned earlier (ed. Krause, 282), the text must have been written at least after that date.

⁷⁵ The last papal document issued in Verona is JL 16003 (22 September 1187). On 3 October the pope was in Ferrara (JL 16005), where he died on 20 October.

⁷⁶ The papal mandate is not extant but mentioned in a letter from Pope Clement III (8 June 1188, JL 16274) and by Joachim himself in his so-called testament. For the texts, see Abbot Joachim of Fiore, *De concordia novi ac veteris testament*, ed. Randolph E. Daniel, *Transactions of the American Philosophical Society* 78/8 (Philadelphia, 1983), 3–6; and cf. *Italia pontificia X: Calabria, Insula*, ed. Dieter Girgensohn (Zurich, 1975), 121–2 nos. 8–11.

⁷⁷ Reeves, *Influenc*, 6 n.4 shows some reservation about this. According to Potestà, *Il Tempo dell’Apocaliss*, 93, the way the mandate is mentioned in Clement III’s letter ‘fa pensare a “mandati” espressi in forma orale e diretta’ which would have required Joachim’s personal presence. From the point of view of papal diplomatics, however, the sentence ‘Cum igitur, iubente et exortante bone memorie Lucio papa predecessore nostro, Expositionem Apocalipsis et Opus concordie inchoasse et postmodum auctoritate domini pape Urbani successoris ipsius composuisse dicaris, caritatem tuam monemus et exhortamur in domino ...’ (as in last note) does not necessarily imply such a conclusion.

⁷⁸ Norbert Backmund, *Die mittelalterliche Geschichtsschreibung des Prämonstratenserorden*, *Bibliotheca analectorum Praemonstratensium* 10 (Averbode, 1972), 260–67; Mireille Chazan, *L’Empire et l’histoire universelle. De Sigebert de Gembloux à Jean de Saint-Victor (XII^e–XIV^e siècle)*, *Etudes d’histoire médiévale* 3 (Paris, 1999), 332–41.

⁷⁹ Robert of Auxerre, *Chronico*, 277 ll. 15–16: ‘Ceterum ea quae subiunximus partim alibi digesta reperimus, partim vel a nobis sunt visa vel certa relatione comperta.’ For the famous prologue to the chronicle, see Mireille Chazan, ‘Le regard d’un historien sur son oeuvre: le préface de la chronique de Robert d’Auxerre’, *Les Prologues médiévaux. Actes du Colloque international organisé par l’Academia Belgica et l’Étrangère de Rome avec le concours de la F.I.D.E.M., Rome 26–28 mars 199*, ed. Jacqueline Hamesse, *Textes et études du moyen âge* 15 (Turnhout, 2000), 189–228.

⁸⁰ In this context it is interesting to note that both explicitly refer to hearsay as a source for Joachim's divine inspiration: 'ut aiunt' (Ralph), 'de quo ferebant' (Robert). Another instance which suggests common sources is the story of Alpais of Cudot: Ralph of Coggeshall, *Chronico*, 125–8; Robert of Auxerre, *Chronico*, 243–4.

⁸¹ George B. Flahiff, 'Ralph Niger. An Introduction to His Life and Works', *Mediaeval Studie*, 2 (1940) 104–26, at 114–15. Unfortunately very little is known about Niger's later life. He was probably dead by 1199.

⁸² 'Priora de historiis et chronicis aliorum excepiimus et pleraque sequentium, verum ea, que prope tempora nostra acciderint vel etiam diebus meis accident, latius expandi secundum ea, que prius audivi aut vidi et a veridicis relatoribus accepi.' Radulfus Niger, *Chronic*, ed. Krause, 259.

⁸³ His chronicle is extant in two redactions, an earlier one published under the name of Benedict of Peterborough: *The Chronicle of the Reigns of Henry II and Richard I. A.D. 1169–1192 known commonly under the name of Benedict of Peterborough*, ed. William Stubbs, 2 vols, RS 49/1–2 (London, 1867) ii, 151–5; and a later one, to be dated after the Third Crusade: *Chronica magistri Rogeri de Houeden*, ed. William Stubbs, 4 vols, RS 51/1–4 (London, 1868–71) iii, 75–9. For Roger of Howden, see – among others – Gransden, *Historical Writing*, i, 222–30; John Gillingham, 'Writing the Biography of Roger of Howden, King's Clerk and Chronicler', *Writing Medieval Biography, 750–1250: Essays in Honour of Professor Frank Barlo*, ed. David Bates, Julia Crick, and Sarah Hamilton (Woodbridge, 2006), 207–20.

⁸⁴ John Gillingham, 'Roger of Howden on Crusade' id., *Richard Cœur de Lion. Kingship, Chivalry and War in the Twelfth Century* (London and Rio Grande, 1994), 141–53 (first in: *Medieval Historical Writing in the Christian and Islamic World*, ed. David O. Morgan [London, 1982], 60–75); David Corner, 'The Gesta Regis Henrici Secundi and Chronica of Roger, Parson of Howden', *Bulletin of the Institute of Historical Research*, 46 (1983), 126–44, at 140. It should be mentioned that the trustworthiness of Roger's account has recently been questioned: Hubert Houben, 'Monarchia normanno-sveva e Ordini riformati (con alcune considerazioni sulla religiosità di Federico II)', *Gioachimismo e profetismo in Sicilia (secoli XIII – XVI). Atti del terzo convegno internazionale di studio, Palermo-Monreale, 14–16 ottobre 2000*, ed. Cosimo Damiano Fonseca (Rome, 2007), 15–28, at 18; but Houben's approach does not sufficiently take into account the context either of the narrative or of the author.

⁸⁵ Robert of Auxerre, *Chronico*, 255 ll. 1–4 (to 1190) : 'Venit ad eos [Kings Richard and Phillip at Messina] abbas Ioachim, de suo evocatus monasterio in Calabria constituto, qui ab eis de futuris sciscitatus respondit, quod mare transituri forent, sed aut nichil aut parum proficerent, necdum adesse tempora, quibus liberanda foret Iherusalem et regio transmarina.' It remains to be explored whether Robert is dependent on Roger of Howden or if he got the information from elsewhere. According to him, Joachim's prophecy about the result of the Third Crusade was more explicitly negative than in both redactions of Roger's chronicle, probably from hindsight.

⁸⁶ Rev. 12:1–6 (the Woman girt with the sun), especially the sevenheaded dragon, whose heads are identified with historical figures and linked to the seven kings in Rev. 17:9–10.

⁸⁷ See, e.g., Reeves, *Influence*, 6–10; Pispisa, *Gioacchino*, 20–24. It is, however, interesting to note that Roger's narrative is a generally correct rendering of Joachim's ideas. Especially with respect to the Antichrist there is a striking parallel in Joachim's commentary to the Apocalypse:

Roger of Howden ('Benedict of Peterborough', ed. Stubbs, ii, 153–154	Joachim of Fiore, <i>Expositio in Apocalypsim</i> (Venice, 1527), fol. 133ra (Apc 9: 11)
<i>Et unus nondum venit</i> (Apc 17: 10), id est	... Multi iam forsitan precesserunt qui essent pro auctoritate perfidie dicendi Antichristi, maxime cum dicat Ioannes utens presenti vel

Antichristus. De isto Antichristo dicit idem abbas de Curacio sentire quod iam natus est, quindecim annos habens a nativitate: sed in potestate sua nondum venit. ... Respondit ei Joachim ... quod Antichristus ille in urbe Romana iam natus esse creditur, et in ea sedem apostolicam obtinebit, de quo dicit Apostolus: <i>et adversatur et extollitur supra omne quod dicitur Deus aut quod colitur; ita ut in templo Dei sedeat, ostendens se tamquam sit Deus. Et tunc revelabitur ille iniquus quem Dominus Iesus interficiet spiritu oris sui, et destruet illustratione adventus sui.</i> (2 Thess 2: 4.8)	preterite pro future (1 John 2:18): <i>Sicut auditis quia Antichristus venit, nunc Antichristi multi facti sunt.</i> Et quia protinus subinfert <i>Unde scimus quia nouissima hora est</i>, sequi non longe post ipsum magnum Antichristum demonstrare, quem ego considerans universas faciès scripturarum et introitus et exitus concordiarum presentem puto esse in mundo, etsi necdum venerit hora reuelationis ipsius. Oportet enim secundum Hieronymum desolari Romanum imperium quod resistit ei antequam reueletur, <i>et tunc</i> (inquit) <i>reuelabitur ille iniquus, cuius est aduentus secundum operationem Sathane in omnibus signis et prodigiis mendacibus</i> (2 Thess 2: 8–9)...
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Joachim's reference to Jerome is either to the commentary on Jeremiah, V, 27, *CCSL* 74 (Turnhout, 1960), 246 or to Ep. 121, 11, *CSEL* 54 (2nd edn, Vienna, 1996), 53–4. Both texts refer to 2 Thess. 2:3–10. Quotations from the same biblical text are in Joachim's *Expositio* and in Roger of Howden. According to Roger, Joachim was reproached by his audience for the assertion that the Antichrist was already born and living in Rome, because it was in contradiction to the traditional doctrine – in the Middle Ages widely available in several versions of Adso of Montier-en-Der's treatise *De ortu et tempore antichristi* (Adso Dervensis, *De ortu et tempore Antichristi*, ed. Daniel Verhelst, *CCCM* 45 [Turnhout, 1976]. In some manuscripts of Roger's chronicle the Joachim-episode is followed by a version of Adso's treatise: *Chronica*, ed. Stubbs, iii, 80–85) – that the Antichrist was to be born in Babylon. It will be remembered that in the accounts of Ralph of Coggeshall, Ralph Niger, and Robert of Auxerre the question of the coming of the Antichrist was of some significance, too: Roger: Antichrist already born in Rome, now 15 years old, not yet in power, will become pope; Ralph of Coggeshall, text I: in 1199 opening of the sixth seal, persecution by Antichrist, his death; Ralph of Coggeshall, text II: Antichrist already born, a youngster living in Rome, his reign is to come soon; Ralph Niger: Day of Judgement, opening of the last seal and coming of Antichrist imminent; Robert of Auxerre: within two generations (60 years) everything that had been foretold about the Antichrist will be fulfilled.

From this comparison it is obvious that Roger's rendering of Joachim's assertion is closest to Ralph of Coggeshall's text II, while the already observed relationship between Ralph's text I, Ralph Niger, and Robert of Auxerre is further confirmed.

⁸⁸ Roger of Howden, *Chronica*, ed. Stubbs, 75: 'Eodem anno Ricardus rex Angliae, audiens per communem famam, et multorum relationem, quod quidam vir religiosus erat in Calabria, dictus Johachim, abbas de Curacio, de ordine Cistrensi, habens spiritum propheticum, et ventura populo praedicebat, misit pro eo ...' In the first redaction the wording is slightly different ('Benedict of Peterborough' ed. Stubbs, 151).

⁸⁹ Grundmann, 'Zur Biographie', 307–8; Matthias Kaup, *De prophetia ignota. Eine frühe Schrift Joachims von Fiore*, MGH Studien und Texte 19 (Hannover, 1998), 2, and *De prophetia ignota*, I, 2, ed. Kaup, 181.

⁹⁰ Kaup, *Deprophetia ignota*.

⁹¹ Geoffrey, born in Auxerre, was a student in Paris and a pupil of Peter Abelard. In 1140 he was converted to the monastic profession by Bernard of Clairvaux, whose secretary he was; he then became successively abbot of Igny, Clairvaux, Fossanova, and finally of Hautecombe. He died in c. 1188. His commentary to the Apocalypse has already been mentioned (supra n. 72). For quick reference, see the article by M.-A. Dimier in *Dictionnaire d'histoire et géographie ecclésiastiques*, 20 (Paris, 1984), col. 529–32.

⁹² Edited in Grundmann, 'Zur Biographie', 358–60; extensive commentary in Gastaldelli, *Goffredo di Auxerre e Gioacchino da Fiore*, 387–406.

⁹³ Edited in Pietro De Leo, *Gioacchino da Fiore: Aspetti inediti della vita e delle opere*, Biblioteca di storia e cultura meridionale: Studietesti 1 (Soveria Mannelli, 1988), 135–48. Cf. Gian Luca Potestà, 'Ger. 24 nell'interpretazione di Gioacchino da Fiore', *La cattura della fine. Variazioni dell'escatologia in regime di christianità*, ed. Giuseppe Ruggieri, Testi e ricerche di scienze religiose, n.s. 7 (Genoa, 1992), 65–88.

⁹⁴ The text was found and published for the first time by Philippe Buc, *L'Ambiguïté du livre. Prince, pouvoir, et peuple dans Us commentaires de la Bible au moyen âge*, Théologie historique 95 (Paris, 1994), 164 n. 96: '... Persecutio gentilium manet donec mare rubrum, id est ignem iudicii Christo duce et iudice, transeamus. Qui vero christianos persequuntur, cum rege suo antiquo in stagno ignis submerguntur eterniter. Sic et ille Ioachim comparans status ecclesie ante adventum Christi, in quo consummatio [fuit], statibus et eventibus eius [ecclesie] post adventum Christi predicat iam imminere adventum antichristi in qua consummatio et destructio boni [sic, bonorum]. Sed predicta comparatio inutilis videtur et incongrua, eo quod Hebrei non sunt afflicti afflicto Egipto.' In its Joachite context it was discussed by Robert Lerner, 'Joachim and the Scholastics', *Gioacchino da Fiore tra Bernardo di Clairvaux e Innocenzo III. Atti del 5° Congresso internazionale di studi gioachimiti, S. Giovanni in Fiore, 16–21 settembre 1999*, ed. Roberto Rusconi, Opere di Gioacchino da Fiore: testi e strumenti 13 (Rome, 2001), 251–64.

⁹⁵ Lerner, 'Joachim and the Scholastics', 257.

⁹⁶ Already Bloomfield and Reeves, 'Penetration' 775–6 and 781 emphasized the accuracy of both Coggeshall and Robert in describing Joachim's ideas. However, they did not arrive at any conclusions with respect to the sources used.

⁹⁷ E.g. Hugh of St Victor: see Patrice Sicard, *Diagrammes médiévaux et exégèse visuelle. Le Libellus de formatione arche de Hugues de Saint-Victor*, Bibliotheca Victorina 4 (Paris and Turnhout, 1993) and, more generally, *Die Bildwelt der Diagramme Joachims von Fiore. Zur Medialität religiös-politischer Programme im Mittelalter*, ed. Alexander Patschovsky (Ostfildern, 2003).

⁹⁸ The most important manuscript is Oxford, Corpus Christi College, MS 255A, accessible via the Internet: <http://image.ox.ac.uk/show?collection=corpus&manuscript=ms255a> (seen 27 February 2011). See *Il libro delle figure dell'abbate Gioacchino da Fiore*, ed. Leone Tondelli, Marjorie Reeves and Beatrice Hirsch-Reich, 2 vols (2nd edn, Turin, 1953); Marjorie Reeves and Beatrice Hirsch-Reich, *The Figurae of Joachim of Fiore*, Oxford-Warburg Studies (Oxford, 1972); Fabio Troncarelli, 'Il *Liber figurarum*: Osservazioni ed ipotesi' in *Roma, Magistra Mundi. Itinera Culturae medievalis. Mélanges offerts au Père L. E. Boyle à l'occasion de son 75e anniversaire*, ed. Jacqueline Hamesse, 3 vols, Textes et études du moyen âge 10 (Louvain-la-Neuve, 1998), ii, 927–49; id., 'Il *Liber figurarum* tra "gioachimiti" e "gioachimisti"', *Gioacchino da Fiore tra Bernardo di Clairvaux e Innocenzo III. Atti del So Congresso internazionale di studi gioachimiti, S. Giovanni in Fiore, 16–21 settembre 1999*, ed. Roberto Rusconi, *Opere di Gioacchino da Fiore: testi e strumenti* 13 (Rome, 2001), 267–86; Marco Rainini, *Disegni dei tempi. Il Liber Figurarum' e la teologia figurativa di Gioacchino da Fiore*, *Opere di Gioacchino da Fiore: testi e strumenti* 18 (Rome, 2006).

⁹⁹ This is the name used by Reeves and Hirsch Reich. Rainini, *Disegni*, 221 calls the diagram 'Albero delle generazioni ascendenti' and dates it to 1185.

¹⁰⁰ Oxford, Corpus Christi College, MS 255A, fol. 5v–6r; *Liber figurarum*, ed. Tondelli, Reeves, and Hirsch-Reich, tav. IX–X.

¹⁰¹ For a short description of the manuscript, see Wannenmacher, *Hermeneutik*, 285.

¹⁰² Joachim's works included in this manuscript are not easily recognizable from the description in Joseph Van den Gheyn, *Catalogue des manuscrits de la Bibliothèque royale de Belgique*, ii (Brussels, 1902), 56–7 n. 986; the manuscript was therefore until recently unknown to Joachimite scholarship. The texts were first identified in Thomas Falmagne, *Un texte en contexte: Les Flores Paradisi et le milieu culturel de Villers-en-Brabant dans la première moitié du 13e siècle*, *Instrumenta patristica et mediaevalia*, 39 (Turnhout, 2001), 497–99 (I am grateful to Valeria de Fraja [Padua], who drew my attention to this book). Falmagne's otherwise excellent description is inaccurate inasfar he identifies the Pope Innocent mentioned as the last pope in the list as Pope Innocent V and therefore dates the manuscript to after 1276. The pope is Innocent III; as his name had been added by another hand, the manuscript might well have been written before 1198.

¹⁰³ This very short description can by no means do justice to the complex conceptual background of the diagram. A thorough discussion can be found in Reeves, Hirsch-Reich, *Figurae*, 130–41; Rainini, *Disegni*, 37–66.

¹⁰⁴ The text was first published by Jeanne Bignami Odier under the title *Epistula subsequenterum figurarum*, but she did not believe it to be authentic (Jeanne Bignami Odier, 'Notes sur deux manuscrits de la Bibliothèque du Vatican contenant des traités inédits de Joachim de Fiore', *Mélanges d'archéologie et d'histoire*, 54 [1937], 211–41, at 224–6). Its true character was recognized by Stephen E. Wessley, 'A New Writing of Joachim of Fiore: Preliminary Observations', *Prophecy and Eschatology*, ed. Michael Wilks, *Studies in Church History: Subsidia* 10 (Oxford, 1994), 15–27 (also in *Florensia*, 7 (1993, 39–58); it was edited and further discussed by Gian Luca Potestà, 'Die Genealogia. Ein frühes Werk Joachims von Fiore und die Anfänge seines Geschichtsbildes', *Deutsches Archiv für Erforschung des Mittelalters*, 56 (2000), 55–101.

¹⁰⁵ The original text is preserved in Paris, BNF, MS lat. 11864 fol. 151va–152va (see above, 168) and Zwettl, Stiftsbibliothek, MS 326, fol. 8vb–9vb. Paris, BNF, MS. lat. 3595 and Rome, BAV, MS Vat. lat. 3822 have a revised version, followed by two diagrams titled *figura arboris*.

¹⁰⁶ These considerations are the background to the famous calculations of the year of the coming of Antichrist as being 1260: *Genealogia*, ed. Potestà, 92 (and 67 n. 47).

¹⁰⁷ In *De Septem sigillis*, ed. in Wannenmacher, *Hermeneutik*, 347, the text is described as *carta*; cf. *ibid.*, 250–51, about this notion. Cf. Rainini, *Disegni*, 65, who arrives at a similar conclusion.

¹⁰⁸ I would, however, like to emphasize that I am not asserting that it was the Brussels' manuscript which Ralph or Robert had been using.

¹⁰⁹ See above, 167.

¹¹⁰ See above, 150.

¹¹¹ With a short interruption fol. 114v l. 27 – 115r l. 8.

¹¹² *Chronicon*, ed. Stevenson, 164–83.

¹¹³ See above, 158 l. 13.

¹¹⁴ Compare 'Innocentius' (abbreviated as i[n]noc[e]ntius) to 'Innocentio' (abbreviated the same way) on fol. 113v l. 10, and 'successore(m)' to *ibid.* l. 13 'successoribus'.

¹¹⁵ This had already been argued by Marjorie Reeves – see above, 146.

¹¹⁶ See above, 166.

¹¹⁷ Christoph Egger, 'Joachim von Fiore, Rainer von Ponza und die römische Kurie', *Gioacchino da Fiore tra Bernardo di Clairvaux e Innocenzo III Atti del 5° Congresso internazionale di studi gioachimiti, S. Giovanni in Fiore, 16–21 settembre 1999*, ed. Roberto Rusconi, *Opere di Gioacchino da Fiore: testi e strumenti* 13 (Rome, 2001), 129–62, at 135–6.

¹¹⁸ In two charters issued by King Richard in 1196 (of dubious authenticity) and 1198 in favour of Perseigne Adam is mentioned as 'dilectus confessor noster': Gabriel Fleury, *Cartulaire de l'abbaye cistercienne de Perseigne précédé d'une notice historique* (Mamers, 1880), 34–8 n. 14; 39–43 n. 15. A short biography of Adam can be found in *Lettres d'Adam de Perseigne*, ed. Jean Bouvet, *Sources chrétiennes* 66 (Paris, 1960), 7–29.

¹¹⁹ In 1199 Adam was one of the papal envoys who were to act as intermediaries between King Richard and his half-brother Archbishop Geoffrey of York (*Die Register Innocenz' III. 2. Pontifikatsjahr*, ed. Othmar Hageneder et al., *Publikationen des Österreichischen Kulturinstituts in Rom* II/i, 2 [Rome and Vienna, 1999], 102–4n.55 [57, 58]). In 1201 he was charged with an inquiry about the legal status of a crusader and servant of King John (Christopher R. Cheney and Mary G. Cheney, *The Letters of Pope Innocent III. concerning England and Wales. A Calendar* [Oxford, 1967], 58 n. 356); in 1208 he and the abbot of the Cistercian abbey of Le Pin were to negotiate a truce between King John and King Phillip Augustus of France (*Die Register Innocenz' III. 11. Pontifikatsjahr*, ed. Othmar Hageneder et al., *Publikationen des historischen Instituts beim Österreichischen Kulturforum in Rom* II/i, 11 [Vienna, 2010] 39–40n.28 [30,31]).

¹²⁰ *Twelfth-century Statutes*, ed. Waddell, 337–8 n. 56 (for 1195). Adam was also involved in the proceedings leading to King Richard's only Cistercian foundation, the abbey of Bonport: *ibid.*, 195 n. 7 (for 1190).

¹²¹ Cf. Harald Müller, *Päpstliche Delegationsgerichtsbarkeit in der Normandie (12. und frühes 13. Jahrhundert)*, *Studien und Dokumente zur Gallia Pontificia* 4/1–2 (Bonn, 1997), index.

¹²² Jacques de Vitry, *Historia occidentalis*, ed. John F. Hinnebusch, *Spicilegium Friburgense* 17 (Fribourg, 1972), 102–3; Coggeshall, *Chronicon*, for 1201, ed. Stevenson, 129–30; *Twelfth-century Statutes*, ed. Waddell, 493–4 n. 35 (for 1201); Alberto Forni, 'La "nouvelle prédication" des disciples de Foulques de Neuilly: intentions, techniques et réactions', *Faire croire. Modalités de la diffusion et de la réception des messages religieuses du XII^e au XV^e siècle*, *Collection de l'Ecole française de Rome* 51 (Rome, 1981), 19–37.

¹²³ Alfred J. Andrea, 'Adam of Perseigne and the Fourth Crusade', *Cîteaux*, 86 (1985), 21–37.

¹²⁴ For the sermons, see Johannes B. Schneyer, *Repertorium der lateinischen Sermones des Mittelalters für die Zeit von 1150–1350*, vol. i, Beiträge zur Geschichte der Philosophie und Theologie des Mittelalters 43,1 (Münster, 1969), 46–8. The letter collection is edited in Jean Bouvet, *Correspondance d'Adam, abbé de Perseigne (1188–1221)*, Archives historiques du Maine 13 (Le Mans, 1951–62). A partial edition is *Lettres d'Adam de Perseigne*, ed. Bouvet.

¹²⁵ Andrea, 'Adam of Perseigne and the Fourdi Crusade' 31.

¹²⁶ For the development of the theological theory of prophecy and revelation, see Paul Alphandéry, 'De quelques faits de prophétisme dans les sectes latines antérieures au joachimisme' *Revue de l'histoire des religions*, 52 (1905), 177–218; Marianne Schlosser, *Lucerna in caliginoso loco. Aspekte des Prophetie-Begriffes in der scholastischen Theologie*, Veröffentlichungen des Grabmann-Institutes zur Erforschung der Mittelalterlichen Theologie und Philosophie, n.s., 43 (Paderborn, 2000); Jean-Pierre Torrell, *Recherches sur la théorie de la prophétie au moyen âge. XIIe–XIVe siècles*, Dokimion 13 (Fribourg, 1992).

¹²⁷ Text II, see above, p. 158 l. 1. A detailed analysis of Joachim's approach can be found in Gian Luca Potestà, 'Intelligentia Scripturarum und Kritik des Prophetismus bei Joachim von Fiore', *Neue Richtungen in der hoch- und spätmittelalterlichen Bibelexegese*, ed. Robert E. Lerner, Schriften des Historischen Kollegs: Kolloquien 32 (Munich, 1996), 95–119 [Italian version: 'Progresso della conoscenza teologica e critica del profetismo in Gioacchino da Fiore', *Cristianesimo nella storia* 17 (1996), 305–34].

¹²⁸ Cassiodorus, *Expositiopsalmorum*, Praefatioc. 1. *Magni Aurelii Cassiodori expositio psalmorum*, ed. M. Adriaen, CCSL 97–8 (Turnhout, 1958), i, 9. Cf. Potestà, 'Intelligentia', 96–7. Cassiodorus' text was quoted in the *Glossa ordinaria* to the Psalms (Strasbourg, 1480–81, repr. Turnhout, 1992), ii, 457.

¹²⁹ See above, 161.

¹³⁰ Bernard of Clairvaux, *Ep.* 56: '... Verum de Antichristo cum inquirerem quid sentiret, durante adhuc ea, quae nunc est, generatione revelandum illum esse certissime se scire protestatus est. At cum eamdem certitudinem unde haberet, sciscitanti mihi, exponere vellet, audito quod respondit, non me illud pro certo credere debere putavi. Ad summam tamen hoc asseruit, non visurum se mortem, nisi prius videat generalem in Ecclesia persecutionem.' *S. Bernardi opera vii: Epistolae i*, ed. J. Lerclercq and H. Rochais (Rome, 1974), 148; and see Hans-Werner Goetz, 'Eschatologische Vorstellungen und Reformziele bei Bernhard von Clairvaux und Norbert von Xanten', id., *Vorstellungsgeschichte. Gesammelte Schriften zu Wahrnehmungen, Deutungen und Vorstellungen im Mittelalter*, ed. Anna Aurast et al. (Bochum, 2007), 75–88 (first in: *Zisterziensische Spiritualität. Theologische Grundlagen, funktionale Voraussetzungen und bildhafte Ausprägungen im Mittelalter*, ed. Clemens Kasper, Klaus Schreiner, Studien und Mitteilungen aus dem Benediktinerorden, Ergänzungsband 34 [St Ottilien, 1994], 153–69).

¹³¹ See above, 165.

¹³² 'Salutat uos ecclesia quae est in Babylone conelecta et Marcus filius meus. Babylonem typice Romam dici, uidelicet propter confusionem multiplicis idolatriae in cuius medio sancta ecclesia iam rudis et perparua fulgebat...' Beda Venerabilis, *In epistolas VII catholicas. In epistolam I beati Petri*, ed. D. Hurst, CCSL 121 (Turnhout, 1983), 259. Also in the *Glossa ordinaria* to the Bible (Strasbourg, 1480–81, repr. Turnhout, 1992), iv, 528.

¹³³ As already has been shown it is very likely an addition to the text, although almost contemporary and by the same hand. See above, 173.

¹³⁴ For instance Joachim, *Expositio in Apocalypsim*, fol. 133ra (quoted above, n. 87). For Joachim's 'Antichristology' see Raoul Manselli, 'Il problema del doppio Anticristo in Gioacchino da Fiore' id., *Da Gioacchino da Fiore a Cristoforo Colombo. Studi sul*

Francescanesimo spirituale, sull'ecchiologia e sull'escatologismo bassomedievali, ed. Paolo Vian, *Nuovi studi storici* 36 (Rome, 1997), 509–32 (first in: *Geschichtsschreibung und geistiges Leben im Mittelalter Festschrift für Heinz Löwe zum 65. Geburtstag*, ed. Karl Hauck and Hubert Mordek [Cologne and Vienna, 1978], 427–49); Robert Lerner, 'Antichrists and Antichrist in Joachim of Fiore', *Speculum*, 60 (1985), 553–70; Julia Eva Wannenmacher, 'Die Macht des Bösen. Zur Rolle und Bedeutung des Antichristen in der Eschatologie Joachims von Fiore' *Gioacchino da Fiore tra Bernardo di Clairvaux e Innocenzo III. V Congresso internazionale di studi gioachimiti. Comunicazioni, Florensia*, 13/14 (1999/2000), 365–78.

¹³⁵ The ultimate consequence is the idea of an Angel pope, elaborated later in the thirteenth century. Cf. Bernard McGinn, 'Angel Pope and Papal Antichrist', id., *Apocalypticism in the Western Tradition*, Variorum Collected Studies Series 430 (London, 1994), V (first in: *Church History*, 47 [1978], 155–73).

¹³⁶ Oxford, Corpus Christi College, MS 255A, fol. 5v-6r; *Liber figurarum*, ed. Tondelli, Reeves, and Hirsch-Reich, tav. IX-X.

¹³⁷ Rainini, *Disegni*, 46–50.

¹³⁸ *Ibid.*, 252.

¹³⁹ Dresden, Sächsische Landes- und Universitätsbibliothek, MS A 121, fol. 91r; Rainini, *Disegni*, 268. Celestin III's second successor was Honorius III (1216–27).

¹⁴⁰ Paris, BNF, MS lat. 11864, fol. 151v; Rainini, *Disegni*, 275. Innocent III's fifth successor was Alexander IV (1254–61), thus suggesting the middle of the thirteenth century as date of this copy.

¹⁴¹ Brussels, Bibliothèque royale, MS II 924, fol. Br; see above, n. 102. Innocent III's second successor was Pope Gregory IX (1227–41).

¹⁴² Potestà, *Il tempo dell'apocalisse*, 24 with n. 1, to quote only the most recent biography.

PART III

Joachim of Fiore's Influence in Early
Modern Europe

Chapter 9

English Joachimism and its Codicological Context: A List of Joachite Manuscripts of English Origin or Provenance before 1600¹

Kathryn Kerby-Fulton

England has always been the poor cousin in Joachimist studies,² partly owing to the perception that there is not much evidence of Insular awareness of the abbot's works, and, more importantly, that what there is often does not reveal serious understanding of his unique, optimistic theology of history. This, as the material collected here suggests, is an unwarranted assumption. The evidence of actual manuscript survival shows a complex pattern of sustained Insular fascination with Joachim's legacy, which is equally mixed, however, with a heightened alertness to the perceived dangers of Joachite thought. The evidence, in short, shows both active transmission, and active *suppression* or concealment – perhaps some of the most wary in Europe.

This short historical sketch that precedes the List itself is meant as a convenient digest or micro-history of what is known of English Joachimism, into which I have inserted brief references, wherever possible, to some of the manuscript material listed below. Many of the historical events and allusions to Joachite thought are described in more detail

elsewhere, often by Marjorie Reeves and Morton Bloomfield, several most recently in my own *Books under Suspicion: Censorship and Tolerance of Revelatory Writing in Late Medieval England* (to which this List forms a kind of companion). Except in the very few instances indicated, I have seen all these manuscripts, and I offer here as much codicological information as I can in the footnotes to it. But many of these manuscripts have not received the kind of prolonged textual analysis they deserve. Many will have parent or sibling manuscripts in Continental libraries that have not yet been identified. A good example is the link between a thirteenth-century manuscript owned and annotated by Pierre de Limoges, now Paris BNF, MS lat. 16397, which as Nicole Bériou has shown, was probably the exemplar for a fourteenth-century manuscript owned by Richard Kilvington, Dean of St Paul's, BL, MS Royal 8. F. XVI (see List below). Both contain a rare set of excerpts from Joachim's original works, perhaps even once redacted from Gerard of Borgo San Donnino's infamous *Liber introductorius*, along with a copy of the equally rare Protocol of Anagni.³ Without the various marginal and ownership clues the Paris manuscript provides, neither Marjorie Reeves nor I had been able to make sense fully of the English one, Kilvington's *Liber excerptionum abbatis Joachim*.⁴ My hope is that by setting out the List of Insular manuscripts, more such connections can be made by those familiar with the rich repositories of Joachimism on the Continent.

An Introductory Sketch of the History of Joachimism in England through Its English Manuscripts

As Marjorie Reeves and Morton Bloomfield showed in their classic article of 1954, England figures very early and very prominently in the history of Joachimism.⁵ During his own lifetime Joachim's first non-Italian audience was made up of the English (that is, the Anglo-Normans) in Richard the Lionhearted's entourage during the Third Crusade, and so it came to be that English chroniclers were among the very earliest in Europe to record Joachim's novel views.⁶ Englishmen also provide our earliest accounts of the condemnation of his Trinitarian opinions in 1215 at the Lateran Council. Among these Roger of Wendover, writing within a decade or so of the condemnation, is an especially precious witness because he actually quotes from Joachim's lost condemned book, *De Unitate*, in a remarkably even-

handed and well-informed discussion.⁷ Less friendly is perhaps one of the earliest accounts of the condemnation extant anywhere, a hostile poem copied c. 1220–1230 in a manuscript alongside poetry of the Austin prior of Canons' Ashby (see MS Bodl. 40 in the List below).

A few lines from the poem (or 'poem' – really a compilation of phrases from the condemnation) will suggest the unfortunate tone. In the manuscript, it follows a copy of the Creed, and begins rhetorically:

Creditis, o fratres, hec omnia? Credimus. Ergo
Abbatis Joachim dampnamus scripta, Magistri
Petri Lombardi scriptis contraria...⁸

It proceeds through the theological analysis of the question, and ends:

...Hos ergo conciliante
Sacri concilii sinodo credendo fatemur
Cum Petro contra Joachim...
Joachim reprobamus. [my emphasis]

What had begun as really no more than an academic disputation had come to condemnation, sadly for Joachim's reputation, in the great Lateran Council in 1215. And, as English reformers took the tenets of the Council very seriously, using them as the basis for a national initiative in pastoral reform, it appears that what was a minor theme elsewhere in Europe in the later reception of Joachim was sharply magnified in England.

The English were to remain very interested in Joachim's censure, although not always unempathetically. Alongside the unique survival of the Bodley 40 poem in England we must place another unique Insular survival, the *Liber contra lombardum*. Whether or not its author reflects Joachim's condemned Trinitarian views (as its modern editor Ottaviano thought), or whether he simply arrives at a similar position via a return to older, patristic methods like Joachim's (as Fiona Robb has suggested more recently),⁹ the text remains a valuable witness to the aftermath of the dispute. The only copy extant anywhere today has been preserved in Balliol College, Oxford, and, though written in an English hand of the early fourteenth-century, bears a striking collection of Continental twelfth-century theologians, including Abelard, that other great twelfth-century thinker who laboured under censure (see MS Balliol 296 in the List below).

When censure struck Joachimism again in the Scandal of the Eternal Evangel in 1254, it was also an Englishman, this time chronicler Matthew

Paris, who was the first historian in Europe to record it – in fact, before 1256.¹⁰ An important factor here is that Matthew was a great promoter of anti-mendicantism; he had already copied to that end a unique versification of Hildegard of Bingen's Cologne prophecy (as non-poetic, we might add, as the Ashby poem).¹¹ In fact, anti-mendicantism was to account for an unusually large share of English interest in Joachimism for the rest of the Middle Ages.¹² Mid-century was the period, of course, when attitudes towards Joachimism were in a dramatic state of flux everywhere. England's best theologians debated it, just as in Paris, and Joachimism created enthusiasms as well as disagreements there, as everywhere.¹³ Roger Bacon's advocacy of Joachimism is well known, as is the fact that Adam Marsh had enthusiastically sent copies of Joachim's works to Grosseteste sometime before 1253.¹⁴ But perhaps less well known is the impact in England of Olivi's one-time teacher at Paris, the Franciscan John Pecham. By the 1270s the Insular tide once again was running against Joachim, with Archbishop John Pecham's influential warnings of the dangers of both Joachim and Hildegard, especially in his high-profile debates with his Dominican predecessor, Robert Kilwardby.¹⁵ The clash of these attitudes is epitomized in an interesting early fourteenth-century English manuscript, Bodleian Library, MS Lat. Misc. c. 75 (see List), which preserves Pecham's works bound in with both pro- and anti-mendicant writings, including Joachite items (works by Arnold of Villanova and 'Joachim' all delivered in a riot of misattributions).¹⁶

This collection was associated with The Queen's College, Oxford, soon to be the academic home of John Wyclif. Later English scholastic thinkers from Archbishop Pecham to Wyclif, now a hundred years on, participated in a dismissive denunciation of Joachite apocalypticism that crossed party lines. This kind of opposition stemmed at least in part, as I suggested elsewhere, from the predisposition of their scholastic training.¹⁷ But it also stemmed in part from the threat that Joachimism appeared to pose to the respectability of both thirteenth-century Franciscanism and fourteenth-century Wycliffism.¹⁸

English Joachimism, however, did have its brighter moments. The *Columbinus Prophecy*, with its complex Joachimist calculations and dire warning about the decline of the papacy, is copied in record numbers of Insular manuscripts, far outrunning Continental interest (see the List below).¹⁹ Although it ends with a gloomy prediction of chaos and disgrace

for the papacy and clergy, it does carry a genuine Joachimist message of Third Status reform and world peace, elaborated at the beginning of the Seventh Seal ('et tunc incipiet septimum signaculum in quo erit omnis pax et tranquillitas'²⁰). The *Apocalypse Commentarius* of Henry of Costesy, whom David Burr has memorably named 'next to Olivi, the most Joachimite Franciscan commentator whose works have survived', was also very popular in England to judge from the numbers of extant manuscripts and citations (see List below).²¹ The manuscripts themselves can tell us a riveting story of itinerant Franciscans passionate about Henry's Joachimite schemas, clearly carrying the commentary with them in tiny but fat vade mecum books, and sometimes hiding its authorship. These are heavily abbreviated, and full of the kinds of diagrams that make Henry's work even *look* Joachimite on the page. Sadly for us, Henry wrote his Apocalypse commentary after he had been cited to Avignon in 1330 under suspicion of heresy, and it is interesting to speculate on how different the commentary would have been had he written it earlier. His arrest came along with that of three other Franciscan lecturers at Cambridge, as John XXII's campaign against Olivi and the Spiritual wing of the order was well under way. Henry was released, but his Apocalypse commentary, while rich in Joachimist historical exegesis of Salvation History's remote past, bears the mark of striking reticence about applications of Joachimist theology to the history of his *own* (sixth) period. His references to the Third Status are oblique, and he is more comfortable talking about the role of gifted new spiritual order ('quidam ordo... qui habebit donum spiritualem'²²) in the conversion of the non-Christian peoples, than in overt discussion of the upcoming *status*. As Mariorie Reeves wrote when noting his reticence about mentioning the Third Status directly, 'Henry wanted the whole play of *Hamlet* – without *Hamlet*.'²³

We now know why. This was not a good moment in history to advertise radical views. As Decima Douie showed, the papal letters regarding Henry's arrest are mingled with those dealing with Ockham, who was perhaps the prize fugitive whom John XXII was really hoping to catch in England in 1330.²⁴ Henry's legacy, however, is a rich one: his text continued to be copied, albeit, as the manuscripts (like many English Joachimite manuscripts) show, with careful attempts to hide authorship.²⁵ As much as a hundred years later the Carmelite Alan of Lynn (confessor to Margery Kempe) created a full index for it, even as his Provincial, Thomas

Netter, condemned Wyclif as an heir of the heresy of Joachim.²⁶ This is perhaps typical of the kind of ‘clash of cultures’ in which Joachimist works were read in England.

Anti-mendicantism, especially from the 1350s onwards, brought renewed Joachite transmission into medieval England and Ireland. In the 1350s, the codicological evidence supplements our scantier historical sources indicating that the anti-mendicant propagandists were using the Joachimist leanings of certain fraternal orders against them.²⁷ This is most apparent in the case of the Dean of St Paul’s, Richard Kilvington (chief aide to FitzRalph) and virulent anti-mendicant campaigner, who, as we saw above, owned a copy of the now extremely rare Protocol of Anagni (see MS Royal 8. F. XVI in List below). This is preceded in the manuscript with an anthology of genuine and pseudonymous Joachite writings, in which it looks like some attempt has been made by the compiler to slightly play down ideas of the Third Status.²⁸ Oddly, as I have shown elsewhere, every leaf in the entire manuscript bears Kilvington’s name – an unusual, and likely protective device in the event that any bifolium of this unbound and rather suspect book go astray.²⁹ In 1358 Kilvington’s ally FitzRalph was consulted regarding the unprecedented case of an Austin friar, campaigning for disendowment at Oxford, not only within the university but also, as the charges tell us, by courting powerful laity outside.³⁰ The friar, whose name was probably John Kedington, was not only condemned and forced to recant but was also subsequently debarred from lecturing at the university. Whether Joachite ideas were directly involved is difficult to tell, but mounting circumstantial evidence suggests that it would be unwise to rule it out.³¹

Joachite manuscripts dealing with disendowment issues were pouring into England throughout the fourteenth century. English copies of Rupescissa’s writings, which sensationally predicted the forcible stripping away of clerical wealth, are very common.³² As can be seen from the List below, some English copies are so early they were made while Rupescissa was still in prison. Moreover, the extent of contemporary insular engagement with his message can be gauged by copious marginalia, and by the way his *Vade mecum* becomes intertwined with the transmission of a pro-Franciscan chronicle, the *Eulogium historiarum*.³³

Perhaps more striking is the English fascination with Pseudo-Joachite works that speak of violent despoliation of clerical wealth and chastisement

of the clergy. Copies of or extracts from *Super Esaiam*, and most especially the *De oneribus prophetarum*, blossom in English libraries at this time. Of the three major Pseudo-Joachite texts of the mid-thirteenth century (*Super Hieremiam*, *De oneribus prophetarum*, and *Super Esaiam*), *De oneribus* is by far the most popular. *Super Hieremiam* is the earliest of these – it is quoted in England, but no copy (to my knowledge) of certain English provenance survives. In addition to the disapproval that these texts had heaped upon the papacy in the figures of Caiaphas and Zedekiah, they also court calls for the confiscation of church wealth (often by reworking of the gospel scene in which Peter is naked in John 21:7). This image and others like it become increasingly violent in *De oneribus prophetarum* (written 1255–56) and *Super Esaiam* (written between 1260 and 1266). Moreover, as Reeves observed, these last two works show ‘no hint of [Joachim’s] transformation of the papacy in the new age’.³⁴ And, therefore perhaps, it is no accident that they were by far the most popular in late medieval England, a land fraught with anti-papal sentiment. In fact, another popular Joachite treatise, the *Vaticinia de Summis Pontificibus*, has such an interesting English transmission as to have provoked speculation that it originated there.³⁵

It was sometime between 1358 (when the Austin friar was condemned) and 1369 – long before Wyclif’s campaign – that the tables began to turn, and the fraternal forces advocating disendowment agendas began to get the upper hand. In 1369 renewed struggles with France brought new political pressure to bear on the possibility of confiscating clerical possessions. The Austin friars, among whom, as Marjorie Reeves established long ago, Joachim had a serious following, were some of the most important collectors of Joachite texts in England.³⁶ Indeed, in 1371 two Austin friars laid a disendowment bill before Parliament,³⁷ and by 1373 a Great Council would be called by the Black Prince to discuss the clerical rights to temporal possessions. In the colourful account of this council given in the *Eulogium historiarum* (which, we will remember, travels in close association with John of Rupescissa in three manuscripts), the friars are portrayed as victorious, the Black Prince as brutal towards the non-cooperative ‘possessionist’ clergy, who are firmly silenced.³⁸

Both disendowment and clerical poverty are issues that were much disputed in England during these years, and especially as Wycliffism became more public, about the time of the Great Schism in 1378. These

were also the issues for which not only Rupescissa's but Olivi's exegesis was known. Wyclif had the support of many of the friars until about 1381, when the condemnation of his eucharistic doctrines by William Barton, Chancellor of Oxford, seriously dented the enthusiasm of both of the friars and the nobility – the two groups, that is, most interested in pursuing disendowment causes. In 1382 the right to dispute this and other topics was withdrawn from the university.³⁹

This is the backdrop against which in 1389 the authorities were seeking to suppress writings conveying Joachimism from, it appears, two opposite directions: in William of St Amour's anti-mendicant eschatology, and in Franciscan Joachites like Olivi and Rupescissa. And they were even concerned to suppress the Franciscan Michaelists' ideology in writers like William Ockham. A Wycliffite work of that year, the *Opus arduum*, while lashing out against Joachim for heretical depravity, complains bitterly of the confiscation of these four other writers.⁴⁰ These thinkers, to us astonishingly different, suddenly oddly yoked together, were all considered dangerous to the status quo in the 1380s -and more so than even Wycliffism. All four had a history of really significant challenge to the church at a time when Wycliffism was still a vague university movement, with yet vaguer associations to the Rising of 1381. Interestingly, among institutions holding such texts, the Oxford Franciscan House is actually recorded in the fourteenth-century union catalogue of English libraries as owning two of Joachim's works (see Attestations list below), but there, as we are told by the author of the *Opus arduum*, works like Olivi's and Rupescissa's were being kept behind deadlocked doors.⁴¹

Was it, then, generally considered dangerous to own works by Joachim? Here our evidence is mixed and not yet fully sifted, but given how relatively common his works were, in England one should perhaps not overly stress the 'danger'. So, for instance, the compiler of the country's first great union catalogue, Henry of Kirkstede (also the maker of a splendid prophetic anthology, Cambridge, Corpus Christi College, MS 404), was clearly well informed about Joachim's other works, but not about their whereabouts. He lists their titles at length, but gives no other English locations beyond Oxford's Franciscan house, for which he notes the *Liber Concordiae* and the *Super Apocalypsim*. Moreover, Oxford may have acquired its justly famous *Liber Figurarum* (now Corpus Christi College MS 255A) prior to the sixteenth century, when it is recorded at Balliol

College, but we do not know (see List below). But one could very easily have studied Joachim and Joachite thought in more than one college of Oxford: according to the Attestations list alone (see below), in addition to those already noted, Balliol College had a rich collection, including some of Joachim's minor works and major works 'in Apocalypsin' and 'in Psalterium'; Oriel College had 'Excerptiones librorum abbatis Ioachim', according to John Bale; and Merton College, famous for its astronomy, had Arnold of Villanova and other works more loosely associated with prophecy. In the fifteenth century one could have found a chained copy of Olivi's *Postilla* on Matthew (see New College, MS 49) at Gloucester College, Oxford, and as Sylain Piron kindly informs me, a Merton College fellow copied another work by Olivi amidst texts relating to the Wycliffite controversies (see MS Bodley 52 below).

Outside Oxford there were other significant holdings. Bernard's 1697 catalogue lists three locations for 'Joachim's' works, all three apparently still extant: one among the Irish Franciscans (now Dublin, Trinity College, MS 347), one at Bury St Edmunds (Henry of Kirkstede's own, now Cambridge, Corpus Christi College, MS 404), and one at Balliol College (did he mean the *Liber Figurarum* now at Corpus Christi, Oxford, or the others?). Exeter Cathedral had Joachim 'super Apocalypsim Johannis' from at least 1327. The London Dominican convent had his *Expositio in Apocalypsim*. The medieval catalogue of the Benedictine abbey of Ramsey has a tantalizing reference to an 'ordo hystoriarum cum Tabula Ioachym' (whether or not related to the York Austin library's 'Tabula Joachim de concordancia testamentorum'?) and, in a separate volume, Ramsey had a 'uisio Ioachym uno uolumine', perhaps even a reference to the extremely rare poetry of Joachim.⁴² The York Austin's convent, as mentioned above, breaks all the English records for Joachite holdings (pseudonymous especially), and is impressive even by Continental standards. Byland Abbey, Yorkshire, however, had the genuine 'Ioachim Enchiridion super Apocalypsim' and Syon Abbey was also very rich in genuine materials, with their *Expositio in Apocalypsim*, and a 'Prophecia Ioachim de duobus ordinibus', which, if not original, must be very close in spirit to the abbot's thought. This item, intriguingly, was brought to Syon by a former master of Lincoln Cathedral School, perhaps the only university graduate among the brothers at Syon.⁴³ Like so many other medieval English libraries, Syon also had Henry of Costesy's serious Joachite exegesis, *Super Apocalypsim*

(as did Oxford's All Souls College, the Dominican convent at Norwich, Pembroke College, Cambridge, Evesham, and London's St Paul's). So, too, did St Augustine's Canterbury, along with an unknown 'Prophetia Abbatis Joachim' (which could be anything).

In short, in most major convent libraries and university college libraries in the country, Joachim's works, or works by serious disciples, could be found. The summary above, garnered from the list of Medieval Attestations (and barely touching upon the list of individual extant manuscripts that precedes it) still makes for an impressive insular collection. Scholarship has been slow to examine these works because Joachim's (or 'Joachim's') authorship was often obscured, whether casually or deliberately. We have seen, for instance, that measures were taken to obscure the authorship of Henry of Costesy's works, even in Cambridge, in the wake of John XXII's persecutions. And we also know that even the chained Gloucester College, Oxford copy of Olivi commissioned by the great Benedictine abbot of St Albans, John Whethamstede, shows evidence by the mid-fifteenth century of concern for heresy (see New College MS 49 below).⁴⁴

In fact, what seems particularly striking when these manuscripts are examined as a group is that only a tiny number of prelates, all in relatively high-profile positions – and so relatively untouchable – seem willing to sign themselves as *owners* or commission a piece of genuine Joachita. This includes men like Richard Kilvington, Dean of St Paul's (owner of MS Royal 8. F. XVI), John Whethamstede, Abbot of St Albans (owner of New College MS 49), Robert Thwaytes, one-time Chancellor of Oxford (owner of Balliol MS 149), William Ebchester, Bishop of Durham (owner of Harley MS 3049), and Bishop Gray of Ely (owner of Balliol MS 274).⁴⁵ But even clerics like this owned manuscripts that have often been marked or mutilated by *someone*.⁴⁶ Aside from the instances we have examined, tactics include the removal of the first (and thus identifying) leaf of Joachim's work, and sometimes the final leaf (presumably containing an explicit), too. This can be seen, for instance, in Ebchester's copy of Joachim's *Enchiridion super Apocalypsim*, and also in a copy of Joachim's *Praephatio super Apocalypsim* (Harley MS 3969), a manuscript with no visible ownership marks, but in all likelihood associated with Cambridge. Three of the Henry of Costesy manuscripts are similarly mutilated, one of which, the Laud MS, also has the leaf that contained much of the interpretation of the name of the Beast removed (the place, that is, which would most obviously

carry or invoke or imply contemporary history and enemies, or attract identifying annotations). And most of the Olivi manuscripts (see List below) have either had their authorship obscured or suffered erasure and mutilation; New College MS 49, as just mentioned, contains an explicit *caveat lector* note regarding both Olivi's and Joachim's reputation for heresy.

However, despite all this, many Joachite works, as the List shows, were lying unmolested in monastic libraries (especially Benedictine and Austin libraries), and also freely making their way through the vast network of anonymous transmission and ownership.⁴⁷ The following long List of manuscripts of English provenance which carry some form of Joachite thought includes some known items of importance: the Corpus *Liber figurarum*, the Balliol College *Liber contra Lombardum*, the Royal MS of Kilvington's Protocol of Anagni, two copies of Olivi's Matthew *Postilla*, and a collection of his commentaries in Vatican Library, MS Urb. lat. 480. It also contains some hitherto unnoticed treasures. One that must be mentioned is Cambridge University Library MS Dd. 1. 17, actually an important *Piers Plowman* MS copied along with an unnoticed piece of Joachite exegesis proving that Rachel is responsible for the salvation of all the world.⁴⁸ It also quotes extensively a part of the *Belial* prophecy that implicated Jan Hus at the Council of Constance.⁴⁹ I will leave the reader to explore the List and its notes for personal favourites and surprises.

To sum up, then, Joachite manuscripts and citations in England are often associated with a distinctive array of alternative and sometimes dissenting materials. They are also often associated with a wide range of medieval writings, many unexceptional. We can discern the following common categories of other contents in English Joachite manuscripts:

1. material on anti-papalism or schism issues;
2. material on issues of clerical reform, disendowment, anti-mendicantism;
3. (conversely) material expressing clerical fear of losing their temporal goods, clerical privileges, or even life and limb;
4. Wycliffite materials, also very occasionally Hussite connections;
5. material containing classical humanism, or other historical texts (such as chronicles) or trans-cultural items (such as *Mandeville's Travels*);

6. material on the salvation of the non-Christian peoples or other salvational disputes, and material on the allegorical and exegetical treatment of salvation history;
7. material about political crisis or international events, including political prophecy;
8. visionary writings and *mirabilia*.

This List by no means exhausts every last association, but it covers the most frequent. Many of these manuscripts contain no evidence of ownership, and several pieces are falsely attributed. These categories can also help us understand the large amount of elaborate citation of Joachite thought in England. This is a topic we have no space to cover here, but, to name but a few illuminating examples of users of Joachite thought: the thirteenth-century minorite exegetes like John Russell, John Ridewall, and John Lathbury; and Henry of Harclay, the Oxford Chancellor who later condemned Arnold of Villanova's Joachite calculations, accusing him of Jewish sympathies.⁵⁰ We also have the serious use of Joachim's *Dialogi de Praescientia Dei* by Archbishop Bradwardine (d. 1349); by 1388 Thomas Wimbeldon's invocation of *Super Hieremiam* in an English-language sermon to calculate the imminent end of the world; and sometime in the early Schism period, Henry of Kirkstede's annotation of the *Vaticinia* to show that Urban VI would be the last and most horrible of the popes. On the other side of orthodoxy, we have an anonymous Wycliffite preacher's hope that the coming new orders will include *vernacular* preachers.⁵¹ These are just a few examples, but they suggest a rich network of thought and usage for Joachite texts. The List below will, I hope, add more. There is a great deal still to be done to meet the dearth of scholarship on English Joachimism that Bloomfield lamented in 1961, and much more still to be done to honour the ground-breaking work that Marjorie Reeves did, without whose life's work this List would have been unimaginable.

One of the major questions I hope this List will allow scholars to explore in more detail is that of English awareness of the very essence of Joachimism: the conviction that a Third Status of history will bring significant spiritual renewal *after* the coming of the greatest Antichrist, and *before* the End of Time. The charge against English writers and users of Joachimism in the past has usually been that they did not seem to know or care much about this aspect of the abbot's thought. In fact, as we have just

seen, and as the List shows further, much of the English interest in Joachim demonstrates acute awareness of the controversial history of his work. When this material is studied more closely, I believe we will be able to confirm what the evidence already suggests: that is, that the learned English were often all too aware of the implications of Joachim's Third Status, and, especially in the wake of 1215 and 1254, *afraid* or *uncertain* about dabbling in it overtly. But the fascination persisted.

LIST OF JOACHITE MANUSCRIPTS OF ENGLISH ORIGIN OR PROVENANCE BEFORE 1600

A Note on Using this Chart*

My goal in this list has been to provide key information in a simple format and reserve detailed comments for the footnotes. Also, given the limited space available here, I have tried to highlight mainly the features of a manuscript's contents that will be of interest to those who study Joachimism, prophecy, apocalypticism, or related issues of church history like Judaism. Where a published description of a manuscript is available, a footnote refers the reader to that source; where the description is inadequate, I have tried to supplement it in the footnotes; where a description does not exist, a footnote gives a brief description, including contents, booklet structure, or collation. Where a manuscript is made up of separate booklets, the date refers to the booklet containing the Joachite material. As a result of limitations of space, information on modern editions, where they exist, may not always be directly cited here, but can be found in the further scholarship cited in the footnote. Modern editions of Joachim's writings, or of those by Pseudo-Joachite writers not explicitly mentioned here, may be found in the second edition of Marjorie Reeves' *The Influence of Prophecy* (Notre Dame, 1993), in Appendix A: The Genuine and Spurious Works of Joachim, or in Select Bibliography I and II. I follow the titles Reeves uses for these works throughout.¹ Those published since 1993 may be found in the list of editions in Julia Eva Wannenmacher, *Hermeneutik der Heilsgeschichte* (Leiden, 2005), 357–364, or at oliviana.revues.org (seen 24.8.2009).

COPIES OF ENGLISH PROVENANCE BEFORE 1600

Shelfmark	Joachite Contents	Earliest Known Owner or Provenance	Date and Origin
London, BL, MS Harley 3049 ¹	Joachim's <i>Enchiridion super Apocalypsim</i> , fol. 135r–218v (new foliation), ² defective, and spurious <i>extrada</i> claiming to be <i>de Expositione Abbatis Joachym super ysaiam</i> , fol. 253v–254r ³	William Ebchester, Prior of Durham, 1446–56, ⁴ d. 1448	1446–56
London, BL, MS Harley 3969 ⁵	Joachim's <i>Praephatio super Apocalypsim</i> , fol. 216r–224r (defective) ⁶	Emmanuel College ⁷	s. xiii with annotation in hand of s. xiv
Oxford, Corpus Christi College, MS 255A ⁸	Joachim's <i>Liber figurarum</i> , fol. 4r–14r	May have arrived in England between s. xiii and s. xv; it is first known to have belonged to Bryan Twyne, who arrived at Oxford in 1594	Italian, late s. xii/early s. xiii ⁹
London, BL, MS Royal 8. F.XVI, part A ¹⁰	Part A: <i>Liber excerptionum abbatis Ioachim</i> , containing excerpts from the <i>Liber Concordia</i> , fol. 1r; the Prologue and <i>Introduccio in Expositionem Appocalypsis</i> , fol. 24r; Joachim's <i>Epistola Universis Christi Fidelibus</i> , fol. 35r–37r, and from the <i>De oneribus prophetarum</i> , fol. 38r–44r; ¹¹ <i>Exposicio Iezechielis Prophete</i> , fol. 44r; followed by a copy of the very rare Protocol of Anagni, fol. 45v, inc. 'Etnotauimus' ¹²	Richard Kilvington, Dean of St Paul's, 1353–61, signed his name on every bifolium of the manuscript	s. xiv (med.)
London, BL, MS Sloane 156 ¹³	John of Rupescissa, <i>Vade mecum</i> , fol. 19v (once fol. 150v), <i>De oneribus</i> , fol. 34r, ¹⁴ followed by <i>Ioachim in maiori</i> ¹⁵ <i>libro de concordanciis</i> on fol. 41r	Unknown	s. XV
London, BL, MS Cotton Tiberius B.V, part ii ¹⁶	<i>Praemissiones</i> , fol. 89r–91r; <i>Super Esaia</i> , fol. 92r–l 17r; followed by an unnoticed copy of <i>De oneribus prophetarum</i> , fol. 118r–138v ¹⁷	Unknown before Robert Cotton	s. xiv
Oxford, Bodleian Library, MS Bodley 40 ¹⁸	'Creditis, O fratres, hec omnia?', a poem on the condemnation of Joachim in 1215 provoked by his Trinitarian dispute with Peter Lombard ¹⁹	Owned by Alexander, Austin Prior at Canons' Ashby,	s. xiii (in.)

		Northampton, (fl. 1220s)	
Cambridge, Corpus Christi College, MS 321 ²⁰	Peter Olivi's <i>Postilla super Mattheum</i> , copied as anonymous, but attributed to William of Auvergne in a contemporary note	"R-ye", that is, Ramsey Abbey ²¹	Late s. xiv.
Oxford, New College, MS 49 ²²	Olivi's <i>Postilla super Mattheum</i> , ascribed as 'Petrus Iohannis', with caveat lector warning of Olivi's status as 'hereticus' and 'unus complicitibus Ioachimi abbatis heresiarche' ²³	John Whethamsted, abbot of St Albans ²⁴	s. xv (1420–40) ²⁵
Rome, Vatican Library, MS Urb. lat. 480	A collection of Franciscan writings, containing the following by Olivi: <i>Postilla in Ecclesiastem</i> , fol. 1r–20r; <i>Questio</i> , 'Quomodo autem diligere christum sit melius quam' (on Matt. 9), fol. 20v–22r; <i>Postilla in Iob</i> , fol. 22r–105v; <i>Expositio super regulam s. Francisci</i> , fol. 109r–122r; <i>Expositio in Dionysii de angelica hierarchia</i> , fol. 122r–165v; <i>Postilla in cantica canticorum</i> , fol. 168r–183r. ²⁶	Written in an English hand	s. xiv (in.)
Oxford, Bodleian Library, MS Laud Misc. 85 ²⁷	Henry of Costesy, <i>Commentarius super Apocalypsim</i> , fol. 67r–172r (defective; mutilated; identified by a post-medieval hand) ²⁸	Pembroke College, Cambridge ²⁹	s. xiv (med.)
Oxford, Bodleian Library, MS Bodl. 52 ³⁰	Olivi's <i>De contractibus</i> , in an anthology dealing with a range of reformist and dissenting works by Ockham and William of St Amour, and including Wycliffite materials	Written by John Maynesford, a fellow of Merton College	c. 1420–30
St Bonaventure, NY, St Bonaventure University (formerly Convent of the Holy Name), MS 69 ³¹	Henry of Costesy, <i>Commentarius super Apocalypsim</i> , fol. 1r–(116), attributed to Petrus Aureolus	Unknown	s. xiv
Oxford, Bodleian Library, MS Rawlinson C.16 ³²	Henry of Costesy, <i>Commentarius super Apocalypsim</i> , fol. 131r–221r (identified only by a fifteenth-century hand)	Friar's vade mecum ³³	s. xiv
London, BL, MS Harley 7401 ³⁴	Henry of Costesy, <i>Commentarius super Apocalypsim</i> , fol. 1r–117r (unattributed) ³⁵	Friar's vade mecum	s. xiv (med.)

London, Lambeth Palace, MS 127 ³⁶	Henry of Costesy, <i>Commentarius super Apocalypsim</i> , fol. 117r–199r (defective)		s. xv
Dublin, Trinity College, MS 244 ³⁷	<i>The Last Age of the Church</i> , a vernacular Pseudo-Joachite tract, ³⁸ inc. ‘Alas forsorwe grete prestis’	Called <i>De ultima aetate Ecclesiae</i> by John Bale ³⁹	s. xiv (ex.)–xv (in.)
London, Lincoln’s Inn, MS Hale 73 ⁴⁰	John of Rupescissa’s <i>Vademecum</i> , fol. 134r, embedded in the middle of the <i>Eulogium historiarum</i> , a chronicle with evident Franciscan empathies which treats Joachim positively	Given by Bartholomew Brokesby in 1437 to the Augustinian Priory of Kirby Bellars ⁴¹	s. xiv (ex.)
Cambridge, Trinity College, MS 740 ⁴²	John of Rupescissa’s <i>Vade mecum</i> , p. 393, embedded in the middle of the <i>Eulogium historiarum</i> (as in MS Hale 73 above)	Probably from Malmesbury	s. xiv
Dublin, Trinity College, MS 497 ⁴³	John of Rupescissa’s <i>Vade mecum</i> , fol. 1r, ⁴⁴ copied alongside the <i>Eulogium historiarum</i> , fol. 9r (cf. MS Hale 73 and Cambridge, Trinity College, MS 740 above)	Unknown before Robert Cotton (fol. 1r)	s. xiv (ex.)
London, BL, MS Royal 13.E.IX ⁴⁵	John of Rupescissa, letter to archbishop of Toulouse (Stephanus Aldobrandi), inc. ‘Vos misistis’ ⁴⁶	St Albans	c. 1400
Oxford, Bodleian Library, MS Rawlinson D. 339 ⁴⁷	The copy of ‘Vos misistis,’ fol. 545r, used by Edward Brown, followed by a second letter of Rupescissa’s, ‘Reverendissime Pater’	Copied or commissioned by William Crashaw (father of the poet Robert)	c. 1600
Oxford, Corpus Christi College, MS 47 ⁴⁸	A very early copy of John of Rupescissa, <i>Vade mecum</i> , fol. 1r ⁴⁹	Donated to the college by Sebastian Benfield in 1605 ⁵⁰	s. xiv (med.) ⁵¹
London, BL, MS Royal 8. E. VII ⁵²	John of Rupescissa, <i>Vade mecum</i> , fol. 57r, in a miscellany containing historical texts on Oxford and Cambridge, <i>questiones</i> directed against Wyclif; and ‘questio de duracione huius etatis mundi’, fol. 73r	<i>Questio</i> on fol. 73r is copied ‘ex libris magistri Edmundi Lacy episcopi Exoniensi’ (1421–55)	s. xv
London, BL, MS Harley	Abridgement of John of Rupescissa’s <i>Vade mecum</i> , fol. 27r, heavily annotated in relation to the Great	Unknown	s. xiv (ex.)–xv (in.)

1008 ⁵³	Schism and in defence of Urban VI ⁵⁴		
London, BL, MS Cotton Cleopatra C.IV ⁵⁵	‘Gallorum levitas’, fol. 80r; prophecy of John of Bassigny, ‘Tacui et semper silui’, fol. 81v; ⁵⁶ abstract of John of Rupescissa’s <i>Vade mecum</i> , fol. 113r	Owned by Thomas Ulveston (or Wulverston), fl. 1556 ⁵⁷	s. xv (ex.)
London, BL, MS Lansdowne 752 ⁵⁸	Prophecy of John of Bassigny, ‘Tacui et semper silui’, fol. 54r		s. xvi (in.)
London, BL, MS Royal 7. A. IX ⁵⁹	Extract from John of Rupescissa’s <i>Vade mecum</i> , fol. 3r, (inc. ‘Surget tunc popularis justicia’) and a short treatise on the <i>Vade</i> , fol. 4v (inc. ‘intellectio est’, defective)	Austin Priory, St Mary’s, Southwark ⁶⁰	s. xv
London, Wellcome Institute, MS 507 (Misc. XI) ⁶¹	Extracts from Rupescissa’s <i>Vade mecum</i> , fol. 1r		s. xv
Cambridge Corpus Christi College, MS 404 ⁶²	A large anthology of prophetic texts, including an excerpt from Ralph of Coggeshall concerning Joachim’s views on Antichrist, fol. 66rv; ⁶³ <i>Columbinus Prophecy</i> , fol. 7v; ⁶⁴ the <i>Pentachronon</i> collection of Hildegard’s prophecies, fol. 9r; vision of John the Hermit, fol. 39r; <i>De Semine Scripturarum</i> , fol. 43v; ⁶⁵ <i>Oraculum Cyrilli cum Expositione Abbatis Joachim</i> , fol. 67r; ⁶⁶ <i>Vaticinia de Summis Pontificibus</i> , fol. 88r; ⁶⁷ <i>Ioachim in maiori libro de concordanciis (Corruent nobiles)</i> , fol. 100r; ⁶⁸ <i>Visio fratris Johannis</i> , fol. 100r; letter by John of Rupescissa, inc. ‘Vos misistis’, fol. 103r ⁶⁹	Benedictine house of Bury St Edmunds, compiled largely by Henry of Kirkestede, librarian	s. xiv (med.), except <i>Vaticinia</i> : s. xiv. (in.)
Cambridge, Corpus Christi College, MS 138 ⁷⁰	<i>Vaticinium Sibillae Erithreae</i> , 179–82, followed by political prophecies, and <i>Ioachim in maiori libro de concordanciis (Corruent mobiles)</i> 183, various political prophecies, and an excerpt from John of Rupescissa ‘abreviata de libro qui intitulatur ostensor futurorum’	Norwich, ⁷¹ and by 1545–58, Cambridge ⁷²	s. xv
Cambridge, University Library, MS Mm.I.16	<i>Vaticinium Sibillae Erithreae</i> , fol. 24r–46r, ⁷³ various political prophecies		s. xiv
Oxford, Balliol College, MS 149 ⁷⁴	<i>Columbinus Prophecy</i> , fol. 205v, followed by <i>Tractatus brevis de periculis</i> (William of St Amour), fol. 206r–218r ⁷⁵	Robert Thwaytes, Master of Balliol College (1450–56), and Chancellor of	s. xiv (med)

		Oxford (1446) ⁷⁶	
Cambridge Gonville and Caius College, MS 230/116 ⁷⁷	‘Flamine romano’, fol. 22v ⁷⁸ in the commonplace book of John Whethamstede, who commissioned the Olivi Matthew <i>Postilla</i> (see New College, MS 49 above)	John Whethamstede, abbot of St Albans, c. 1420–40 ⁷⁹	s. xv
Oxford, St John’s College, MS 202 ⁸⁰	<i>Deprophetia abbatis Ioachim</i> , fol. 153v–4v		s. xiv (in.)
Cambridge Gonville and Caius College, MS 249/277	An extensive collection of prophecies, including ‘Gallorum levitas’, fol. 182r; ‘Ioachim in libro de honoribus’, fol. 183r (see also Dublin, Trinity College, MS 516); and an unnoticed extract from Robert of Uzes (‘robertus de sey’), fol. 183v; an abstract of John of Rupescissa’s <i>Vade mecum</i> , fol. 216v; followed by the compiler’s own treatise, fol. 217r, comparing Rupescissa’s predictions with those of other prophets including ‘Joachimi’ ⁸¹	Compiled by Harryson ⁸²	c. 1443–73
Paris, BNF, MS lat. 4126 ⁸³	<i>Oraculum Cyrilli cum Expositione Abbaus Joachim</i> , fol. 282r–294r ⁸⁴	York Carmelites, compiled by Robert Popilton	s. xiv (ex.)
Oxford, Bodleian Library, MS Lat. Misc. c. 75 ⁸⁵	(Arnold of Villanova,) <i>Apologia de versuciis atque perversitatibus pseudotheologorum at religiosorum</i> , fol. 122r (begins defectively); ⁸⁶ <i>Prophecias Venerabilis Abbatis Joachim contra religiosos tenentes ordinem mendicum</i> ‘Insurgent gentes’, fol. 124v–125r; <i>Prophecias magistri Arnaldi de Villa Nova magistrum in medina ad bonefacium</i> ..., fol. 125r (in fact three letters by Arnold and ‘Quoniam scriptum’, in which he lists his previous titles on the question of pseudo-prophets, fol. 126v); ⁸⁷ <i>Epistola Cyrilli ad Abbatem Joachim</i> , fol. 132r, attributed here to Arnold	Franciscan convent, Oxford?/ later The Queen’s College, Oxford	s. xii–xv
Dublin, Trinity College, MS 347 ⁸⁸	<i>Ioachim in maiori libro de concordanciis (Corruent mobiles)</i> , fol. 388v–389r; ‘Dixit Ioachim quod primus status seculi’, fol. 389r–398v ⁸⁹	Franciscan, Irish provenance	s. xiii (med.)
Oxford, Bodleian Library, MS Bodley 761 ⁹⁰	<i>Ioachim in maiori libro de concordanciis (Corruent nobiles)</i>	Compiled for Thomas de Walmesford, ⁹¹ dependant of	s. xiv (2)

		the Bohun family	
Oxford, Bodleian Library, MS Douce 88 ⁹²	<i>Vaticinia de Summis Pontificibus</i> , fol. 138r, illustrated		s. xiii
Cambridge University Library, MS Gg.iv.25	Extract from <i>De oneribus prophetarum</i> , fol. 65r, inc. ‘Quando sub egipti filia’; ⁹³ <i>Ioachim in maiori libro de concordanciis (Corruent nobiles)</i> , fol. 67r	A note on fol. 57v records birth of William Carpenter in 1573	s. xv ⁹⁴
Cambridge University Library, MS Dd. 1. 17 ⁹⁵	Joachite exegetical prophecy attributed to Pseudo-John of Lignano, fol. 203vb–204rb, inc. ‘Regnum Spiritus sancti distinguntur in iacob’ ⁹⁶	Austin Friars’ convent, York (likely)	s. xiv (ex.) – xv (in.)
Oxford, Bodleian Library, MS Digby 218 ⁹⁷	<i>Ioachim in maiori libro de Concordanciis (Corruent nobiles)</i> , fol. 107r; followed by ‘Flamine romano crescit britanniis honor’ ⁹⁸	Owned by John Dee, s. xvi ⁹⁹	s. xiv
London, BL, MS Cotton Vesp. E. VII ¹⁰⁰	<i>Ioachim in maiori libro de concordanciis (Corruent nobiles)</i> , fol. 70v; ¹⁰¹ ‘Flamine romano’, fol. 112r: an abridged version of John of Rupescissa’s letter to Innocent VI, ‘Vos misistis’, fol. 122r, and an excerpt from his <i>Vade mecum</i> , fol. 123v		s. xv
Oxford, Bodleian Library, MS Hatton 56 ¹⁰²	An extensive collection of prophecies, including the <i>Columbinus Prophecy</i> or ‘De Septem signaculis’ (inc. ‘Attende secundum Eusebium’), fol. 33r; extracts from John of Rupescissa’s <i>Vade mecum</i> , fol. 8r, mainly concerning the papacy. ¹⁰³ In addition, extracts from Bridget of Sweden, fol. 1r, Hildegard of Bingen, fol. 27r and 28r, ¹⁰⁴ the Bridlington prophecies, fol. 11r, and ‘Revelatio anni nostri mccccxlviii’, fol. 6v, mentioning Joachim	Unknown	c. 1450
Oxford, Bodleian Library, MS Digby 176 ¹⁰⁵	<i>Ioachim in maiori libro de concordanciis (Corruent nobiles)</i> , fol. 38r ¹⁰⁶		s. xiv
Oxford, Bodleian Library, MS Ashmole 393 ¹⁰⁷	<i>Columbinus Prophecy</i> , fol. 80r		s. xv
Oxford, Bodleian Library, MS Digby 196 ¹⁰⁸	<i>Columbinus Prophecy</i> , fol. 18r, inc. ‘Attende secundum Eusebium’, and ‘Gallorum levitas’, fol. 24r; ¹⁰⁹ in an anthology containing eschatology,	Unknown	s. xv (2)

	ecclesiology, and politics (including the Rising of 1381)		
London, BL, MS Cotton Cleopatra C.X ¹¹⁰	<i>Columbinus Prophecy</i> , fol. 157r–158r, to which is added the <i>Post Celestinum</i> -Prophecy (inc. ‘Papa cedet’) ¹¹¹	Thomas Allen (1540–1632)	s. xiv (in.)
Oxford, Bodleian Library, MS Bodley 397 ¹¹²	<i>Columbinus Prophecy</i> , fol. 43r, together with exegetical items, including Hugh of St Victor, and preceded by a note on history and tropological interpretation, same folio ¹¹³	st Mary’s, Reading, ‘ex dono Johannes Sarum’ ¹¹⁴	s. xiii (ex.)
Lincoln Cathedral Library, MS 66 ¹¹⁵	<i>Columbinus Prophecy</i> , fol. 123r–v ¹¹⁶	Unknown	s. xv
Aberystwyth, National Library of Wales, MS Peniarth 50 ¹¹⁷	<i>Columbinus Prophecy</i> , fol. 166–9, in an anthology of prophecies in Latin, Welsh, and English, largely political	Welsh in origin	s. xv
London, BL, MS Additional 14251	<i>Columbinus Prophecy</i> , fol. 216v, with various political prophecies and works on English history ¹¹⁸	East Yorkshire or Lincolnshire	1421
Cambridge Gonville and Caius College, MS 388/608 ¹¹⁹	<i>Oraculum Cyrilli cum Expositione Abbatis Joachim</i> , fol. 103r–125v ¹²⁰	‘liber Roberti Tomsun’ (early xiv), Thorelby’, (xv–xvi) also copied in Greek letters	s. xiv (in.) ¹²¹
Oxford, Balliol College, MS 274 ¹²²	Excerpts from the <i>Vaticinium Sibillae Erithreae</i> , fol. 255r, and ‘In ultima etate humiliabitur’, fol. 257r ¹²³	Brought to England by William Gray, bishop of Ely	Before 1442–44; decoration is Rhenish
Oxford, Balliol College, MS 296 ¹²⁴	<i>Liber contra Lombardum</i> , fol. 219r–249v, in a collection including Abelard, Bernard, and other twelfth-century theologians	‘Expert English (?) hand, with a touch of court-hand about it’ ¹²⁵	s. xiv (in.)
Cambridge University Library, MS Mm.v.31 ¹²⁶	<i>Expositio secundem intellectum historicum Apocalypsim</i> (commentary on the historical sense of the Apocalypse) by Friar Alexander, with illustrations	script and illustrations English in character	s. xiii (med.)
Cambridge	<i>Joachim in maiori libro de concordantiis</i> (<i>Corruent</i>	Collection of	s. xiv (in.)

Cambridge University Library, MS li.vi.25 ¹²⁷	<i>Ioachim in maiori libro de concordanciis</i> (<i>Corruent nobiles</i>), fol. 107v, set out here as six consecutive prophecies for the years 1350, 1354, 1357, 1360, and 1365, followed shortly by the Statute suppressing the Templars ¹²⁸	Collection of Statutes probably made for civil service or legal use ¹¹⁹	s. xiv (iii.)
London, BL, MS Harley 3724 ¹³⁰	‘Fata monent’, fol. 49v ¹³¹	Anglo-Irish	s. xiii (ex.)
Cambridge Corpus Christi College, MS 283	‘Fatamonent’ ¹³²	Christchurch, Canterbury	s. xiii

A Small Sampling of Manuscripts containing Brief or Flyleaf Joachite Entries

London, BL, MS Harley 1280 ¹³³	‘Cum fuerint,’ fol. 427r, ¹³⁴ in a Bible	Bury St Edmunds	s. xiii
Oxford, Merton College, MS 202	‘Cum fuerint’, fol. 85v, preceded by ‘Gallorum levitas’, ¹³⁵ fol. 85r, both added to a manuscript of Bonaventure	friar’s vade mecum ¹³⁶	s. xv, s. xiv for additions, s. xiii for main text
London, BL, MS Royal 8. D.11 ¹³⁷	‘Cum fuerint’, copied at the end of an article on Antichrist in the Wycliffite compilation, the <i>Floretum</i> ¹³⁸	In family of John Theyer, s. xvii	s. xv
Dublin, Trinity College, MS 497	A collection of prophecies containing a version of ‘Gallorum levitas’ with four extra verses referring to 1325 and the persecution of followers of Peter Olivi ¹³⁹		s. xiv
Washington, D.C., Folger Library, MS 546 ¹⁴⁰	Vernacular prophecy attributed John of Rupescissa, fol. 2v, on the future of papacy and voluntary poverty	Copy said to be found in an ‘auncient house in plymothe in Cornewell’	c. 1540
Dublin, Trinity College, MS 516 ¹⁴¹	fol. 48r–48v: ‘Ioachim in libro de honoribus’; ‘Gallorumleuitas,’ fol. 48v–49r; ¹⁴² excerpt from Rupescissa’s <i>Vade mecum</i> , fol. 111r	John Benet’s Chronicle for 1400–1462, ¹⁴³ in his own hand	s. xv (med.)
London, BL, MS Royal 8.	<i>Ioachim in maiori libro de concordanciis</i> (<i>Corruent nobiles</i>), fol. 66r, ¹⁴⁵ in a manuscript containing many	Bury St Edmunds,	s. xiii (ex.)

C. IV ¹⁴⁴	Franciscan materials	partly in Kirkestede's hand (but not 'Corruent')	
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Manuscripts Rejected for Lack of Evidence of English Provenance

London, BL, MS Arundel 117 ¹⁴⁶	<i>Vaticinia de Summis Pontificibus</i> , fol. 137r–52r; ¹⁴⁷ 'Gallorum levitas', fol. 146v (in relation to an account of the Council of Constance)	German, from Charterhouse at Mainz ¹⁴⁸	s. xv
London, BL, MS Add. 11439 ¹⁴⁹	<i>Super Hieremiam</i> , fol. 2r; <i>Vaticinium Sibillae Erithreae</i> , fol. 73r, 75r; <i>Epistola Universis Christi Fidelibus</i> , fol. 76r; <i>Adversus Judaeos</i> , fol. 78r; <i>Super Esaiam</i> , fol. 92r; <i>Praemissiones</i> , fol. 99r	Likely Italian in origin, early provenance unknown	1377

A Sampling of Medieval Attestations in England

Location	Joachite Works cited	Details
Cambridge, University Library, MS Add. 3470, <i>Catalogus Scriptorum Ecclesiae</i> , ¹⁵⁰ entry for Joachim, p. 94	Henry of Kirkestede's inventory (s. xiv) of English libraries recording copies of Joachim's <i>De concordia</i> , and <i>Super Apocalypsin</i> [sic].	All at Library No. 168, that is, the Oxford Franciscan House; Kirkestede also listed the following titles, for which he had no location: ¹⁵¹ <i>Super libros Prophetarum</i> ; <i>De Seminibus</i> ; <i>De moribus paparum</i> (inc. 'Genus nequam'); <i>De oneribus Prophetarum</i> ; <i>De duobus ordinibus</i> ; <i>Super oraculum Cirilli</i>
Exeter, Cathedral Library ¹⁵²	'Joachim Albas [sic] super Apocalypsim Johannis'	Catalogue of books in inventory of 1327, from Exeter Cathedral, MS 3671 ¹⁵³
E. Bernard, <i>Catalogi Librorum Manuscriptorum Angliae & Hiberniae</i> (Oxford, 1697)	For Joachim, records three locations: one in 'Bibliothecis Hiberniae', one in 'Publicis ... Bibliothecis Angliae', one in Oxford Colleges	Trinity College, Dublin, no. 365 (now TCD, MS 347; see above); no. 1348 (now Corpus Christi, Cambridge, MS 404, see above); Oxford, Balliol College, no. 458 (now MS Balliol 149, see above)
Ramsey Abbey,	Joachim: no. 537b 'Ordo hystoriarum, cum Tabula Ioachym et tribus aliis', no. 535 e, 'uisio Joachym uno uolumine'	The Tabula may be an index to any work by Joachim, although the work it is

Benedictine Library ¹⁵⁴		attached to is perhaps the <i>Liber de concordia</i> ; or the Tabula could be a figurai work like the <i>Praemissiones</i> , or even the <i>Liber Figurarum</i> ; the second could be one of Joachim's poems by this title ¹⁵⁵
London, Dominican Convent ¹⁵⁶	'Joachimi expositio in Apocalypsin'	As noted by John Leland in his <i>De rebus Britannicis Collectanea</i> , D7.29
York, Library of Austin Friars (and John Erghome)	'Joachim de seminibus litterarum, Joachim de oneribus prophetarum, Joachim de duobus ordinibus, Joachim de successionem papali [i.e. the Vaticinia], Oraculum cirilli cum expositione ioachim; excerptiones prophetie fr. Johannis de rupescissa'; ¹⁵⁷ 'Joachim super Apocalypsim, Joachim de concordancia testamentorum'; ¹⁵⁸ 'Tabula Joachim de concordancia testamentorum'; ¹⁵⁹ 'Liber Joachim de summis pontificibus'; ¹⁶⁰ 'Prophecie paparum' ¹⁶¹	s. xiv (med.). An astonishing collection of Joachite works, including apparently genuine ones (the <i>Expositio</i> and the <i>Liber de Concordia</i>) and no fewer than three copies of the spurious <i>Vaticinia</i>
Byland Abbey, Yorkshire	Copy of 'Ioachim Enchiridion super Apocalypsim'	No. Z4.4 ¹⁶²
York, St Mary's Abbey	Henry of Costesy, <i>Super Apoc.</i>	No. 561, two copies ¹⁶³
Syon Abbey Library	Henry of Costesy, <i>Super Apoc.</i>	Recorded in catalogue, and copies later seen by Bale in Richard Grafton's printshop ¹⁶⁴
Syon Abbey Library	Peter Olivi, a commentary on Genesis (followed by an unidentified Apocalypse commentary); and, in a separate catalogue entry, a <i>quodlibet</i> by Olivi	No. 603 and No. 437 ¹⁶⁵
Syon Abbey Library	Joachim of Fiore, <i>Expositio in Apocalypsim</i>	No. 582 ¹⁶⁶
Syon Abbey Library	'Prophecias Ioachim de duobus ordinibus'	No. 977dd, brought by Johannes Bracebrigge, former master of Boston Grammar School and Lincoln Cathedral School, apparently the only graduate among the brethren of Syon by 1428 ¹⁶⁷
Oxford, All Souls College	Henry of Costesy, <i>Super Apoc.</i>	Gift of Henry VI ¹⁶⁸
Norwich, Dominican	Henry of Costesy, <i>Super Apoc.</i>	seen by Leland ¹⁶⁹

Priory		
Cambridge, Pembroke College	Henry of Costesy, <i>Super Apoc.</i>	seen by Bale ¹⁷⁰
Canterbury, St Augustine's	Henry of Costesy, <i>Super Apoc.</i>	In library listing ¹⁷¹
Canterbury, St Augustine's	'Prophetia Abbatis Joachim'	Catalogue from s. xv in Dublin, Trinity College, MS 360 ¹⁷²
Evesham	Henry of Costesy, <i>Super Apoc.</i>	Given by Nicholas Hereford in 1392 ¹⁷³
London, St Paul's	Henry of Costesy, <i>Super Apoc.</i>	seen by Bale ¹⁷⁴
Oxford, Merton College	Olivi's <i>Postilla</i> on Matthew	Bequeathed by William Duffield to Merton in 1453 'ad incathendum in communi libraria' ¹⁷⁵
Oxford, Balliol College	'Opera Joachimi abbatis super Hieremiam, de seminio Scripturarum, de prophetia ignota, de ultimis tribulationibus, expositio super Cyrillum, de provincialibus praesagiis [perhaps <i>De oneribus prophetarum?</i>], in Apocalypsin, in Psalterium'	As noted by Leland in his <i>De rebus Britannicis Collectanea</i> . ¹⁷⁶ This is a rich collection of Joachite works, including the genuine <i>De prophetia ignota</i> , <i>De ultimis tribulationibus</i> , <i>Expositio</i> and <i>Psalterium</i>
Oxford, Oriel College	'Excerptiones librorum abbatis Ioachim', <i>inc.</i> 'Quia labentes ac perituri seculi perurgere ruinam'	Bale, <i>Index</i> ¹⁷⁷
Oxford, Merton College	A manuscript containing six works by Arnold of Villanova: <i>Gladius</i> , <i>Allocutio</i> , <i>De versutiis</i> , <i>De mysterio cymbalorum</i> , <i>De adventu Antichristi</i> , and <i>Philosophia catolica</i>	Bale, <i>Index</i> ¹⁷⁸
Robert Cotton's Library, MS Vitellius E. II, largely destroyed in Cotton library fire	Final items in the manuscript are very similar to those of Booklet E of Oxford, Bodleian Library, MS Lat. Misc. c. 75, containing the 'Joachim' <i>Insurgent</i> and the Arnold of Villanova pieces (see above), according to the 1696 description ¹⁷⁹	Fragmentary and badly burnt, these items now entirely missing

Notes

¹ This essay, and the List that follows, benefited enormously from the advice, encouragement, and enthusiasm of Marjorie Reeves, who knew of it in its embryonic state, and who always made me so

welcome at her home in Oxford during my research trips there. It is offered here in gratitude, in sadness, and in celebration of her marvellously inspiring life.

² See Morton Bloomfield, *Piers Plowman as a Fourteenth-century Apocalypse* (New Brunswick, 1962), who concluded that ‘the time is not yet ripe’ for arguing Joachim’s influence in England because ‘too much important material lies buried in Latin manuscripts not well known or not easily available for study’ (Appendix One, 157).

³ Robert Lerner very kindly informed me of this connection. See Nicole Bériou, ‘Pierre de Limoges et la fin des temps’, *Mélanges de l’École française de Rome, Moyen Age – Temps Modernes*, 98 (1986), 65–107.

⁴ In *Books under Suspicion* I noted that it contained a deliberately abridged text, and that Kilvington took special measures to guard it, both observations that are independently congruent with Bériou’s findings. See Kathryn Kerby-Fulton, *Books under Suspicion: Censorship and Tolerance of Revelatory Writing in Late Medieval England* (Notre Dame, 2006), 89–95, and further discussion below.

⁵ Morton Bloomfield and Marjorie Reeves, ‘The Penetration of Joachimism into Northern Europe’, *Speculum*, 29 (1954), 772–93. See also Marjorie Reeves, *The Influence of Prophecy in the Later Middle Ages* (Oxford, 1969, repr. Notre Dame, 1993), esp. 81–8; Davide Bigalli, ‘Gioachimismo ed escatologia in Inghilterra,’ in id., *I Tartari e l’Apocalisse. Ricerche sull’escatologia in Adamo Marsh e Ruggero Bacone* (Florence, 1971), [chapter 7](#); Kathryn Kerby-Fulton, *Reformist Apocalypticism and Piers Plowman* (Cambridge, 1990); E. Randolph Daniel and Kathryn Kerby-Fulton, ‘English Joachimism, 1300–1500: The Columbinus Prophecy’, in *Il profetismo gioachimita tra Quattrocento e Cinquecento. Atti del III Congresso internazionale di studi gioachimiti, S. Giovanni in Fiore, 17–21 settembre 1989*, ed. Gian Luca Potestà (San Giovanni in Fiore, 1990), 313–350; Curtis Bostick, *The Antichrist and the Lollards: Apocalypticism in Late Medieval and Reformation England* (Leiden, 1998). For the Renaissance period, see Marjorie Reeves, ‘History and Eschatology: Medieval and Early Protestant Thought in Some English and Scottish Writings’, *Medievalia et Humanistica*, 4 (1973), 99–123.

⁶ See Reeves’s discussion of the accounts in *Influence*, 7, citing ‘Benedict of Peterborough’, from *The Chronicle of the reigns of Henry II. and Richard I. A.D. 1169–1192, known commonly under the name of Benedict of Peterborough*, ed. William Stubbs, 2 vols, RS 49 (London, 1867), ii, 151–5, and Roger Howden, from *Chronica magistri Rogeri de Houedene*, ed. William Stubbs, 4 vols, RS 51 (London, 1868–71), iii, 75–9.

⁷ See Bloomfield, Reeves, ‘Penetration’, and see also Reeves, *Influence*, 45, for Roger of Wendover, citing *Rogeri de Wendover liber qui dicitur flores historiarum ab anno Domini MCLIV annoque Henrici anglorum regis secundi primo*, ed. Henry G. Hewlett, 3 vols, RS 84 (London, 1886–89), i, 121–3, and especially *Influence*, 65, n. 1, giving a list of the European historians who copied their account from Roger of Wendover.

⁸ Cited from the transcription in Bloomfield and Reeves, ‘Penetration’, 784–5. Christoph Egger informs me that (contrary to Bloomfield and Reeves’s information), a more recent edition of Alexander’s work gives no indication that this manuscript belonged to Alexander or to Canons’ Ashby, but Alexander of Ashby is the author of the text fol. 1r–38v; see Alexander Essebiensis, *Opera poetica*, ed. Greti Dinkova-Bruun, CCCM 188A (Turnhout, 2004), lx–lxi (description of MS Bodl. 40).

⁹ Fiona Robb, ‘A Late Thirteenth-century Attack on the Fourth Lateran Council: The “Liber Contra Lombardum” and Contemporary Debates on the Trinity’, *Recherches de Théologie ancienne et médiévale*, 62 (1995), 110–44.

¹⁰ Bloomfield and Reeves, ‘Penetration’, 787. It is recorded in the *Additamenta* to Matthew’s *Chronica Majora*, in BL, MS Cotton Nero D. I, a manuscript executed under Matthew’s direction before 1256.

¹¹ David Townsend and Arthur G. Rigg, 'Medieval Latin Poetic Anthologies (v)', *Mediaeval Studies*, 49 (1987), 353–90.

¹² See Kerby-Fulton, *Books under Suspicion*, [Chapter 3](#) and Case Study 2.

¹³ Bigalli, 'Gioachimismo in Inghilterra'.

¹⁴ Reeves, *Influence*, 46.

¹⁵ See Charles Lethbridge Kingsford et al., *Fratris Johannis Pecham Tractatus Tres de Paupertate* (Aberdeen, 1910), 13 and 111; Kathryn Kerby-Fulton, 'Prophecy and Suspicion: Closet Radicalism, Reformist Politics, and the Vogue for Hildegardiana in Ricardian England', *Speculum*, 75 (2000), 318–41.

¹⁶ Kerby-Fulton, *Books under Suspicion*, 194–5.

¹⁷ *Ibid.*, [Chapter 4](#).

¹⁸ Wycliffites were sometimes accused of having inherited Joachim's heresy (see Kerby-Fulton, *ibid.*, [Chapter 5](#)).

¹⁹ In addition to Kerby-Fulton and Daniel, 'Columbinus Prophecy', see Elizabeth A.R. Brown and Robert Lerner, 'On the Origins and Import of the Columbinus Prophecy', *Traditio*, 45 (1989–90), 219–56.

²⁰ Kerby-Fulton and Daniel, 'Columbinus Prophecy', 344.

²¹ David Burr, *Olivi's Peaceable Kingdom: A Reading of the Apocalypse Commentary* (Philadelphia, 1993), 255. See also Kerby-Fulton, *Books under Suspicion*, 81–7.

²² Bodleian Library, MS Laud Misc. 85, fol. 82v.

²³ Reeves, *Influence*, 87.

²⁴ D.L. Douie, 'Three Treatises on Evangelical Perfection', *Archivum Fmnciscanum Historicum*, 24 (1931), 341–54, at 342.

²⁵ See the footnotes to the *Commentarius* manuscripts listed below, and Kerby-Fulton, *Books under Suspicion*, 83–4.

²⁶ This case is discussed in Kerby-Fulton, *ibid.*, 102–3, 258–60.

²⁷ *Ibid.*, [Chapter 3](#).

²⁸ See, particularly, the discussion of the text of the *De oneribus prophetarum* in this manuscript, Kerby-Fulton, *ibid.*, 92; see also the comment by Bériou in 'Pierre de Limoges' suggesting that the redaction of the *De oneribus* is one not known to Holder-Egger in his edition. To her excellent analysis of the text, 72–3, I would add that the compiler, at least in Kilvington's copy, emphasizes the *virī spiritualles* more than the Third Status, an intriguing approach if this is indeed a more sober Franciscan redaction of Gerard of Borgo San Donnino's radical text.

²⁹ Kerby-Fulton, *ibid.*, 89–95, which also contains plates.

³⁰ *Munimenta Academica or Documents illustrative of academical life and studies at Oxford*, ed. Henry Anstey 2 vols, RS 50 (London, 1868), i, 208–11; the case is discussed in Kerby-Fulton, *Books under Suspicion*, 134–45. But see also Andrew Larsen's article, 'The Oxford "School of Heretics": The Unexamined Case of Friar John', *Vivarium*, 23 (1999), 168–77, and more recently his 'The Condemnation of John Kedington, OSA', *Augustiana*, 59 (2009), 159–72, setting out the case that the unnamed friar in the *Munimenta* and other records of the case is Kedington. Moreover, [Chapter 6](#) of Andrew Larsen, *The Gymnasium Haereticorum: Academic Condemnation at the University of Oxford, 1277 to 1409* (Leiden, 2011), also deals with this case. Larsen's accounts parallel my own in emphasizing the role of Richard FitzRalph in the condemnation, but Larsen does not discuss FitzRalph's and Kilvington's many connections to Joachite thought and anti-Franciscan Spiritual inquisitorial officials. Larsen does, however, note that Humphrey de Bohun, the most prominent patron of the Austins in England in the 1350s, was likely Kedington's lay protector. This is significant, I would add, because the English Austin John Erghome, who wrote a lengthy

commentary on the so-called *Bridlington Prophecies* for Humphrey, owned a staggering collection of Joachite works (see the entry for York, library of the Austin friars in the section called *A Sampling of Medieval Attestations* below).

³¹ See Kerby-Fulton, *Books under Suspicion*, 134–42, and 106–8 on John Erghome and his connections with Humphrey de Bohun (for whom, see the previous note above). Erghome's prophetic satires captured, in Marjorie Reeves's view, 'something of the Joachimist optimism in its expectation of an Age of Glory... under the Black Prince' (*Influence*, 256).

³² On copies of Rupescissa's *Vade mecum* in British libraries, see in the second volume Matthias Kaup, forthcoming.

³³ Kerby-Fulton, *ibid.*, 105–6; and Ruth Nisse, 'Prophetic Nations', *New Medieval Literatures*, 4 (2001), 95–115.

³⁴ Reeves, *Influence*, 398.

³⁵ See Robert Lerner, 'Recent Work on the Origins of the "Genus nequarum" Prophecies', *Florensia*, 7 (1993), 141–57; at 149, however, Lerner gives reasons why he feels this is not possible.

³⁶ Reeves, *Influence*, 254–6; Kerby-Fulton, *Books under Suspicion*, 104–8.

³⁷ Vivian Hunter Galbraith, 'Articles Laid before the Parliament of 1371,' *English Historical Review*, 34 (1919), 579–82.

³⁸ See *Eulogium historiarum sive temporis. Chronicon ab orbe condito usque ad annum Domini 1366 a monacho quodam Malmesburiensi exaratum*, ed. Frank Scott Haydon, 3 vols, RS 9 (London, 1858–63), iii, 337–9; Kerby-Fulton, *Books under Suspicion*, 106–8.

³⁹ See Anne Hudson, 'Wycliffism in Oxford, 1381–1411', in *Wyclif in His Times*, ed. Anthony Kenny (Oxford, 1986), 67–84.

⁴⁰ See Kerby-Fulton, 'Prophecy and Suspicion' for these quotations from the *Opus arduum*, and discussion; *ead.*, *Books under Suspicion*, [Chapter 5](#).

⁴¹ See previous note, but see also Anne Hudson, 'A Neglected Wycliffite Text', in *ead.*, *Lollards and Their Books* (London, 1985), 43–66.

⁴² Printed in Marjorie Reeves and John Fleming, *Two Poems attributed to Joachim of Fiore* (Princeton, 1978). On the poem, see in this volume 75–95.

⁴³ See Attestations list below, and *Syon Abbey: with the Libraries of the Carthusians*, ed. Vincent Gillespie and Ian Doyle, *Corpus of British Medieval Library Catalogues* 9 (London, 2001), 570; Bracebridge had once been a grammar school teacher. I would like to thank Robert Lerner for drawing my attention to this.

⁴⁴ Kerby-Fulton, *Books under Suspicion*, 1, 95–9.

⁴⁵ See List below for each of these, and the next note.

⁴⁶ Kerby-Fulton, *Books under Suspicion*, 81–99. In two of the signed MSS, Kilvington's and Ebchester's, Joachim's reputation in relation to heresy is also directly addressed by the contents of the manuscript.

⁴⁷ Kerby-Fulton, *Books under Suspicion*, 100–104.

⁴⁸ Kerby-Fulton, *ibid.*, Case Study I.

⁴⁹ I would like to thank Robert Lerner for his helpful advice about this text and the *Belial*.

⁵⁰ On Henry of Harclay and other English figures important in the history of reception of Joachimism, see E. Randolph Daniel, 'Henry of Kirkstede's De antichristo et de fine mundi', *Abbot Joachim of Fiore and Joachimism* (Farnham, 2011), 1–38. I would like to thank Prof. Daniel for sharing this text with me.

⁵¹ The first three instances are discussed in Reeves, *Influence*, 82–8, the fourth, *ibid.*, 315–17, the fifth, 84–4; the Kirkstede instance is discussed by Robert Lerner, *Powers of Prophecy: The Cedar of Lebanon Vision* (Berkeley, 1983), 93–101, and see also Daniel, *ibid.*; and Kerby-Fulton, *Books under*

Suspicion, 66–70; for Wimbledon, *ibid.*, 42; the Wycliffite sermon appears in Cambridge, UL MS li. iii. 8, fol. 149r.

* I would like to thank especially Robert Lerner for kindly looking over this chart for me and offering several suggestions and points of information, and Christoph Egger and Sylvain Piron for additional information as well as their careful reading and advice.

¹ See *A Catalogue of the Harleian Manuscripts in the British Museum*, 4 vols (London, 1808–12), ii, 729, no. 3049, which, however, cites the old foliation. The first leaf of Joachim's piece has been removed (before fol. 135 [old fol. 137]). There is also a leaf cut out between fol. 129 and fol. 130 (new foliation) at the beginning of Jerome's commentary on the Apocalypse, and the leaf containing Jerome's comments on the number of the Beast has also been cut out between fol. 134 and fol. 135. The book is large (measuring 10" × 15") and has splendid, but rather rudely executed, decoration in green, blue, ochre, and gold leaf on initial folios of individual works. It is composed of quires of 12 with quire signatures often visible. It contains, in addition, several works by St Ambrose (including *De Spiritu Sancto*), two by Jerome (including a 'brevis explanatio super Apocalipsim'), two by Isidore, and a collection of items, a number by friars, relating to the power of the papacy (mostly in the *questio* genre). At the end, just before the spurious item attributed to Joachim, is a list of the seats of the archbishops and bishops of the world. The manuscript has been very carefully corrected in a bastard secretary hand; corrections were first written in a cursive hand in the lower margin and were meant to be cropped (see, e.g., fol. 163); the main text is in a secretary hand.

² Reeves, *Influence*, 26, n. 3 and bibliography listed there on textual matters.

³ This claim is brazen (see the discussion in Kerby-Fulton, *Books under Suspicion*, 88–9 and 433, n. 57); the full heading reads: 'Hec extracta sunt de expositione abbatis Joachym super ysaia vbi agit de onere babilonis', a title which mixes allusion to *Super Esaia* and *De oneribus prophetarum*. The little piece, however, is largely about the Waldensians, the Wycliffites, and the Hussites and their doctrine of clerical possessions (making Joachim very far-sighted for a twelfth-century prophet!). But it is worth noting that Joachim himself discusses heresy (the Cathars) in the *Expositio in Apocalipsim* (Venice, 1527), fol. 130v–135r, which may have emboldened the pseudonymous writer. On the latter, see Lorenzo Paolini, 'Italian Catharism and Written Culture', in *Heresy and Literacy, 1000–1530*, ed. Peter Biller and Anne Hudson (Cambridge, 1994), 83–103, at 90–91. I am grateful to Marjorie Reeves for advice on this passage.

⁴ Note on fol. 1v at opening of Table of Contents says that Ebchester 'fecit hunc librum fieri' while he was Prior of Durham. For Ebchester's career, see Alfred Brotherston Emden, *Biographical Register of the University of Oxford to A. D. 1500 [BRUO]*, 3 vols (Oxford, 1957–59), i, 622.

⁵ Described in *A Catalogue of the Harleian Manuscripts*, iii, 100, and discussed in more detail in Kerby-Fulton, *Books Under Suspicion*, 88–92. There is a table of contents on the flyleaf in a contemporary hand, fol. 233v. In addition to the grammatical, classical, and medical texts in the manuscript, there are several historical items, including William of Malmesbury, and items to do with marvels and prognostications, including 'De presagiis temporum', fol. 224r, and *De septem mirabilibus mundi*, often given this title and attributed to John of Salisbury, as in this manuscript (see also note 93 below). For its correct title, *De septem septenis*, and attribution to Robert de Curzon, see Richard Sharpe, *A Handlist of the Latin Writers of Great Britain and Ireland before 1540* (Turnhout, 2001), 310. MS Harley 3969 measures 8.5" × 12.5" and is ruled to accommodate professional marginal annotation such as the reader guides throughout the Joachim piece, supplemented in a later medieval hand. It has professionally executed initials and decoration similar to those in MS Sloane 156.

⁶ Collated in the edition of this text by Kurt-Victor Selge, 'Eine Einführung Joachims von Fiore in die Johannesapokalypse', *Deutsches Archiv*, 46 (1990), 85–131. The folio carrying the opening of the text has been torn out (between fol. 215 and fol. 216) with the result that the text begins defectively

at 103, 1. 28 of Selge's edition, thereby omitting the primary discussion of the three *status*, which opens the text.

⁷ Under 'List of Manuscripts Now Missing', M.R. James prints a detailed description of a manuscript exactly like MS Harley 3969 from an eighteenth-century catalogue of Emmanuel College, Cambridge. See MS 257 in Montague R. James, *The Western Manuscripts in the Library of Emmanuel College* (Cambridge, 1904), at 158. All 20 items of the contents agree exactly with the contents of Harley. Most important for students of Joachim is the system of rubrics, marginal guides, and later annotations, all of which attempt to trace Joachim's concords.

⁸ Reeves, *Influence*, 518; Joachim of Fiore, *Il libro delle figure [Liber figurarum]*, 2nd edn, ed. L. Tondelli, M. Reeves, and B. Hirsch-Reich (Turin, 1953). For its English provenance, see Wannenmacher, *Hermeneutik der Heilsgeschichte*, 279–81.

⁹ Many of the manuscripts from Canterbury came into the possession of Bryan Twyne's grandfather John Twyne, which strengthens the possibility of an earlier Canterbury route of transmission. See Andrew G. Watson, 'John Twyne of Canterbury (d. 1581) as a Collector of Medieval Manuscripts', *The Library*, 8th series, 6 (1986), 133–51. For the argument that the manuscript was produced at Fiore, see Fabio Troncarelli, 'A Terrible Beauty. Nascità ed evoluzione del Liber Figurarum', *Florentia*, 11 (1997), 7–40, and the discussion in Robert Lerner, *The Feast of St. Abraham: Medieval Millenarians and the Jews* (Philadelphia, 2001), 27–8 and notes. I am grateful to Robert Lerner for his advice on the provenance of this manuscript.

¹⁰ For description, see George F. Warner and Julius P. Gilson, *British Museum. A Catalogue of Western Manuscripts in the Old Royal and King's Collection*, 4 vols (London, 1921), i, 273; for detailed discussion, see Kerby-Fulton, *Books under Suspicion*, 89–94 (and see the next note). The first and last leaves of Part A, fol. 1r and fol. 54v, were once outer leaves and are very stained and dirty. The decoration looks English and is by the same hand throughout. The manuscript has been very carefully corrected by the main scribe and especially checked for wrongly expanded abbreviations (e.g., fol. 20v and fol. 34r), showing that the scribe was comparing his work with yet another exemplar of this rare text. There are annotations in both a contemporary hand (e.g., fol. 2v, 3r) and a later hand (e.g., fol. 27r, 29r, and 29v), sometimes using a system of signs. The only note in the Protocol section is, significantly, 'Super Bestia'.

¹¹ The text largely follows the one in Oswald Holder-Egger, 'Italienische Prophetieen des 13. Jahrhunderts (iii)', *Neues Archiv*, 33 (1908), 96–187, but is a different redaction. One striking exception in an Insular context appears on fol. 39r, where a large piece of text is missing, corresponding to Holder-Egger, 152: 'A pressurarum igitur oneribus ...' where it runs to the beginning of the heading *Secunda distinctio*, Holder-Egger, 171. Since this has the effect of removing the section called 'De statibus' in other manuscripts, one can only assume that the omission may have been deliberate. Moreover, Nicole Bériou identifies this version of the text as a copy of a redaction by Pierre de Limoges, now in Paris, BNF, MS lat. 16397, and notes that neither copy is collated in Holder-Egger's edition; see Bériou, 'Pierre de Limoges', 65–107, especially 74. I would like to thank Robert Lerner for mentioning Bériou's study to me.

¹² Reeves, *Influence*, 521.

¹³ MS Sloane 156 is largely unstudied and has only been partially described. See Edward Scott, *Index to the Sloane Manuscripts in the British Museum* (London, 1921), 280, 465. It was briefly mentioned by Bloomfield, *Piers Plowman as a Fourteenth-century Apocalypse*, Appendix One. Fol. 1r contains a Table of Contents in a late hand, fol. 2r–6r a prophecy in English in a later (that is, secretary) hand, followed by some medical texts (fol. 7r 'Remedia contra morbos', fol. 9v 'De ponderibus medicorum'). Most of the rest of the manuscript is apocalyptic in nature: in addition to the Joachite texts mentioned in the table above, on fol. 11r begins 'Tractatus de Antichristo et fine mundi', a short work of conventional eschatology. On fol. 41v, in copying 'Ioachim in magno libro', the scribe apparently switched to an older exemplar, because after the date 1347, he starts imitating an older

anglicana hand. A catchword ('in terram') on the bottom of fol. 41v makes clear that something is missing between that leaf and text that follows on fol. 42r, suggesting the following collation: i⁶ | ii⁴ | iii⁸ (wants 1) iv – vii⁸ | viii¹¹. In an email message dated 26 October 2006, Robert Lerner kindly provided me with the following information: 'I might add that I take the MS to have been copied c. 1350, that the Rupescissa *Vade mecum* may be one of the best surviving, and that the opening Antichrist text (missing the opening part) is the Antichrist section from Hugo Ripelin.'

¹⁴ 'Incipit liber Joachimi abbatis florentis. Henrico sexto inclito Romanorum augusto frater Joachim, abbas florentis. Pie petis aliquid de propheciis qui vel tempora tua respiciunt...' and ends, fol. 41v: 'dolor dabit super miseram egiptu'. It appears to be an abridgement of the text as edited by Holder-Egger, 'Italienische Prophetieen (iii)', 139–87.

¹⁵ Here 'magno'. This text forms part of a small collection of short prophecies added on to the *De oneribus*, among them, on fol. 40v, a text of the Tripoli prophecy not mentioned in Lerner, *Powers*.

¹⁶ Joseph Planta, *A Catalogue of the Manuscripts in the Cottonian Library Deposited in the British Museum* (London, 1802), 35–6, and Thomas Smith, *Manuscripts in the Cottonian Library* (Oxford, 1669), 22–3 [ed. Colin G.C. Tite (Cambridge, 1984)].

¹⁷ I follow here the older foliation to coincide with Reeves's description. The opening of *De oneribus* is not clearly marked, and therefore Reeves thought the entire text was *Super Esaiam*, but on fol. 118r the 'Onus phylistini' of *De oneribus* begins, on fol. 118v the 'Onus Moab', on fol. 120r the 'Onus Damasca', and so on, until fol. 138r, where we read, 'Explicit tractatus honerum prophetarum'. (Compare Holder-Egger's 'Italienische Prophetieen' edition, which is ordered slightly differently.) Moreover, on fol. 138v a brief new text begins, 'Ecce ab honeribus omnibus expediti quibus orbis in suis urbibus ...'.

¹⁸ See Falconer Madan and H.H.E. Craster, *A Summary Catalogue of Western Manuscripts in the Bodleian Library at Oxford*, 7 vols (Oxford, 1895–1953), ii/1, 78–9, no. 1841.

¹⁹ For a transcription and discussion, see Morton Bloomfield and Marjorie Reeves, 'The Penetration of Joachimism into Northern Europe', *Speculum*, 29 (1954), 772–93, at 784–5.

²⁰ Described by Montague R. James, *A Descriptive Catalogue of Manuscripts in the Library of Corpus Christi College, Cambridge*, 2 vols (Cambridge, 1912), ii, 137–8.

²¹ D.L. Douie, 'Olivi's Postilla Super Matthaeum (MS New College B. 49)', *Franciscan Studies*, 35 (1975), 66–92, at 67, for description; a folio (s. xi) containing an Anglo-Saxon dialogue of Bede's is interpolated, suggesting English provenance.

²² Described by Henry Octavius Coxe, *Catalogus Codicum Manuscriptorum qui in Collegiis Aulisque Oxoniensibus hodie adservantur*, 2 vols (Oxford, 1852), i, pars 7: Collegii Novi, 14.

²³ 'Erat quidam Petrus Iohannis hereticus, unus complicitibus Ioachimi abbatis heresiarche, cum ergo non constat cuius Petri Iohannis hoc opus sit, non alienum putavi ab offitio meo imprudentem lectorem admonere', (fol. 159v; the rest is erased); see Douie, 'Olivi's Postilla', 68, n. 9; and for discussion, see Kerby-Fulton, *Books under Suspicion*, xiv and 95–9. Dating the hand that created this note is not easy. Coxe, *ibid.*, says only that it is 'recentior' than the hand that copied the manuscript. In fact, there are several examples of such hands in English manuscripts even during Whethamstede's lifetime; see Andrew G. Watson, *Catalogue of Dated and Datable Manuscripts c. 435–1600 in Oxford Libraries*, 2 vols (Oxford, 1984), ii, s.p., plate 453 of St John's College, MS 35, fol. 90v, dated as 'England, 1447'; plate 415 of Balliol College, MS 122, fol. 265, dated at 'Oxford, 1442?'; plate 426(b) of Bodley MS 742, fol. 302, dated as 'England, 1444'. We should also note that there is no sign of classicized Latin orthography in the note (e.g., 'hereticus' and 'heresiarche' are not classicized), suggesting that the hand, whatever its date, is medieval, not Renaissance.

²⁴ On Whethamstede, see Kerby-Fulton, *Books under Suspicion*, 100–103.

²⁵ Made during Whethamstede's first tenure as abbot of St Albans, during which period he paid 60 shillings for having it done. Unlike the other extant books he commissioned during this period, there is no explicit mention of his ownership, and the flyleaves have been deliberately excised. However, the 'lamb and flag' decoration associated with him, and the evidence of library chaining which closely resembles that of Oxford, Worcester College, MS 233, show that there is no doubt it was donated to Gloucester College, Oxford by Whethamstede. See Watson, *Dated and Datable Manuscripts*, i, 141.

²⁶ For the full description, see Cosimus Stornajolo, *Codices Vrbinales Latini*, i (Rome, 1902), no. 480. The manuscript also contains works by Hugh of Digne and St Bonaventure. Stornajolo notes that 'tituli, fortasse marginibus excisis, desunt', but that a sixteenth-century hand supplies a listing of Olivi's works. I have not seen this manuscript, but this fits the pattern of excision and erasure in Olivi's other extant works of English provenance, discussed in Kerby-Fulton, *Books under Suspicion* (see n. 24 above for further details). Olivi's commentary on Pseudo-Dionysius (starting on fol. 122r) is currently being edited by Sylvain Piron; see Sylvain Piron, 'Deplatonising the Celestial Hierarchy: Peter John Olivi's Interpretation of the Pseudo-Dionysius', in *Angels in Medieval Philosophical Inquiry: Their Function and Significance*, ed. Isabel Iribarren and Martin Lenz (Aldershot, 2008), 29–44. Prof. Piron tells me that the 'English hand' of this manuscript may be that of an Aquitaine friar trained under English tutelage when the region was under English influence (private correspondence, 22 July 2008).

²⁷ For full description, see *Catalogi codicum manuscriptorum Bibliothecae Bodleianae, pars ii: Codices Latinos et Miscellaneos Laudiani*, by Henry Coxe (Oxford, 1858–85), no. 85. And see the entry for Henry of Costesy (Cossey) in Sharpe, *Handlist*, 166, for a full list of manuscripts and medieval attestations (see also the list of attestations below). The other authors it contains are Pecham, Grosseteste, and William of Auvergne; the Henry of Costesy commentary is copied by Hand 2, the most active of three hands in the manuscript, and also the corrector. It was once part of a much larger manuscript; the first item, the opening of the Pecham, now fol. 1r, was once fol. 175r. Reader's symbols like those designed by Grosseteste and used in university manuscripts appear, e.g., fol. 155v. The tendency, presumably Henry's own, to use a great many informal handwritten diagrams of a Joachite kind to illustrate his points, is evident in other Costesy manuscripts listed below (like Rawlinson and Harley), but rarely used in Laud.

²⁸ The Henry of Costesy commentary is defective at the end (its final words are 'Sed genus, quia addit temporalis nativitatis'). It has also been deliberately mutilated in at least two ways: the opening rubric has been carefully cut away on the first folio (67v), that is, both the upper margin and the side margin (the places where authorship or other identifying annotation would be most likely to occur). The decorative flourishing in the manuscript is of the most utilitarian sort. (This is a very plain Franciscan text, judging by surviving opening pages, adorned only with standard issue blue capitals and red flourishing.) There would therefore have been no aesthetic temptation to make these cuts (see fol. 32r, the Grosseteste opening, for a surviving instance). The knife used also injured, but did not remove, sections of fol. 66r and fol. 65r. Secondly, there is a stub of a folio between what is now fol. 122r and fol. 123r which once contained most of the portion of the text on the name of the beast; what now survives is a little of the inner margin and a note: 'notate bestia'.

²⁹ For the reasons why the book likely originated in the Franciscan House at Cambridge, see Kerby-Fulton, *Books under Suspicion*, 84–5.

³⁰ See Madan and Craster, *A Summary Catalogue*, ii/1, 138–40, no. 1969. I am most grateful to Sylvain Piron for this reference. On Olivi's work in this manuscript, see his 'Marchands et confesseurs: Le Traité des contrats d'Olivi dans son contexte (Narbonne, fin XIIIe — début XIVE siècle)', in *L'Argent au Moyen Age: XXVIIIe Congrès de la SHMESP, Clermont-Ferrand, 1997* (Paris, 1998), 289–308.

³¹ Originally Convent of the Holy Name, Washington, DC, MS 69, now kept at St Bonaventure University, St Bonaventure, New York. Described in Seymour De Ricci and William Jerome Wilson, *Medieval and Renaissance Manuscripts in the United States and Canada*, 2 vols (New York, 1935–57), ii, 31, as written in England, but in modern times obtained from Germany. Significantly, the text is attributed in this manuscript to Petrus Aureolus; 24 x 18 cm in size.

³² Described *Catalogi codicum manuscriptorum Bibliothecae Bodleianae, pars v/2: Codices Manuscripti ... Ricardi Rawlinson*, by William Dunn Macray (Oxford, 1878). This tiny, heavily abbreviated, and roughly written text contains Bonaventure's *Breviloquium*, starting fol. 1r (in a hand of s. xiii), in addition to the Henry of Costesy text (s. xiv, in fact, contemporary with Henry's lifetime). It is heavily annotated. On fol. 224v is a third short text, *De significatione symbolica forme jus jurandum imponende*. The text of Henry's commentary differs significantly in Rawlinson from the one in Laud. The text was only explicitly identified as Henry's in a hand of the fifteenth century, which wrote 'lectura costeseye super Apocalypsim' on fol. 131r (that is, the opening page). The same hand wrote 'Cantelow' in the lower margin of the page and also on the opening page of the Bonaventure. This may be the name of a fifteenth-century owner.

³³ As the contents and the tiny size suggest; see previous note on possible fifteenth-century ownership.

³⁴ Described in *A Catalogue of Harleian Manuscripts*, iii, 530; see also Sharpe, *Handlist*.

³⁵ Harley is a tiny, palm-size manuscript, undoubtedly a Franciscan vade mecum book. There are some summary annotations in the original scribe's hand (e.g., 'stelle cadunt' on fol. 57v); there are also extensive sixteenth-century annotations. It is a utility-grade manuscript in every sense; Henry's many figures are simply and informally executed here; it is also in poor condition, apparently having been unbound for a long time early in its life.

³⁶ *A Catalogue of the Archiepiscopal Manuscripts in the Library at Lambeth Palace* (London, 1812), 14–15, and see Sharpe, *Handlist*.

³⁷ The manuscript is a large collection of vernacular Wycliffite materials, for a description of which, see Thomas Kingsmill Abbot, *Catalogue of the MSS in the Library of Trinity College, Dublin* (Dublin, 1900), 35–6.

³⁸ Pseudo-Joachite works cited by name (in Middle English translation) are: *De oneribus prophetarum*, *De semine scripturarum*, and *Vaticinia de Summis Pontificibus*. 'Gallorum levitas' is also cited as by the 'Sibille'. See Kerby-Fulton, *Reformist Apocalypticism*, 184–6. The treatise is edited by J. Todd (who mistook it for a work by Wyclif), in James Henthorn Todd, *The Last Age of the Church* (Dublin, 1840), xxi–xxxvi.

³⁹ Bale gives the incipit in Latin translation, 'Sacerdotes, proh dolor!', and also refers to the tract as 'De Simonia Sacerdotum, lib. 1. Heu magni Sacerdotes in tenebris', in John Bale, *Scriptorum illustrium Maioris Britanniae Catalogus*, 2 vols (Basle, 1557–59), ii, 453. See Todd, *Last Age*, xvi.

⁴⁰ See the description in Neil Ripley Ker, *Medieval Manuscripts in British Libraries*, 5 vols (Oxford, 1979–2002), i, 127.

⁴¹ Perhaps originally written for a member of the Brokesby family, whose arms appear on fol. 27r, although this may have been a later addition. Given to the Augustinian priory of Kirby Bellars, Leicestershire by Bartholomew Brokesby (d. 1448) in 1437, which is significant because the continuation of the *Eulogium* (for 1356–1534) was done at Kirby Bellars, probably by Canon William Wymondham, whose colophon is on fol. 26v. The *Eulogium* mentions Joachim positively both in the original version and in the continuation.

⁴² See Montague R. James, *The Western Manuscripts in the Library of Trinity College, Cambridge*, 4 vols (Cambridge, 1900–1904), ii, 216–17, no. 740; and see Jeanne Bignami Odier, *Études sur Jean de Roquetaillade* (Paris, 1952), 245.

⁴³ See Marvin L. Colker, *Trinity College Library Dublin: Descriptive Catalogue of the Mediaeval and Renaissance Latin Manuscripts*, 2 vols (Aldershot, 1991), ii, 914–16.

⁴⁴ Heavily glossed with marginal annotations and even drawings (e.g., fol. 3r), concerning disendowment, the Franciscan order, earthquakes, Antichrist, and the coming ‘reparatoris orbis’ (fol. 4r) Rupescissa predicts.

⁴⁵ For the most recent and detailed description of this manuscript and its important copy of Walsingham’s *St. Albans Chronicle* (which shows evidence of having suppressed sensitive political narrative at the accession of Henry IV), see *The St. Albans Chronicle*, ed. John Taylor et al. (Oxford, 2003), Appendix One. However, the editors still follow the *Royal Catalogue* description in not identifying the letter on fol. 94vb, written by ‘an imprisoned friar to Pope Innocent VI’ in 1356, as in fact Rupescissa’s. The manuscript, which also contains *mirabilia* literature, *Mandeville’s Travels*, the ubiquitous vision of Becket at Sens, and other chronicles, was made at St Albans c. 1400. On the manuscript context, see Kathryn Kerby-Fulton, ‘Langland’s Reading: Some Evidence from MSS of English Provenance Containing Latin Religious Prophecy’, in *The Uses of Manuscripts in Literary Studies: Essays in Memory of Judson Boyce Allen*, ed. Charlotte Cook Morse, Penelope Reed Doob, and Marjorie Curry Woods (Kalamazoo, 1992), 137–61. On the letter itself (‘Vos misistis’) and some of the textual differences between it and the printed version, see Kerby-Fulton, *Books under Suspicion*, 211 and 429, nn. 29, 30, 34. The letter is printed from an English manuscript in Ortvinus Gratius, *Appendix ad Fasciculum rerum expetendarum et fugiendarum*, ed. Edward Brown (London, 1690), 404–6. On its occurrence in the *Prima Vita Innocentii VI*, see Robert Lerner’s introduction to the text of Rupescissa’s *Liber secretorum eventuum*, ed. Christine Morerod-Fattebert (Fribourg, 1994), 40, n. 59.

⁴⁶ I am grateful to Robert Lerner for advice about this. For another copy, see Cambridge, Corpus Christi College, MS 404 (below).

⁴⁷ I am grateful to Robert Lerner for his advice about the dating and origin of the manuscript.

⁴⁸ Described in Coxe, *Catalogus*, ii/l, pars 4: Collegii Corporis Christi, 17.

⁴⁹ The *Vade mecum* is the only medieval item in the manuscript; it is bound with a printed edition of the *Speculum Ecclesiae Pontificiae Nicolaus Clemangis* (London, 1606). The text of the *Vade mecum* contains an elaborate set of contemporary annotations made by Hand 2 (using a script of probably the second quarter of the fourteenth century). Hand 2 copied fol. 2r–10v, after which Hand 3 takes over, a contemporary of Hand 2. The annotations show detailed interest in Antichrist, clerical poverty, clerical chastisement, and foreign affairs. The annotator is especially concerned with passages which predict the reduction of clerical *modus vivendi* (e.g., fol. 3r, 3v, 4r). Cropping has spoiled some of the annotator’s work, but it remains a very interesting example of contemporary marginalia.

⁵⁰ ‘Liber Collegii Corporis Christi ex dono Sebastiani Benfield Bacchalaurei in S. Theologia socii ejusdam Collegii, 1605’.

⁵¹ Hand I of MS Corpus 47, which copied only fol. 1r–v of the text, writes a very early script, consistent with someone taught to write earlier in the fourteenth century. This would have to have been written in England by a contemporary of John of Rupescissa and almost certainly before his death (sometime not long after 1365).

⁵² Warner and Gilson, *British Museum. A Catalogue of Western Manuscripts*, i, 253.

⁵³ Described in *A Catalogue of the Harleian Manuscripts*, i, 507.

⁵⁴ See, e.g., the annotation on fol. 34v; on fol. 40v is the ‘Epistola soldani’ and response. On fol. 40r is ‘Ter tria lustra’, a short prophecy of church reform (on which, see Kerby-Fulton, *Reformist Apocalypticism*, 187) and then a ‘Disputatione sompniorum’ on fol. 44r, all copied by Hand 3 of the manuscript. On fol. 81r, Hand 3 becomes active again and copies several political prophecies, including ‘Lilium regnans’, followed by a key and ‘Gens erit australis’.

⁵⁵ A collection of largely political prophecies, for a full listing of which, see Planta, *Catalogue*, 580–81, and also Henry L.D. Ward, *Catalogue of Romances in the British Museum*, 3 vols (London, 1883–1910), i, 310–11; see also Leslie Coote, *Prophecy and Public Affairs in Later Medieval England* (York, 2000), 265. The manuscript also includes the so-called *Bridlington Prophecies*, fol. 100r, on which, see Reeves, *Influence*, 254–6, who reads them very astutely as a kind of secular Joachimism.

⁵⁶ Called ‘John of Bessagoria’ in this manuscript, an astrological prophet who gained a reputation in the mid-fourteenth century for foretelling the Black Death, and whose prophecy here predicts an angelic pope. See Lynn Thorndike, *A History of Magic and Experimental Science*, 8 vols (New York, 1923–58), iii, 312. I would like to thank Robert Lerner for kindly sharing information with me about the ‘Tacui’ prophecy and its author; on the manuscript, see Lerner’s *Feast of St. Abraham*, 157–8, n. 39, and on his interest in the Jews, 83–8.

⁵⁷ A letter of his appears on fol. 122v, in which he loans the book to M. Chester, hoping that he will profit by it because ‘I have no understandynge of yt butt a lyttyll’. (The modern reader empathizes!)

⁵⁸ See Lerner, *Feast of St. Abraham*, 157–8, n. 39. I would like to thank Robert Lerner for advice about this.

⁵⁹ Bignami Odier, *Roquetaillade*, 250. The manuscript is described in Warner and Gilson, *British Museum. A Catalogue of Western Manuscripts*, i, 165–7.

⁶⁰ I would like to thank Robert Lerner for this piece of information.

⁶¹ Robert Lerner alerted me to this copy. The manuscript is described in S.A.J. Moorat, *Catalogue of Western Manuscripts of Medicine and Science in the Wellcome Historical Medical Library*, 3 vols (London, 1962), i: MSS written before AD 1650, 344–7.

⁶² Described in James, *A Descriptive Catalogue*, ii, 269–77. MS 404 is an important and extensive anthology of prophetic texts gathered together over a period of years by the Benedictine librarian at Bury St Edmunds, Henry of Kirkestede, author of England’s first union catalogue (see above). See Lerner, *Powers*, 93–101; and Kerby-Fulton, *Reformist Apocalypticism*, 25, 209–10 and 237–8. I have listed here only the obviously Joachite pieces in the anthology, although there are others which are arguably relevant to or influenced by Joachimism. I have also mentioned Gebeno of Eberbach’s *Pentachronon*, this being an especially interesting text of it (on which, see Kerby-Fulton, ‘Prophecy and Suspicion’). Charl Harper and E. Randolph Daniel have kindly shared with me their forthcoming paper, ‘Henry of Kirkstede and the “De Seminibus Scripturarum”’, which deals with this manuscript in detail. For a full listing of the political prophecies in this manuscript, see Coote, *Prophecy and Public Affairs*, 241 and Anke Holdenried, *The Sybil and Her Scribes: Manuscripts and Interpretation of the Latin Sibylla Tiburtina, c. 1050–1500* (Aldershot, 2006), 74, and see Henry of Kirkestede, *Catalogus de libris authenticis et apocryfis*, ed. Richard and Mary Rouse, *Corpus of British Medieval Library Catalogues 11* (London, 2004), lxxvii–lxxxii.

⁶³ For which, see Ralph’s *Chronicon Anglicanum*, ed. Joseph Stevenson, RS 66 (London, 1875), 67–70, and Reeves, *Influence*, 12–14. See also Lerner’s discussion (*Powers*, *ibid.*) of Henry of Kirkestede’s version of the passage, important because Henry copied it into Corpus MS 404 from a manuscript at Coggeshall itself, and because it confirms that the interview between Joachim and Adam of Perseigne took place in 1195. As Lerner points out, Henry may have suppressed Joachim’s name here. However, Christoph Egger has kindly informed me that the dating to 1195 may not be tenable: see his essay in this volume, %%.

⁶⁴ Kerby-Fulton and Daniel, ‘Columbinus Prophecy’.

⁶⁵ Called here *De Seminibus Litterarum*.

⁶⁶ Reeves, *Influence*, 523.

⁶⁷ Containing the first 15 only (inc. ‘Genus nequam’), and a very early copy. See Reeves, *Influence*, 524; Lerner, *Powers*, 96–8; and for a helpful survey of the literature, Lerner, ‘Recent Work’.

⁶⁸ Cited in Reeves as *Ioachim in maiori libro de concordanciis*, elsewhere often as ‘Corruent nobiles’. See Reeves, *Influence*, 50, for the text of the prophecy, and Lerner, *Powers*, 58, n. 39, and 98, n. 33 (for Corpus MS 404), 120, n. 14 for all English copies joined to the Tripoli prophecy, and 193.

⁶⁹ See also London, BL, MS Royal 13. E. IX above.

⁷⁰ Described in James, *A Descriptive Catalogue*; Christian Jostmann, *Sibilla Erithea Babilonica. Papsttum und Prophetie im 13. Jahrhundert*, MGH, Schriften, 54 (Hannover, 2006), 437; for a listing of the political prophecies, see Coote, *Prophecy and Public Affairs*, 240.

⁷¹ A single leaf of vellum is inserted with entries in a hand of s. xiii after 216 with material relating to the bishop of Norwich. Corpus MS 138 contains items from chronicles and various items associated with the Avignon papacy, including the letters of 1333 relating to the Beatific Vision controversies, 157.

⁷² James notes that on the flyleaf is a table made for Parker (whose collection forms the basis of Corpus Christi’s present collection) by Robertus Recorde, M.D. Cambridge 1545, died 1558.

⁷³ Copied in one hand. See description in *Catalogue of the Manuscripts Preserved in the Cambridge University Library*, 5 vols (Cambridge, 1856–67) iv, 107–9; in Reeves, *Influence*, 520, and in Jostmann, *Sibilla*, 411–15; for political prophecies, see listing in Coote, *Prophecy and Public Affairs*, 248; and Holdenried, *Sibyl*, 159.

⁷⁴ Described by Roger Aubrey Baskerville Mynors, *Catalogue of the Manuscripts of Balliol College Oxford* (Oxford, 1963), 130–35.

⁷⁵ These two items appear in the second booklet of the manuscript (which begins at fol. 107r) and is a generation earlier than the first booklet (which was written not long after 1381). The first booklet contains mainly sermons but also a fragmentary copy of Uthred de Boldon’s defence, *Contra querelas fratrum*, fol. 63r. The second booklet contains correspondence relating to the papacy, a commentary (‘Moralitates quedam super librum Apo.’ fol. 192r), and a sermon. For a fuller discussion, see Kerby-Fulton, ‘Langland’s Reading’, and ead., *Reformist Apocalypticism*, 229.

⁷⁶ A note on the flyleaf records that the volume was given to Balliol ‘ex legato magistri Roberti Thwaites quondam magistri eiusdem domus’; see Mynors, *Catalogue*, 135.

⁷⁷ Described Montague Rhodes James, *Catalogue of Manuscripts in the Gonville and Caius Library*, 3 vols (Cambridge, 1907–14), ii. The commonplace book of John Whethamstede, distinguished abbot of St Albans and Benedictine representative at international church councils. The book also contains, among other interesting entries, an article on papal power by Whethamstede himself, citing Dante, *De Monarchia*, and Marsilius of Padua, *De Ecclesiastica Potestate*, fol. 142r (inc. ‘Papa presidem supremus in ecclesia’), and an excerpt from John of Lignano on the Schism, fol. 167r.

⁷⁸ The prophecy does not mention Joachim explicitly, but it has a vaguely Joachite form of optimism, and often travels with other Joachite or ecclesiastical reformist materials. It prophesies a ‘pax finalis’ throughout the world, ‘unita fide simul et unitur ovile’ (quoting here from the copy in Gonville and Caius, MS 230, fol. 22v).

⁷⁹ Whethamstede’s first tenure as abbot.

⁸⁰ See the description in Ralph Hanna, *Manuscripts in St. John’s College, Oxford* (Oxford, 2002), 295–9, at 297–8. I would like to thank Robert Lerner for alerting me to this manuscript.

⁸¹ One of our very few named compilers of such materials, John Harryson (or Herryson) was a Cambridge student and doctor of medicine, whose compilation is largely made up of historical texts (including a history of Cambridge) and prophecy. He is very interested in natural disasters, which partly explains his interest in apocalypticism. His comments on the *Vade mecum* passage take note of Rupescissa’s predictions of floods, epidemics, tempests, and the moral effects of the Antichrist’s triumph (noting especially *intentio quinta*). His commentary asserts that Rupescissa’s predictions are verified by a host of other prophets, whom he lists, and among whom is Joachim. Since James,

Catalogue of Manuscripts in the Gonville and Caius Library, gives a very incomplete and sometimes inaccurate list of the short prophecies, and Coote lists only the political prophecies (*Prophecy and Public Affairs*, 242–3), I will give the incipits all here. Even though many are simply political prophecies, several have been noticed in Holder-Egger, ‘Italienische Prophetieen’, and elsewhere in modern Joachimite studies: fol. 181r ‘Extincto herede regnans’, fol. 181v ‘Tolle capud’, fol. 182r ‘Regnum Scotorum’, ‘Ter tria lustra’ [see above, MS Harley 1008], and ‘Cambria carnerwan Anglie’, fol. 182v ‘Gens normanorum’, ‘Anglorum regnum’, ‘Quando sambucus’ (which includes ‘Gallorum levitas’ here), ‘Veniet aquila’ [see Reeves, *Influence*, 534, who says it may be derived from *Super Hieremiam*], and ‘Regina austri’, fol. 183r ‘Catulus linxus in lupum’, ‘Quoniam superbus’, ‘Draco maxime fidet’, ‘Sub gallo hispano’, ‘In novissmio temporibus princeps’, followed by ‘Joachim in libro de honeribus: Ve ti vitula eligans & gallus & galiam stupefcunt ...’ ending ‘propter tores superabit’. (I have not found this in Holder Egger’s edition, and suspect it is pseudo-pseudo-Joachim, to coin a term, especially since it is followed by ‘Surget leo’, which is also claimed to be from *De oneribus*.) This is followed by ‘Pagani habentes vaticinia quam plura’, and on fol. 183v ‘Veniet ab occidente’, ‘Cedrus alta libani’ [that is, the Tripoli prophecy; see Lerner, *Powers*, 101, n. 42 and 222], ‘Denique de latero’, ‘A longe petra veniet’, ‘In occidus partibus’, ‘Misterium hominis cuius’, ‘Deposito diademate’, followed by a rare Robert of Uzes extract, ‘Post hec factum est verbum domini ad me dicens: Serve meus congregati sunt ...’ ending ‘columba ingemiscet’. This is followed by ‘Gallus rex francie’. On fol. 217r, after the Rupescissa commentary, there are a few more prophecies: ‘Quando ego Thomas’, fol. 217v, ‘Arbor fertilis’, with a comparison to ‘Mortuo leone’ and then the verses ‘Bruti posteritas albanis associata’ [a correction to James, ‘Beati posteritas’], followed by ‘Lilium regnans’, and ‘Lilium rex Francie’. For the vernacular political prophecies that follow, see Coote, *Prophecy and Public Affairs*, 243.

⁸² See Alfred Brotherston Emden, *A Biographical Register of the University of Cambridge to 1500* (Cambridge, 1963), 290, who corrects the earlier assumption that Harryson had been chancellor of Cambridge (based on a misreading of the list of chancellors he gives in this manuscript, fol. 131v). Harryson writes here that he incepted ‘in sacris medicinis, licet indignus’ in 1457. From 1449 to 1450 he was chaplain to the nuns of St Radegund’s Priory in Cambridge, a vocational interest that may account for the notes on holy women related to the apostles ‘Nota quod S. Petronilla virgo ...’, flyleaf.

⁸³ Reeves, *Influence*, 523; for the political prophecies in the manuscript, see Coote, *Prophecy and Public Affairs*, 279.

⁸⁴ The manuscript also contains Hildegardian material.

⁸⁵ A large anthology made of booklets from more than one period, of which Booklets D and E are of concern to us. These are described in the *Sotheby’s Sale Catalogue* of November 1973. Booklet D, containing 68 leaves, deals predominantly with the mendicant controversies of the thirteenth century, and largely from a Franciscan perspective; it also contains excerpts from William of St Amour’s *De periculis*, fol. 56r. On the connections of this manuscript with the Franciscan house at Oxford, and, more certainly, with The Queen’s College, see Kerby-Fulton, ‘Prophecy and Suspicion’. Booklet E, beginning at fol. 122r, contains the Joachimite material listed here. For a detailed description of the manuscript, see Kathryn Kerby-Fulton, Magda Hayton, and Kenna Olsen, ‘The Pseudo-Hildegardian Prophecy and Antimendicant Propaganda in Late Medieval England: An Edition of the Most Popular Insular Text of “Insurgent gentes”’, in *Proceedings of the Harlaxton Conference on England and France in the Fifteenth Centuries*, ed. Nigel Morgan (Oxford, 2004), 160–93. See also the earlier discussion and list in Andrew George Little, *Fratris Thomae Vulgo Dicti de Eccleston Tractatus de Adventu Fratrum Minorum in Angliam* (Manchester, 1951). Especially unusual is the attribution of ‘Insurgent gentes’, a piece almost universally (pseudonymously) attributed to Hildegard of Bingen, here attributed to Joachim. A copy of the material in Booklet E, or something very like it, was once a part of MS Cotton Vitellius E.II, which was badly damaged in the Cotton library fire. See Attestations below.

⁸⁶ Moreover, the leaves of the quire are disarranged.

⁸⁷ 'Quoniam scriptum' lists three works, which the scribe has highlighted, and notes on fol. 126v: '1. Prophecia Catholica incipit Homines pestilentes; 2. Apologia de pseudo-theologorum et religioses; 3. Eulogium de noticia verorum & pseudo-apostolarum'. In 'Quoniam scriptum' Arnold lists 'XII spurcias' [sic, written over erasure; cf. 'De spuraciis' in the running headings] revealed to 'Cirille' the hermit. Arnold's list seems to owe a great deal to Hildegard's Cologne letter and to 'Insurgent gentes', which precedes it here, in informing the public about how to distinguish pseudo-prophets.

⁸⁸ Colker, *Trinity College Library*, ii, 976–1002; Kerby-Fulton, *Reformist Apocalypticism*, 210 and 240.

⁸⁹ Reeves, *Influence*, 529. The prophecy explains the three *status*, but is mainly interested in the two orders. (In fact, the rubric at the end of the prophecy reads: 'Explicit prophecia ioachim de ordine fratrum minorum et predicatorum'. On the official Franciscan content of the manuscript, see Kajetan Esser, Remy Oliger, *La Tradition manuscrite des opuscles de S. Frangoise d'Assise*. Subsidia Scientifica Franciscalia, 3 (Rome, 1972), %%. The 'Dixit Joachim' is genuinely Joachite in exegetical method; it is followed appropriately by an extract from Eusebius, fol. 389v (a writer who figures in the Columbinus prophecy, on which see Kerby-Fulton and Daniel, 'Columbinus Prophecy'). On fol. 393r is the Wyenne Prophecy, which mentions that the teachers of theology at Paris will cease in 1255, and that in 1270 a pope will abandon Rome to be replaced by another. The interest in the Paris theology faculty in 1255 must stem from mendicant concern about the issues surrounding the condemnation of the radical Franciscan Joachite Gerard of Borgo San Donnino, and William of St Amour's attack on the friars.

⁹⁰ Madan and Craster, *A Summary Catalogue*, ii/1, 413–15, no. 2535.

⁹¹ A rector of Sherfield in 1328. See also Lerner, *Powers*, 118, n. 6, for further bibliography on MS Bodley 761.

⁹² See Madan and Craster, *A Summary Catalogue*, iv, 516–17, no. 21662, Booklet E. The manuscript also contains a treatise of monsters and portents, followed by *De septem mirabilibus mundi*, fol. 115v, and excerpts from the *Polycraticus* of John of Salisbury, fol. 116v. See also Kerby-Fulton, 'Langland's Reading'; *Reformist Apocalypticism*, 24, 209, 240; and Lerner, 'Recent Work'.

⁹³ Compare Holder-Egger's edition, 140. The excerpt ends: '... vt manus magis attrahat quam extendat'. The collection also contains the Becket prophecy, 'Quando ego Thomas', fol. 61v, and a Bridgettine prophecy, fol. 62r (inc. 'Cum essem orando vidi qualiter', that is, the famous political vision involving 'Beatus dionisius', which made Bridget more popular in England than in France. On fol. 63v is a prophecy that plagiarizes the Tripoli prophecy (see Lerner, *Powers*, 134); on fol. 66v 'Cesaris imperium', and fol. 67r, 'Anglia transmittet' (the latter two being popular prophecies that often travel with Joachite works). See Coote, *Prophecy and Public Affairs*, 274 for a full listing.

⁹⁴ An originally separate booklet of the twelfth century is bound in with this one, starting at fol. 94. Contrary to what the *Catalogue of the Manuscripts Preserved in the Cambridge University Library*, iii, 169, says, the collection of prophecies, fol. 63v–67r, is in fact in a different hand (Hand 1), but of the same period as the previous item (*Liber Methodius*, fol. 58r) and the item that follows it (*De Mirabilibus Rome civitatis*, fol. 68r), both copied by Hand 2. Hand 1 began the manuscript and copied up to fol. 12r, including a chronicle from Creation to 1447 (which records the important events of recent history, especially the plague, the windstorm of 1362, and the Rising of 1381). Hand 1 was very interested in history, prophecy, and the ages of the world; he copied *De sex etatibus* from fol. 4ff. Collation (of s. xv section): i¹⁰ ii¹⁴ (14 cancelled) iii–vii¹² viii¹² (wants 10 and 12).

⁹⁵ Described most recently in C. David Benson and Lynne Blanchfield, *The Manuscripts of Piers Plowman: The B-version* (Woodbridge, 1997), 33–7.

⁹⁶ On this very exegetical Joachite prophecy, unnoticed before, see Kerby-Fulton, *Books under Suspicion*, Case Study 1, 109–24. I am grateful there and here to Robert Lerner for advice on the

connection between this prophecy and the *Belial* text by Jacobus de Theramo (on whom, see note to Digby 218 below).

⁹⁷ The manuscript is made up of various booklets and looks like a working university compilation of the late thirteenth and fourteenth centuries. The same hand copied all the prophecies, items 17–20 in *Catalogi codicum manuscriptorum Bibliothecae Bodleianae pars ix: Codices a ... Kenelm Digby ... donatos*, by William Dunn Macray (Oxford, 1883), cols 231–3, and items 21 and 22, where 197b should read 107b. In the margin on fol. 107r is the prophecy of the holy oil of Thomas Becket, followed by the Tripoli prophecy (for which see Lerner, *Powers*, 118, n. 6; Lerner dates the copying of fol. 107r by notes on the verso about the chronology of English events c.1400). Fol. 107r is a singleton bound into the manuscript at a later date, but it is worth noting that the manuscript contains several texts relating to reformist issues. Our prophecy was bound in beside the Council of Vienne constitutions of Clement V (promulgated by John XXII in 1318), implicating beguines and followers of Olivi in heresy. Earlier in the manuscript is a copy of the controversial *Belial*, or ‘Jacobi de Tharamo liber dictus Consolatio Peccatorum’ (or sometimes ‘Processus Luciferi contra Jesum’), here fol. 25r. This was the text that the Joachite author of the Pseudo-Lignano prophecy borrowed from extensively (see C.U.L. MS Dd. 1. 17 above).

⁹⁸ This little-known prophecy, here in verse version, I have noticed in two manuscripts of English provenance (see also MS Gonville and Caius 230/116 above, for a prose version). The entirely positive apocalyptic note upon which it ends may suggest Joachite influence. On its political aspects, see Coote, *Prophecy and Public Affairs*, 212, 223.

⁹⁹ Montague R. James, *Lists of Manuscripts formerly Owned by John Dee*, Supplement to Transactions of the Cambridge Bibliographical Society 1 (Oxford, 1921), showing that Dee owned MS Digby 218 and also MS Digby 192, which he signed in 1576.

¹⁰⁰ Contains numerous prophecies; see Lerner, *Powers*, 101–3, 179 and 224–5.

¹⁰¹ Reeves, *Influence*, 51, n. 1; for a full listing of political prophecies, see Coote, *Prophecy and Public Affairs*, 261. There is also an excerpt from Bridget of Sweden on fol. 116v.

¹⁰² Described in Falconer Madan, H.H.E. Craster, and N. Denholm-Young, *A Summary Catalogue*, ii/2, 821–2, no. 4062. See Kerby-Fulton and Daniel, ‘Columbinus Prophecy’; Kerby-Fulton, *Reformist Apocalypticism*, 209, 210; Lerner, *Powers*, 118 and 227; and for the political prophecies, Coote, *Prophecy and Public Affairs*, 276 (with different foliation).

¹⁰³ Bignami-Odier, *Etudes sur Jean de Roquetaillade*, 249.

¹⁰⁴ Her ‘Justicia’ prophecy from the *Liber divinorum operum* and her Cologne prophecy; on both of these, and on Hatton, see Kerby-Fulton, ‘Prophecy and Suspicion’.

¹⁰⁵ Reeves, *Influence*, 84.

¹⁰⁶ See Kerby-Fulton and Daniel, ‘Columbinus Prophecy’. On the attack by John of Eschenden because its predictions for 1357–65 were unfounded, see Reeves, *ibid.* and see MS Ashmole 393 (below) and MS Digby 218, fol. 107r.

¹⁰⁷ Described in William Henry Black, *A descriptive, analytical and critical catalogue of the manuscripts bequeathed unto the University of Oxford by Elias Ashmole* (Oxford, 1845), cols 299–308. A collection of five manuscripts, the first of which, written in a rough cursive fifteenth-century hand, is a personal collection, largely astrological in nature. ‘Columbinus’ is preceded by ‘Aschyndene de tribus conjuncctionibus’, fol. 79r (astrological prophecy by John of Eschenden) followed by ‘Pronosticum Milonis Toletani de conjuncctione facta anno 1357’, fol. 80v. On fol. 96r, extracts from Chaucer’s *Treatise of the Astrolabye* begin. See Kerby-Fulton and Daniel, ‘Columbinus Prophecy’, 432–3 for the Ashmole text. MS Ashmole 192, part I, 1 contains an eighteenth-century transcript of this text, see Black, *ibid.*, col. 160.

¹⁰⁸ Madan and Craster, *Summary Catalogue*, i, 75, no. 1797, and described by Macray, *Catalogi ... Digby*; see also Coote, *Prophecy and Public Affairs*, 275. An 8.5” × 11” manuscript of 197 leaves,

many of which are singletons, this is a much rearranged collection to which several hands have contributed, with a Table of Contents from late s. xvi, containing chronicles, prophecies, and *mirabilia*. The hand that copied 'Columbinus' is the main hand of fol. 18r–22r (even though fol. 20r–23r are on smaller sheets of paper) and continues to fol. 29r. On these pages he created a small anthology of political and ecclesiastical prophecy, to which he also added the macaronic poem concerning the Rising of 1381 on fol. 20v, incipit 'The taxe hath tened us alle,/ Probat hoc mors tot validorum'. The same scribe's hand appears elsewhere in the manuscript sporadically, for instance on fol. 53r–54r, where he copied Macray's item 41 'De sex aetatibus mundi' (which is not Joachite), and item 42 'De vestibus sacerdotum'. He also copied item 54 on the English churches, 'tabula ecclesiarum cathedralium et abbatialium', fol. 73r, and item 91 'De Antichristo scire volentibus primo nomen notabimus', fol. 194r–194v. See also the entry for this manuscript in Patrick Horner, *Index of Middle English Prose*, Handlist iii (Cambridge, 1986), 59–61.

¹⁰⁹ See Reeves, *Influence*, 528, on 'Gallorum', and on 'Columbinus', see Kerby-Fulton and Daniel, 'Columbinus Prophecy'.

¹¹⁰ Described Planta, *Catalogue*, 582. It is the earliest English copy of the *Columbinus Prophecy*, in a fragmentary quire assembled with unrelated materials likely by Thomas Allen (b. 1540). This version of the prophecy likely preserves an allusion to Joachim's *Enchiridion super Apocalypsim*, which also circulated in England (see MS Harley 3049 above); see Kerby-Fulton and Daniel, 'Columbinus Prophecy', 322–3.

¹¹¹ See Kerby-Fulton and Daniel, 'Columbinus Prophecy', 333, n. 35; Lerner, *Powers*, 90, n. 11.

¹¹² Three manuscripts, the first two of which were together fairly soon after they were made, judging by consistent rubrication throughout. Moreover, the list of contents on the flyleaf mentions *Columbinus* as the last item. See Madan and Craster, *Summary Catalogue*, ii/1, 268–9, no. 2228.

¹¹³ See Kerby-Fulton and Daniel, 'Columbinus Prophecy'.

¹¹⁴ 'Iste est liber sancte Marie de Radynga ex dono Johannes Sarum de quo qui fraudem fecerit nouerit se excommunicatum', written on flyleaf, c. 1300, with table of contents in the same hand. Ker, *Medieval Libraries of Great Britain*, 155; Alan Coates, *English Medieval Books. The Reading Abbey Collections from Foundation to Dispersal* (Oxford, 1999), 67, 116, 136, 141, 161.

¹¹⁵ Described in Reginald Maxwell Woolley, *Catalogue of the Manuscripts of Lincoln Cathedral Library* (Oxford, 1927), no. 66, and Rodney Malcolm Thomson, *Catalogue of the Manuscripts of Lincoln Cathedral Chapter Library* (Lincoln and Cambridge, 1989), 47–9.

¹¹⁶ A version very close to that found in MS Digby 96 and which appears to understand the Joachite interpretation of the sixth seal. See Kerby-Fulton and Daniel, 'Columbinus Prophecy'.

¹¹⁷ Described by J.G. Evans, *Historical Manuscripts Commission Report on Manuscripts in the Welsh Language* (London, 1898–1910), 389–99, and see Kerby-Fulton and Daniel, 'Columbinus Prophecy', nn. 48 and 49. This is a maverick version of the prophecy made deliberately obscure to fit the political prophecy genre.

¹¹⁸ Coote, *Prophecy and Public Affairs*, 253; Coote writes 'the apocalyptic "Attende secundum Eusebium"' (that is, an unnoticed copy of the *Columbinus Prophecy*). I have not seen this manuscript.

¹¹⁹ Described by James, *Catalogue of Manuscripts in the Gonville and Caius Library*, ii, 448–9. The portion of the manuscript containing the *Oraculum* is a booklet beginning at fol. 85r, where an imperfect text of 'Jacobus de Cessolis de ludo Scaccarum' begins, followed by Isidore on the patriarchs, fol. 87r, followed by the *Oraculum*. The manuscript suggests a very interesting context for Joachite thought, perhaps among the clerks of the civil service; prior to this booklet, the collection includes statutes and annotations mentioning London.

¹²⁰ See Corpus Christi College, MS 404 above.

¹²¹ This date applies to the booklet containing the Joachite material, not the whole manuscript.

¹²² See Mynors, *Catalogue of the Manuscripts of Balliol College*, 289–90, description, mentioning that Gray travelled to Cologne in 1442–44 and brought this manuscript back. It was ‘scriptum per me, Paulum de Mertzenich’ in 1409. It contains, in addition, John of Wales’s *Communiloquium Breviloquium*, works by Peter the Blessed, Walter Burley, a letter of Bernard’s, and notes on Arthur and Methodius.

¹²³ See Oswald Holder-Egger, ‘Italienische Prophetieen des 13. Jahrhunderts (i)’, *Neues Archiv*, 15 (1890), 141–78, at 161–66.

¹²⁴ Mynors, *Catalogue of the Manuscripts of Balliol College*, describes the MS at 314–17, and at 315–16 points out that the *Liber contra Lombardum* is not identified as by Joachim in the manuscript, but that a seventeenth-century hand supplies the title: ‘Joachimus abbas (ut a quibusdam supponitur sed falso) contra Lombardum’. The piece originally ended on the now lost fol. 246r (which may have had an *explicit* identifying the work). The manuscript is also described in *Joachimi Abbatis Liber Contra Lombardum (Scuola di Gioacchino da Fiore)*, ed. Carmelo Ottaviano (Rome, 1934), 65–70; Fiona Robb, ‘A Late Thirteenth-century Attack on the Fourth Lateran Council: The “Liber contra Lombardum” and Contemporary Debates on the Trinity’, *Recherches de Théologie ancienne et médiévale*, 62 (1995), 110–44, at 112–14.

¹²⁵ Mynors, *ibid.*, 314. The earliest official record of its presence in Balliol is 1654, *ibid.*, 317.

¹²⁶ Julius Parnell Gilson, ‘Friar Alexander and his Historical Interpretation of the Apocalypse’, in *Collectanea Franciscana*, ii, ed. Charles Lethbridge Kingsford (Manchester, 1922), 20–36, at 20; see also Reeves, *Influence*, 177–8. According to Sabine Schmolinsky, *Der Apokalypsenkommentar des Alexander Minorita. Zur frühen Rezeption Joachims von Fiore in Deutschland*, MGH, Studien und Texte 3 (Hannover, 1991), 17–18 the manuscript was written in Germany and was still there in the sixteenth century.

¹²⁷ Described in *Catalogue of the Manuscripts Preserved in the Cambridge University Library*, ii, 521–4, to which should be added the collation: a8 (wants 1,4,6) i–ii⁸ iii⁶ iv–xiv⁸/xv–xviii⁸ xix–xxii⁸ xxiii⁸ (8 cancelled) xxix⁶ (wants 6).

¹²⁸ The manuscript is primarily a collection of statutes in Law French and Latin. The prophecy and the miscellaneous items that follow it, including the statute concerning the Templars, were added at the end of a booklet (see collation above). On the facing page (fol. 108r) is a copy of the statute announcing the suppression of the Templars: *Statutum novum de terris Templariorum*. 17 Edward II. (The order was suppressed by papal decree in 1312.)

¹²⁹ See the annotations in Law French, e.g., on fol. viir. A prayer precedes the prophecy (inc. ‘Anima christi sacrificia me’). These various items were added by the same hand (one of two active in the manuscript) but at different times. The small size of the manuscript (6.75” × 4”) suggests a circuit judge or civil servant. I am grateful to John Van Engen for his advice about this

¹³⁰ *A Catalogue of the Harleian Manuscripts*, iii, 55, no. 3724. On this manuscript, see Kathryn Kerby-Fulton and Denise Despres, *Iconography and the Professional Reader: The Politics of Book Production in the Douce Piers Plowman* (Minneapolis, 1999), 56, 99, 101, and figure 63.

¹³¹ Erwin Herrmann, ‘Spätmittelalterliche englische Pseudoprophetien’, *Archiv für Kulturgeschichte*, 57 (1975), 87–116, see, esp., 90 and n. 10; Holder-Egger, ‘Italienische Prophetieen (iii)’, 106, for the text. This is a supposed exchange between Frederick II and the Pope.

¹³² Holder-Egger, *ibid.*

¹³³ *A Catalogue of the Harleian Manuscripts* i, 646, no. 1280.

¹³⁴ Introduced by these two lines: ‘Hoc Cistercienni Joachim predixit in anno / Quo Saladinus sanctum sibi subdidit Urbem, / Cum fuerint ...’. See Todd, *Last Age*, xxiv, and see Reeves, *Influence*, 49, n. 4, 51, n. 1, and 84, n. 1, for a listing of several ‘Cum fuerint’ texts and other short prophecies in England.

¹³⁵ On ‘Gallorum’, see Holder-Egger, ‘Italienische Prophetieen (iii)’, 125–6, and Reeves, *Influence*, 528. The text of ‘Gallorum’ is cropped and ‘Cum fuerint’ is here called ‘Sancti Edmundi archiepiscopi prophetia de antichristo’.

¹³⁶ Apparently, from the small size (6” × 4.5”) and the contents.

¹³⁷ Described in Warner and Gilson, *British Museum. A Catalogue of Western Manuscripts*, i, 240.

¹³⁸ Reeves, *Influence*, 50, n. 3. The article begins, ‘Beatus qui exspectat et prevenit vsque ad dies 1335 ...’.

¹³⁹ The lines are (following the usual last line, ‘Papa cito moritur, Cesar regnabit ubique’): Anno millesimo C. ter vicesimo v. dabit ether
Blada vina fractus fiet pro principe luctus;
Una columpna cadet, quae terram schismate tradet
Gens periet subito, Petro testante perito.

See Todd, *Last Age*, xxxiii, 9, who compares it with records in Limborch’s *Liber*

¹⁴⁰ Nothing has been published on this. In London, BL, Additional MS 24663, there is also an English translation of John of Rupescissa’s *Vade mecum*, fol. 11r.

¹⁴¹ Colker, *Trinity College Library*, ii, 976–1002.

¹⁴² The manuscript contains large numbers of prophecies, among which the following often travel with Joachite materials: on fol. 48r is one attributed to Joachim and claims to come from the *De oneribus*: ‘Ioachim in libro de honoribus. Ve tibi uitula eligans et gallus et gallina stupescunt et tendunt pectora’; on fol. 47v, ‘Tria lustra tenent cum semi tempora sexti’ and ‘Versus Vaticinales De Normania De Sexto. Anglia transmittet leopardum’; on fol. 48v, ‘Gallorum levitas’. See Coote, *Prophecy and Public Affairs*, 250, for the full list of political prophecies.

¹⁴³ G.L. Harriss and M.A. Harriss, ‘John Benet’s Chronicle for the Years 1400–1462’, in *Camden Miscellany*, 24 (London, 1972), 151–75. Benet was vicar of Harlingdon, Bedfordshire.

¹⁴⁴ Described in Warner and Gilson, *British Museum. A Catalogue of Western Manuscripts*, i, 231; see also Bloomfield and Reeves, ‘Penetration’, 788.

¹⁴⁵ Copied between a commentary on Genesis and one on Exodus, the prophecy appears in a quire of eight beginning on fol. 69r; it is copied in a tiny hand of the late thirteenth century. There is considerable interest in Franciscan issues in the manuscript, which includes pertinent papal bulls, and what Franz Pelster described (in a note in the manuscript written in 1932) as a fragment of the first known commentary of the Franciscan school at Oxford (by Richardus Cornubiensis). There is also, unusually, a diagram of a plough on fol. 41r with English glosses to Latin words. Kirkestede copied the ‘Ars fidei catholice’ on fol. 8r and the Seneca item on fol. 24r.

¹⁴⁶ Herrmann, ‘Pseudoprophetien’, 90, n. 10.

¹⁴⁷ Also contains items by ‘Telesphorus’ and Henry of Langenstein.

¹⁴⁸ I am grateful to Robert Lerner for this information.

¹⁴⁹ See Reeves, *Influence*, Appendix A; Jostmann, *Sibilla*, 386–8; *Ioachim Abbas Florentis Exhortatorium Iudeorum*, ed. Alexander Patschovsky, *Fonti per la storia dell’Italia medievale*, *Antiquitates* 26 (Rome, 2006), 80–86.

¹⁵⁰ This manuscript is a late seventeenth-century transcript by Tanner, now edited and annotated as Henry of Kirkestede, *Catalogus de libris authenticis et apocryphis*, ed. Richard and Mary Rouse, listed there as number 293.

¹⁵¹ Three of these later appear in his own collection, Cambridge, Corpus Christi College, MS 404 (see above), that is, the ‘De Seminibus’, the ‘De moribus paparum’ (or *Vaticinia de Summis Pontificibus*), and the ‘Super oraculum Chilli’.

¹⁵² David N. Bell, *An Index of Cistercian Authors and Works in Medieval Library Catalogues in Great Britain* (Kalamazoo, Mich., 1994), 89. I would also like to thank Christoph Egger for referring

me to George Oliver, *Lives of the Bishops of Exeter and a History of the Cathedral* (Exeter, 1861), 363, for this reference.

¹⁵³ P. 373 l. 31, cited from Bell, *An Index*, 89 and n.

¹⁵⁴ See Bell, *An Index*, 125, and *English Benedictine Libraries: The Shorter Catalogues*, ed. Richard Sharpe et al., Corpus of British Medieval Library Catalogues 4 (London, 1996), 407 for speculations on the identity of both items.

¹⁵⁵ *Two Poems Attributed to Joachim of Fiore*, ed. Marjorie Reeves and John V. Fleming (Princeton, 1978).

¹⁵⁶ Bell, *An Index*, 105, citing John Leland's *De Rebus Britannicis Collectanea*, 6 vols (London, 1774), iv, 52.

¹⁵⁷ Montague R. James, 'Catalogue of the Library of the Augustinian Friars at York', in Fasciculus J.W. Clark dicatus (Cambridge, 1909), 2–96, at 9; see also the further discussion in Reeves, *Influence*, 255; Kerby-Fulton, *Books under Suspicion*, 101–24. The catalogue has been more recently reprinted with annotations in *The Friars' Libraries*, ed. Kenneth Wood Humphreys, Corpus of British Medieval Library Catalogues, 1 (London, 1990), where these entries appear as numbers: A8.163e, f, 306e, 330b, 361b, c, d, i, o. See also Bell, *An Index*, 152.

¹⁵⁸ *The Friars' Libraries*, ed. Humphreys, A8.163e–f; see also Bell, *An Index*, 152.

¹⁵⁹ *The Friars' Libraries*, ed. Humphreys, A8.306e; Bell, *An Index*, 152.

¹⁶⁰ *The Friars' Libraries*, ed. Humphreys, A8.330b; Bell, *An Index*, 152.

¹⁶¹ *The Friars' Libraries*, ed. Humphreys, A8. 363d; Bell, *An Index*, 152.

¹⁶² As edited by David N. Bell, *The Libraries of the Cistercians, Gilbertines and Premonstratensians*, Corpus of British Medieval Library Catalogues, 3 (London, 1992), 12–13.

¹⁶³ See Sharpe, *Handlist*, 166, for this and all the Henry of Costesy attestations below.

¹⁶⁴ Sharpe, *Handlist*, 166, citing numbers from Mary Bateson, *Catalogue of Syon Monastery, Isleworth* (Cambridge, 1889), as I. 28 and I. 29.

¹⁶⁵ See *Syon Abbey: With the Libraries of the Carthusians*, ed. Vincent Gillespie and Ian Doyle, Corpus of British Medieval Library Catalogues 9 (London, 2001), nos. 603 and 437 respectively.

¹⁶⁶ *Syon Abbey*, ed. Gillespie and Doyle, no. 582; see also Bloomfield, *Piers Plowman*, 159.

¹⁶⁷ See *Syon Abbey*, ed. Gillespie and Doyle, no. 977dd, and note on possible incipit; for biography of Bracebrigge, see 570. I am very grateful to Robert Lerner for drawing this reference to my attention.

¹⁶⁸ Sharpe, *Handlist*, 166.

¹⁶⁹ Sharpe, *Handlist*, 166.

¹⁷⁰ Sharpe, *Handlist*, 166.

¹⁷¹ Sharpe, *Handlist*, 166.

¹⁷² Bell, *An Index*, 77, citing Montague Rhodes James, *The ancient libraries of Canterbury and Dover. The catalogues of the libraries of Christ Church Priory and St. Augustine's Abbey at Canterbury and of St. Martin's Priory at Dover* (Cambridge, 1903), 292, no. 4, cross-listed with no. 870.

¹⁷³ Sharpe, *Handlist*, 166.

¹⁷⁴ Sharpe, *Handlist*, 166.

¹⁷⁵ Neil Ripley Ker, *Records of All Souls College, 1437–1600*. Oxford Bibliographical Society, n.s. 16 (Oxford, 1971), 173, n. 1; cited in David R. Howlett and Richard William Hunt, 'The Provenance of MS. New College 49', *Bodleian Library Record*, 10 (1978–82), 225–8, at 225.

¹⁷⁶ Bell, *An Index*, 113, citing Leland, *De Rebus Britannicis Collectanea*, iv, 63.

¹⁷⁷ Cited by Bell, *An Index*, 139, from Bale, *Index Britanniae Scriptorum*, 173. Robert Lerner (private correspondence, 25 July 2008) has suggested to me that this manuscript is very likely Richard Kilvington's (see Royal 8. F. XVI above), since Kilvington bequeathed his manuscripts to Oriel College.

¹⁷⁸ Bale, *Index Britanniae Scriptorum*, 33. Robert Lerner very generously provided me with this reference (private correspondence, 25 July 2008).

¹⁷⁹ Compare the description in Smith, *Manuscripts in the Cottonian*, ed. Tite. Only articles 22 and 23 of the original description survive. I would like to thank Robert Lerner for mentioning to me the missing Arnold items in Cotton Vitellius.

Chapter 10

Joachim of Fiore through Johannes Wolff: A Visit to the Archives of Joachism in the *Lectiones Memorabiles* (1600)

Sabine Schmolinsky

Reading Johannes Wolff's *Lectiones memorabiles* turns out to be almost a rereading since the pathway leading to this exuberant treasure of prophecies and predictions was conveniently prepared by Marjorie Reeves herself. In *The Influence of Prophecy in the Later Middle Ages*, published in 1969, she first introduced Wolff to the community of scholars interested in Joachim of Fiore. Presenting him as a leading figure in the Protestant reception of medieval prophecies, she established a Joachite approach to reading his voluminous journey through 16 centuries of ecclesiastical history.¹ To commemorate her enormous contribution means to attempt some further steps through the door which she so perspicaciously opened.

Manifesting History

Johannes Wolff (1537–1600) as a writer generally enjoys a twofold reputation in sixteenth-century intellectual history: first as an editor of treatises on the art of history² and of chronicles³ and second, as the author

of the impressive two volumes in folio of the *Lectionum memorabilium et reconditarum centenarii XVI* (Figure 10.1).⁴ These resulted from Wolff's lifelong passion for the state of ecclesiastical and public affairs, as well as several constantly recurring issues of his day. His humanist education at Johann Sturm's school in Strasbourg (1552–57), theological studies under Philipp Melanchthon in Wittenberg (1557–60), philosophical studies with Jakob Scheck in Tübingen (1560–164), and finally legal studies at the universities of Bourges, Angers, Besançon, and Dôle, culminated in the award of the licentiate degree in February 1568. This enabled him to develop his far-reaching historical and theological interests while serving as a polyglot diplomat to the dukes of Zweibrücken/Pfalz. Desiring a more stable life, he next joined the service of the margraves of Baden in 1573, taking up residence in Mundelsheim on the Neckar near Bietigheim in 1574.⁵ There, evidently, he found the leisure and means through which to realize the more ambitious of his scholarly undertakings.



Figure 10.1 *Johannes Wolff, Lectionum memorabilium et reconditarum centenarii XVI.*, Tom. 2, Lauingae 1600, f.)(1v. Staats- und Universitätsbibliothek Hamburg, B 1952/313:2.

Throughout his professional life, Wolff strove to observe the habits of scholars by visiting their places of study. Seizing the opportunities offered by his various legations, not only to the imperial court and imperial diets

but also to the royal and princely courts of France, Navarre, England, Poland, and the German Empire, he frequently visited famous libraries of all kinds belonging to rulers, monasteries, colleges, universities, towns, and scholars, and there avidly devoured their book collections.⁶ By this time he was already participating in scholarly debates which, as he said, he deliberately sought out for religious reasons. In his lengthy ‘Epistola dedicatoria’ addressed to two dukes of Pomerania, Barnim X (XII) (1549–1603) and Philipp Julius (1584–1625), forming the introduction to the first volume of his *Lectiones memorabiles*, Wolff recounts the origins of his commitment to his ever-expanding collections of books and materials. Feeling troubled about his own salvation when confronted with examples of erudite, prudent men who were either vacillating in their confessional orientation or who had actually moved from one confession to another, he attempted to converse with those men and then to set about scrutinizing biblical and patristic texts and historiography.⁷ Following his almost complete withdrawal from public affairs, he intensified his studies and began to organize his findings, collecting them more systematically. Very soon, he was able to set down this private preoccupation as an aide-mémoire, subsequently moving into the public sphere of scholarly as well as political interest, by allowing himself be persuaded to unveil and communicate his thesaurus in an edition.⁸

Wolff’s argument, that, ever since Apostolic times, ecclesiastical defects emerging from an obstinate disobedience to God’s precepts had been deplored by pious Catholics of both sexes desirous of reform, requires substantiation.⁹ He presents this debate on more than 2,100 folio pages covering more than 3,000 authors.¹⁰ Since, Wolff declares, the clergy in general and the popes in particular have always proved to be depraved¹¹ and since, according to the ‘Abbas Ioachim’us’, the Roman Church was like the Babylonian whore, who fornicates with secular princes while its prelates fail to blush with shame, the church deserved to be abolished.¹² Although the demand for reform has been concomitant with the church’s historical existence, Wolff can think of only a few effective attempts, including those in the ninth and tenth centuries initiated by the emperors Charlemagne, his son Louis the Pious, and Otto I. The next figure chronologically to be cited as a reformer is ‘Abbas Ioachim’us de reformatione futurâ’. Referring to the two Joachite commentaries *Super Hieremiam* and *Super Esaiam*, Wolff emphasizes those prophecies which concern a future preacher of the Gospel

who will revolutionize the church.¹³ Above all, he aims at a specific reformer, Martin Luther, who is deemed to have been predicted by Joachim and still more explicitly by Telesphorus of Cosenza.¹⁴ It is obviously Luther who, by virtue of the Holy Spirit, had identified the church's traditions as false and had restored the preaching of the true Bible.¹⁵

After citing further evidence concerning the need for ecclesiastical reforms, Wolff's argument next takes a pictorial turn. Despite every attempt to engender reform being impeded and continuously suppressed, largely by the hierarchy of the wicked church, pious and wise critics sought and found ways to express the truth in various guises, through monuments, pictures, and mysterious signs similar to Egyptian hieroglyphs.¹⁶ Leaving aside those of the ancient world, Wolff concentrates on those images most relevant to his chosen subject, the papacy, supposing that their creators had rendered public in a hidden form what they neither wished nor dared to say in words or to express graphically.¹⁷

Thus Wolff in his printed works proves himself not to be a historian but a reader of history.¹⁸ In his *Lectiones memorabiles*, he moves to a more systematically arranged presentation for public use and benefit and in this way succeeds in generating topically informed archives. He orders his work chronologically by dividing it into centuries but does not comment on this particular system of organization,¹⁹ whereas he does announce as a new method of his own a special type of index following each century. He proposes a catalogue by which a chronological grouping of the names of the emperors, popes, councils, religious orders, and scholars, marginally indicated by years or decades, permits a synoptical reading of names and dates of the authors and of history as well as of historiography.²⁰ In organizing his sources, each according to its century, he may well have been inspired by the authors of the *Ecclesiastica historia Magdeburgica*,²¹ which he repeatedly cites. And he may well have had these authors in mind when he insists that he has carried out this work without any assistance.²² This does not, however, prevent Wolff from telling the story of his young temporary scribe who, through copying many of those conclusively elucidating testimonies, was converted from being a fervent, even viciously slandering disciple of the Fulda Jesuits to a pious Lutheran who, in turn, converted his own parents before suffering an early death from dysentery.²³

Reading Words and Images

As a reader of both old and new texts, it is generally not Wolff's concern to assign significance to words and images²⁴ but rather to communicate meanings already assigned. Joachim of Fiore²⁵ thus assumes the most important position as prophet, since he had been the first person to predict the one and only true reformer, namely Martin Luther. Further, Joachim seems to have fostered a pattern of pictorial obscurity which Wolff deemed to be so remarkable that he regarded him as a pivotal author of prophecies by means of pictures. Thus 'prophetiae cum imaginibus' begin Wolff's list of what he believed to be 'Joachim's' works under the year 1200.²⁶

Wolff introduces Joachim rather briefly by mentioning that his writings and prophecies were first sent to Germany by the then cardinal bishop of Porto around 1250, together with some verses on a disagreement between the cardinals. Wolff cites a passage from the Dominican Conrad of Halberstadt's *Chronographia Interminata* which is in turn drawn from the Erfurt Minorite *Cronica minor*.²⁷ He then turns to the famous *Vaticinia de summis pontificibus*,²⁸ which he obviously appreciates as a topic of polemical controversy reproducing the texts and pictures according to the Latin version of the *Vaticinia, Siue Prophetiae Abbatis Ioachimi, & Anselmi Episcopi Marsicani* in Paschalinus Regiselmus' bilingual Latin and Italian edition of 1589, including its textual notes.²⁹ Wolff adds the interpretations of the 'Vaticinia' by Regiselmus, Lheophrastus Paracelsus, and Johannes Adrasder. Adrasder is known to be a short form for Andreas Osiander the Elder, Lutheran minister at St Lorenz in Nuremberg who, in 1527, had anonymously published the whole series of 30 pope prophecies under the title *Eyn wunderliche weyssagung von dem babstumb*, adding a commentary in High German and verses by Hans Sachs.³⁰ It remains unclear whether Osiander himself translated his work from German to Latin. In any case, Wolff's edition was the first published Latin version.³¹ Wolff notes two Nuremberg manuscripts of the prophecies from Oslanders / Adrasder's prefatory remarks and specifies the editions of Paracelsus, Adrasder, and Regiselmus,³² the last being the first to identify Joachim as the author.³³ Although stylistically resembling those of Osiander, the wood-carvings of the popes are kept in the order first established by Regiselmus, so that their sequence corresponds to all commentaries but may differ from Oslanders vernacular version.³⁴

Wolff's readers would thus have perceived the former dispute on interpretation in chronological reverse. From Regiselmus they learned that

Antichrist would be unveiled soon after 1700 at the time of the pope designated by the thirtieth vaticinium – more precisely around 1728, if the same reckonings were used for the second series starting with the sixteenth vaticinium ('Genus nequam') as for the first (Ascende calve').³⁵ Going backwards, the readers would see that from Paracelsus' critical Catholic point of view the restoration of the sinful papacy had to be effected by future Angelic Popes and finally by Christ himself, a prediction found in at least the last four vaticinia.³⁶ Finally, they would understand from Adrasder that the preaching monk in the nineteenth vaticinium accompanied by symbols of God's word and of secular authority was explained in the twentieth vaticinium. This depicted a monk with a rose and a sickle and was a prediction of Luther.³⁷ Adrasder dedicated the next five vaticinia to an analysis of the confessional and political situation in the years around 1520. From the twenty-sixth vaticinium onwards Adrasder deemed the pictures to be true prophecy, predicting the enduring ruin of the papacy from the fall of Babylon in Revelations 18 and the installation of 'verbi diuini ministri', such as the Apostles Peter and Paul, until Christ's Second Coming at the end of time.³⁸ What all three varying interpretations had in common was that, besides the identification of individual names, they did not determine a chronologically coherent series of individual popes but instead offered typological features of the papacy itself. This explains why Wolff so definitely excludes Paulus Scalichius' comments reintroducing specific popes.³⁹

But before Wolff's readers could scrutinize these interpretations they faced some further prophecies on future popes⁴⁰ including the *Rota Ioachimi* with Regiselmus' comment on it.⁴¹ Referring to obscure oral traditions, Regiselmus offered an identification of the first four images as Pius IV (1559–65), Pius V (1566–72), Gregory XIII (1572–85), and Sixtus V (1585–90), during whose pontificate the *Vaticinia* were published. Since the eight symbols, the sun and moon, a calyx, a dragon, two differing lions, a pelican (?), a bull, and a pope's head, were all identified by initials, Regiselmus found it rather ridiculous that the prophetic validity of the Wheel or *Rota* should remain infinitely. He preferred to make it a secret to be revealed only to true friends and sincere Christians.⁴² This passage could easily escape the reader's attention were it not that the *Rota* is depicted within a zodiac on the frontispiece common to both volumes of the *Lectiones memorabiles*, to which Wolff returns in the second volume under

the year 1581. By way of making explanatory remarks on the allegorical emblems included,⁴³ he renders a metrical ‘Expositio noua figurarH & literarum quarundam Rotæ Ioachimicæ [...]’ which does not focus on specific popes.⁴⁴ One of the six emblems is dedicated to the pope’s negligence towards the mourning church, the pope prophecies thus even appearing on the title-page of the *Lectiones memorabiles*.⁴⁵

Wolff’s reading of those works attributed to Joachim does not appear to be linked to a personalized understanding of prophecy but to a generalized and literal appreciation concerning the fate and state of the papacy. Luther’s name occurs through its use in Adrasder’s comment on the twentieth vaticinium. This must have provoked Wolff’s prefatory remark mentioned above.⁴⁶ His further Joachimist and Joachite readings enabled him to enter the complex area of imperial and ecclesiastical prophecy of which he had already provided examples in the ‘Epistola dedicatoria’ to the first volume of the *Lectiones memombiles*.⁴⁷ They were meant to prove that ‘Abbas Ioachimus’ was a reliable voice, too, under the rubric ‘quid sit tandem expectandum’.⁴⁸

Taking care as usual to indicate his source in the main text⁴⁹ and rearranging his extracts along general lines of argument, Wolff first studies ‘Abbas Ioachimus super Esaïam’.⁵⁰ He does not indicate any difference between quotations from the main text of the commentary and the more numerous ones from the extensive marginal notes, nor does he add any explanation to the political allusions that he cites. His readers thus had to rely on their own historical knowledge to understand that the author, whom he believed to have been Joachim, had had the gift of true prophecy. In this way, the extracts unfolded the prophetic appeal of vaticinia ex eventu.⁵¹ Or perhaps his readers simply grasped the topics chosen by Wolff and learned that, after having persecuted the Roman Church, the German Empire proved to be dangerously damaged itself, thereby infecting the church as well. The apocalyptical discourse of persecuting forces being adopted to the current evil times of the sixth *ætas*, thus also applied to the corrupt ecclesiastical hierarchy.⁵² And finally the readers might have come to the conclusion that things had not changed so much since around the year 1200. If they still remembered Wolff’s rumour about terrifying eschatological threats to the church, signified by the burning of the Rhine bridge at Mainz,⁵³ which he had ascribed to Joachim in his preceding ‘Epistola dedicatoria’,⁵⁴ here they could find it fully expanded.⁵⁵ Wolff’s emphasis on

this specifically regional prediction may well exemplify a further trait of his interest in *Super Esaiam*. It remains the only prophetic commentary of the author, believed to be ‘Abbas Ioachimus’, which ventures into territorial detail.

Wolff’s extracts from ‘Abbas Ioachimus de Concordia vtriusque TT.’⁵⁶ concentrate on the fact that the papacy as well as clerical vices have frequently alienated prelates and monks from the example of the primitive church. The very essence of the book, the concords as well as the Trinitarian structure, the three *status* and three orders, are not a point of reference for Wolff and can only be glimpsed in his excerpts. To the extent that his quotations have been identified, he cites verbatim from Simon de Luere’s Venetian edition of 1519.⁵⁷

Wolff dedicates by far the majority of his Joachite readings to the spurious commentary *Super Hieremiam*,⁵⁸ although he did not read the whole text but rather screened the index. Thus it has been possible to identify the copy that he used as a specimen of the Cologne edition, which was printed by Lodovicus Alectorius in 1577.⁵⁹ Copying as usual with only slight modifications, he follows the given chapter sequence from the prologue through chapters 1–25, 28, 34, 37, and 50, but rearranges the issues chosen within each chapter. Here Wolff found ample evidence not only for the wickedness, corruption, and impenitence of the Roman Church but also for details of its future fate. His list of short summaries yields a series of recapitulated horrors. The church and its prelates corrupted by their secular condition will be suppressed and destroyed by the German Empire. It will be deprived, at the very least, of all its *temporalia*. There will be two preaching orders, the church having despised the admonitions of former *viri spirituales* and preachers of God’s word. There will be no end before a future reformation is carried out by a people.⁶⁰ Wolff thus presents a ‘Joachim’ hidden behind extracts from an anonymous index of a redaction of a spurious work.

Rewriting Ecclesiastical History?

Introducing the history of communication and perception as a new approach to the field, Johannes Burckhardt examined sixteenth-century history from the point of view of a media revolution and focused on the centrality of improvements in printing to the fabric of the Reformation, Lutheran or

otherwise.⁶¹ Wolff's *Lectiones memorabiles* were printed during the second and third generations of the Reformation,⁶² when the formation of a Protestant confession was far advanced and a confessional culture⁶³ had already been established. His work differs fundamentally from the new mass media, the pamphlets ('Flugschriften') which were easily absorbed into his compilation, belonging rather to an advanced level of debate about confessional culture which seeks to prove that Luther's reformism was the true answer to 15 centuries of demand for ecclesiastical reform. Hence, the transition which took place during the period of reform from earlier types of media production and propaganda to forms better suited to the contemporary situation can still be viewed through Wolff's work. His excerpts and his book collection of exceptional copies were fundamental to his own oral reproduction and communication to other scholars which he then transformed into the more durable and highly reproductive medium of print. The manner of extracting and summarizing information, reproductive on a limited scale, corresponds on another level to reproduction by the printing press creating the format which fulfilled the recipients' explicit needs, although much of Wolff's material could already be found in printed copies.

Wolff was by no means the first to explore the field of Protestant ecclesiastical criticism on historical grounds. Some decades earlier, Matthias Flacius Illyricus (1520–75) had published his *Catalogus testium veritatis* which proved that according to the seven thousand pious people mentioned in 1 Kings 19:18, who had not bowed their knees to Baal, there had been quite a number of critics of the papal church before Martin Luther.⁶⁴ Throughout the *Ecclesiastica Historia* (1559–74), the Magdeburg Centuriators had made it possible to discern the frontiers between the idea and doctrine of the true church and opinions deemed as false.⁶⁵ Both works offered extracts of source material. It might therefore be questioned why Wolff's contemporaries felt the need to see his collections published despite having to hand ever-expanding editions of the *Catalogus* and no fewer than 13 volumes of the *Ecclesiastica Historia*.

Obviously, the *Lectiones memorabiles* are based on the notion of the existence of 'testes veritatis' emerging throughout the history of the church.⁶⁶ But here these witnesses testify to the distortion of the Veritas', prompting Wolff to delineate a history of ecclesiastical criticism enriched by prodigious signs of God's wrath. With historiography in general serving

as a background resource,⁶⁷ the method of the ‘loci communes’ of the Magdeburg Centuries⁶⁸ only seems to be echoed by the wide range of topics that Wolff touches upon. Actually, Wolff adds a further ‘locus communis’ to Protestant ecclesiastical history and historiography, namely criticism of the papacy, and he thus reinforces the accentuation of topical coherence through historiographically informed collecting and writing.

To the extent to which the identification of deficiencies led to the demand for reform, Joachim became a crucial figure in this field. Not only had he found serious faults with the church but he also predicted the reformer who would address them, and, indeed, had been the first to do so. Conclusively, Wolff’s presentation of script / image and comment implies that it was Joachim who had brought together reformation and prophecy. Wolff does not analyse the Fourth Lateran Council’s condemnation of Joachim’s Trinitarian doctrine in 1215 as do the Magdeburg Centuriators,⁶⁹ and he does not adopt Flacius’ biographical bias for assigning the quality of a ‘testis veritatis’. What he does is to put together known material and highlight the point of personalized reform after having carried out extended and thorough readings. Flacius reported that Jan Hus had predicted the coming of Luther⁷⁰ but Wolff focuses, without any comment, on a still older and really significant prophet.

Wolff’s archives of Joachism encompass far more items than the Joachite and Joachimist passages mentioned here reveal. Joachim’s presence throughout the *Lectiones memorabiles* is more critical than is indicated by his chronological location, his name appearing in various extracts as Wolff quotes from ‘Theolesphorus de Cusentia’⁷¹ or from those sixteenth-century contemporaries whom he may cite for argument⁷² or agreement.⁷³ To the extent that topics have been examined here, they centre on papal Rome as the whore of Babylon, on the future Angelic Pope, and on the fate of the church in general, thereby relying heavily on the two commentaries *Super Hieremiam* and *Super Esaiam*. Wolff was the first to organize so many texts and to cover contemporary strands of dispute which can now also be recovered, thanks to his compilations. The ongoing appreciation of his work may well be illustrated by the new edition of the *Lectiones memorabiles* which appeared first in 1671 and again in 1672 with Henning Grosses Erben in Frankfurt am Main.⁷⁴ Although Joachim’s original as well as spurious works had been accessible in printed editions since the early sixteenth century, it was Wolff who established a readership of Joachim’s

works up to the time of Johann Albert Fabricius (1668–1736). Fabricius, in the article on ‘JOACHIMUS Abbas de Curatio’ in his famous *Bibliotheca Latinitatis mediae et infimae aetatis*, actually copied Wolff’s sequence of Joachite and Joachimist excerpts, giving wherever they survived, the page numbers of Joachim’s works in the first volume of the *Lectionesmemorabiles*.⁷⁵

As a result of Marjorie Reeves’s distinguished scholarship, Joachim’s impact on Protestantism provides one clue to sixteenth-century debates on the relations between and future advancement of ecclesiastical and secular powers among humanist jurists such as Johannes Wolff. Following these pathways across the range of confessional cultures means continuing to research in her vivid spirit and dedicating it to her memory.

Notes

¹ Marjorie Reeves, *The Influence of Prophecy in the Later Middle Ages: A Study in Joachimism* (Oxford, 1969, repr. Notre Dame, 1993), 487–8.

² See Wolff’s famous anthology ARTIS | HISTORICAE | PENVS | Octodecim Scriptorum tam vete-|rum quàm recentiorum | monumentis | & inter eos Io. præcipuè Bodi-|ni libris Methodi historicae | sex instructa. [...] (Basel: Petrus Perna, 1579); see *Verzeichnis der im deutschen Sprachbereich erschienenen Drucke des XVI. Jahrhunderts – VD 16 -. I. Abteilung Verfasser – Körperschaften – Anonyma*, ed. Bayerische Staatsbibliothek in München in Verbindung mit der Herzog August Bibliothek in Wolfenbüttel, 1–22 (Stuttgart, 1983–95) (henceforth: VD 16), W 4208; Roland Crahay, Marie-Thérèse Isaac, and Marie-Thérèse Lenger, avec la collaboration de René Plisnier, *Bibliographie critique des éditions anciennes de Jean Bodin*, Académie royale de Belgique. Classe des Lettres. Collection in-8°, 2^e série, 70 (Brussels, 1992), 28–31. Wolff’s previous, slightly smaller edition: IO. BODINI | METHODVS | HISTORICA, | dvodecim eiusdem argumenti | Scriptorum, tarn veterum quàm | recentiorum, Commentariis adaui|cta: quorum elenchum Præfationi | subiecimus. (Basel: Petrus Perna, 1576); see VD 16, B 6274; Crahay, Isaac, and Lenger, *Bibliographie critique*, 26–8. See Marie-Dominique Couzinnet, *Histoire et méthode à la Renaissance. Une lecture de la Methodus ad facilem historiarum Cognitionem de Jean Bodin*, Philologie et Mercure (Paris, 1996), 35–6, 39–40, 46; Donald R. Kelley, *Faces of History: Historical Inquiry from Herodotus to Herder* (New Haven and London, 1998), 191, 193.

³ These are: ALBERTI | KRANTZII, | RERVVM GERMANICA-|rum historici clariss. Regnorum A-|quilonarium, Daniæ, Sueciæ, | Noruagiæ, Chronica. [...] (Frankfurt/ Main: Andreas Wechel, 1575); ALBERTI | KRANTZII, | RERVVM GERMANICA-|RVM HISTORICI CLARISSIMI, | ECCLESIASTICA HISTORIA, SIVE | Metropolis. [...] (Frankfurt/Main: Andreas Wechel, 1576); VD 16, K 2251 (see VD 16, K 2252); ROBERTI GAGVINI, | RERVVM GAL-|LICARVM | Annales, | [...] (Frankfurt/Main: Andreas Wechel, 1577); VD 16, G 44. See Ulrich Andermann, *Albert Krantz. Wissenschaft und Historiographie um 1500*, Forschungen zur mittelalterlichen Geschichte 38 (Weimar, 1999), 338; Franck Collard, *Un historien au travail à la fin du XV^e siècle: Robert Gaguin*, Travaux d’Humanisme et Renaissance, 301 (Geneva, 1996). For further details (including Wolff’s works on hunting and falconry), see Sabine Schmolinsky, ‘Prophetia in der Bibliothek – die *Lectiones memorabiles* des Johannes Wolff’, in *Zukunftsvoraussagen in der Renaissance*, ed. Klaus

Bergdolt and Walther Ludwig, *Wolfenbütteler Abhandlungen zur Renaissanceforschung* 23 (Wiesbaden, 2005), 89–130, esp. 98–101.

⁴ IOHAN.VVOLFIIL.C.LECTIONVMMEMO|RABILIVMET RECONDITARVM | CENTENARII XVI. | HABET HIC LECTOR DOCTORVM ECCLE|siæ, Vatum, Politicorum, Philosophorum, Historicorum, aliorumq; | sapientum & eruditorum pia, graua, mira, arcana, & stupenda; iucun|da simul & vtilia, dicta, scripta, atq; facta; Vaticinia item, vota, omina, | mysteria, Hieroglyphica, miracula, visiones, antiquitates, monu|menta, testimonia, exempla virtutH, vitiorum, abusuum; | typos insuper, picturas, atq; imagines: | *SED ET IPSIVS COELI AC NATVRAE HORRENDI SI|gna, Ostenta, Monstra, atq; Portenta: His interiuncti sunt quoq; | omnes sacri prophaniq: Ordines:* | EX QVIBVS OMNIBVS CVM PPÆTERITI STA|tus in Ecclesia, Republica, & communi vita consideratio; tum im|pendentium euentuum, ac indies magis magisq; ingrauescentium | malorum præagatio: sed & multorum abstrusorum hactenus | desideratorum reuelatio ob oculos per|spicuè ponitur. | *Lauiugæ sumtibus Autoris impressit Leonhardus Rheinmichel | Typogr. Palatinus, anno 1600.*

⁵ For Wolff's biography, see Walther Ludwig, *Vorfahren von Paul Ludwig ermittelt, zusammengestellt und mit einem Nachwort versehen von W. L.*, Deutsches Familienarchiv. Ein genealogisches Sammelwerk 116 (Neustadt an der Aisch, 1994), 84, n°. 1522; *Hessisches Geschlechterbuch*, 14, Deutsches Geschlechterbuch, 121 (Glücksburg/Ostsee, 1956), 483–90 with 515–17; Daniel Groh, 'Lizentiat der Rechte Johannes Wolff. Ein Beitrag zur Biographie eines pfälzischen Diplomaten und Historiographen aus der zweiten Hälfte des 16. Jahrhunderts', diss. (Frankfurt/Main, 1923) (which contains some errors with respect to Wolff's work); Sabine Schmolinsky, 'Im Angesicht der Endzeit? Positionen in den *Lectiones memorabiles* des Johannes Wolff (1600)', in *Endzeiten. Eschatologie in den monotheistischen Weltreligionen*, ed. Wolfram Brandes, Felicitas Schmieder, Millennium-Studien 16 (Berlin and New York, 2008), 369–417, esp. 369–77.

⁶ Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, i: [EPISTOLA DEDICATORIA] [...] DOMINO | BARNIMO, ET DOMINO PHILIPPO IVLIO; DVCIBVS STETI|nensibus, Pomeraniæ, [...])()()2^v: [Note that brackets indicate gatherings, numbers leaves within gatherings]: 'Ad quam rem non parum commodabant mihi peregrinationes, frequentes illustrium ac celebriorum terræ locorum visitationes, & legationes. | Nam sicubi in curijs & aulis Imperatoris, & Regum Galliæ, Nauarræ, Angliæ & Poloniæ, vt etiam principum passim; & conuentibus Imperij, ob expedienda negotia, sæpè per menses aliquot commorandum fuit, ne inane periet tempus, interea omnigenas Imperatoris, Regum, Monasteriorum, Collegiorum, Vniuersitatum, Ciuitatum, & doctorum virorum bibliothecas, librosque perlustraui. Et multos, quos habere non potui, non sine sumtibus ex longinquo & molesto itinere missis literis comparare non destiti, solusque & vnus, ac sine adminiculo cuiusquam hominis perlegi, & ex eis hoc Opus congeSSI.' (see n. 7). Wolff thus frequents a preferred space of the 'scholarly culture' of his time: Peter Burke notes libraries as a second feature of the early modern idea of 'res publica litteraria'; see Peter Burke, 'Erasmus und die Gelehrtenrepublik', in id., *Kultureller Austausch. Aus dem Englischen von Burkhardt Wolf*, Erbschaft unserer Zeit. Vorträge über den Wissensstand der Epoche 8. edition suhrkamp 2170 (Frankfurt/Main, 2000), 74–101, 85; Hans Bots and Françoise Waquet, *La République des lettres*, Europe & Histoire ([Paris], 1997), esp. 133–4, 137–40. It is not known whether Wolff was part of a network of scholars or shared in their scholarly aims, though he does mention receiving books or manuscripts (he notes the difference) throughout the *Lectiones memorabiles*. The notion of 'scholarly culture' is to be preferred to the metaphorical 'res publica litteraria', according to Herbert Jaumann, 'Respublica litteraria / Republic of letters. Concept and Perspectives of Research,' in *Die europäische Gelehrtenrepublik im Zeitalter des Konfessionalismus. The European Republic of Letters in the Age of Confessionalism*, ed. id., *Wolfenbütteler Forschungen* 96 (Wiesbaden, 2001), 11–19. See Franz Mauelshagen, 'Netzwerke des Vertrauens. Gelehrtenkorrespondenzen und wissenschaftlicher Austausch in der Frühen Neuzeit', in *Vertrauen. Historische Annäherungen*, ed. Ute Frevert (Göttingen, 2003), 119–51. See n. 22.

⁷ Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, i.)()()2^v: ‘Cùm ante hæc tempora, etiam magnæ eruditionis & sapientiæ viros in causâ religionis vacillare, & nunc mutare, nunc verò abnegare priorem fidem suam, in qua nati, baptizati, & educati fuerant, viderem: ccepi & ego de animæ meæ salute esse sollicitus, & cum doctis pijsque viris de hac re sæpius conferre. | Et hi quidem secundum illud Christi admonebant, animaduertendum, & eò respiciendum esse, quònam animo essent præditi huiuscemodi viri? [...] | Veruntamen ego non acquiescendum ratus huiusmodi rationi, & precatus Deum cum Dauide, vt auertat oculos meos à vanitate, ne similis fierem descendantibus in lacum: sed vt confiteri ipsi Domino possem in Ecclesiâ magnâ, & in populo graui laudare eum: diligenter primùm ex sacris literis, deinde S. Patribus, alijsq; historijs, quas vndiquaque comparare & reperire poteram, de rei veritate disquirere cœpi. Ad quam rem [...]’ (see n. 6).

⁸ Ibid.,)()()2^v–3^r: ‘Gustu igitur dulcedinis ex veritate percepto, tandem ad inquirendum altiùs earn & rimandum, relictis omnibus penè negotiis politicis & aulicis, vnice huic me dedicaui, & sollicitè statum Ecclesiæ antiquæ & hodiernæ (etiam vltra illud præscriptum Horatij, *nonum preme in annum*) non absq; magnis laboribus, & sumtibus indagavi. Quibus dum sedulò incumberem, & tot tantasq; querimonias & detestationes omnifariorum abusuum, tarn in Republica, quàm præcipuè in Ecclesia, patrum, & aliorum grauissimorum authorum penè infinitorum offenderem, cœpi memoriæ causâ colligere & coaceruare huiusmodi testimonia & authoritates, soli mihi, vt instar solatij, speculi, normæ & indicis essent in hac causa. | Cùm verò postmodum inter viros principes ac doctos, & Ecclesiasticos & Politicos, sermo fieret de hisce rebus, & explicarem nonnunquam ego, quæ huius vel alterius authoris esset mens & sententia, ita vt ex me intelligerent, non exiguam copiam ex varijs scriptoribus me domi consignatam habere: nonnulli etiam ipsi vidissent promptuarium huiusmodi lectionum; hunc quasi thesaurum apud vnum hominem delitescere, nolentes, sed vrgentes diu multumq;, & tandem importunè nonnihil, me hæc etiam alijs editione publicâ communicare voluerant; dicentes: dubium non esse, quin, si multi, qui in Papatu viuunt, cognitum & exploratum haberent; quid esset Veritas; & quòd nonnulla mera essent hominum figmenta, totq; vitiis & abusibus pleraque referta; multaque vel quæstus causâ, vel dominandi libidine excogitata; seriò ipsimet miseram suam sortem essent deploraturi, si docerentur, quâ esset incedendum, ne veritate fidei aberrantes, seipsos salute defraudarent.’ See n. 23.

⁹ Ibid.,)2^v: ‘Quæ durities & obstinatio, qualis olim fuit apud Iudæos, clamitantes, templum Domini, templum Domini, & interim legem ac mandata Domini derelinquentes: talis vel atrocior eâ est etiamnum hodie apud plurimos. | Qui enim in Ecclesia sint defectus, quis non videt? & tarnen pleriq; hoc diuerticulo omnem reprehensionem effugere, & elidere conantes, dicunt, esse quidem defectus, sed tantum personarum; doctrinæ nullum: & simili modo nihil aliud quàm Ecclesiam suam; & hoc subinde crepant, eam à Christi & Apostolorum temporibus originem trahere, ac deinde ordinaria successione, veluti per traducem, propagatam, sine errore ac corruptione: nec quenquam ante hæc (vti nunc) extitisse, qui se opposuerit. Quod tamen negârunt ab Apostolorum tempore vsq; ad hodiernum diem plures Catholici viri, quos constat defœdatam Ecclesiæ conditionem pio zelo seriò semper deplorassee, reformationq; toto pectore exoptasse; de quibus nunc paucis tantum, plurimis infrâ toto Opere tractabitur.’ Women are mentioned as prophets according to Joel 2:28–9, 32; *ibid.*,)()4^r: ‘[...] sed tamen & illi, quos post Christum suscitauit Dominus in Ecclesiâ; tum viri, tum fœminæ possunt subintelligi.’ In a first survey (*ibid.*,)2^v–4^v) Wolff cites authors from Irenaeus (dated 179) to Andreas Fricius (dated 1550), ‘[...] qui de corruptione & erroribus doctrinæ Ecclesiæ scripsêre [...]’ (*ibid.*,)4^v).

¹⁰ As a result of reconsideration and condensation: *ibid.*,)()()3^v: ‘[...] & superexcrescens hinc libri magnitudo Lectori strenuo & industrio fastidiH pareret, cùm in reuidendo animaduenterem, opus in aliquot volumina præter opinionis spem excreuisse, nolui, plures eius esse partes, quàm duas; & ideo à plerisq; autoribus subtraxi multa (aliò differendi animo) admodum, vt plurimorum obiter & titulotenus tantum sit in his duobus libris facta mentio: [...] nam plura apponere, numerus sanè trium ferè millium autorum, ex quibus congestum est hoc Opus, admittere noluit.’

¹¹ Ibid.,)(4^v–)(2^r: ‘Ex his paucis, num in doctrinâ & vitâ Pontificiæ Ecclesiæ hactenus nullus fuerit error & labes, satis superq; intelligere quivis potest: [...]’.

¹² Ibid.,)(^r (dated 1200): ‘Abbas Ioachimus: mulier auro inaurata, quæ cum terræ principibus fornicatur, est ecclesia Romana; quæ in Babylone vitæ confusione transfusa mœchatur: occidentalis igitur ecclesia spiritualiter & temporaliter malitiosa, videtur meritò abolenda. Item, prælatis præfracta est frons meretricis; indurati enim malitiâ nolunt erubescere: ideò oppressi ab eis clamant ad Deum, dicentes: ô devs, quò vsque non vindicabis sanguinem innocentem clamitantium sub altari?’

¹³ Ibid.,)(2^r: ‘Abbas Ioachimus de reformatione futurâ hoc affirmat super Ieremiæ cap. 8. & 13. post B. Gregorij tempora neminem comparuisse, qui populum Dei erudierit, vel rectè ingressus fuerit ad Euangelium veritatis. Et propterea secuturum breui à Ieremia prædictum illum ventilatorem Ecclesiæ sextæ, cui aperiendum sit ostium intelligentiæ, ad prædicandum Euangelium diu omissæ & amissæ veritatis; contra illum prædicatorem non præualiturum errorem hæreticorum, semet veros confessores dicentium. Super Esaïam part. 2.’ Concerning ‘Super Hieremiam’, see n. 60; for ‘Super Esaïam’, see n. 52.

¹⁴ Ibid.,)(2^r: ‘Et apertiùs idem Abbas Ioachimus, & quoque Telesphorus prædixerunt: fore, vt vocetur ad Ecclesiam reformandam monachus Augustinianus, qui ob metum persecutorem [recte: persecutorum] lateret inclusus, vt sit pastor Ecclesiæ. Quod quidam tunc impletum fuisse dicunt: cùm Lutherus, monachus Augustinianus, proscriptus & damnatus, latitaret in arce VVartburg, & ab vniuersitate VVittenbergensi ad ministerium vocaretur. In quo loco adeò mirabiliter conseruatus fuit, vt quemadmodum Diaboli locum sepulti Mosis; sic nec pontificij, etsi Magorum & Diaboli auxilium implorauerint, locum absconditi Lutheri detegere potuerint. Chytræus in Chron. Arct. & alij.’ Ibid.,)(3^v: ‘Et de alijs pluribus, qui vates multis annis ante Lutherum natum eius reformationem prædixerunt, quoq; ex sequentibus patebit.’ See n. 71.

¹⁵ This is the reason why Wolff dedicates the whole second volume to his sixteenth-century testimonies; Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, ii: [EPISTOLA NVNCVPATORIA] [...] DOMINO IOACHIMO A SCHVLENBVRG &c. | [...],)(2^v: ‘Licet autem vnicus saltem annorum centenarius supersit, tamen cæteris nullo modo posthaberi debet: sed certè vel vnico hoc maximè præcellere, quòd in eo vera Euangelij lux, multis annis, quæstu & dominandi libidine (heu deplorandum) oppressa, & à pijs viris diu ardentè & effictim desiderata, tandem Dei gratia iterum fulgere cœpit. | nam cùm diutius conuiuere Deus ad miseriam hanc non posset (doluit enim Dominus super miserijs populi sui, Iud. 10.) suscitauit talem, qui, virtute & auxilio Spiritus sancti, Ecclesiæ falsas traditiones detexit, & sic verbum veritatis; tot annos, gladio igne & sanguine suppressum, in lucem vendicauit, [...]’.

¹⁶ Wolf, *Lectiones memorabiles*, i,)(3^v: ‘Cùm igitur dictis modis per multos annos affigeretur Ecclesia his errorum & vitiorum plagis; & interim pleriq; (præsertim summi) reformationem non solùm contumaciter respuer)t, sed etiâ omnes pios de his malis loqui vel scribere ampliùs prohiberent; & qui vel hiscere de emendatione audebant, ferro, flammâ, fune & anathemate persequerentur, tandem lapides clamare cœperunt, Lucæ 19. & pij exprimere veritatem monumentis, picturis, & notis mysticis; imitatione ferè Ægyptiorum, qui olim typis & locutionibus hieroglyphicis sacra sua probebant.’

¹⁷ Ibid.,)(3^v: ‘Antiqui .n. prudentes, vt sapientiæ præcepta cum rerH admiratione imbiberentur, nec ab impijs tam facilè, vt ft, profanarentur, secreta rerum sacrarH occulta esse voluerunt. Non tamen de his hieroglyphicis hoc loco, de quibus [...]: sed de ijs, quibus Methodius, Abbas Ioachimus, Anshelmus Marsicanus, Regiselmus, Telesphorus de Cusentia, Rupecissa, Lubertus Hanschildt, Lichtenbergius, Iosephus Grunbeck, Theophrastus, Durischius, Adrasder, & Pieriusin præfatione hieroglyphicorH, & alij penè innumeri descriptionem totius Papatus, & fortunæ eius per imagines expresserunt; & quod verbis ac oratione tam graphicè tradere vel noluerHt, vel n@ ausi fuerunt, hisce inuolucris manifestârHt. | Ideoque & illas & alia antiquorum simulachra, monumenta, & picturas hinc

inde ex antiquis codicibus & bibliothecis monasteriorum, palatiorum & templorum structuris repetita, cum omnibus communicare hoc libro volui, [...].’

¹⁸ It is not yet possible to determine how consciously Wolff worked in the realm of an *ars historiae legendi* whose most prominent French protagonist François Baudouin had been represented in Wolff’s collection of historiographic methodology *Artis historicae penus* (see n. 2). For the shift from *ars historica* to the art of reading history in the middle of the sixteenth century see Couzinet, *Histoire et méthode à la Renaissance*, 40–42; Gregory B. Lyon, ‘Baudouin, Flacius, and the Plan for the Magdeburg Centuries’, in *Journal of the History of Ideas*, 64 (2003), 253–72, esp. 271 (detailing evidence from Kelley *Faces of History*).

¹⁹ ‘Centenarium’ first appears in the eschatological tract *De semine scripturarum* (1204 or 1205); see Arndt Brendecke, *Die Jahrhundertwenden. Eine Geschichte ihrer Wahrnehmung und Wirkung* (Frankfurt/Main and New York, 1999), 56–62. Matthias Kaup is currently preparing an edition. ‘Centenarius’ meaning centuries post Christum first occurs with the Benedictine humanist Hermannus Piscator’s *Chronicon urbis et ecclesiae Maguntinensis* (c. 1520–26); see Uta Goerlitz, *Humanismus und Geschichtsschreibung am Mittelrhein. Das ‘Chronicon urbis et ecclesiae Maguntinensis’ des Hermannus Piscator OSB*, Frühe Neuzeit 47 (Tübingen, 1999), 174–8, 181–3, 389–92. For ‘centenarius’ in sixteenth-century historiographical works, see Brendecke, *Die Jahrhundertwenden*, 75–90. Dedicating the first volume of the *Lectiones memorabiles* ‘pro felici auspicio huius noui seculi’ (Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, i,)()()4^v) on ‘Calend. Februar. Anno Christi M. D. C.’ (ibid.,)()()6^v), Wolff did not focus on the year 1600 as a jubilee or specific date of the imminent end of the world. See Thomas Kaufmann, ‘1600 – Deutungen der Jahrhundertwende im deutschen Luthertum’, in *Jahrhundertwenden. Endzeit- und Zukunftsvorstellungen vom 25. bis zum 20. Jahrhundert*, ed. Manfred Jakubowski-Tiessen, Hartmut Lehmann, Johannes Schilling, and Reinhart Staats, Veröffentlichungen des Max-Planck-Instituts für Geschichte 155 (Göttingen, 1999), 73–128, esp. 79–104; id., ‘Römisches und evangelisches Jubeljahr 1600. Konfessionskulturelle Deutungsalternativen der Zeit im Jahrhundert der Reformation’, in *Millennium: Deutungen zum christlichen Mythos der Jahrtausendwende. Mit Beiträgen von [...]*, Kaiser Taschenbücher 171 (Gütersloh, 1999), 73–136, esp. 84–8 and 113–34; Brendecke, *Die Jahrhundertwenden*, 97–109.

²⁰ Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, i,)()()3^v: ‘Et præcipuè ne deesset Index Operis; noua methodo, quia distributum est in Centenarios annorum, Catalogum subiunxi singulis seculis omnium Imperatorum & Pontificum Romanorum; ordinum Ecclesiasticorum & plerorumq; alias hominum, eruditionis & similium virtutum laude tunc clarior: sic enim tempus & nomen auctoris cum factorum tum historiarum facilius reperiri potest.’ *Methodus* denotes a method to make history accessible; see Wolff’s commitment to contemporary historiographical methodology (see n. 2 above). Throughout the main text Wolff provides historical orientation to his readers by indicating on the margins of the type-area a year appropriate to the author’s cited work and by adding the emperor’s and the pope’s names of the time to each entry; see his explanations, ibid. After Wolff’s death an *Index absolutissimas* to both volumes was published by Johannes Jacobus Linsius (Lauingen, 1608, repr. Frankfurt/Main, 1672); see *VD 17 – Das Verzeichnis der im deutschen Sprachraum erschienenen Drucke des 17. Jahrhunderts* (henceforth VD 17: <http://www.vd17.de>), 23:230248U.

²¹ See Martina Hartmann, *Humanismus und Kirchenkritik: Matthias Flacius Illyricus als Erforscher des Mittelalters*, Beiträge zur Geschichte und Quellenkunde des Mittelalters 19 (Stuttgart, 2001), 47–52, 198–208; Oliver K. Olson, *Matthias Flacius and the Survival of Luther’s Reform*, Wolfenbütteler Abhandlungen zur Renaissanceforschung, 20 (Wiesbaden, 2002), 256–79; Lyon, ‘Baudouin, Flacius’. For a general survey on Flacius, see Franjo Sanjek, ‘Matthias Flacius Illyricus (1520–1575). L’historien du christianisme’, in *Heresis*, 35 (2001), 119–28.

²² See n. 6. For the early modern scholarly practice of collaborative intellectual enterprise, see Anthony Grafton, ‘Where was Salomon’s House? Ecclesiastical History and the Intellectual Origins

of Bacon's *New Atlantis*', in *Die europäische Gelehrtenrepublik*, 21–38, esp. 26–33 on Flacius and the *Magdeburg Centuries*.

²³ His change of attitude was what motioned Wolff to publish the work; Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, i, 3^r: 'Et huius sanè fatale rei experimentum cùm in proprijs viderim ædibus, motus eo, non potui non publicæ saluti & vtilitati inseruire. Illo enim ipso tempore habui amanuensem, iuuenem ingeniosum, ex schola Iesuitarum Fuldensium, nomine Martinum? [!] ille abundans præceptis & institutis doctrinæ pontificiæ, sæpè acerrimè in contrariam religioni suæ inuectus, additis etiam blasphemijs, dixit; se non optare sibi cælum, in quo Lutherus esset. Verùm cùm describendo magis magisque animaduerneret, quòd Papatus & religio Ecclesiæ Romanæ planè ab Apostolorum semita declinasset; quid item Lutherus docuisset; tandem concedere in aliam sententiam, blasphemiarum suarum pudere, rectiùs sentire, modestiùs loqui de illâ, & frequentare sacras conciones, & legere ipsam scripturam cœpit. | Et cùm aliquanto pòst tempore dysenteria [...].'

(passage following the paragraphs quoted in n. 8).

²⁴ For an instance of a Capestrano prophecy interpreted by Wolff, see Schmolinsky, 'Positionen', 413–16. Further instances might occur upon investigating the second volume in particular.

²⁵ For an understanding of Joachim's theology, see Julia Eva Wannenmacher, 'Alpha und Omega. Joachim von Fiore in der Theologie des 12. Jahrhunderts. Versuch einer Standortbestimmung, in *What is 'Theology' in the Middle Ages? Religious Cultures of Europe (11th–15th Centuries) as Reflected in Their Self-understanding*, ed. Mikolaj Olszewski, *Archa verbi: Subsidia* 1 (Münster, 2007), 103–22. For Joachim's biography and the interpretation of his works, see Gian Luca Potestà, *Il tempo dell'Apocalisse. Vita di Gioacchino da Fiore*, Collezione Storica (Rome and Bari, 2004); Kurt-Victor Selge, 'Joachim von Fiore', in *Reformer als Ketzer. Heterodoxe Bewegungen von Vorreformatoren*, ed. Günter Frank and Friedrich Niewöhner, *Melanchthon-Schriften der Stadt Bretten* 8 (Stuttgart and Bad Cannstatt, 2004), 123–43. For his millenaristic and prophetic reception, see Robert E. Lerner, *Scrutare il futuro. L'eredità di Gioacchino da Fiore alla fine del Medioevo*, *Opere di Gioacchino da Fiore: testi e strumenti* 21 (Rome, 2008).

²⁶ Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, i, 443–501 (including *testimonia* about Joachim). Wolff does not show any knowledge of specific Joachimist imagery; see, recently, *Die Bildwelt der Diagramme Joachims von Fiore. Zur Medialität religiös-politischer Programme im Mittelalter*, ed. Alexander Patschovsky (Ostfildern, 2003).

²⁷ Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, i, 443: 'ABBAS IOACHIMUS. | Hic vixit circa annum Domini 1200. Eius scripta, & prophetias primùm in Germaniam misit Cardinalis Portuensis, cum subsequentibus versibus de Cardinalium discordiâ, circa annum 1250. | *Non concordamus, nec concordare putamus, [...]*. Hæc ex Conradi Halberstadensis Chronico.' Conrad's entry is mentioned in: Konrad von Halberstadt O.P., *Chronographia Interminata 1277–1355/59*, ed. Rainer Leng, *Wissensliteratur im Mittelalter* 23 (Wiesbaden, 1996), 98; Leng refers to the cardinals' disputes on Gregory's X election. For the Erfurt Minorite chronicle, see *Cronica minor Minoritæ Erphordensis*, in *Monumenta Erphesfurtensia saec. XII. XIII. XIV.*, ed. Oswald Holder-Egger, *MGH SRG in us. schol.*, [42] (Hannover and Leipzig, 1899), 679, 13–28, ad 1269. The inserted (Ghibelline) prophecy 'Regnabit Menfridus', ascribed to Joachim, is said to have been transmitted to Germany by John of Toledo; see Hannes Möhring, *Der Weltkaiser der Endzeit. Entstehung, Wandel und Wirkung einer tausendjährigen Weissagung*, *Mittelalter-Forschungen* 3 (Stuttgart, 2000), 242–3; Robert E. Lerner, *The Powers of Prophecy: The Cedar of Lebanon Vision from the Mongol Onslaught to the Dawn of the Enlightenment* (Berkeley, Los Angeles, and London, 1983), 56–57; Reeves, *Influence*, 74, 311–12, and 309. The Cardinal's passage, which is quoted by Matthias Flacius Illyricus in his article on Joachim in his *Catalogus testium veritatis* (see below), has so far not been correlated with his article on the 'Cardinalis Portuensis', as results from Christina Beatrice Melanie Frank, 'Untersuchungen zum Catalogus testium veritatis des Matthias Flacius Illyricus', diss. (Tübingen, 1989 [1990]), 32. Wolff has omitted the Joachite prophecy, ascribed to Joachim, of the two Mendicant orders,

obviously quoted by Konrad from the Erfurt minorite (which Leng, *ibid.*, n. 427 does not mention; see *Cronica minor*, *ibid.*, 679,28–680,5), although religious orders enjoy Wolff’s attention throughout his work.

²⁸ For the versions of the Latin pope prophecies and recent research, see *The Late Medieval Pope Prophecies: The ‘Genus nequam’ Group*, ed. Martha H. Fleming, *Medieval and Renaissance Texts and Studies* 204 (Tempe, Ariz., 1999), 1–11; Christian Jostmann, *Sibilla Erithea Babilonica. Papsttum und Prophetie im 13. Jahrhundert*, *Monumenta Germaniae Historica: Schriften* 54 (Hannover, 2006), 64–5, 359–60; Marjorie Reeves, ‘The Medieval Heritage’, in *Prophetic Rome in the High Renaissance Period. Essays*, ed. ead., *Oxford-Warburg Studies* (Oxford, 1992), 3–21, esp. 9–14. For an edition, see Robert E. Lerner and Robert Moynihan, *Weissagungen über die Päpste. Vat. Ross. 374. Eine Einführung*, *Codices e Vaticanis selecti quam simillime expressi iussu Ioannis Pauli PP II consilio et opera curatorum Bibliothecae Vaticanae*, 69. *Belser Faksimile Editionen aus der Bibliotheca Apostolica Vaticana* (Zurich, 1985). The popes’ identifications are discussed by Bernard McGinn, ‘“Pastor Angelicus”: Apocalyptic Myth and Political Hope in the Fourteenth Century,’ in *Santi e santità nel secolo XIV. Atti del XV Convegno internazionale, Assisi, 15 – 16 – 17 ottobre 1987*, *Publicazioni dell’Università degli Studi di Perugia* (Perugia, 1989), 219–51, 234–6. For iconographic studies, see Paola Guerrini, *Propaganda politica e profezie figurate nel tardo Medioevo*, *Nuovo Medioevo* 51 (Naples, 1997), 9–23. In Zurich Frank Schleich currently works on the *Vaticinia de summis pontificibus*; see http://www.uzh.ch/mls/projelae.html#projekte_schleich [seen 4 October 2010].

²⁹ VATICINIA, | Siue | PROPHETÆ | Abbatis | IOACHIMI, | & | Anselmi Episcopi | Marsicani, | *Cum imaginibus are in-|cisis, correctione, et pul-|critudine, plurium manu-|scriptorum exemplariū | op[er]e, [...]. Qvibvs rota, et | Oraculum Turcicum | maxime considerationis adiecta sunt. | Vna cum Præfatione, | et Adnotationibus | Paschalini | Regiselmi.* (Venice: Hieronymus Porrus, 1589; repr. Leipzig, 1972). The only major difference is that Wolff does not note the end of Paschalinus’ first group marking the transition from Joachim as an author to Anselmus Marsicanus; *ibid.*, [D4]^r / [D4]^v, *Vaticinium XV. / XVI. (‘Genus nequam’)*; Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, i, [451].

³⁰ [Andreas Osiander d. Ä.], *Schriften und Briefe April 1525 bis Ende 1527* [in collaboration with] Gottfried Seebaß ed. Gerhard Müller, *Andreas Osiander d. Ä. Gesamtausgabe*, 2 (Gütersloh, 1977), 403–84, no. 84: *Wunderliche Weissagung 1527*. Bearbeitet von Hans-Ulrich Hofmann.

³¹ See Hofmann, ‘Wunderliche Weissagung’, 415–16, who thinks Wolff did the translation; 418–20. See Reeves, *Influence*, 454, referring to Karl Sudhoff, *Bibliographia Paracelsica. Besprechung der unter Theophrast von Hohenheim’s Namen 1527–1893 erschienenen Druckschriften*, *Versuch einer Kritik der Echtheit der Paracelsischen Schriften*, 1 (Berlin, 1894), 39, who actually mentions a vernacular selected edition.

³² Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, i, 443: ‘DEinde circa annum 1520. reperta sunt exemplaria Prophetiarum cum imaginibus huius Abbatis: vnum in Carthusianorum monasterio: alterum in Bibliothecâ Illustrissimi Senatus Norimbergensis, pictum ante annos 200. tertium editum est à Theophrasto Paracelso: quartum à Ioanne Adrasder: quintum typis Venetianis anno 1589. à Paschalino Regiselmo: omnia cum annotatis, vt in sequentibus constabit.’ The secondly mentioned Nuremberg manuscript formerly had belonged to the theologian, jurist and physician Konrad Kunhofer (d. 1452) who donated his library to the Nuremberg Council in 1443; for reference, see Schmolsky, ‘Prophetia’, 120, n. 103.

³³ As to Wolff, David Heffner’s conclusion that in the Anglo-German tradition of the *Vaticinia* ‘Joachim is forgotten in this rush to polemicize’ cannot be confirmed; see *id.*, ‘The Use of Medieval Prophecy in Reformation Polemic’, in *Il profetismo gioachimita tra Quattrocento e Cinquecento. Atti del III Congresso Internazionale di Studi Gioachimiti S. Giovanni in Fiore, 17–21 settembre 1989*, ed. Gian Luca Potestà, *Centro Internazionale di Studi Gioachimiti. Opere di Gioacchino da Fiore, strumenti* 3 (Genova, 1991), 295–304, esp. 303, for Osiander, Paracelsus, and Wolff 297–9.

Unfortunately, I have not been able to see Heffner's dissertation: id, "'Eyn wunderliche Weyssagung von dem Babstumb": Medieval Prophecy into Reformation Polemic', doctoral thesis (University of Pennsylvania, 1991, UMI Dissertation Services, Ann Arbor, Mich., 48106).

³⁴ Osiander translating his German version must have adapted the sequence to the Latin standards, so that a dis coherence occurred between his two versions. Hofmann, 'Wunderliche Weissagung', 416 notes, that the woodcuts originally were carved according to Osiander's copies and partly adapted to those of Regiselmus later on.

³⁵ Regiselmus, *Vaticinia, Siue Prophetiæ*, [14]^{r-v}, [K4]^{r-v} (see Italian version M2^v [indicating 1727], N2^v – [N3]^r); Regiselmus considers neither Luther nor Calvin to have been the Antichrist; *Vaticinium* 28, *ibid.*, [K4]^r, see N2^v]. Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, i, 459–66, here 463, 466. See Reeves, *Influence*, 458–60; Hofmann, 'Wunderliche Weissagung', 418.

³⁶ 'In imagines Ioachimi Abbatis annotationes Iheophras-|sti Paracelsi, cum marginalibus Adami Durischij | translatoris'; Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, i, 466–83, cited 466; for vaticinia 27–30 see 482–3. Durischius is not known so far; see Sudhoff, *Bibliographia Paracelsica*, no. 249, 431 and no. 399, 609–10. Paracelsus' work critically reacts to Osiander; see Reeves, *Influence*, 454–5; Hofmann, 'Wunderliche Weissagung', 417.

³⁷ Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, i, 483–8, esp. 486. See Reeves, *Influence*, 454; for Luther's reaction 490 and Hofmann, 'Wunderliche Weissagung', 414–15. The picture had been related to Celestine V; see Peter Herde, *Cölestin V. (1294) (Peter vom Morrone) der Engelpapst. Mit einem Urkundenanhang und Edition zweier Viten*, Päpste und Papsttum 16 (Stuttgart, 1981), 200–201 (with reference to Wolff's edition). See McGinn, "'Pastor Angelicus'", 229–30.

³⁸ Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, i, 487–8, quotation 488. The last five vaticinia traditionally referred to five future angelic popes; see Hofmann's annotations to Osiander's German version in: Hofmann, 'Wunderliche Weissagung', 474–83; McGinn, "'Pastor Angelicus'", 236.

³⁹ Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, i, 443: 'Sed & Scalichius Apostata non veritate sed ventre impellente contra mentem authoris super eas pro papa glossas mendaces edidit: vt apud eum.' (following the quotation in n. 32; reference to Wolff's entry *ibid.*, 502). Scalichius (Pavao Skalić, Scaliger) turns against Paracelsus' comment; see Reeves, *Influence*, 456–8; Hofmann, 'Wunderliche Weissagung', 417; Sudhoff *Bibliographia Paracelsica*, 217.

⁴⁰ Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, i, 458: 'Alia futuri Pontificis notæ & indicia ex vetustissimis manuscriptis vaticiniis. | RVpe veni incultâ [...].'

⁴¹ Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, i, 459: 'Rota Abb. Ioachimi, à Pio IV. (vt aiunt) in Solis & Lunæ imaginibus incipiens, & futura de Pontificibus prædicens. | De hac Ioachimi Rota iudicium & declaratio Paschalini Regiselmi.'; according to Regiselmus, *Vaticinia, Siue Prophetiæ*, [a4]^v (image) and L^{r-v} (text). For wheels predicting popes in later sixteenth-century prints and manuscripts, see Marjorie Reeves, 'Some Popular Prophecies from the Fourteenth to the Seventeenth Centuries', in *Popular Belief and Practice*, ed. G.J. Cuming and Derek Baker, Studies in Church History 8 (Cambridge, 1972), 107–34, esp. 127–8; repr. in *ead.*, *The Prophetic Sense of History in Medieval and Renaissance Europe*, Variorum Collected Studies Series (Aldershot, Brookfield, Vt., Singapore, and Sydney, 1999), VI.

⁴² Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, i, 459: 'Dicimus nos, si vera sit, admiratione, stupore, & mentis commotione digna, & plena de futuro Pontifice expectanda, pluresque annos præsentì dandos: ipse nempe viam ante eum præparaturus est rotæ huius significatione, [...]. Hinc aliquid curiosi abstrusorum scrutatores eruite, & in vestrum vsum conuertite: nam mihi plura ostendere, palamque in lucem dare minimè licet. Solis hæc amicis seruamus, & iis verè synceris, & Christianæ religionis, sanctæque Romanæ Ecclesiæ amantibus, memores Euangelici dicti: Ne proiciatis margaritas vestras ante porcos.'; see Regiselmus, *Vaticinia, Siue Prophetiæ*, L^v.

⁴³ Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, i and ii, [(1^r); ii, 938–40. Wolff starts with quotations from Claudius Minois on Andreas Alciatus' emblem 80; *ibid.*, 939–40; see *Omnia Andreae Alciati Emblemata. Cum commentariis, [...] illustrantur per Claud. Minoem [...]* (Paris: Richer and Gueffier, 1618), 392: Desidia. EMBLEMA LXXX. See Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, i,)() (4^r and ii,)()(^v.

⁴⁴ Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, ii, 940–41. He then adds a vaticinium in verses on the surrounding zodiac: 'Vaticinium antiquum, cuius hoc est schema synasterismi cœlestis prodigiosi, additum & insertum (ne intercideret) his figuris, Ioachimiaeq; Rotæ circumpositum, [...]' *ibid.*, ii, 941–2.

⁴⁵ Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, ii, 938: 'Explicationem picturæ Papæ insidentis equo, & Ecclesia derelicta in miserijs & deplorandis afflictionibus vidua, abeuntis hinc post voluptates & ludicra peregrè, vide suprâ part. 1. fol. 447.471.472. & 485.'; related to the emblem at upper right of the front page giving a small version of the eighth vaticinium; the page specifications refer to the eighth vaticinium and the three commentaries on it.

⁴⁶ See above, p. 241.

⁴⁷ Wolff, *Lectiones memombiles*, i,)()(^r,)()()(^v-)()() (2^r (without indication of source).

⁴⁸ Wolff, *Lectiones memombiles*, i,)()()(^r.

⁴⁹ Flowing with words Wolff assures not to pretend his authors' discourses to be his own, by the way for his own sake, too; *Lectiones memombiles*, i,)()() (3^v-)()() (4^r.

⁵⁰ Wolff, *Lectiones memombiles*, i, 488–9. He seems to have used Lazarus de Soardis' edition once even copying a marginal reference letter: Eximij profundissimiq[ue] sacro [rum] | eloquio[rum] perscrutatoris ac futuro[rum] prenuncia-|toris Abbatis Joachim florentis scriptum | super Esaïam prophetam: plurimis | internis ac mysticis itellectibus | sacras litteras penetrans. | Maximeq[ue] partis orbis | terrarum ciuitatum va|ticia. Reuisum ac | correctū: quota-|tionibusq[ue] in | marginib[us] | orna- |tū. | Cum gratia vt patet infra. (Venice, 1517. 1516 is the date of Lazarus' printing license; see aa 2). As to date and authorship see Reeves, *Influence*, 57 and 151–4; as to political positions *ibid.*, 308, 314 n. 1, 320, 397–8. For the contexts of this and further Joachimist and Joachite editions, see Bernard McGinn, 'Circoli gioachimiti veneziani (1450–1530)', *Cristianesimo nella storia*, 7 (1986), 19–39, esp. 31–2.

⁵¹ The origins of the marginal annotations have not yet been studied; they are mentioned by Johannes Chrysostomus Huck, *Joachim von Floris und die joachitische Literatur. Ein Beitrag zur Geistesgeschichte des hohenstaufischen Zeitalters mit Benützung und teilweiser Veröffentlichung ungedruckter Joachimsschriften* (Freiburg/Breisgau, 1938), 200–201.

⁵² Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, i, 488–9; refering to *Super Esaïam*, 19^r, 19^v, 20^r, 20^v, 27^v (all marginal), 28^v (marginal and main text), (one quotation unidentified), 4^r (main text), 5^r, 5^v (both marginal), 6^r (main text), 6^v, 7^r (both main text and marginal, parts slightly reworked), 10^v, 11^r, 15^r, covering the [chapters 3](#) to 7, 13 (Onus Babylonis) and one unidentified. Slight verbal or grammatical modifications may occur. See n. 13: Wolff seems to refer to *ibid.*, 50^r, although some of his keywords do not occur (nor in 'Sexta pars libri', *ibid.*, 56^v-59^v).

⁵³ After 10 years' construction work on behalf of the emperor Charlemagne, the bridge crossing the Rhine at Mainz – the only one there between Roman times and 1862 / 1885 – was consumed by fire immediately after its consecration; see Ludwig Falck, *Mainz im frühen und hohen Mittelalter (Mitte 5. Jahrhundert bis 1244)*, Geschichte der Stadt Mainz, ed. Anton Ph. Brück, Ludwig Falck, 3 vols (Düsseldorf, 1972), ii, 34.

⁵⁴ Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, i,)()() (2^r: 'Apud hunc eundem Abbatem habes horrenda, quæ postremis temporibus Ecclesiæ impendeant, significata per pontem Moguntinum, prodigiōse conflagratum, de quibus infrâ.'

⁵⁵ Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, i, 488: ‘Idem. Moguntina regio quid in diebus Caroli passa fuerit, nequaquam Spiritus indicat, qui pontem eius vastissimum sub hora permodica, ignea facie consumsit: illud futurum, prodigium indicans, quòd fremitus Theotonicus frangi vel reprimi debeat sub aquilæ temporibus posteriorum. In partibus istis non levis tribulatio renascenda præscribitur inter Saxones & Sueuos: sed & Romana Ecclesia casura in petram scandalì, Esa. 8. [- Is 8: 14] videat, si de acceptandis & improbandis electionibus principum confusionis maculam non incurrit: [...]’.

⁵⁶ Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, i, 489–91. He concludes with a quotation from the *Liber de Flore* on a specimen of the fifth and sixth *status*.

⁵⁷ *Diuini vatis Abbatis Joachim liber cō|cordie noui ac veteris Testamenti: nunc | primo impressus: [et] in lucē editus: Opus | equidem diuinum ac aliorum fere omni-|um tractatum suorum fundamē|tale diuinorum eloquiorum ob-|scura elucida: archana reserās: | necnon eorundē curio | sis sitibundisq[ue] menti-|bus nō minus satiata-|tem afferens* (Venice, 1519, repr. Frankfurt/Main, 1964 and 1983). For a modern edition of Book 1 to 4 based on five manuscripts, see Abbot Joachim of Fiore, *Liber de Concordia Noui ac Veteris Testamenti*, ed. E. Randolph Daniel, Transactions of the American Philosophical Society Held at Philadelphia for Promoting Useful Knowledge, 73, 8 (Philadelphia, 1983). Thanks to Reeves, *Influence*, 488, n. 2, and Daniel’s indices, extracts have been identified from lib. 3, pars 1, cap. 4–6 (with variations); lib. iii, pars 2, cap. 5 and 6; lib. iv, cap. 27; lib. 5, cap. 13 (Venice 1519, 27^{ra}–28^{ra}; 41^{rb} and 41^{vb}; 54^{vb}; 66^{vb}–67^{ra}; according to Daniel, 220–25; 301 and 304; 394); see Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, i, 490–91.

⁵⁸ Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, i, 491–7. He concludes with a short note ‘*Abbas Ioachimus de expeditione ad terram sanctam.*’ whose origin is not indicated; *ibid.*, 497.

⁵⁹ ABBATIS IOACHIM | Diuina prorsus | IN IEREMIAM | PROPHETAM INTER|PRETATION PLVRIMIS REFER-|TA VATICINIIS, QVORVM | NONNVLLA IAM EVENTV | comprobata, certam de reli-|quis in posterum fidem | faciunt. (Cologne: Lodovicus Alectorius & hæredes Iacobi Soteris, 1577). See VD 16, J 286. So far no editor is known the volume being opened by a reprint of Silvestro Meucci’s dedication to Paolo Angelo from 1525; see McGinn, ‘Circoli gioachimiti veneziani’, 28–39, esp. 32. The index, following the concluding page 386, is of unknown origin and unique to this edition: ‘INDEX. | TABVLA SEV ANNOTATIO PRIN-|cipalium dictorum, quæ in expositione Abbatis | Ioachim super Hieremiam continentur.’ Using a print version Wolff has dealt with the ‘long’ version of the commentary; see Robert Moynihan, ‘The Development of the “Pseudo-Joachim” Commentary “Super Hieremiam”: New Manuscript Evidence’, in *Mélanges de l’Ecole française de Rome. Moyen Age – Temps Modernes*, 98 (1986), 109–42, esp. 110, 119, 137; *id.*, ‘Joachim of Fiore and the Early Franciscans: A Study of the Commentary “Super Hieremiam”’, diss. (Yale University, 1988).

⁶⁰ The last issue in [chapter 5](#); Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, i, 493; IN IEREMIAM, [Bb 7]^f. For Wolff’s remarks in his ‘Epistola dedicatoria’ on a future reformation predicted by ‘Joachim’, see n. 13: he refers to INIEREMIAM, [Bb 8]^v (chapter 13 mentioned by Wolff cannot be confirmed).

⁶¹ Johannes Burkhardt, *Das Reformationsjahrhundert. Deutsche Geschichte zwischen Medienrevolution und Institutionenbildung 1517–1617* (Stuttgart, 2002), 16–76. See ‘AHR Forum. How Revolutionary Was the Print Revolution?’, in *American Historical Review*, 107 (2002), 84–128 (exchange between Elizabeth L. Eisenstein and Adrian Johns). For book production in the fifteenth and sixteenth centuries, see Uwe Neddermeyer, *Von der Handschrift zum gedruckten Buch. Schriftlichkeit und Leseinteresse im Mittelalter und in der frühen Neuzeit. Quantitative und qualitative Aspekte*, 2 vols, Buchwissenschaftliche Beiträge aus dem Deutschen Bucharchiv München 61 (Wiesbaden, 1998); *id.*, ‘Lateinische und volkssprachliche Bücher im Zeitalter Gutenbergs. Überlegungen zu den Auswirkungen von medientechnischen Umstellungen auf den Buchmarkt – nicht nur im Mittelalter’, in *Bibliothek und Wissenschaft*, 32 (1999), 84–109. For the role of print in the early Reformation movement, see Mark U. Edwards, Jr., *Printing, Propaganda, and Martin Luther* (Berkeley, Los Angeles, and London, 1994). For the quantity of Lutheran

apocalyptic Flugschriften in Wolff's lifetime, see Volker Leppin, *Antichrist und jüngster Tag. Das Profil apokalyptischer Flugschriftenpublizistik im deutschen Luthertum 1548–1618*, Quellen und Forschungen zur Reformationsgeschichte 69 (Gütersloh, 1999).

⁶² For his theological studies Wolff had attended Philipp Melanchthon's classes in Wittenberg; see above, 232.

⁶³ For this term see Thomas Kaufmann, *Dreißigjähriger Krieg und Westfälischer Friede. Kirchengeschichtliche Studien zur lutherischen Konfessionskultur*, Beiträge zur historischen Theologie 104 (Tübingen, 1998), 7–8.

⁶⁴ *Catalogus testi-VM VERITATIS, QVI | ante nostram ætatem recia-|marunt Papæ. | Opus uaria rerum, hocpræsertim tempore | scitu digniſimarum, cognitione refertum, | ac lectu cum, primis utile atq; | necessarium. | Cum Præfatione MATHIÆ FLA-|CII Illyrici, qua Operis huius & | ratio & usus exponitur. | 3. Reg. 19. Rom. II | Reliqua mihi ipsi feci Septem millia uirorum, qui | non incuruarunt genu imagi-|ni Baal.* (Basel: Ioannes Oporinus, see 1095: Basel: Michael Martinus Stella, 1556). For an online version, see http://www.uni-mannheim.de/mateo/camenahist/autoren/flacius_hist.html [seen 4 October 2010]. Dedicatory prologue quoted from *Die Anfänge der reformatorischen Geschichtsschreibung. Melanchthon, Sleidan, Flacius und die Magdeburger Zenturien*, ed. Heinz Scheible, Texte zur Kirchen- und Theologiegeschichte 2 (Gütersloh, 1966), 48: 'Studio demonstrandi semper fuisse Septem piorum millia, qui Romano Baali genua non incurvaverint, collegi mediocrem catalogum eorum, qui ante doctorem Martinum pia memoriae vel totum papatum vel aliquos eius errores reprehenderunt, vel etiam turpitudinem vitae papistici cleri pastoralisque officii neglectionem satis acriter sunt insectati.' Further editions of the *Catalogus* were enlarged or revised; see Joachim Massner, *Kirchliche Überlieferung und Autorität im Flaciuskreis. Studien zu den Magdeburger Zenturien* (Berlin and Hamburg, 1964), 76–7, esp. n. 19; Martin Wallraff, 'Die Rezeption der spätantiken Kirchengeschichtswerke im 16. Jahrhundert', in *Auctoritas patrum II. Neue Beiträge zur Rezeption der Kirchenväter im 15. und 16. Jahrhundert. New Contributions on the reception of the Church Fathers in the 15th and 16th Centuries*, ed. Leif Grane, Alfred Schindler, and Markus Wriedt, Veröffentlichungen des Instituts für Europäische Geschichte Mainz, Beiheft 44 (Mainz, 1998), 223–55, esp. 242–3; Hartmann, *Humanismus und Kirchenkritik*, 141–5; Olson, *Matthias Flacius*, 233–41; Wilhelm Schmidt-Biggemann, 'Flacius Illyricus' "Catalogus testium veritatis" als kontroverstheologische Polemik', in *Reformer als Ketzer*, 263–91, esp. 274–91.

⁶⁵ See the 'Praefatio' on 14 'utilitates': 'Prima est: Ideam ecclesiae Domini nostri Iesu Christi ob oculos videre quasi in tabula depictam facillique labore complecti posse, [...]. Quarta: Praebet etiam iudicii recti et explicati normam in haeresibus diiudicandis. [...] Quinta: Ipsam rationem gubernationis in ecclesia Dei, qualis ea fuerit, veluti pingit talis historia; ut quantum iam vel retineatur a prima et vetustissima forma, in quibus vero aberretur, liquido scire possimus. [...] Undecima: Exempla suggerit eiusmodi historia, quod in maximis viris non modo imbecillitates communes, sed etiam turpissimi opinionum, nonnunquam etiam corruptelarum naevi adhaeserint, [...] Doctrina prophetarum et apostolorum indubitata est; sed doctrina ministrorum ecclesiae, quantavis autoritate, doctrina, donis fulgeant, tamen ad normam illorum exigenda est; ac si dissentiat, iure improbatur et reiicitur. [...]'; quoted from *Die Anfänge der reformatorischen Geschichtsschreibung*, 64–6. For arguments in the two prefaces, see Irena Backus, *Historical Method and Confessional Identity in the Era of the Reformation (1378–1615)*, Studies in Medieval and Reformation Thought 94 (Leiden and Boston, 2003), 358–64. See Wallraff, 'Die Rezeption der spätantiken Kirchengeschichtswerke', 243–5. For polemical contexts at Wolff's times, see José L. de Orella y Unzué, *Respuestas católicas a las Centurias de Magdeburgo (1559–1588)*, Publicaciones de la Fundación Universitaria Española: Monografías 23 (Madrid, 1976).

⁶⁶ From a terminological point of view, the *Lectiones memorabiles* do not contribute to the history of the notion of 'testis veritatis' not figuring in Theodor Mahlmann, "'Vorreformatoren",

“vorreformatörisch”, “Vorreformation”. Beobachtungen zur Geschichte eines Sprachgebrauchs’, in *Reformer als Ketzer*, 13–55.

⁶⁷ Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, i, 3^v: ‘Communia ex historijs, Balæo, Nigrino, Sleidano, & similibus, vt inter alia est illud Petri Aloisij, filij Papæ Pauli, [...]’ The *Ecclesiastica Historia Magdeburgica* is quoted for New Testament discussions on the Antichrist; see Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, ii, 848, ad 1567.

⁶⁸ See Heinz Scheible, *Die Entstehung der Magdeburger Zenturien. Ein Beitrag zur Geschichte der historiographischen Methode* (Gütersloh, 1966), 9–10, 63–5; Hartmann, *Humanismus und Kirchenkritik*, 199–200; Lyon, ‘Baudouin, Flacius’, 261 (without reference to the last ‘locus’). For a description of the topics in the general preface, see Scheible, *Die Anfänge der reformatorischen Geschichtsschreibung*, 61–2.

⁶⁹ Decimatertia Centuria | ECCLESIASTICAE | HISTORIÆ, CONTINENS DE=|SCRIPTIONEM AMPLISSIMARVM RERVM IN | Regno Christi, quæ Decimotertio post eius natiuitatem | seculo acciderunt: cum Imperium Romanum gubernarent, Philippus Barbarossæ filius, Otto quartus, [...] | [...] Adolphus: & Doctores in Ecclesia celebres essent, Gulielmus Parisiensis, | Ioachim Abbas, Alexander de Ales, [...] | IN DVCATV ILLVSTRISSIMORVM | Principum ac Ducum Megapolensium, in | ciuitate Vuismaria. | PER AVTORES CONTEXTA. | [...] (Basel: Officina Oporiniana, 1574), col. 554: CAPVT V. | DE HÆRESIBVS., [...]; col. 565,34 – 570,33: ABBATIS IOACHIMI | errores.; see col. 794,8 – 795,58 and 171,58 – 172,2. In the preceding volume dedicated to the twelfth century (1569) Joachim’s submission of his works to papal correction is mentioned by [Hartmann] Schedel; see col. 1085, 10–12. In his *Catalogus* Flacius mentions the condemnation in the context of Luther’s defence of Joachim’s doctrine; see *Catalogus testium veritatis* (1556), 664; Wolff quotes Flacius’ entry on Joachim from the 1562 edition; see *Lectiones memorabiles*, i, 501–2.

⁷⁰ Schmidt-Biggemann, ‘Flacius Illyricus’ “Catalogus testium veritatis”, 287–8.

⁷¹ Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, i, 662–9; see nn. 14, 17. See Emil Donckel, ‘Studien über die Prophezeiung des Fr. Telesphorus von Cosenza, O.F.M. (1365–1386)’, diss. Freiburg in der Schweiz (Florence, Quaracchi, 1933); also in *Archivum Franciscanum Historiatm* 26 (1933, printed 1934), 29–104, 282–314. See Johannes Helmuth, ‘Telesphorus v. Cosenza’, in *Lexikon für Theologie und Kirche*, 3, vollig neu bearb. Aufl., ed. Walter Kasper, 9 (Freiburg, Basel, Rome, and Vienna, 2000), col. 1320; Georg Kreuzer, ‘Telesphorus von Cosenza’, in *Biographisch-Bibliographisches Kirchenlexikon*, ed. Friedrich-Wilhelm Bautz † and Traugott Bautz, 14 (Herzberg, 1998), col. 1539–41, http://www.bautz.de/bbkl/t/telesphorus_v_c.shtml.

⁷² This is the case with ‘Theodorus Graminaeus’, i.e. Theodoor Gras (c. 1530 – after 1592); see Wolff, *Lectiones memorabiles*, ii, 838–9, ad 1565, with quotations taken from Graminaeus’ MYSTICVS | AQVILLO, | SIVE | Declaratio Vaticinij Ieremi[a]e Prophetæ: Ab Aquilone pandetur ma-lum super omnes habitato-res terræ: [...]. COLONIAE, | APVD LVDOVICVM ALECTORI-um, & hæredes Iacobi Soteris. | Anno M.D.LXXVI.; see Reeves, *The Influence of Prophecy*, 449–50, 290, 353 n. 1, 373–4. For Graminaeus’ biography and works, see Biografisch Archief van de Benelux, fiche 273, fol. 237–50.

⁷³ For example Simon Schardius (1535–73), whose ‘Testimonia ex triginta maxima: autoritatis scriptoribus, qui Romam Babylonem, eiusq; Episcopum Antichristum certò statuerunt: à Simone Schardio I.C. Imperialis Camerae assessore, in vnum collecta & edita.’ Wolff inserts; *Lectiones memorabiles*, ii, 839–44, ad 1565, Abbas Ioachim Calaber’ being n. 19. See Eisenhart, ‘Schard, Simon S.’, in *Allgemeine Deutsche Biographie*, 30 (Leipzig, 1890, repr. Berlin, 1970), 581–3.

⁷⁴ See VD 17 23:230241R and 23:230244P; repeated in 1672; see VD 17 23:230226R. According to Johann Heinrich Zedler, *Grosses vollstaendiges Universallexikon aller Wissenschaften und Kuenste, welche bishero durch menschlichen Verstand und Witz erfunden und verbessert worden*. [...], 58 (Leipzig and Halle, 1748), col. 705–8, esp. 707–8, the first edition is ‘besser und correcter’ than the second.

⁷⁵ Jo. Alberti Fabricii [...] Bibliotheca Latina Mediæ et Infimæ Ætatis cum supplemento Christiani Schoettgenii jam a P. Joanne Dominico Mansi [...] post editionem Patavinam an. 1754. nunc denuo emendata et aucta, [...], 4 (Florence, 1858, repr. Graz, 1962), 328–30. See Erik Petersen, *Intellection liberare. Johann Albert Fabricius – en humanist i Europa at frigøre intellektet*, Danish Humanist Texts and Studies 18 (Copenhagen, 1998), ii, 797–811, 991–2, esp. 805 and 992: Fabricius published the fourth volume in 1735.

Chapter 11

De Oraculis Gentilium (1673) and the *Sibilla Erithea Babilonica*: Pseudo- Joachimite Prophecy in a New Intellectual Context

Anke Holdenried

Marjorie Reeves had a special interest in the reception of the writings and thought of Joachim of Fiore in the fifteenth and sixteenth centuries.¹ It seems fitting, therefore, to honour her by extending into the seventeenth century the investigation she began and to focus attention on a text she referred to in her work but which she never studied in further detail herself.

The text in question is a thirteenth-century prophecy known as *Sibilla Erithea Babilonica*.² Numerous surviving manuscripts as well as printed copies of the text testify to the interest it commanded throughout the Middle Ages and beyond, up until the seventeenth century. Considering merely the most successful of the different recensions of the *Erithea* which circulated in the medieval period (L1), we currently know of 59 manuscripts, of which the great majority were produced towards the end of the medieval period, in the fifteenth century.³ Interest in the text, however, did not cease with the advent of printing, Humanism and the Reformation. At least five printed editions of the medieval *Erithea* were published in the period c. 1500–1700.⁴ In addition, and previously this has been overlooked, there circulated

a version of the text which had been created in the first quarter of the sixteenth century by Berthold Pürstinger (1465–1543), the Catholic bishop of Chiemsee. Pürstinger substantially reworked the thirteenth-century text and included this reworked version in a work of his own, the *Onus Ecclesiae*.⁵ Subsequently, on at least two occasions, the *Onus* became the source from which this altered version of the *Erithea* was then lifted. The first to appropriate it was the Protestant reformer Johannes Wolff (1537–1600), while the second was Daniel Clasen (1623–78), a Lutheran scholar and Professor of Jurisprudence at the University of Helmstedt, who cited Pürstinger’s version of the *Sibilla Erithea Babilonica* in his work *De oraculis gentilium et in specie de vaticiniis sibyllinis libri tres ... in fine adiuncta sunt: Carmina sibyllina e versione Sebastiani Castalionis ut et Onuphrii Panvinii tractatus de sibyllis* (Helmstedt, 1673). Hitherto scholars have been unaware of the *Erithea*’s presence in Clasen’s work. It is worth looking at because it has much to tell us about the layers of meaning which could be attached to the same prophecy.

Clasen’s use of the *Erithea* has broader implications in a historiographical context. The current assumption among scholars is that changes in the meaning of a prophetic text arise from the adaptability of its predictions to fit current needs. In short, scholars work on the premise that the meaning of prophecy has a ‘contextual nature [...] tied to a set of circumstances that involve social, political, and moral dangers to the “present” that the text serves’.⁶ The first part of this chapter illustrates the validity of this premise with regard to the *Erithea*’s creation in the thirteenth century and its subsequent reception up to the confessionalization of religion in the sixteenth century. However, while analysis of prophetic texts such as the *Erithea* from a purely political perspective is not without merit, it is not a complete explanation of the text’s appeal.

Surprisingly, circumstances which do not involve sociopolitical crises, such as variations in a text’s intellectual milieu, have been written out of the picture almost completely when scholars explain the appeal of prophecy. Likewise, there has been almost no serious attempt to engage with the potential of prophetic texts to appeal to their readers on more than a social, political, or moral level, for example as literary constructs whose references to intellectual traditions (which derived from origins as diverse as those of Scripture or the classical world) often had an appeal in their own right.

Both these hitherto-neglected approaches to prophecy, however, are central to an understanding of the *Erithea*'s afterlife in the seventeenth century and to an appreciation that an interest in the learned traditions about Sibyls as antiquity's prophetesses also had a bearing on the prophecy's reception.⁷ Learned traditions about the Sibyl had first been harnessed by the *Erithea*'s author in the thirteenth century. As a narrative, the *Sibilla Erithea Babilonica* is typical of the genre of apocalyptic prophecy in that it is pseudonymous:⁸ the opening paragraphs of the text declare it to be the prophecy that the Sibyl of Erythrea had given to the Greeks after the conquest of Troy:

This book is taken from the book called Basilographia, that is the 'Imperial Writing' the Erythrean Sibyl of Babylon made at the request of the Greeks in the time of Priam the king of Troy. Doxopater, a father of extraordinary skill, translated it from Syriac into Greek, then it was taken from the treasury of Manuel, emperor of the Greeks, and translated from Greek into Latin by Eugenius, admiral of the king of Sicily.⁹

The reference to the ancient Sibyl is then repeated in the final sentence of the text: "This is the end of the Book of the Erythraean Sibyl of Babylon."¹⁰ Today this attribution might seem obscure, but in the medieval tradition in which the prophecy's author worked the figure of the Erythrean Sibyl counted among the most authoritative prophetic voices known to the Christian world.

The Sibyls were the prophetically inspired women of Greek and Roman religion. According to the most frequently cited authority, the Roman author Varro (116–27 BC), there were 10 Sibyls. Early Christians, keen to undermine pagan polytheism from within, utilized the Sibyls' prestige in the ancient world by placing prophecies concerning the First and Second Coming of Christ into their mouths. One such pious Christian fake was an acrostic poem about Judgement Day. Its popularity was such that Augustine cited it in a Latin translation in his *De civitate Dei*,¹¹ naming the Erythraean Sibyl as its author and celebrating her as a member of the City of God. This acrostic was very well known in the medieval period, as was its supposed source, the Erythraean Sibyl: Isidore of Seville (c. 570–636) said in his widely read *Etymologiae* that she was the fifth Sibyl, came from Babylon, had predicted the fall of Troy and was nobler and more celebrated than the other Sibyls.¹² Given the widespread appreciation in the medieval period of the Erythraean Sibyl's prestige and acrostic poem on Judgement Day, it is not surprising to find that the concluding part of the thirteenth-century

Sibilla Erithea Babilonica draws liberally on this acrostic to enrich its description of the signs of Judgement Day.¹³ Thus the connection of our newly minted thirteenth-century prophecy with the prophecies of the ancient Sibyls is proclaimed not only outright at the beginning and end of the text, but also permeates it in subtler form.

As we shall see below, it was the openly proclaimed connection which was later to impinge on the *Sibilla Erithea*'s reception. Daniel Clasen's interest, as that of earlier readers, was aroused in particular by the claim that the prophecy was 'taken from the book called Basilographia, that is the "Imperial Writing" the Erythraean Sibyl of Babylon made at the request of the Greeks in the time of Priam the king of Troy'.¹⁴ This will be discussed in the second part of this chapter which considers Clasen's reception of the *Erithea* within the broader context of early modern debates about the *Oraculo, Sibyllina*, a distinct corpus of prophetic material attributed to the Sibyls written between c. 150 BC and c. AD 300.

The Church in Crisis: Creation of the Erithea and Its Reception up to the Reformation

While learned traditions about the Sibyls shaped the narrative of the *Erithea*, they have had no bearing on modern scholarly classifications of the prophecy. Occasionally, scholars might loosely refer to the *Erithea* as Sibylline prophecy but they classify the text as a witness to the tradition of 'imperial apocalyptic', that is, texts which interlace a general prophecy on the End of the World with predictions about the fate of the empire.¹⁵

As we shall see, though, in the *Erithea* the fate of the empire is of concern mainly because it impinges on that of the papacy. In terms of content, the text presents a sketch of world history in three books, each with distinct themes.¹⁶ The first book begins with the history of Greece and Rome and sketches world history from the Trojan War to the Fourth Crusade as one of continuous conflict between Greeks and Latins. This book concludes with the prediction that Constantinople will eventually be restored to the Greeks. In the second book the Sibyl predicts Church History from the incarnation to the End of the World, including a sketch of the life of Christ; it also portrays the church militant in its fight against Islam, heretics, and the Antichrist. The third book concerns the kingdom of Sicily under the Hohenstaufen dynasty and focuses on Emperor Frederick II

and his wars in Italy. Finally, the concluding or properly apocalyptic section describes the combat with the Antichrist and the End of the World. Much emphasis is placed here on the signs that precede the coming of Antichrist, as well as those preceding the Last Judgement with Christ on 'his throne of terror'.¹⁷

The true creator behind this pseudonymous text remains unknown but we can speculate at least on the circles in which it originated. For a long time scholars placed the author among the Sicilian Joachites, but recently a different view has been put forward by Christian Jostmann on the basis of his study of the corpus of surviving manuscripts of the prophecy. Jostmann argues that the *Erithea* was written by a member of the papal curia to express the grave concerns of his circle about an undesirable shift in the international balance of power arising from the marriage alliance in 1241 between the Greek emperor John III Vatatzes with Constance Lucia, daughter of the vilified Hohenstaufen emperor Frederick II.¹⁸ A second enlarged edition' was brought into circulation a couple of years later in 1249. This new edition embellishes certain details of the 1241 text (such as its prediction of the Last Judgement) but does not change the prophecy's overall outlook and conception, which is to portray the conflict between Latins and Greeks, the Italian fight against the Hohenstaufen, and the struggle with the Saracens as all being aspects of a conflict which was part of the final act of salvation history and at the centre of which stood the Latin Church headed by the papacy.¹⁹

While in the context of its creation in the thirteenth century, the extent of the *Erithea*'s debt to Joachimism may still be a matter of debate, there is no doubt that, once created, the *Erithea* became closely associated with the legacy of Joachim of Fiore. For instance, in the early manuscript tradition the *Erithea* frequently travels both with Joachim's genuine works, as well as those merely attributed to him, and several of the printed editions preserve such associations.²⁰ What is more, early in the sixteenth century, in light of the interpretative scheme of Revelation developed by Joachim, the text of the *Erithea* itself was reworked by Berthold Pürstinger for inclusion in his work entitled *Onus Ecclesiae*.²¹ Pürstinger, the Catholic bishop of Chiemsee,²² was a man profoundly influenced by Joachim of Fiore's scheme for the unfolding of history, as well as a sharp critic of the church. The religious turmoil of his time, especially the Turkish threat to the church, both in East and West, and the growing significance of Luther,

moved Pürstinger to reflect on the development of the Catholic Church, past, present, and future. By 1519 he had assembled his reflections on the need for a reform of both the body and the head of the church in his *Onus Ecclesiae*, a book of 70 chapters eventually published in 1524 in Landshut. Pürstinger revised his work for a second edition in 1531,²³ in which he declared his Catholic partisanship much more strongly than in the 1524 version and also expanded his material on the Turkish threat to the church.²⁴

As Marjorie Reeves has pointed out, the *Onus Ecclesiae* structures history on the pattern of the seven ages of the church. In so doing, Pürstinger followed a leading Franciscan spiritual, Ubertino of Casale (c. 1259–c. 1330) in identifying the sixth and seventh age of the church with Joachim's third *status*.²⁵ Pürstinger placed himself at the end of the fifth age, or at the beginning of the sixth, that is, at the dawn of Joachim's final age (or *status*) of the Holy Spirit.²⁶

Besides having an interest in the teachings of Joachim, whether directly or as mediated by his later followers, Pürstinger also had a fondness for mystics and prophets, whether biblical or non-biblical.²⁷ He considered them sources of valuable information about the history of the church (both completed and yet to come) and hence quoted from them liberally throughout his book.²⁸ Among this material is our thirteenth-century prophecy, the *Erithea*, which was the basis for Chapter 65 ('Sibyllae praenotatio de septem statibus ecclesiae')²⁹ and also makes a much briefer appearance in Chapter 45 ('De ruina ecclesiae orientalis') in the form of a short quoted passage which, in the thirteenth-century text, concerned the destruction of Constantinople by the Crusaders in 1204 and its restitution to the Greeks but which Pürstinger now applied to the recent Turkish conquest of the city.³⁰

It is noteworthy that Pürstinger does not simply cite the *Erithea* verbatim in Chapter 65, but presents it in a reworked form which now incorporates his very own outline of the Joachimite seven ages of the church. Here the focus is mainly on the earlier part of the text, which charts the respective fates of Rome and Constantinople and which Pürstinger rearranged to suit his own end. For instance, in the thirteenth-century prophecy, the line 'Gallus ovis accubans modicis leonis spolio vestietur, nigrum convertetur in rubrum' ('The rooster lying on eggs of middling size will be clothed in the skin of the lion, black will be changed into red') is an encoded reference to the moment in the investiture ceremony, when the emperor places a red

cloak around the shoulders of the pope.³¹ Pürstinger adapted this line and added a commentary linking it to the second age of the church, that of the martyrs, interpreting the ‘black’ of which the text speaks as a reference to heretics and the ‘red’ as a reference to the blood of the martyrs.³²

Subsequent passages from the *Erithea* are given a similar treatment, so that by the end its strange allusions and animal images are so closely entwined with an outline of seven stages of church history as to virtually eliminate their original political meaning as specific coded references to the thirteenth-century conflict between the Hohenstaufen dynasty and the papacy.³³ Instead, the text now has a distinctly Joachimite flavour. In this new guise, Pürstinger’s version of the *Erithea* now echoes the expectation of the *Onus* as a whole, namely that now, at the transition of the church from the fifth to the sixth age, there will be a first climax of evil. In short, the *Erithea* now reflects the Joachimite understanding of history’s basic framework of ‘trials, respite, end’ laid out in the Book of Revelation.

Reform-minded Protestants also deployed the *Erithea*. In all likelihood, it was not only the text’s purported antiquity but also the recently acquired Joachimist layer which led the Protestant scholar Johannes Wolff to include it in his *Lectiones Memorabiles*, published in 1600.³⁴ This was a substantial collection of ammunition from history which could be used against the Roman Church and to support the Reformation position.³⁵ Wolff followed the text of the *Erithea* he found in Pürstinger’s *Onus Ecclesiae*, ch. 65 with that found in ch. 45, §4 and included both parts in *Centenarius Tertius* of his *Lectiones*.³⁶ This *Centenarius* is virtually given over to things Sibylline, citing patristic, medieval, and near-contemporary authors (for example Onofrio Panvinio) who discuss and use the testimony of Sibylline prophecy.³⁷ The *Erithea* is included under the heading ‘Sibylla Erythrae in suo Nozilographo, quod habetur Venetiis in Bibliotheca S. Georgii, inter alia ait.’³⁸ This placement indicates an awareness of the prophecy’s antiquity, but since Wolff included large amounts of other Joachimist material elsewhere in his *Lectiones*³⁹ we may legitimately assume that he recognized and appreciated the Joachimist philosophy of history that the *Erithea* expressed. There can be little doubt that he understood it to refer to the chastisement of the Catholic Church, a process which for him, unlike for Pürstinger, implied an eventual *renovatio* of the church under the aegis of the Protestant Reformers.⁴⁰

Clearly, then, the remarkably long literary life enjoyed by the *Sibilla Erithea Babilonica* was intimately bound up with its political message regarding the future of the church, in particular its unity (whether threatened by Saracens, Ottomans, or Lutheran heretics) and the role of the papacy. Yet, the enduring appeal of the text was not confined to this particular politicized appreciation of its content. This can be most clearly seen in the seventeenth-century afterlife of the text. Daniel Clasen's *De oraculis gentilium* of 1673 considers a specific body of material, namely the Greek *Oraculo, Sibyllina*, that is, the aforementioned collection of religious Sibylline prophecies produced by various Jewish and Christian authors between c. 150 BC and c. AD 300. This ancient Judaeo-Christian collection of prophecies sparked an international controversy about their authenticity which lasted some two hundred years until c. 1700.

The remainder of this chapter therefore considers Clasen's work within the early modern debate about the Sibyls and what this can tell us about his approach to, and interpretation of, the pseudo-Joachimite *Sibilla Erithea Babilonica*. As will be shown below, Clasen departs from the previous dominant tradition of using the *Sibilla Erithea Babilonica* as an embodiment of either political or confessional conflict. This tradition is evident, for instance, in Clasen's direct source for the *Sibilla Erithea*, Johannes Wolff's *Lectionum Memorabilium*, a printed work which was written from a confessional standpoint. This work harnessed to the cause of the Protestant Reformers the *Erithea*'s Joachimist outline (as shaped by Pürstinger) of a God-given plan involving trials and tribulation for the righteous followed by respite and the eventual triumph of the righteous at the End of the World. By contrast, Clasen's approach to the *Erithea* was determined by an antiquarian interest in Sibyllinica. As we shall see, this interest was shaped in turn by the particular preoccupations and intellectual fashions which by the 1670s had begun to impinge on the controversy about the *Oracula Sibyllina*. Yet, Clasen's apolitical and antiquarian treatment of the prophecy also shows an affinity with approaches in some medieval and humanist manuscript copies of the text. Thus the presence of the *Erithea* in the seventeenth-century *De oraculis gentilium* sharpens our perception of the various tributaries which flowed not only into the creation but also, over the centuries, into the reception and interpretation of this prophecy attributed to the Sibyls.

Three such tributaries can easily be distinguished. As the first part of this chapter has shown, the first tributary is made up of beliefs concerning the governance and future of the church and the second consists of beliefs concerning the unfolding of history ultimately derived from the exegesis of the Book of Revelation. As the following discussion will make clear, the third distinct tributary is provided by contemporary beliefs about the origins, authority, and significance of the Sibyls, the female seers of classical antiquity. Currently little is known about the impact of these beliefs about the Sibyls on the literary life of the *Sibilla Erithea*. When scholars consider these beliefs at all, it is mainly in relation to the text's creation, that is, to acknowledge that one of these ancient figures, the Sibyl of Erythraea, provides both the cloak of pseudonymity for the medieval author(s) of the text and the voice of authority for its political message.⁴¹ In the discussion below, however, medieval and early modern beliefs about, and knowledge of, the Sibyls and their prophecies will move centre stage and provide the framework within which the reception of the *Erithea* will be considered. It is fitting, therefore, to briefly outline these beliefs.

Prior to their early modern reception, the Sibyls were accepted and, indeed, profoundly appreciated because of the importance of their prophecies as independent, non-Christian evidence of the truth of Christ's incarnation. It is important to note, though, that in the medieval period prophecies supposedly uttered by these Sibyls were known merely through the mediation of patristic and some Carolingian authors who had cited them in their works (for instance Augustine, Isidore of Seville, and Hrabanus Maurus, as mentioned above), rather than from direct access to ancient collections of Sibylline prophecies.⁴²

The Romans had produced such collections, the Sibylline Books, which were kept carefully guarded in the Temple on the Capitol. According to tradition, these prophecies were written in Greek hexameters and were consulted in times of political crisis.⁴³ After a great fire destroyed the temple in the first century AD, the Sibylline Books were reconstructed from other sources and continued to be consulted. Eventually, after the establishment of Christianity as the state religion, Emperor Honorius (from 395) ordered the Sibylline Books to be destroyed. Only a few fragments of this pagan collection of oracles survive today.

What does survive, however, is a collection of prophecies written in Greek hexameters and called the *Oracula Sibyllina*. Although a few pagan

oracles are included, the prophecies in the *Oracula Sibyllina* were mostly those produced by various Jewish and Christian authors between c. 150 BC and c. AD 300.⁴⁴ Already in the second century BC, Jews had appropriated the prophecies in hexameters because they were held in such high esteem in the Hellenic world as the utterances of the Sibyl. Diaspora Judaism therefore used the Greek and Roman prophetic genre as a means to spread the tenets of the Jewish faith in the gentile community.⁴⁵

Early Christianity followed the example of Judaism and utilized the potential of the Sibylline genre to promote its religious beliefs. The popularity of the Sibyls in the Christian community was such that many early Christians regarded Sibylline prophecy as having a status akin to that of the Old Testament prophets. In his *Divinae Institutiones* Lactantius, for example, makes more references to the Sibyl than to all the Old Testament prophets combined. In the Middle Ages the close association of Sibyls and Old Testament prophets was common, too; for instance, we find it in many surviving artistic representations of the Sibyls, from the carvings on eleventh- and twelfth-century pulpits in Campagna to, later, Michelangelo's ceiling painting in the Sistine Chapel.⁴⁶ Even after the passing of Early Christian apologetic theology which had provided the original context for Christian interest in Sibylline prophecy, the theological role of the Sibyls as prophetesses of Christ continued undiminished into the period of scholasticism. The only difference was that their testimony was now adduced in the context of increasingly complex issues.⁴⁷

Essentially then, up to the end of the Middle Ages, which for convention's sake we may place around 1500, the history of the reception of the Sibyls is one of acceptance by Christian authors. Having lasted for a millennium and a half, this picture changed dramatically in a relatively short space of time. By c. 1700 a flurry of often highly critical discussions and full-blown monographs on the Sibyls and their prophecies had appeared in print.⁴⁸ In summary, within the space of about two hundred years we move from acceptance to rejection, from a tradition of positive reception to a far more hostile one, concerned no longer with keeping the Christological predictions of the Sibyls in circulation but debating instead their very authenticity.⁴⁹

Early Modern Erudition and the Antiquarian Appeal of the *Sibilla Erithea Babilonica*

The early modern debate about the authenticity of the Greek *Oracula Sibyllina* provides the literary and intellectual context for the *Sibilla Erithea* in the seventeenth century as part of Daniel Clasen's *De oraculis gentilium*. As yet there is only a slim body of research concerning this context. Scholars have rather overlooked the need for a comprehensive study of the controversy about the Sibyls and their prophecies in the period c. 1500–c. 1700 and have, on the whole, shown little interest in the figure of Daniel Clasen. It is necessary therefore, to consider both topics in some detail here.

To date, research on the controversy of the Sibyls has been largely limited to a concern with either specific figures or with distinct moments in its history. For instance, there is as yet no study which addresses the mechanics of communication, that is, if, and how, views were exchanged among this clearly international group of scholars. What is more, little has been done to comprehend the development of the debate up to the early eighteenth century in terms of the different ideas and issues that were being debated and how any changes in emphasis might be connected to the broader intellectual currents of their time.⁵⁰ For instance, Anthony Grafton concentrates on the early phase of the controversy and demonstrates the link between the demise of Sibylline prophecy and humanist textual criticism based on the rigorous application of philological techniques.⁵¹ Here one needs to recall that the Christian Sibylline tradition was indeed rooted in the *Oracula Sibyllina*, the ancient prophetic collection of Greek hexameters produced between c. 150 BC and c. AD 300. This collection had been lost during the Middle Ages and only been rediscovered by humanist scholars engaged in editing and publishing pursuits. Two humanist scholars with an editorial interest in the *Oracula Sibyllina* deserve to be singled out here in particular because their work forms the appendix to Clasen's own treatise, Sebastian Castellio (1515–63) and Onofrio Panvinio (1529–68).⁵²

The Greek source text for Sibylline prophecies thus reappeared at precisely the moment when scholars were again able and keen to read it in the original. Their linguistic skills enabled these scholars to detect anachronism in style and content. This led them to realize that supposedly Sibylline predictions about Christ, hallowed by both patristic and medieval tradition, were in fact not authentically pagan, but later, pious Jewish or Christian fakes.⁵³ In the wake of this realization, both philology and the prophecies of the Sibyls became part of the armoury of those involved in

confessional conflict, depending on whether the aim was to damage or salvage a longstanding tradition of the medieval church.

Grafton centres his discussion on two sixteenth-century figures, Joseph Scaliger and Isaac Casaubon. Therefore, while Grafton's work makes a valuable contribution to illuminating the concerns about Sibylline prophecy of sixteenth-century scholars, many questions about the controversy over the Sibyls remain to be answered. Grafton's interest lay with the history of classical scholarship and the evolution of the techniques of textual criticism, not with understanding the controversy about Sibyls as a whole.

One of the features of this controversy was, after all, its longevity, for the debate continued well into the 1700s. It is clearly variegated. Scholars could all use the same text critical methods centred on the detection of anachronisms in style and content, but still pursue different aims. It would be erroneous, therefore, to assume that the controversy about the Sibyls was merely put to the service of confessional debates and issues. Although further study is required to capture the full range of issues, it is already clear that other contemporary debates could also play a part in fashioning an author's views on the controversy about Sibyls. For instance, as we shall see below with reference to the work of Isaac Vossius (1618–89), one such scholarly debate that intersected with the debate about the *Oracula Sibyllina* is that concerning the Bible. An understanding of the variegated nature of the controversy about the Sibyls is essential for an appreciation of Clasen's *De oraculis gentilium* as a work which is situated outside particular confessional concerns with the Sibyls and their prophecies. This in turn is the essential prerequisite for appreciating that the confessionalism which determined Pürstinger's and Wolff's reading of the *Sibilla Erithea* no longer applies in Clasen's case.

Returning therefore to the controversy about the Sibyls which spanned some two hundred years, we can distinguish different phases within the controversy shaped by changes in the relationship between textual scholarship and theology. For instance, in the sixteenth century textual critics had trained their text critical skills on individual points of belief. Possibly the fullest expression of this type of engagement with the Sibyls and their prophecies can be found in the work of the French reformed theologian and professor of history at Amsterdam, David Blondel (1591–1655).⁵⁴ His aim was to discredit the Sibyls as authentic witnesses concerning purgatory, a central doctrine of the medieval church. By the late

seventeenth century, however, scholars were critically engaging with the foundation text of Christianity itself, the Bible. One individual who did this was Isaac Vossius (the son of the famous scholar Gerhard Johann Vossius). Isaac entered the University of Leiden, where he studied Classics, Hebrew, church history, and theology. In 1673 he became a canon at the Royal Chapel at Windsor in England.

Isaac Vossius spotted the potential of the Jewish-Christian *Oracula Sibyllina* which had been written in Greek in the period *c.* 150 BC and *c.* AD 300 for contemporary debates about the relative merit of the masoretic text of the Bible.⁵⁵ Since the sixteenth century doubts had increased about the factual accuracy of Scripture. Attempts to establish an accurate chronology for antiquity had brought to light that pagan sources and the Bible were incompatible. For instance, the duration of Egyptian dynasties as they could be calculated using fragments of the work of Eusebius of Caesarea, implied that the world was older than the Masora (the universally accepted text of the Hebrew Old Testament dating from between the seventh and the ninth century AD) would permit. The resulting need to harmonize different chronologies led to a fierce conflict between defenders of the truth of the masoretic text and those who advocated the superiority of the Septuagint, the Greek translation of the Old Testament begun in 250 BC in Alexandria to serve as scripture for Hellenic Jews. Scholars observed that the Hebrew text on which the Septuagint was based frequently diverged from that of the Masora and that this divergence brought benefits in the context of establishing an accurate *chronologia sacra*. For instance, while the Masora dates the Flood to the year 1656 after Creation, the Septuagint dates it to the year 2242, which allowed for greater room in which to accommodate the Egyptian dynasties.⁵⁶ Isaac Vossius was one of the scholars who favoured the Septuagint and caused a Europe-wide stir when he voiced his opinion in a work entitled *De vera aetate mundi* in 1659. The reason for the disquiet caused by this work was that it touched on an issue that was far more fundamental than that of chronology. In favouring the Septuagint, Vossius placed a question mark over the validity of the principle of 'hebraica Veritas', that is, over the belief sacred in the orthodox Protestant camp, that the masoretic text of the Old Testament was a direct record of divine revelation and hence beyond critical scrutiny. Against this, Vossius argued that the Septuagint provided the better record of the

authentic word of God, because it derived from Hebrew texts that were older than those of the Masora.⁵⁷

Non-scriptural evidence which further supported the superiority of the Septuagint was naturally most welcome. Vossius recognized that the Greek *Oracula Sibyllina* could serve precisely this purpose. For instance, Book III of the *Oracula* originated almost entirely among authors from the Jewish Hellenic diaspora, that is, in circles in which at least the early parts of the Septuagint can be located. Consequently Vossius coupled his defence of the Septuagint with a study of the *Oracula Sibyllina*. Previously, the Sibyls and their oracles had been debated with a view to determining the extent to which they were pious Christian fakes or, worse, deceptions by Satan.⁵⁸ When Vossius therefore chose to focus on the Jewish origins of the *Oracula* he introduced a new dimension into the controversy about them.⁵⁹

His views on the matter are expressed in his *De sibyllinis aliisque quae Christi natalem praecesserunt oraculis*.⁶⁰ Technically, this appeared several years after Clasen's *De oraculis gentilium*. However, discussions concerning the Greek and Jewish milieu of Scripture (which eventually led to considering Sibylline prophecy in relation to biblical criticism) were already well under way in 1673, when Clasen's own work on the Sibylline oracles appeared. In other words, now, more than ever, the scholarly treatises about the Sibyls were about the study of the language and culture of the pre-Christian past encoded in the Greek *Oracula Sibyllina*, rather than a mask for confessional debates about the authenticity of certain beliefs of the Catholic Church, as had been very much the case a century earlier when David Blondel published his work in 1549.⁶¹

Indeed, it is clear that Daniel Clasen himself had an interest in biblical scholarship with its attendant disciplines of Hebraic Studies and, more broadly, Oriental Studies (which contemporaries understood as the study of the languages and cultures of the biblical Near East) feeding into the burgeoning discipline of comparative religion.⁶² With this observation it becomes necessary to consider Daniel Clasen and his intellectual profile, as well as the place of his *De oraculis gentilium* in the controversy about the Sibyls.⁶³

Clasen's work on the Sibyls was published in Helmstedt, Germany in 1673. Helmstedt at the time was famous for its Lutheran University founded in 1576.⁶⁴ Today Helmstedt is probably best known as the home of the theologian Georg Calixt (1586–1656), a man of tolerant spirit whose

ecumenically inclined theology was more concerned with bridging the ever-widening gulf between the Catholic and Protestant Churches than with the defence of orthodox Lutheranism.⁶⁵ Daniel Clasen himself was a product of the University of Helmstedt where he studied philosophy and jurisprudence between 1640 and 1646 (when Calixt himself was Prorector). After graduation and a spell of teaching at various grammar schools and aristocratic academies, he was called to his *alma mater* to take the Chair in Jurisprudence and practical philosophy' (ethics and politics) in 1669, a position he held until 1678. Clasen left the university to take up the post of Syndicus in the town of Magdeburg, but died not long after, in November 1678.⁶⁶

As Clasen's list of publication makes clear, he was, in keeping with his times, a polymath, publishing on subjects outside the law, especially on subjects concerning classical antiquity and ancient religion. For instance, as early as 1649 he published a commentary on Plutarch which his eighteenth-century biography considered an immature work.⁶⁷ By the end of his life, however, Clasen had acquired a measure of expertise that could command the respect of other experts in his field. For instance, with regard to Clasen's *Theologia Gentilis*, published posthumously in Frankfurt in 1684, the literary historian Jacob Friedrich Reimann credits Clasen with an above-average command of the relevant literature as well as with the knowledge of many languages.⁶⁸ Indeed, Clasen cites Latin, Greek, and Hebrew material in his *Theologia Gentilis*, a work which seeks to prove that the religion of the pagans (that is, their gods and sacrifices) was derived from Scripture. A further mark of Clasen's achievement is the fact that Jacob Gronovius (1645–1716) of the University of Leiden included the *Theologia Gentilis* in his *Thesaurus Graecorum Antiquitatum* (1735). The depth of Clasen's involvement in the study of antiquities, oriental studies, and comparative religion is evident not only from his publications, but also in his private library of 1803 volumes.⁶⁹ At least 21 titles concerning these fields can be counted.⁷⁰

Clasen's work *De oraculis gentilium* is clearly very much in line with his scholarly interests, especially in the field of comparative religion. This discipline included engagement with pagan cults and such cults often involved the consultation of oracles.⁷¹ From this perspective it was natural, therefore, for Clasen to turn his attention onto the Sibyls, who were known to have formed a part of such pagan cults.

Closer examination of Clasen's work on the Sibyls reveals he was mostly unoriginal on the subject.⁷² His work offers the conventional mix of discussion of ancient textual traditions, patristic as well as medieval authorities and theological issues which one would encounter in many other works on the Sibyls which preceded his own. This is illustrated, for example, by a juxtaposition of the *Index Caputum* for the third and final book of Clasen's *De oraculis gentilium* (the book which, in [Chapter 8](#), includes the *Sibilla Erithea Babilonica*) with a brief outline of David Blondel's work on the Sibyls. Its overall aim and the methods it deploys are clearly indicated in the English translation of Blondel's work by John Davis (1625–93) published in London in 1661. On the title page we read:

A TREATISE OF THE SIBYL So Highly Celebrated, As well as by the Ancient Heathens as the Holy Fathers of the CHURCH; GIVING An *Accompt* of the *Names*, and *Number* of the SIBYLS, of their *Quality*, the *Form* and *Matter* of their *Verses*; As also of the *BOOKS* now Extant under their Names, and the *Errours* crept into *Christian Religion*, from the *Impostures* contained therein, Particularly concerning the *Just* and *Unjust* after Death.⁷³

If we now turn to the chapter index (*Index Caputum*) for the third book of Clasen's *De oraculis gentilium*, we note that [Chapters 1](#) and [2](#) are dedicated to a discussion of the names and the number of Sibyls. This is then followed by individual chapters on each of the 12 Sibyls and their verses vouchsafed by tradition (cap. III – cap. XIII). The final chapter of Clasen's (cap. XX) third book considers the Sibyls in relation to issues concerning the Last Judgement.⁷⁴ This shows that Clasen, in common with his predecessor in the field, David Blondel, proceeds by systematic engagement with the catalogue of the known Sibyls, which is then harnessed to the issue of the Last Judgement in the Christian tradition. It is highly unlikely that Clasen came to his approach independently, given that a copy of Blondel's treatise on the Sibyls is listed in the auction catalogue of Clasen's private library.⁷⁵

Clasen's work on the Sibyls only stands out from the early modern controversy in that he clearly sought to make the ancient, patristic, and medieval tradition concerning the Sibyls accessible. This can be seen in the work's extensive indices: there is an index of all ancient, medieval, and contemporary authors referred to in this work and a separate and substantial subject index. None of the previous works on the Sibyls are so accessible and 'user friendly'. Ease of reference is further facilitated by the fact that Clasen's work includes the text of the *Oracula Sibyllina* as edited authoritatively by Sebastian Castellio in 1555.

The structure and scholarly apparatus of Clasen's work thus suggest that his overarching aim was to present a scholar's digest of the debate about the Sibyl, rather than to contribute novel insights about the authenticity of the Sibylline Oracles or about the authority of certain Christian beliefs traditionally supported by Sibylline prophecy. Rather, he wished to rehearse the whole tradition of authorities from pagan writers and the Church Fathers to medieval authors who had written to support or reject the credibility of the Sibyls and their prophecies. If one were to credit Clasen with any originality in terms of his approach to the Sibyls at all, it would be by reference to the sheer richness of the material he considers, which includes, besides the ancient *Oracula Sibyllina*, also two other Sibylline prophecies which today we know were medieval creations, namely the *Sibilla Erithea Babilonica* and a prophecy known as the *Sibylla Tiburtina*. Each of these medieval creations is included in the diverse material gathered together for each of their respective Sibyls, that is, the medieval *Tiburtina* can be found in Book 3, Chapter 12 (cap. XII): 'De Sibylla Tiburtina' and the *Sibilla Erithea Babilonica* concludes Book 3, Chapter 8 (cap. IIX): 'De Sibylla Erythraea'. Here the comments which Clasen adds to the *Sibilla Erithea Babilonica* are sparse, but they indicate at least that, among the reasons for incorporating it into his *De oraculis gentilium*, was the desire to present everything connected with the Sibyl of Erythraea,⁷⁶ including this particular text (claiming to be derived from the Greek imperial writings), which could be found, so Clasen tells us, both in the *Onus Ecclesiae* of Berthold Pürstinger and the *Lectiones Memorabiles* of Johannes Wolff.⁷⁷

This, then, provides the literary and intellectual context for the *Sibilla Erithea* in the seventeenth century as part of Daniel Clasen's *De oraculis gentilium*. By this point in time the content of the thirteenth-century prophecy had been transformed, if we recall, by Berthold Pürstinger into a prophecy with a Joachimite flavour about the ages of the church and been understood as such by the Protestant reformer Johannes Wolff.

Pürstinger's and Wolff's work were embodiments of confessional conflict. By contrast, Clasen's was a work of scholarship and intended as a contribution within the fields of comparative religion and the study of antiquities. It is within this context therefore that Clasen's approach to the *Erithea* is to be located. Like its thirteenth-century antecedent, the sixteenth-century version of the *Sibilla Erithea* known to Clasen still purports to be the prophecy of the ancient Erythrean Sibyl. No doubt Clasen

was aware of the high standing of this particular Sibyl in the ancient tradition from his own study of the ancient, patristic, and medieval authorities on the Sibyls. Given, too, that the attribution in the sixteenth-century *Erithea* also states that the prophecy was taken from the *Basilographia*,⁷⁸ Clasen might have believed the text to be of genuinely ancient Greek origins and that earlier works on the ancient *Oracula Sibyllina* had simply overlooked it. The lines proclaiming the prophecy's origins thus appear to have become the most salient feature of the text, enticing Clasen to discuss it in his own tract on the *Oracula Sibyllina*.

This supposition is given further weight if we consider Clasen's treatment of a text that is in many ways very similar to the *Erithea*, namely the aforementioned prophecy of the Tiburtine Sibyl, or *Sibylla Tiburtina*. Like the *Erithea*, the *Tiburtina* purports to be the record of an ancient prediction made by one of the Sibyls (the *Tiburtina*): the antiquity of the Sibyl is emphasized, for instance, in the prologue which provides historico-biographical data on the Sibyl, for example that she was descended from the noble lineage of Alexander the Great (with King Priam of Troy being her father and Hecuba her mother) and that, while she was called Tiburtina in Greek, in Latin she was called Albunea or Cassandra.

The emphasis on the Sibyl's link with antiquity is evident also in the remainder of the prophecy's text, which makes much of the veneration of the Romans for her. In terms of prophetic content, however, the *Tiburtina*'s predictions go beyond the Roman world. Rather, it presents a sketch of world history which will be played out over nine generations and includes substantial predictions concerning the exploits of German kings and emperors prior to the coming of Antichrist.⁷⁹ Like the *Erithea*, therefore, the *Tiburtina* constitutes a piece of imperial apocalyptic, that is, it interlaces a general prophecy concerning the End of the World with predictions about the fate of the empire. Finally, the *Tiburtina* resembles the *Erithea* in that its description of Judgement Day draws liberally on the acrostic poem cited in Augustine's *De civitate Dei*.⁸⁰

The similarities between the two prophecies make it legitimate to consider Clasen's treatment of the *Tiburtina* for the purpose of further illuminating his approach to the *Erithea*, an approach which, as has been argued here, is characterized by an interest in the Sibyl's ancient context and indifference to the text's actual predictions and their political or confessional application.

While Clasen's comments on the *Erithea* are very sparse, those accompanying the *Tiburtina* are much more extensive and hence more revealing of his approach. Clasen had found the text in the *Pantheon* of the twelfth-century chronicler Godfrey of Viterbo and cites it in Chapter XII. This chapter is devoted to the Tiburtine Sibyl and begins with a discussion of her historico-biographical data as they can be found in ancient sources, such as the works of Varro, Lactantius, or Solinus.⁸¹ Even Virgil's *Aeneid* is brought into the discussion.⁸² Consideration of this source is then followed by discussion of the *Tiburtina's* historico-biographical data as they are presented in Godfrey of Viterbo's text of the *Tiburtina*, whose prologue Clasen cites.⁸³ This is then followed by a seven-point critical commentary which considers issues raised by the *Tiburtina's* prologue. The question that most occupied Clasen here was whether the *Tiburtina's* strong association with Italy (in particular with Tivoli) was compatible with the claims made by Godfrey of Viterbo's text as to the *Tiburtina's* Greek origins and her identity with Cassandra, daughter of King Priam of Troy in Greek legend.⁸⁴

Having considered the merits of the claims made by Godfrey of Viterbo's text, Clasen then explores the information on the Sibyls found in the *Ara coeli* legend,⁸⁵ before returning to the text of the *Tiburtina* itself. Clasen now considers it as part of his discussion of the cultic significance of the Sibyl in Roman life. He cites a lengthy extract from the text of the *Tiburtina* which begins with the report of the legatine mission to bring the Sibyl to Rome to interpret a prophetic dream dreamed simultaneously one night by one hundred Roman senators; the extract selected by Clasen ends with the Sibyl's first brief overview of the meaning of this dream.⁸⁶ What concerns Clasen here are the passage's clues about the cultic setting of the Sibyls, whose activities contemporary scholarship variously associated with Jove's temple on the Capitol (where the Sibylline Books were kept) or with a temple dedicated specifically to the Tiburtine Sibyl in Tivoli.⁸⁷ After this, Clasen cites no further material from the prophecy of the Tiburtine Sibyl, that is, he shows no interest in the predictions concerning the role of kings and emperors of Germany in the events leading up to the last days.⁸⁸ Instead, for the remainder of Chapter XII Clasen considers the Christological content of a number of Greek verses associated with the Sibyl. Clearly, then, the prophecy of the Tiburtine Sibyl was of interest to Clasen because its text could be mined for information on the Sibyl's place

in Roman religious life, as well as for further information on the roots of the Sibyls in Greek culture.

Considering this, as well as the broader intellectual context of the *De oraculis gentilium* as outlined above, it is unlikely that it was the *Erithea*'s prediction about the future of the church along Joachimite lines which resonated with Clasen and prompted him to include the *Erithea*. Rather, it was of interest to him because it claimed to be by a pagan Sibyl, and what is more, it claimed to have roots in Greek imperial writings (the *Basilograpbo*).⁸⁹ Its actual prophetic content was at best a secondary concern. Clasen adopted an antiquarian reading of the *Erithea*.

The term 'antiquarian' requires some further clarification, however, because it cannot automatically be assumed that antiquarians are indifferent to the present state of religion and the church. Indeed, it is well known that, after the Reformation, antiquarianism often championed the legal, political, or religious causes of the age. However, in this discussion the term 'antiquarian' merely denotes a specific type of erudition devoid of any partisanship for a particular cause, that is, as a counterpoint to the term 'confessional' which is used to imply a concern with the present state of the church. In particular, for current purposes, the antiquarian characteristics are: an interest in the traditions of the distant past (especially of classical antiquity) rather than in the events of (very) recent history; the desire to collect all the material connected with a certain subject, whether it helps to solve a problem or not; and a concern with producing systematic handbooks which both preserve and make ancient records accessible.⁹⁰

All these characteristics can be observed in Clasen's treatment of the *Sibilla Erithea Babilonica*. The systematic handbook character of his *De oraculis gentilium* has already been commented on. As we have further observed, the very inclusion of the *Sibilla Erithea Babilonica* in the *Oraculis gentilium* departs from previous early modern treatises, which were restricted to Sibylline prophecies as they survived either in the ancient *Oracula Sibyllina* or in references in ancient pagan and Early Christian authors' sources. Clasen, however, clearly regarded its purported origins among the Greek imperial writings as sufficient to merit inclusion. This outweighed any concerns he might have about the text's overt Joachimite content and sixteenth-century confessional context. In short, Clasen displays a profound antiquarian desire to collect all material connected with

a certain subject, as well as an interest in the traditions of the distant past rather than in the events of recent history.⁹¹

On one level, such an antiquarian approach is in keeping with its times. Scholars consider the seventeenth century a period of profound transformation in European intellectual life, which saw the beginnings of the abandonment of the belief in history's divine purpose and, consequently, the abandonment of prophecy.⁹² On another level, however, Clasen's antiquarian approach constitutes a reminder of a hitherto-neglected reader response to the *Sibilla Erithea Babilonica* in the medieval period. While the prophecy's role as a vehicle to express contemporary concerns about the church is well understood, its appeal simply as Sibylline prophecy (that is, as a prediction uttered by a figure from the ancient past) has yet to be the subject of more detailed discussion. It is appropriate, therefore, to highlight affinities between the seventeenth-century approach and medieval approaches to the *Erithea* as they can be gleaned from the textual material with which the prophecy travels in extant manuscripts.

To recapitulate, key to the seventeenth-century approach was a particular type of erudition shaped by an interest in the traditions of the distant past (especially of classical antiquity) rather than interest in the events of recent history, and by the desire to collect all the items that are connected with a certain subject. Both this interest and this desire existed in the Middle Ages with regard to Sibylline prophecy, including the *Sibilla Erithea*. This is not to claim that medieval and early modern antiquarian erudition were directed towards the same goals. Pious regard for the Christological content of the prophecies of the Sibyl was undoubtedly far greater in the medieval period and ultimately legitimized the more profane fascination with the Sibyls as figures from a distant, pagan age and with the details of their lives. Yet, even if there was potentially a qualitative difference in terms of ultimate motivation, educated men of the medieval period, too, attempted to gather together all the items of information accessible to them that were connected with the subject of the Sibyls.⁹³

The work of two encyclopedists of the early Middle Ages, Isidore of Seville and Hrabanus Maurus, embodies this preoccupation with the Sibyl as figure from the past. Both encyclopedias cover a diverse range of subjects (from grammar, rhetoric, architecture, medicine, war, and precious metals to the affairs of the church) and are the result of systematic collection and presentation of information on a given subject from a variety

of authorities. Both works include entries on the Sibyls: Isidore's focused on the geographic and cultural origin of the 10 Sibyls derived from Lactantius' *Divinae Institutiones* 1, 6.⁹⁴ Hrabanus Maurus' *De Universo* quotes the entry on the 10 Sibyls in Isidore's *Etymologiae* verbatim, adding to it the acrostic from Augustine's *De civitate Dei*, 18, 23, the commentary on its translation from Greek into Latin provided by Augustine, and the prophecy *In manus inquit* ascribed by Augustine to an unnamed Sibyl.⁹⁵

I have shown elsewhere that encyclopedic approaches to Sibyls and their prophecies continued after Hrabanus Maurus.⁹⁶ There are numerous medieval manuscripts, such as, for example, Klosterneuburg Stiftsbibliothek, MS 320 (s. XIV), which show that the information on Sibyls supplied by Isidore and Augustine was put together by individual scribes. This manuscript contains a *Tractatus de sibyllis* (fol. 116vb, inc.: 'Sibille dicuntur omnes femine sacre') which begins with the catalogue of the 10 Sibyls from the *Etymologiae*, copied in full. To this the scribe added the rubric 'Augustinus de civitate dei', followed by *De Civitate Dei*, 18, 22 (fol. 117ra, inc. 'Tempore igitur quo Roma condita est'). He thus did not amend the entry from the *Etymologiae* with *De Civitate Dei*, 18, 23 (which deals with the Erythraean Sibyl), but with the chapter preceding it (which provides the chronological context for the Erythraea). This means that the *Tractatus* is not derived from *De Universo* by Hrabanus Maurus, but is an independent composition.

This *Tractatus de Sibyllis* is typical of medieval encyclopedic Sibylline resumes, which consist of compilations of excerpts from the best-known authorities on the Sibyls and their prophecies. When I discussed the *Tractatus* previously I pointed out that it was rooted in a reference mentality characteristic of medieval attitudes to knowledge, which was valid only when firmly grounded in tradition. I was able to show that it was applied consistently throughout the Middle Ages to the Sibyls and their prophecies, including the *Sibylla Tiburtina*, a well-known Sibylline prophecy which, as we have seen above, is comparable to the *Sibilla Erithea Babilonica* in several respects. Ultimately, this reference mentality even stirred readers of the *Tiburtina* away from a political reading towards a non-political, Christological interpretation in the context of personal eschatology.⁹⁷ Broadly speaking, then, the presence of Sibylline resumes is indicative of two things: an interest in the Sibyl as representative of the prophetic traditions of classical antiquity and the desire to collect information

connected with this subject – in short, an antiquarian interest – and a pious appreciation of the Christological content of the Sibyls predictions.

An interest in Sibyls can be observed, however, not only in surviving manuscripts of the *Sibylla Tiburtina* but also in those of the *Sibilla Erithea Babilonica*. The existing cursory survey of the associated content in extant *Erithea* manuscripts reveals that 18 of the 59 manuscripts of the *Erithea*'s most widely disseminated version, L1, contain 'Sibyllinica', that is, other material concerning the person of the Sibyl(s) and/or her predictions.⁹⁸ Of these 18 manuscripts, 11 have been classed as 'humanist' either on account of their script or because their provenance connects them closely with known humanists.⁹⁹ This group of humanist manuscripts deserves our particular attention because they originate from a milieu that is associated with an increased ability to appreciate the classical past as a distinct phenomenon rather than merely as an element in a continuum of Christian history. It is therefore among the humanist manuscripts that we may expect a search for an antiquarian appreciation of the *Erithea* to be most fruitful.

Turning therefore to the 11 humanist manuscripts which contain Sibyllinica, we find that often they take a form which mirrors the medieval encyclopedic Sibylline resumes discussed above.¹⁰⁰ As we have seen, though, the antiquarian significance of these resumes is balanced by a pious regard for the Christological content of Sibylline prophecy. Consequently, much more detailed study than can be provided here is required to ascertain with greater certainty where the balance lay in any given manuscript. We may, however, consider at least one example in further detail to show that an antiquarian approach to the *Erithea* existed, even if it might ultimately be impossible to delineate it sharply from a pious interest in the prophecy's Christological passages.

A manuscript which provides such an example is that written by the Veronese humanist and antiquarian Felice Feliciano (1432/33–80).¹⁰¹ He copied a text of the *Erithea* whose inherent antiquarian appeal by virtue of its claim that it was derived from the *Basilographia* had already been enhanced further by an addition of verses from the *Metamorphoses* by the celebrated ancient poet Ovid.¹⁰² A text such as this could easily appeal to an individual intent on appropriating antiquity in its own right.

Yet, the fact remains that the medieval *Erithea* also predicts the Last Judgement in some detail and this is the theme which the added verses from Ovid's *Metamorphoses* pick up on, for they concern the 'Weltenbrand'.

Thus the ancient verses enhance simultaneously both the antiquarian and the religious meaning of the prospect of a Final Judgement of the text. It is thus difficult to determine to what extent Feliciano's attraction to the text was purely antiquarian. Closer study, for example of Feliciano's glosses, might well yield an answer. In the meantime, however, we may note that immediately after the text of the *Erithea's* prologue in Feliciano's manuscript, there is a fifteenth-century drawing which depicts the Sibyl standing in a cave and handing a book to a Greek. There is some debate over whether this drawing is by Feliciano himself, but whoever was responsible for it clearly appreciated that the prophecy's prologue claims it was taken 'from the book called Basilographia, that is the "Imperial Writing" the Erythraean Sibyl of Babylon made at the request of the Greeks in the time of Priam the king of Troy'.

An appreciation of precisely this aspect of the *Erithea* can be observed in Daniel Clasen's approach to the text in the seventeenth century, when he took an interest in the *Erithea's* supposed origins among the ancient Greek *Basilographia*. Looked at merely from the perspective of early modern approaches to the *Erithea* (which, in the sixteenth century, still related the prophecy to the political and religious conflict of the time), Clasen's antiquarian appreciation of the supposed antiquity of the *Erithea* looks like a new reader response which breaks with tradition. However, once we broaden our perspective to encompass the text's entire literary life from the thirteenth century onwards, it becomes clear that such antiquarian approaches can be traced back as far as the fifteenth century. For some readers in the period *c.* 1500–*c.* 1700 at least an antiquarian reading replaced a concern with the text's prognostication about future tribulations of the church. Non-political traditions, therefore, clearly had a powerful appeal, too. So far they have been absent from the historical record not because they did not exist, but because of modern scholarly preferences for reading the dissemination of prophetic texts as reflections of crisis in contemporary society.

Notes

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See Marjorie Reeves, 'Studies in the Reputation and Influence of the Abbot Joachim of Fiore, Chiefly in the Fifteenth and Sixteenth Centuries', Ph.D. diss. (University of London, 1932). The research behind this doctoral dissertation fed into her seminal study of Joachimism, *The Influence of Prophecy in the Later Middle Ages* (Oxford, 1969, repr. Notre Dame, 1993).

² The standard edition of the *Erithea* (version L1) is still Oswald Holder-Egger, 'Italienische Prophetieen des 13. Jahrhunderts I', *Neues Archiv*, 15 (1890) [henceforth HE 1], 141–78. Marjorie Reeves refers to the *Erithea* (or *Vaticinium Sibillae Erithreae*) in her *Influence of Prophecy* on pages 56–7, 81, 91, 93, 146–7, 181, 185, 307–8, 326, 348, and 520. For further English-language discussions of the *Erithea*, see Paul J. Alexander, 'The Diffusion of Byzantine Apocalypses in the Medieval West and the Beginnings of Joachimism', in *Prophecy and Millenarianism. Essays in Honour of Marjorie Reeves*, ed. Ann Williams (Harlow, 1980), 53–106 and Bernard McGinn, *Visions of the End. Apocalyptic Traditions in the Middle Ages* (New York, 1979), 122–5. The most recent, as well as the most comprehensive study of the *Erithea* to date is Christian Jostmann, *Sibilla Erithea Babilonica. Papsttum und Prophetie im 13. Jahrhundert*, Monumenta Germaniae Historica: Schriften 54 (Hannover, 2006) [henceforth SBE], which also provides editions of versions L2, K1, and K2, see 498–527.

³ Of the later medieval manuscripts preserving L1, 34 date from the fifteenth century. Two date from the thirteenth (or perhaps the early fourteenth) century; 11 manuscripts certainly survive from the fourteenth century; see SBE, 42.

⁴ See SBE, 489–93.

⁵ See Heinrich Werner, *Die Flugschrift 'Onus Ecclesiae' (1519)* (Giessen, 1901) and Josef Schmuck, *Die Prophetie 'Onus Ecclesiae' des Bischofs Berthold Pürstinger. Religiöse Kritik der Zustände in Kirche und Welt aus den ersten Jahren der Reformationszeit* (Vienna, 1973).

⁶ See 'Introduction: Prophecy as Political Discourse', in *Prophetic Margins: The Medieval Vatican Impulse and Social Stability*, ed. E.L. Ridsen, Karen Moranski, and Stephen Yandel (New York, 2004), 2. The claim made by the editors of this volume that their commitment to documenting the role of prophetic poetry in sociopolitical controversy enriches scholarship which 'has tended to neglect the idea of prophecy as political tool' (p. 1) is puzzling given that the 'political prophecy' view constitutes the prevailing paradigm within which prophecy has been studied for the past half-century at least and is evident, for example, in all the secondary works on prophecy referenced in this chapter.

⁷ For a comprehensive overview of the works which make up this learned tradition, see Karl Prümm, 'Das Prophetenamt der Sibyllen in kirchlicher Literatur mit besonderer Rücksicht auf die Deutung der 4. Ekloge Virgils. I. Theologische Gesichtspunkte. Patristische Grundlagen; II. Vom frühen Mittelalter bis zum Beginn der Echtheitskontroverse; III. Die Echtheitskontroverse und ihre Nachwirkung', *Scholastik*, 4 (1929), 54–77; 221–46; 498–533.

⁸ It is further typical in that it is rich in obscure allusions intended to enhance the credibility of the predictions: it uses animal names (the goat, the lion, the bull, the lamb, the eagle, the rooster) to encode the Sibyl's predictions. For a basic taxonomy of prophecy, see, e.g., Robert E. Lerner, *The Powers of Prophecy: The Cedar of Lebanon Vision from the Mongol Onslaught to the Dawn of Enlightenment* (Berkeley, Calif, 1983), 186; id., 'Medieval Prophecy and Religious Dissent', *Past and Present*, 72 (1976), 3–24, at 8.

⁹ English translation from B. McGinn, *Visions of the End*, 123–4. For the Latin text, see HE 1, 155: *Hic liber est extractus ... de Greco transtulit in Latinum*.

¹⁰ See McGinn, *Visions*, 125 and HE 1, 173.

¹¹ Augustine, *De civitate Dei*, lib. xviii, cap. 23, CCSL 48, 613–14.

¹² Isidore, *Etymologiae*, lib. viii, cap. 8, ed. Wallace Martin Lindsay, 2 vols (Oxford, 1911), i, n.p., PL 82, col. 309C–310A. The information provided by Augustine and Isidore was repeated in a

further well-known medieval encyclopaedia, *De universo*, by Hrabanus Maurus (780–856). For further literature on the Sibyls (ancient and medieval), see below, nn. 41–6.

¹³ For a detailed analysis of the *Erithea*'s borrowing from the acrostic, see *SBE*, 147, n.451.

¹⁴ On the kind of material the *Erithea*'s author might have had in mind when he used the term 'Basilographia', see *SBE*, 228–35. On what the reference to the Basilographia and the claim to the prophecy's translation from Greek into Latin by Eugenius can tell us about the stages of the *Erithea*'s composition, see *SBE*, 236–46.

¹⁵ See McGinn, *Visions*, 122–3.

¹⁶ See *SBE*, 338–40. The *Erithea* is extant in two versions. The longer version (L) dating from 1249 blurs the clear distinction between the three books. It was edited by Oswald Holder-Egger (HE 1, cited above) and has been partly translated in McGinn, *Visions*, 123–5.

¹⁷ See McGinn, *Visions*, 125 and HE 1, 173.

¹⁸ See *SBE*, esp. 297. See also Christian Jostmann, 'Die Sibilla Erithrea. Eine historiographische Skizze', *Florensia*, 15 (2001), 109–41.

¹⁹ Jostmann postulates the *legatio* to John III Vatatzes led by the Franciscan General John of Parma at the behest of Pope Innocent IV as the occasion which prompted the creation of this longer version (which is the version discussed here), see *SBE*, 337–43. It must be noted that Jostmann's view overturns Holder-Egger's view that the longer version represents the first, original' text.

²⁰ See *SBE*, 490 (printed editions nos. 2. and 2a.). On the manuscript transmission and Joachimite material, see *SBE* 64 and 378–431.

²¹ On the appeal of Joachim's scheme in the sixteenth century more generally, see Bernard McGinn, 'Reading Revelation: Joachim of Fiore and the Varieties of Apocalypse Exegesis in the Sixteenth Century,' in *Storia e figure dell'Apocalisse fra '500 e '600. Atti del 4° Congresso internazionale di studi gioachimiti, San Giovanni in Fiore, 14–17 settembre 1994*, ed. Roberto Rusconi, *Opere di Gioacchino da Fiore: testi e strumenti* 7 (Rome, 1996), 11–35.

²² For biographical information on Pürstinger, see *Deutscher Biographischer Index. 3. kumulierte und erweiterte Ausgabe*, ed. Victor Herrero Mediavilla (Munich, 2004). This index assembles references to the biographical material in the *Deutsches Biographisches Archiv* (henceforth *DBA I*), *Deutsches Biographisches Archiv. Neue Folge bis zur Mitte des 20. Jahrhunderts* (henceforth *DBA II*), and *Deutsches Biographisches Archiv 1960–1999* (henceforth *DBA III*) (Microfiche edition 1982). Material on Pürstinger can be found in *DBA III*, microfiche no. 720, microfiche fields 372–6.

²³ *Onus ecclesiae temporibus hisce deplorandis Apocalypseos suis aequae conveniens, Turcarum incursui iam grassanti accomodatum*, etc. (Augsburg, 1531); the work was printed the same year in Cologne. The edition used here is 'Köln, 1531', as represented by the digitised copy available at the *Johannes a Lasco Bibliothek* (Emden), see http://hardenberg.jalb.de/display_dokument.php?elementId=12972.

²⁴ Schmuck, *Prophetie 'Onus Ecclesiae'*, 1–8.

²⁵ On Pürstinger's debt to Ubertino, see Werner, *Flugschrift*, 54–7 and Schmuck, *Prophetie 'Onus Ecclesiae'*, 10. On Pürstinger's periodization of history, see Schmuck, *Prophetie 'Onus Ecclesiae'*, 186–200.

²⁶ Reeves, *Joachim of Fiore*, 125; On Pürstinger, see also Reeves, *Influence*, 362, 368, 390 and esp. 467–8.

²⁷ Among the works used are the *Revelationes* of Birgitta of Sweden, the *Liber divinae doctrinae* of Catherine of Siena, the *Liber divinorum operum* of Hildegard of Bingen, *De fine mundi* of Vincent Ferrer, and the *Revelationes* of Pseudo-Mediodius; see Werner, *Flugschrift*, 53–6.²⁸ Schmuck, *Prophetie 'Onus Ecclesiae'*, 9–10 and 181–5.

²⁹ The text in Chapter 65 ends ‘... sancti Georgii maioris Venetiarum’, see Appendix III, Section II, a: C 61.

³⁰ Cf. HE 1, 164–5: *Ascendent in conspectu altissimi Biancie scelera ... polices semique pertranseant* and *Onus Ecclesiae*, c. 45, par. 4, as cited in Appendix III, Section II, b). See also *SBE*, 208–13 and Werner, *Flugschrift*, 57–8.

³¹ See *SBE*, 157 and 164–6

³² See Appendix III, Section II, a: C 8, C 9 and C 10.

³³ See Appendix III, Section II, a. It must be noted that virtually none of Pürstinger’s insertions and comments are derived from the glosses which accompany the *Erithea* in manuscript copies but are expressions of his own ideas and concerns when reading the text.

³⁴ *J. Wolffii Lectionum memorabilium et reconditarum centarii XVI*. 2. torn. (Lauingen, 1600). On Wolff’s life and work, see Zedler’s *Universal-Lexicon* (Halle and Leipzig, 1732–50) vol. 48, cl. 705–8 and *DBA III*, microfiche no. 1006, microfiche fields 277–90. A useful short biographical sketch of Wolff is included in Sabine Schmolinsky, ‘Im Angesicht der Endzeit? Positionen in den *Lectiones memorabiles* des Johannes Wolff (1600)’, in *Endzeiten. Eschatologie in den monotheistischen Weltreligionen*, Millennium-Studien, 16, ed. Wolfram Brandes and Felicitas Schmieder (Berlin, 2008), 368–417, see also her contribution in this volume 231–52.

³⁵ See Reeves, *Influence*, 487–8. The manner in which Wolff’s technique of compiling and presenting material from a vast array of sources expresses his view of history and in particular that of the corruption the church past, future, and present has been analysed by Sabine Schmolinsky, ‘Prophetia in der Bibliothek – die *Lectiones memorabiles* des Johannes Wolff’, in *Zukunfts voraussagen in der Renaissance*, ed. Klaus Bergdolt and Walther Ludwig, Wolfenbüttler Abhandlungen zur Renaissanceforschung, 23 (Wiesbaden, 2005), 89–130 and Schmolinsky, ‘Im Angesicht der Endzeit’. The prophecies which Schmolinsky singles out for discussion include the Pope Prophecies (*Vaticinia abbatis Joachim de summis pontificibus*) and the *Revelationes* of Pseudo-Methodius, but not the *Sibilla Erithea*.

³⁶ See *Lectiones Memorabiles* ..., i, 69–71. The inspiration for bringing both excerpts from the *Erithea* together into closer proximity was provided by Pürstinger himself. The first line of cap. 65, par. 5 reads *Uterius de quinto sextove statu ac de Turcarum incursu presumitur Sibylla dicere*. Against this placed in the right margin is the reference to cap. 45, par. 4.

³⁷ It must be noted, though, that while Sibylline material dominates the content of *Centenarius Tertius*, in terms of chronological placement the Sibyls and their prophecies are subordinated to Pseudo-Methodius; see Schmolinsky, ‘Prophetia in der Bibliothek’, 112–15.

³⁸ This is the *Erithea* from cap. 65 of the *Onus Ecclesiae*. Wolff’s heading represents a radically shortened version of the introductory paragraph in Pürstinger’s text (see Appendix III, Section I). The *Erithea* as it is represented in cap. 45, par. 4 of the *Onus* is introduced by Wolff under the heading ‘Uterius Sibylla in Nosilographus’ (p. 71). With exception of these headings, however, Wolff cites cap. 65 and cap. 45, par. 4 of Pürstinger’s *Onus Ecclesiae* faithfully, only inserting the line ‘illius, putà, qui scripsit Dominus Ecclesiae, cuius & est explicatio & glossa hujus vaticinii Sibyllini’ into the passage lifted from c. 45, par. 4 (see Appendix III, Section II, b).

³⁹ See Schmolinsky, ‘Prophetia in der Bibliothek’, 117.

⁴⁰ Cf. Reeves, *Influence*, 448.

⁴¹ See, for example, *SBE*, 65.

⁴² Bernard McGinn, ‘Teste David cum Sibylla: The Significance of the Sibylline Tradition in the Middle Ages’, in *Women of the Medieval World*, ed. Julius Kirshner and Suzanne F. Wemple (Oxford, 1985), 7–35; reprinted in id., *Apocalypticism in the Western Tradition*, Variorum Collected Studies Series 430 (Aldershot, 1994), provides an English-language overview over the antique and medieval tradition of Sibylline prophecy, as well as further bibliographical references.

⁴³ On the Roman use of the Sibyls, see *Sibyls and Sibylline Prophecy in Classical Antiquity*, ed. Herbert William Parke and Brian C. McGing (London, 1988).

⁴⁴ *Oracula Sibyllina* (Greek, with German translation), see J.-D. Gauger, *Sibyllinische Weissagungen. Griechisch/Deutsch (Oracula Sibyllina)* (Düsseldorf and Zurich, 1998). See also Arnaldo Momigliano, 'From the Pagan to the Christian Sibyl: Prophecy as History of Religion', in *The Uses of Greek and Latin*, ed. A.C. Dionisotti, Anthony Grafton, and Jill Kraye, Warburg Institute Surveys and Texts, 16 (London, 1988), 2–18.

⁴⁵ On the Sibyls in Jewish culture, see 'Sibyls and Sibylline Oracles', in *Encyclopaedia Judaica* 14 (Jerusalem, 1971), col. 1489–91.

⁴⁶ Dorothy F. Glass, 'Pseudo-Augustine, Prophets, and Pulpits in Campania', in *Studies on Art and Archeology in Honor of Ernst Kitzinger on His Seventy-fifth Birthday*, Dumbarton Oaks Papers, 41 (1987), 215–26. On the tradition of visual representation of the Sibyls in the Renaissance, see Wolfgang Augustyn, 'Zur Bildüberlieferung der Sibyllen in Italien zwischen 1450 und 1550', in *Zukunftsvoraussagen*, ed. Ludwig Bergdolt, 365–434.

⁴⁷ For examples of the kind of intricacies of theological debate in which the prophecy of Sibyls played a part, see McGinn, 'Teste David' and Prümm, 'Das Prophetenamt der Sibyllen II'.

⁴⁸ Cf. Appendix II, which lists a small selection of works (by an international group of authors) which contributed to this critical discussion.

⁴⁹ See, for example, Richard Bentley's mockery of those 'men of elegant judgement who revere the oracles commonly ascribed to the Sibyl as the real effusions of that prophetic old lady, Noah's daughter' in his *Epistola ad Millium* of 1691, as cited in Anthony Grafton, *Forgers and Critics: Creativity and Duplicity in Western Scholarship* (Princeton, 1990), 73.

⁵⁰ To date, the most comprehensive treatment of the early modern tracts on the prophecies of the Sibyls is still that provided by Prümm, 'Das Prophetenamt der Sibyllen [...] III. Die Echtheitskontroverse und ihre Nachwirkung'. Prümm's account is useful in that it provides brief summaries of distinct aspects of the works of a large number of the individuals who contributed to the early modern debate about the Sibyls. It achieves little, however, in charting the debate's progress in relation to intellectual currents other than those tied up with the process of confessionalization.

⁵¹ See Anthony Grafton, 'The Strange Death of Hermes and the Sibyls', in id., *Defenders of the Text: The Traditions of Scholarship in an Age of Science, 1450–1800* (Cambridge, Mass., and London, 1991), 162–77. There has also been some discussion of a seventeenth-century contributor to the debate, Isaac Vossius: see David S. Katz, 'Isaac Vossius and the English biblical critics 1650–1689', in *Scepticism and Irreligion in the Seventeenth and Eighteenth Centuries*, ed. Richard H. Popkin and Arjo Vanderjagt (Leiden, 1992), 142–84.

⁵² Editions of their works are cited in Appendix II. On Castellio, see Herbert Jaumann, *Handbuch der Gelehrtenkultur der frühen Neuzeit, Band 1: Biobibliographisches Repertorium* (Berlin and New York, 2004), 170–71. On Panvinio, see Nancy G. Siraisi, 'History, Antiquarianism and Medicine: The Case of Girolamo Mercuriale', in *Journal of the History of Ideas*, 64/2 (2003), 233.

⁵³ This was, for instance, Johannes Opsopaeus's conclusion; see Grafton, *Forgers and critics*, 94. Opsopoeus' edition of the *Oracula Sibyllina* is cited in Appendix II.

⁵⁴ David Blondel, *Des Sibylles célébrées tant par l'antiquité payenne, que par les Saints Pères* (Charenton, 1649), translated into English by John Davies (London, 1661) and available on *Early English Books Online*.

⁵⁵ This is discussed in Katz, 'Isaac Vossius'.

⁵⁶ François Laplanche, 'Die Kirchen und die Kultur des 17. Jahrhunderts', in *Die Geschichte des Christentums. Religion, Politik, Kultur. Band 9: Das Zeitalter der Vernunft (1620/30–1750)*, ed. Norbert Brox, Odilo Engels, Georg Kretschmer, Kurt Meier, and Herbert Smolinsky (Freiburg/Breisgau, 1998), 939, n. 15 and 948–51.

⁵⁷ See Katz, 'Isaac Vossius', 153.

⁵⁸ The view of Sibylline prophecy as deceits by Satan was expressed, for example, by Tobias Wagner, a Protestant theologian at the University of Tübingen, in his *Inquisitio in Oracula Sibyllarum de Christo occasione orationis anno 1662 ... habitae, per annotationes varias institute a Tobia Wagnero, Ecclesiae Tubingensis Praepositio et Universitatis Cancellario* (Tübingen, 1664); see Prümm, 'Das Prophetenamt der Sibyllen [...] III. Die Echtheitskontroverse und ihre Nachwirkung', 510–11.

⁵⁹ It should be noted that Vossius' interest in the Sibylline heritage extended beyond the corpus of the Greek *Oracula Sibyllina* and included medieval Sibylline creations such as the text known as *Sibylla Tiburtina*; see his medieval copy of the text, now housed in the library of the University of Leiden, as MS Vossius codices Latini Q69.

⁶⁰ *Isaac Vossii de sibyllinis aliisque quae Christi natalem praecesserunt oraculis accedit eiusdem responsio ad objectiones nuperae criticae sacrae* (Oxford, 1679). For a contemporary response, see that of Richard Simon (1638–1712), which was translated into English and published in 1684 as *Critical enquiries into the various editions of the Bible. Together with Animadversions upon a small treatise of Dr Issac Vossius; concerning the oracles of the Sibylls. And an answer to the objections of the late critica sacra* (Written originally in Latin, by Father Simon, transl. into English by N.S.) (London, 1684).

⁶¹ Prümm ('Das Prophetenamt der Sibyllen III', 504) calls Blondel's work a 'konfessionelle Kampfschrift'.

⁶² On the emergence of the discipline of comparative religion, see Jan Assman et al., *Das 17. Jahrhundert und die Ursprünge der Religionsgeschichte*, Archiv für Reformationsgeschichte 3 (Munich and Leipzig, 2001) and Arnaldo Momigliano, 'Ancient History and the Antiquarian', *Journal of the Warburg and Courtauld Institutes*, 13 (1950), 308–9.

⁶³ This discussion of Clasen's intellectual profile considers specifically his scholarly interests. For an appraisal of other aspects of Clasen's outlook, especially on matters of religion and the state, see Martin Mulsow, *Moderne aus dem Untergrund. Radikale Frühaufklärung in Deutschland 1680–1720* (Hamburg, 2002), 215–23.

⁶⁴ Rolf Volkmann, *Die Universität Helmstedt und die Epochen ihrer Geschichte* (Braunschweig, 1976).

⁶⁵ This particular theological outlook ('Calixtinism') predominated at Helmstedt in the period 1624–1700; see Inge Mager, 'Helmstedt, Universität' in *TRE 15* (Berlin and New York, 1986), 35–9, which includes an extensive bibliography on Helmstedt in the context of its broader intellectual and political milieu. See also Johannes Wallmann, 'Calixt', in *TRE 7* (Berlin and New York, 1981), 552–9; Hermann Schüssler, *Georg Calixt: Theologie und Kirchenpolitik: Eine Studie zur Ökumenizität des Luthertums* (Wiesbaden, 1961), and Benjamin J. Kaplan, 'Coexistence, Conflict and the Practice of Toleration', in *A Companion to the Reformation World*, ed. Ronnie Po-chia Hsia (Oxford, 2004), 486–505.

⁶⁶ This information is derived from the multiple entries for Clasen in *DBA I*, microfiche no. 192, microfiche fields 119–35 and *DBA III*, microfiche no. 147, microfiche field 4003.

⁶⁷ See Johann Friedrich Jugler, *Beyträge zur juristischen Biographie*, vol. 2 (Leipzig, 1775), as cited in *DBA I*, microfiche no. 192, microfiche fields 123–4.

⁶⁸ See Jugler, *Beyträge*, as cited in *DBA I*, microfiche no. 192, microfiche field 130.

⁶⁹ Clasen's private library concerned mostly theology and jurisprudence. We know its content from the catalogue that was produced when it was auctioned on 23 April 1679 after Clasen's death in 1678; see *Bibliotheca Claseniana hoc est catalogus ... librorum ... qui publice distrahentur Initium ... 23. Apr.* (Helmstedt, 1679). For a discussion of this catalogue and the library behind it, see Hans Dieter Gebauer, *Bücherauktionen in Deutschland im 17. Jahrhundert*, Bonner Beiträge zur

Bibliotheks- und Bücherkunde 28 (Bonn, 1981), 64, 103, 177, and 143 (A9) and Heidi Mecke, *Vorbesitzer-Eintragungen im Bestand der ehemaligen Universitätsbibliothek Helmstedt. Provenienzkatalog mit Kurzbiographien. Diplomarbeit im Studiengang Bibliothekswesen an der Fachhochschule Hannover* (Hannover, 1991), 81–2.

⁷⁰ See Appendix I. Twenty-one titles might seem a small number considering the overall size of Clasen's library, but the significance of the library's holdings in the fields of Hebraic and Oriental Studies/Comparative religions has to be assessed against the fact that Clasen's library was that of a working scholar, that is, it had to support primarily his university teaching in the fields of Jurisprudence and Practical Ethics.

⁷¹ In the seventeenth century it had become increasingly apparent that the study of the *antiquitates sacrae* based on the command of Oriental languages and history were necessary to pursue the question whether some pagans had known the truth independently of Jewish and Christian religion; see Momigliano, 'Ancient History', 308–9.

⁷² On Clasen's lack of an original and independent approach, see also Prümm, 'Das Prophetenamt der Sibyllen III', 511.

⁷³ I have retained the spelling, capitalization, and italics as they can be found on the 1661 title-page.

⁷⁴ Chapter XX carries the title 'De Judiciis & argumentis eorum, a quibus carmina Sibyllina habeantur pro supposititiis'.

⁷⁵ The entry for this work in the auction catalogue of Clasen's private library (*Bibliotheca Claseniana*) is: '122. Q171 David Blondelle des Sibylle. à Chareton 649'.

⁷⁶ The only comment which Clasen makes appears in the lines with which he introduces the text, namely 'I can do nothing but [non possum, quin] report here the prophecy of the Sibyllae Erythraeae about the seven ages of the church which Iohannes, bishop of Chiemsee shows in the book to which he gave the title ONUS ECCLESIAE; that is [utpote], in which <book> he refers to the prophecies of the Sibyllae Erythrae, which are kept in Venice in the library of St Gregory the Great. That prophecy, which follows, is copied from Wolf's Wolfii Centenario.3. fol. 54. & 55. Memorabil. where the Sibylla, in her No-zilo-grapho said thus:' [For the Latin text, see Appendix III, Section I]. Clasen's comment that he can do no more than cite the text reads like an admission that (unlike in the case of the *Sibylla Tiburtina*) he was not able to cross-reference this text (including its attribution to the *Basilographo* and the journey of its transmission into Latin via Greek) with information provided by genuinely ancient sources on this Sibyl.

⁷⁷ See Appendix III, Section I. In this context it must be noted that the reference to the Venetian manuscript in Clasen's introductory comments on the *Sibilla Erithea Babilonica* is derivative. This manuscript is already referred to both by Wolf and Pürstinger. It must be noted that the reference to the Venetian manuscript is already present in the early sixteenth-century printed text of the medieval *Erithea* instigated by Silvestro Meuccio who, between 1516 and 1527, had taken up the task of publishing the works of Joachim of Fiore, see Reeves, *Influence*, 262. The *Erithea* was included in the volume *Expositio magni prophete Joachim: in librum beati Cirilli de magnis tribulationibus ... statu sancte matris ecclesie: ab hiis nostris temporibus usque in finem seculi; una cum compilatione ex diversis prophetis novi ac veteris testamenti Thelosphori de Cusentia: presbyteri ... heremite* (Venice, 1516; from the press of Lazaro de Soardis), see *SBE*, 490. It must further be noted that Pürstinger's text hardly deviates from the text printed in Venice in 1516. On Pürstinger's use of this edition, see Werner, *Flugschrift*, 58.

⁷⁸ See Appendix III, Section I, which shows that Pürstinger retains (in similar form) the attribution of the prophecy to the Erythraean Sibyl which can be found in the thirteenth-century text, together with the reference to the 'Nazilographo' (the Greek imperial scriptures) as the ancient written source of the predictions. However, Pürstinger omits the thirteenth-century references to the various translations and translators of the text.

⁷⁹ The version of the *Tiburtina* considered here is the Bedan recension, which is printed among the *spuria* of Bede (see *PL* 90, col. 1181–6), and in Godfrey of Viterbo, *Pantheon*, ed. Georg Waitz, *Monumenta Germaniae Historica, Scriptores* 22 (Hannover, 1872), 145–7.

⁸⁰ This summary stresses the common features of the *Erithrea* and the *Tiburtina*, but there are, of course, also differences – for instance, the *Tiburtina* does not use animal names to encrypt her predictions and contains a passage known as the Sibylline Gospel, which brings the text into close proximity with a narrative known as *Vos inquam* that was used in the liturgy; see Anke Holdenried, *The Sibyl and Her Scribes: Manuscripts and Interpretation of the Latin Tiburtina c. 1050–1500* (Aldershot, 2006), 61–2 and 118–21. These differences, however, have no bearing on our understanding of Clasen’s approach to the two prophecies.

⁸¹ See Clasen, *De oraculis gentilium*, 621: ‘Decima in ordine Sibillarum à Varrone et Lactantio collocatur Sibylla, quae Tiburtina appellata est ab urbe Tibure ad Anienem fluvium sita, quaeque hodie vocatur Tivoli...’.

⁸² See *ibid.*, 622.

⁸³ See *ibid.*, 624 (text in italics is that lifted from the *Tiburtina* [my italics]) : ‘Gotheфридус Viterbiensis part. 10 Chronici fol. 214 apud Pistor. par. 2. 2 Historic. German. fol. 214 scribit de hujus Sibyllae nativitate sequentia. *Fuit igitur, inquit, haec Sibylla Priami Regis filia et ex matre Hecuba procreata: vocata est autem in Graeco Tiburtina; Latine vero Albunea nomine vel Cassandra: et illa circumiens diversas provincias ac partes orbis praedicavit per Assiam [...]. In omnes hisce provinciis bonis bona, mali mala. Scimus namque quae in praeconiis suis annuntiavit, ... quae in novissimis erant Ventura praedixit*’ (cf. *PL* 80, col. 1181B–1181C).

⁸⁴ See Clasen, *De oraculis gentilium*, 624–6.

⁸⁵ See *ibid.*, 628. The oldest version of the *Ara Caeli* legend is in the Chronicle of the sixth-century writer John Malalas; it also survives in the *Gesta Romanorum*, in the *Mirabilia urbis Romae*, the *Golden Legend*, and in other works, cf. M.F. Smith, *Wisdom and Personification of Wisdom in Middle English Literature before 1500* (Washington, DC, 1935), 73–4. The legend was also used as an exemplum – see, for example, *Liber exemplorum ad usum praedicatorum*, ed. A.G. Litde, British Society of Franciscan Studies I, xiii (Aberdeen, 1908).

⁸⁶ See Clasen, *De oraculis gentilium*, 630–31 (text in italics is that lifted from the *Tiburtina* [my italics]) : ‘Romani publica, quae de hac Sibylla extabat passim commoti fama dicuntur earn ad se accersivisse, ... in suam civitatem magnâ pompâ& solemnitate deduxisse, ubi postea centum senatu viris somnium de novem solibus, quod una eadem nocte habuisse dixerunt, in monte Appenino interpretata est. Rem totam, (sed cuius fide, divinare nequeo) persequitur Gothofredus Viterbiensis par. x. fol. 214 ... 215 in Tom. 2. script. res. Germanic. Pistorii. Verba ita se habent. *Audientes igitur famam eius Romani statim nunciaverunt in conspectu senatorum. Mittens ergo senatores legatos ad eam [...] Nonus autem sol, nova generatio est: exurgent principes Romani in perditione multorum et &c.*’ (cf. *PL* 90, col. 1181C–1183C).

⁸⁷ See Clasen, *De oraculis gentilium*, 631 – 2.

⁸⁸ For the text of the *Tiburtina* which Clasen omits, see *PL* 90, col. 1183C–1186C, *inc.*: ‘Tunc exsurgent duo reges de Syria’; *expl.*: ‘et regnabit Dominus cum Sanctis in saecula saeculorum. Amen’.

⁸⁹ See Appendix III, Section I.

⁹⁰ In singling out these criteria I have drawn in particular on Arnaldo Momigliano, *Ancient History and the Antiquarian*, 286–8. To gain a fuller appreciation of the many facets of antiquarianism, see *Ancient History and the Antiquarian: Essays in Memory of Arnaldo Momigliano*, ed. M.H. Crawford and C.R. Logota, Warburg Institute Colloquia, 2 (London, 1995) and Graham Parry, *The Trophies of Time: English Antiquarians of the Seventeenth Century* (Oxford, 1995).

⁹¹ This approach to collecting information on the Sibyls is qualitatively different from that adopted some seventy years earlier by Johannes Wolff. As discussed by Schmolinsky ('Prophetia in der Bibliothek', 104–10), Wolff compiles material from different sources in the spirit of a tradition which is exemplified by Matthias Flacius Illyricus (1520–75).

⁹² Robert Lerner (*Powers of Prophecy*, 181) remarked that 'only around 1700 did learned antiquarians stop gathering and poring over "ancient prophecies" [...] a new sense of historical perspective made it clear that old documents had to be read as products of their times: details in old prophecies no longer could be applied anachronistically to current situations.' On the seventeenth century as a period of transformation, see Laplanche, 'Kirchen und die Kultur des 17. Jahrhunderts', 933–86 and Andrew C. Fix, *Prophecy and Reason: The Dutch Collegiants in the Early Enlightenment* (Princeton and Oxford, 1991), 4. As Fix himself acknowledges (Fix, *Prophecy*, 3–22 and 247–56), this transformation took place over an extended period of time and its causes were naturally complex. It must also be remembered that different types of prophecy were affected at different paces – see the discussions assembled in *Im Zeichen der Krise. Religiosität im Europa des 17. Jahrhunderts*, ed. Hartmut Lehmann and Anne-Charlott Trepp, Veröffentlichungen des Max-Planck-Instituts für Geschichte 152 (Göttingen, 1999). Further valuable observations on the rise, diversification, and decline of western Europe's superstitious customs and beliefs are provided by Euan Cameron, *Enchanted Europe. Superstition, Reason, and Religion, 1250–1750* (Oxford 2010).

⁹³ Sibyls appeared frequently not only in the works of Early Christian writers but also in other texts which the Middle Ages inherited from classical antiquity such as Virgil's *Eclogues* (*Ecl.* 4.4–10) or the geographical work *Collectanea rerum memorabilium* by the third-century author Solinus. See Virgil, *Eclogues. Georgics. Aeneid 1–6*, trans. H. Rushton Fairclough, Loeb Classical Library 63 (rev. edn 1935, repr. Cambridge, Mass., 1978), and *C. Iulii Solinii Collectanea rerum memorabilium*, ed. T. Mommsen (Berlin, 1864), 38, l. 14 and l. 22; 39, l. 1; 54, l. 3.) In some of these works, the pagan prophetess is given a name. In others she is only referred to generically as 'Sibyl'. Often details of her exploits are given which cannot be cross-referenced to another text.

⁹⁴ Lactantius, *Divinae Institutiones*, lib. i, cap. 6, CSEL 19/1, 20–25.

⁹⁵ Hrabanus Maurus, *De Universo*, PL 111, col. 420–22.

⁹⁶ See Holdenried, *Sibyl and Her Scribes*, 59.

⁹⁷ See *ibid.*, esp. 93–130.

⁹⁸ See *SBE*, 55.

⁹⁹ See *SBE*, 68 and 493–5 (Table 'Kontexte').

¹⁰⁰ For full details, see the manuscript descriptions which Jostmann provides for manuscripts no. 4, 16; 17, 20, 32, 34, 40, 52, 55, 56, 57 in his table 'Kontexte'; see *SBE*, 493–5.

¹⁰¹ The manuscript survives as Verona, Biblioteca Civica, MS 2845, with the *Erithea* on fol. IIV–XXXIr. Feliciano's intellectual profile and literary activity have been considered by Charles Mitchell, 'Felice Feliciano *Antiquarius*', *Proceedings of the British Academy*, 47 (1961), 197–221. For further literature on Feliciano and this manuscript, see *SBE*, 487.

¹⁰² That Feliciano himself did not add the verses from Ovid's *Metamorphoses* to the *Erithea* is clear from the fact that they already accompany the *Erithea* in two fourteenth-century manuscripts; see *SBE*, 46.

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